

Language as Evidence: A Discourse Semantic and Corpus Linguistic Approach to Examining Written Terrorist Threatening Communication

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Publication Date:

2022

DOI:

<https://doi.org/10.26190/unsworks/24434>

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Language as Evidence:

A Discourse Semantic and Corpus Linguistic Approach to Examining Written
Terrorist Threatening Communication

Awni Etaywe

A thesis submitted in fulfilment of the requirements for the degree of Doctor of
Philosophy

School of the Arts and Media
Faculty of Arts, Design and Architecture

2022

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Etaywe and Zappavigna (2021) emerged from the findings of the first research question conducted on OBL's texts as a case study. It specifically describes how the exploration of discursive patterns of authorial identity offers a diagnostic for a terrorist's personal and relational identities, which are performatively produced or constituted by repeated, attitudinally loaded lexical items. In this publication, a system and structure approach (i.e., paradigmatic and syntagmatic, features-based approach) and value parameter-based approach were applied. The analytical procedures undertaken in this publication are elaborated in Chapter 4, Section 4.4.3.2, and the findings of this analysis relating to the four terrorists are provided in Chapter 5, Section 5.4.

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ABSTRACT

This thesis contributes to the growing international commitment to countering transnational terrorism. It undertakes an empirical investigation of the language of violent extremism by using a forensic linguistic lens, innovatively combined with the Appraisal and Affiliation frameworks from Systemic Functional Linguistics. These frameworks offer tools for understanding the discursive nature of the language of extremism, including how terrorists attempt to incite violence and threaten their audiences through their evaluative language, and how they position key social bonds in their discourse. The study involved a specialised corpus of 20 terrorist public statements produced by four terrorists from two of the most lethal, transnational terrorist ideologies: jihadism and far-right extremism. The aim was to explore the patterns of a set of discursive features that mark a violent extremist's language and to investigate two aspects of threat – or alternatively alarming, aggrieving and intimidating content – in these statements: incitement to violence and communicated threats. The forensic findings regarding the authors' features that mark their extremist language showed relatively frequent discursive themes, conceptual burstiness, and repeated, attitudinally loaded lexical items. The authors' 'appraisal signature' (i.e. evaluative style) revealed their underlying ideological schemas, moral reasoning, and enactment of (dis)affiliation when inciting violence and expressing threats.

The analysis of the incitement texts identified two main affiliation strategies: COMMUNION, aimed at forging alignments around shared bonds with potential incitees, and ALIENATION, aimed at legitimating disalignments with negatively evaluated outgroups. In the threat texts the disaffiliation strategies identified had three discursive functions: ethical manipulation, deontic retribution, and the boulomaic function. The mixed method approach adopted in this study has the key benefit of enhancing our understanding of the attitudinal and moral positioning that occurs in terrorist incitement and threat texts. It also has a number of potential applied uses in establishing suspect engagement in terrorist activity, classifying terrorist texts, terrorism justification, and providing a diagnostic for examining the performance of personal and relational identities.

Keywords: forensic linguistics, violent extremist discourse, appraisal, (dis)affiliation, threat text, incitement to violence, morality of terrorism

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

This thesis is a social achievement which would never have been possible without the support of a number of people who have buttressed and propelled me forward over the course of my candidature. First, I would like to offer my sincere gratitude to my supervisor, Michele Zappavigna, whose insight, generosity, constant encouragement and challenging of my writing have been invaluable. Beyond innumerable suggestions, edits and constructive feedback for the research itself, Michele is a great mentor and role model of how excellence in academia need be maintained while paying attention to life-health-work-research balance. Michele's guidance on academic writing and teaching is lifelong impactful. She has provided me with many outlets for my academic growth, learning, teaching, presenting in international conferences, and collaboratively producing research articles. These possibilities have, first, enabled me to make my mark in the academic world as an enthusiastic participant in both the forensic linguistics and Systemic Functional Linguistics research, and, second created many occasions for pride and celebration.

The broader Sydney SFL community have also been a source of stimulation. From Theo Van Leeuwen, who first suggested I contribute to research into the language of incitement and radicalisation to violence, to Peter White, who trained me on the Appraisal framework, and finally to James Martin, Sue Hood and Yaegan Doran, who gave valuable observations on the presentation of my findings every time I presented my chapters in the SFL PhD seminars, I benefitted from their support and their tutelage was incredibly rewarding. Over the course of the thesis' evolution, my secondary supervisor Peter White has offered productive feedback on draft chapters. My reader Paul Ryder has also provided constructive comments and suggested a reading list in discourse analysis that has been crucial in complementing my approach. My peers from SFL-oriented PhD candidates have also offered appreciated remarks on work presented in the SFL seminars at the University of Sydney over three years and on work prepared for annual progress reviews at the University of New South Wales. Lorenzo Logi and Nataliia Laba have been insightful with their engagement and sharing their thoughts.

Among my connections in the field of forensic linguistics, I am very appreciative of the early advice, on my PhD proposal, by Georgina Heydon. Georgina praised my early plan to focus on threat texts as communicated by terrorists. She was also generous to suggest the inclusion of

a computational or statistical analysis phase in my project before I engage with discourse analysis work. Carole Chaski's suggestions on the importance of focus of the computational analysis on the elements of extremism, and her commentary on the need to present the findings of LIWC-based content analysis separately from the findings of the conceptual burstiness analysis, have also been productive.

At home, the patience, support and care of my wife, Shurouq, and my children, Hala, Mohammad, Yara and Rayan, have sustained me in moments of distress and illness. Without their support the journey would have been enormously more stressful. I am also grateful to my brother, Adnan, who has never questioned my determination and academic dream. Sincere thanks to him and to my sisters for giving me their encouragement and unconditional love while overseas and for staying connected and reminding me to relax at times of fatigue. Last but not least, my endless love and prayers go to my late father whose voice of inspiration was missed during this journey despite the presence of his soul and heritage of appreciation of scholarly work.

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CHAPTER ONE: INTRODUCTION

This thesis aims to empirically investigate, using a forensic linguistic lens, terrorist public statements (hereafter, TPSs), as threatening communication. Intimidation, vilification, group defamation, extortion, victim dehumanisation, violence legitimisation, radicalisation and recruitment, incitement to violence, and communicated threats are all examples of illegal practices that are involved in terrorist communication (see e.g. Miller, 1987; Schmid, 2013; Tsesis, 2002, 2013, 2017). Prosecution of these practices, thus, requires successful study of these practices and an investigation into not only clues to suspicion of a terrorist activity but also robust evidence that is useful for the criminal trial of violent extremists (e.g. Shuy, 2010). The field of forensic linguistics is becoming crucial in developing mechanisms for understanding national, international, and cyber terrorism (Shuy, 2021). However, there is much work to be done in order to understand the complex discourses which terrorists leverage in order to enact their social goals. This thesis contributes to understanding terrorist discourse as a contribution to the growing international commitment to fighting crime, counterterrorism and improving the delivery of justice.

This study explores features of the language of terrorism and the discursive nature of two primary aspects of terrorist communication: communicated threats and incitement to violence. These are two social, discursive practices enacted by terrorists in real world terrorism cases. In investigating the language of these two terrorist crimes, this thesis focuses on how terrorists view and evaluate the world in their texts, and how they construct membership and affiliations with communities of values, in opposition to unshared values. In particular, this thesis demonstrates that: (i) the language of transnational terrorism exhibits relatively frequent features in its extremist discourse; and (ii) the appraisal signature (i.e. evaluative style) of a terrorist reveals the values underlying the affiliation strategies they use. Two main strategies are explored in detail: ‘threatener-threatened’ disalignment; and ‘inciter-incitee’ alignment, including their disalignment with the ‘incited-against’ social groups. These concerns are explored in a method that combines forensic linguistics approaches to authorship with the affordances of corpus linguistic methods and discourse analysis tools from Systemic Functional Linguistics (hereafter, SFL) (e.g. Halliday, 1978; Martin, 1992). The authorship analysis undertaken in this thesis incorporated two tasks. The first is the analysis

of the discursive patterns of authorial identity and style. The second involves criminal profiling tasks, that is, criminal investigative analysis used to explore motives for crimes and argumentation strategies (see e.g. Shuy, 1993; Smith & Shuy, 2002).

This chapter presents an introduction to the thesis. The chapter begins in Section 1.1 by presenting terrorist statements as a valid site for investigation. The key definitions that are used in this thesis, of terrorism, text, communicated threat, and incitement, are also provided. Section 1.2 then explains the need for more work on terrorist public statements within forensic linguistics. The aims of the study and research questions are outlined in Section 1.3, followed by the significance of the research in Section 1.4. The chapter then introduces, in Section 1.5, the terrorists whose specific data were collected and analysed for the thesis, as well as their ideologies. The chapter concludes in Section 1.6 by presenting the scope and structure of this thesis.

1.1 Background: Terrorism and terrorist public statements as site of investigation

Coined in the 1790s to describe the ‘legalised’ measure that the French Revolutionary government used against its opponents, the term ‘terrorism’ (La Terreur) has since been used extensively to refer to violent activity by extremists. The term describes the practices of creating a climate of fear and achieving specific goals by state institutions, political organisations, ethnonationalist rightist and leftist groups, and religious groups (Jenkins, 2020). Prior to 2001, the focus of academic research on terrorism was on domestic terrorist groups such as the Kurdistan Workers Party’s (or PKK) campaigns to force Turkey to accept Kurd autonomy (Pape, 2003). The era following the September 11 terrorist attacks on the USA in 2001 (hereafter, the 9/11 attacks) has seen a change in international focus in terms of: (i) prioritisation of a counterterrorism agenda by security and law enforcement agencies worldwide (see e.g. Shuy, 2010); and (ii) the shift in focus of international security towards transnational terrorism and its motivations (Smith & Zeigler, 2017; United Nations, 2018). This thesis is aligned with this international, legal and security commitment to understanding and countering transnational terrorism, through examining its discourse.

In the post 9/11 era, the world entered a new state of long war, often named the ‘global war on terror’ (Buzan, 2006). This war became the central principle organizing US foreign and defence policy (Daalder & Lindsay, 2001), leading US President George W. Bush to declare it

a “crusade”, “a war of ideas”, and “a war in arms” in which nations around the world were polarised as either with or against America (Ray, 2017, p. 12). As such, far from uniting humanity, the war on terror and its aftermath created greater distrust between the West and Muslim majority countries, particularly for the United States of America. Muslims experienced sustained islamophobia, an increase in hate crimes, and the fallout of the militarization of America’s foreign policy, which yielded even more dramatic trends in hostility and hate discourses (Miller, 2015). This US-coalition-versus-‘Others’ polarization has been accompanied by reconceptualization of the construct of terrorism that is, the US administration’s and their protagonists’ ideological reconceptualization of reality within a ‘good We’ versus ‘evil They’ paradigm, to condemn ‘Others’ and to persuade audiences to accept the US policy as ‘legitimate’ behaviour (Bhatia, 2009). In addition, media has tended to focus on the jihadist brand of terrorism, while far-right terrorism is “more likely to be overlooked or tolerated by Western polities” (Corbin, 2017, p. 483; Atran, 2019). Consequently, transnational terrorism, and the ensuing new global order (Pearlstein, 2004), have contributed to different understandings of and approaches to terrorism. However, terrorists of different sociocultural backgrounds may draw on similar versions of ‘jihadist’ struggle that constructs violence as a moral virtue (FBI Counterterrorism Division [FBICD], 2008; Atran, 2019).

This thesis draws attention to the discourses of terrorists of both jihadist and far-right ideologies who: (i) tend to operate – in Atran’s (2019) terms – as a ‘deadly duet’ and (ii) present these as the two most lethal extremists and ideologies worldwide (Global Terrorism Index [GTI], 2020). This thesis also responds to the changing threat landscape of terrorism and its motivations and categorisation (US National Institute of Justice, 2022). In addition, the thesis responds to the deterioration in the overall global level of peace, which continues in different regions of the world, and to the impact of terrorism, which remains the indicator with the largest annual increase and continues to dominate the global agenda of sustainable development (see Global Peace Index, 2019). The heavy economic cost of terrorism amounted to USD 26.4 billion in 2019, excluding the indirect impacts on business and investment, lost opportunities, and the costs associated with security agencies countering terrorism (GTI, 2020).

1.1.1 Defining terrorism and terrorist threatening communication

For the purpose of this thesis, terrorist acts are considered a set of criminal acts (Jenkins, 2020; Shuy, 2021). The term terrorism is taken to refer to illegal practices employed strategically by non-state actors to create a climate of fear and intimidation to help advance their political, national, racial, ethnic and/or religious causes (see Pearlstein, 2004; Whittaker, 2005; Lutz & Lutz, 2008; Smith, 2018; Malešević, 2019; UK National Archive, 2019). In this thesis, a linguistic examination of texts by terrorists coming from the most lethal ideologies is undertaken to help better understand terrorist discursive practices, and as a step towards fighting illegal phenomena involved in terrorist communication, namely: incitement to violence, and communicated threats.

In the laws of many countries of common law jurisdictions (e.g. United States, United Kingdom, Canada and Australia) and continental law jurisdictions (e.g. Germany, the Netherlands, France, Italy and Spain), terrorist communication is considered part of a terrorist's behaviour and is punishable by law. For example, the Ministry of Justice and Security of the Government of the Netherlands considers terrorist texts to be one of the grave aspects of the terrorist threats, such as inciting violence, being "sources of [negative] ideological inspiration" and communicating threats to people or institutions (Government of Netherlands, 2020). However, little is known in forensic linguistics about how terrorists incite or communicate threats. This thesis concerns itself with one type of terrorist communication: terrorist public statements. It forensically examines two main aspects of threat or risk in this communication: communicated threats, and incitement to violent acts. In both cases, language can serve as a primary indicator of risk (i.e. harm or danger) communicated or encouraged by a terrorist. Both aspects of risk in terrorist public statements involve hostility-laden and politically, racially and religiously aggravated crimes (see e.g. Culpeper, Iganski & Sweiry, 2017; Owusu-Bempah & Wiedlitzka, 2019) in the analysed public statements. The following definitions are used in this thesis:

- **Communicated threat:** a "verbalized, written, or electronically transmitted message that states or suggest potential harm to the recipient, someone or something associated with recipient, or specified or non-specified other individuals" (Rugala & Fitzgerald, 2003, p. 778). The threat message is

“delivered to targets/victims or agents acting on their behalf” (Smith, 2008, p. 106).

- **Incitement:** language designed to persuade, arouse, compel, urge and/or encourage those addressed to commit violence against outgroups (Kurzon, 1998; Gordon, 2018; Jaconelli, 2018).

1.1.2 Terrorist public statements as a site of investigation

TPSs, or ‘manifestos’, are taken as one example of terrorist communication that present a potentially valuable source of robust intelligence if analysed appropriately (Miller, 1987; Smith, 2004). TPSs offer a site for investigating a set of criminal acts and – in Bourdieu’s (1991, pp. 8/66) terms – a “relatively durable set of [inter-group] social relations” where linguistic resources and their functions are “capable of procuring a certain material or symbolic profit” for terrorist groups. Given the coercive power of terrorists and their institutions, their discourse also “represents a site for the (re)articulation of ideology and the legitimization of ([...] harmful) social action” (Hart, 2014, p. 5). Terrorist texts and language use are taken, in Verschueren’s terms (2012, p. 17), as “the most visible manifestation of [a terrorist] ideology” which can be tracked in any “**pattern of meaning or frame of interpretation** bearing on or involved in (an) aspect(s) of social ‘reality’ (in particular in the realm of social interactions in the public sphere), felt to be **commonsensical, and often functioning in a normative way**” (Verschueren, 2012, p. 10, emphasis added). In this thesis, the term ideology is also used to describe “the way in which what we say and think **interacts with society**”, whereby ideology “derives from the taken-for-granted **assumptions, beliefs and value systems which are shared** collectively by social groups” (Simpson, 1993, p. 5, emphasis added).

By concerning itself with the language of TPSs, this thesis aims to showcase investigation of evidence: of authors’ engagement in terrorism; and of the two primary language crimes involved in terrorist public statements. These public statements are broadly referred to, in this thesis, as terrorist ‘threatening communication’, since they encompass instances of both: (i) threats ‘communicated’ against victims; and (ii) threats ‘constructed’ to mobilize and incite adherents to a particular ideology for violence against outgroups (Etaywe & Zappavigna, 2021, p. 75). Terrorist statements are considered threatening in the sense of involving alarming, irritating, aggrieving and/or intimidating content.

Unlike other incriminating, one-to-one text types, these terrorist texts, as terrorist acts, are characterised by publicity (Olsson, 2008, p. 145) and are directed at a wide range of audiences. These audiences include enemy societies, host societies, potential recruits, internal audiences within the terrorist organisation, and the audience of world opinion (see e.g. Smelser & Mitchell, 2001, pp. 16-20). In addition, analogizing with Buzan's (1983, p. 57) view of aspects of threats targeting a state, terrorist statements involve two forms of threat: the first is 'threat by capabilities' (i.e. a terrorist's intentions and capacity to harm); and the second is 'threat by ideology', which is under-researched in forensic linguistics, particularly in terms of how terrorist discourse serves to incite people into radical social networks (see e.g. Horgan, 2014; Mandel, 2015). The construction and promotion of violent ideology and ideological networks can be achieved through the means of negotiating social norms and values – an area that is under-explored in forensic linguistic research and one that "law enforcement generally ignores" (Atran, 2015, p. 5, 2011). While forming these ideological networks, terrorists tend to stress the 'morality' of their atrocious acts. Nevertheless, the moral elements motivating terrorism still require further linguistic research to develop a better understanding of what has been referred to as "the morality of terrorism" (Seto, 2002, p. 1227). This thesis responds to this increasing need to understand terrorist discourse in terms of how it generates fear, conflict, and social and action networks, and the moral motivations that stand behind terrorist language crimes.

1.2 A forensic linguistic turn in the analysis of terrorists' language and communication

Linguistic studies of terrorist discourse have provided essential insights into terrorist discourse production and consumption (see e.g. Hodges & Nilep, 2007; Brookes & McEnery, 2020). Having said that, the growing international commitment to counterterrorism has been accompanied by relatively limited forensic linguistic research into terrorism, and little investigating the nature of language used in public statements. Obtaining forensic linguistic insights into the language of terrorism is important for prosecution and for the work of intelligence analysts in order for them to successfully investigate illegal intentions. Failure to consider forensic linguistic contributions to evidence means that prosecution can "easily go awry" (Shuy, 2010, p. 561, 2021).

To support these legal and intelligence efforts, the language of terrorist public statements is taken as a crucial resource of semiotic clues for forensic scientists engaged in investigating terrorist texts. There remains, however, a significant lack of understanding of the discursive nature of inciting language, and a lack of agreement as to how terrorists successfully threaten in these texts. I argue that the terrorist statements analysed in this thesis: (i) are a site of language employed for negotiating relations of power and dominance; (ii) are implicated in real-life terrorist contexts; (iii) comprise language crimes; and (iv) are, thus, considered “forensic texts” (see Olsson, 2008, p. 1). A terrorist forensic text in this thesis is viewed as being a semantic unit that is “functional” in the sense that it is “doing a job in some context” (see Halliday & Hasan, 1985, p. 10; Halliday & Hasan, 1976). The general theoretical orientation adopted in this thesis is social semiotic one and that: (i) everything in a terrorist text is articulated from an ideological viewpoint (Thompson, 1990; Fowler, 1991, 1996); and (ii) the ideological struggles of individuals and groups are manifest in the meanings and social values contested in the texts produced (see Verschueren, 2012, pp. 7–10). The social semiotic theory of SFL, adopted in this thesis, proposes a linguistic model that views language as a reflection of the society within which it occurs (Halliday, 1978) and that “consider[s] the social structure [which is of moral essence] as one aspect of the social system” (Halliday & Hasan, 1985, p. 4). This social semiotic theory is the basis for my derived model for studying incitement and communicated threats.

This thesis is thus a forensic linguistic examination of terrorist language. That is, it is concerned with the “use of linguistic techniques to investigate crimes in which language data forms part of the evidence” (Crystal, 2008, p. 194). It adds to the multi- and cross-disciplinary field of forensic linguistic research which originated in a wide range of disciplines, including linguistics, sociology, law and psychology, and has included the role of the linguist as an expert in court, covering work in, for example, Australia, Europe and North America. Traditionally, forensic linguistic research spans three areas: the language of law; the language of the legal process and proceedings; and language as evidence (within which this thesis operates) – for an extensive introduction into forensic linguistics, see Coulthard & Johnson (2007).

The research is an important showcase of how linguistic evidence is accessible in TPSs. By focusing on the elements of extremism and the two language crimes, communicated threats and incitement to violence, this thesis contributes to understanding the linguistic strategies

and features of terrorists of jihadist and far-rightist ideologies. This understanding is aligned with the United Nations counterterrorism measures introduced to foster the rule of law and preserving the human right to peace (see e.g. United Nations, 2012). The approach taken also ultimately contributes to addressing an important question in forensic linguistics: “How is an utterance or a [terrorist] text to be understood?” (Kniffka, 2007, p. 54).

1.3 Research questions and aims

Terrorists have been effective in fomenting emotions in order to influence social relations and justify violence, through the interpersonal stances construed in “emotion-based narratives” (see Kriner, 2018, p. 22; Wright-Neville & Smith, 2009). This role of emotion and attitudinal stances in terrorist communication makes it crucial to draw on linguistic tools and to employ a well-theorised view of evaluative language. The perspective taken in the present thesis is that of Martin and White’s (2005) Appraisal framework. This account enables the study to assess: (i) types of attitudes (ways of feeling) encoded in discourse; (ii) an author’s stance towards different social groups; and (iii) the linguistic mechanisms for positioning, (dis)aligning/(dis)affiliation, and sharing of emotions. The value of studying evaluative meanings in discourse derives from the power of evaluation in interpersonal discourses and phenomena. Evaluation is multifunctional; that is, it enacts relationships, expresses opinions, and represents attitudes. Evaluative meanings can present a subjective view of the world, reference and construe ideologies (dominant, dominated or resistant), and structure discourse (Gozdz-Roszkowski & Hunston, 2016). Since evaluation also tends to be morally founded, it is useful as a lens for understanding the morality used to justify terrorist acts. This thesis, thus, foregrounds the role of patterning and functions of interpersonal attitudinal meanings in enacting aggressive identity and violent attitudes in communicated threats and incitement to violence. The thesis, therefore, has two main aims:

1. To empirically examine the discursive features of extremism in terrorist public statements;
2. To investigate the communicated threats and incitement to violence, enacted in these public statements, as social semiotic practices.

This thesis will explore a number of dimensions of evaluative language in terrorist statements, including the role that a terrorist's evaluative style, or alternatively appraisal signature, plays in enacting authorial identities and social and action networks. Appraisal signature here refers to patterns of attitudinal meaning, the polarity of which is inflicted by categories or networks of membership of the ideational targets. This thesis will also consider the extent to which these functional patterns exist within terrorist texts of different authors of different organizations, and what they reveal about moral bases or foundations underpinning the discourse. Specifically, the following three research questions are explored:

1. How do the following patterns of lexicogrammatical features discursively mark an author's violent extremist style and identity? These patterns are:
 - Structures realising discursive themes and conceptual burstiness.
 - Repeated, attitudinally loaded lexical items.
2. Which affiliation strategies and tactics are employed as discursive incitement tactics?
 - How does the appraisal signature of a terrorist function within inciting language – i.e. what patterns of bonds are tabled as bases for *affiliation*?
 - How can analysing affiliation strategies inform our understanding of how terrorists incite violent acts?
3. How does the appraisal signature of a terrorist manifest and function in terrorist threat texts?
 - What kinds of patterns of bonds are tabled as bases for *disaffiliation* with the victims?
 - What does the analysis reveal about the discursive functions of threat texts and the 'moral' justifications and purposes of threats?

1.4 Significance of the research

This thesis engages with crimes that form a priority area for governments and security, intelligence, law enforcement and criminal justice communities. This project extends and complements previous methods of examining terrorist cases and language crimes, by showcasing a principled model of exploring and describing a set of discursive markers in

terrorist texts, and by investigating – using a social semiotic model – the discursive nature of communicated threats and incitement as enacted by transnational terrorists. Consequently, this research: (i) proposes methods that are empirically applicable in risk contexts (to e.g. detect, characterize and describe these language crimes); and (ii) makes a number of significant contributions to the area of language and terrorism, through contributing to lexicogrammatical- and semantics-based forensic linguistics research into terrorist discourse of violence and hate speech.

The corpus tools and computational technique used to approach the first question of the thesis contributes to the toolbox that forensic analysts can use to explore patterns of lexical forms and semantic categories, indications of conceptual burstiness, and attitudinal meanings in terrorist texts. The term 'burstiness' is used to designate the tendency of words of certain topics to occur more repeatedly than other words in a set of texts. In this thesis, the increased use of lexical items with close semantic proximity is taken as an indication of the extremist discourse and the discursive purpose to which these concepts are put in the terrorist texts. The technique also proposes semiotic clues (i.e. grounds) for: characterizing terrorist texts and an author or his ideology; providing reasonable suspicion of their agendas (through e.g. geographical information, actions threatened); and identifying a terrorist's motivations. In addition, the focus on repeated, attitudinally loaded lexical items showcases how attitudinal resources can be used as a diagnostic tool for characterizing the personal and relational identities manifest in terrorist communication.

Besides extending the supporting role of evaluative meanings to new areas and genres, this research adds to the tools used by threat assessors and forensic investigators to distinguish threat text types and to describe them (see Kniffka, 2007, pp. 163-164). This is based on not only the distinctive features in an author's repertoire but also how different structures and linguistic units dynamically interact. In addition, the thesis proposes a model for understanding incitement texts. This model is innovative in its use of frameworks and theories developed within Systemic Functional Linguistics (e.g. the Appraisal framework and the affiliation theory) to understand terrorist language. Social semiotics is the underlying theoretical orientation of SFL. To date, there has been no formal SFL study of the discursive practice of incitement to terrorist acts.

In sum, the thesis demonstrates the linguist's responsibility to society by engaging with real-world terrorist texts and showcasing how the research questions can be approached from an "applied linguistics" perspective (Halliday, 2008). It aims to improve interdisciplinary collaboration through informing the investigatory and intervention protocols that respond to terrorism. In addition, the thesis makes available a useful reference dataset, given that there are few contexts in which the practice of threatening and incitement are studied as naturally occurring phenomena.

1.5 Preview of terrorist communication dataset

This research concerns itself with public statements published by terrorists coming from different geographical regions, sociocultural and political backgrounds, and the two most lethal extreme ideologies. Specifically, it analyses texts communicated by the former leader of al-Qaeda, Osama bin Laden (hereafter, OBL), leader of Boko Haram, Abu Bakr Shekau (hereafter, Shekau), former leader of ISIS, Abu Bakr al-Baghdadi (hereafter, al-Baghdadi), and the far-rightist member, Brenton Tarrant (hereafter, Tarrant). Although far-right extremists might be considered domestic terrorists in some countries, they are considered as international terrorism in others, given the international presence. This presence is coupled with social, political and violent agendas of movements such as the alt-right (i.e. alternative right) which is an internet-based extreme-right movement that is based in the USA but exists in and operates in different parts of the world. Brenton Tarrant, an Australian citizen who perpetrated a terrorist attack in New Zealand and outside the jurisdiction of Australia, is an example member of the far alt-right. In addition to considering the regions of the terrorist activity, this thesis adopts Shuy's (2021) distinction between domestic and international terrorism: the former includes illegal acts carried out against one's own government and fellow citizen; the latter refers to illegal acts taking place outside the jurisdiction of one's own country. The following subsections provide a summary on each terrorist and their ideological backgrounds. More details of the specific texts analysed are provided in Chapter Four, Research Methodology.

1.5.1 Osama bin Laden and al-Qaeda

Al-Qaeda is a terrorist group with a self-proclaimed 'Salafist' ideology, that is, a claimed pure form of Islamic thought (Stanley, 2005). Al-Qaeda grew out of the Soviet-Afghan war, fighting

against the Soviet invasion. This jihad, or 'holy' war, was supported by the US CIA in light of the Cold War (see Zghayyir, 2016). After the defeat of the Soviets, al-Qaeda rejected the US presence in the Muslim countries, especially after the US-led war on Iraq in 1991. Since then, al-Qaeda started fighting the Americans through a new wave of jihad, targeting mainly US interests such as the US embassies, ships, military personnel and citizens, which culminated in the 9/11 attacks on Washington and New York (Dalacoura, 2012). OBL fought together with the Pakistani Mujahidin and Taliban/Afghan fighters against the Soviets, and funnelled Mujahidin from the Arab world and financially supported their jihad in Afghanistan. OBL was born in Saudi Arabia and remained a Saudi Arabian citizen until his citizenship was withdrawn in 1994 after declaring his hostile stance against America amid the Saudi monarchy's support of the US in Iraq and elsewhere (Miller, 2015).

OBL thus played a pivotal role in founding al-Qaeda and its ideology and in marketing its ideas and name, the latter which means 'the base' which "invokes a precept or a rule of Islamic ethics" and ways of treating people of different groups (Miller, 2015, p. 371). Under OBL's leadership, al-Qaeda spread transnationally and trans-continentially as the main global terrorist organisation, with affiliate groups worldwide. OBL's brand of the fighter with 'zuhd' (Arabic word, meaning *austerity* and *self-denial*) and commitment to fighting against the Western 'adversary' has cemented al-Qaeda's view of America as being the major far enemy, whom al-Qaeda ultimately aims to drive out of the Muslim world, alongside destroying Israel and seeking to establish the 'caliphate' (Miller, 2015). These goals are realised in the following utterance, taken from an OBL inciting text in the data of this thesis:

We also emphasise on the importance of martyrdom operations against the enemy – it is those operations that gravely inflicted unprecedented losses among Americas and Israeli, by Allah's grace. (OBL 5)

After the 9/11 attacks, the United States declared a war against the jihadist groups and invaded Afghanistan and Iraq, instigating a prolonged era of struggle between the USA and Muslims. OBL continued leading al-Qaeda from Afghanistan.

1.5.2 Abubakar Shekau and Boko Haram

Boko Haram is the media name for the self-proclaimed 'Jamatu Ahlis Sunna Lidda'awati wal-jihad' (meaning *group of the people of Sunnah for preaching and jihad*) terrorist groups. Boko

Haram was founded by Mohammad Yusuf in 2002, based in north-eastern Nigeria, Africa. Boko Haram claims adherence to the Salafist 'Wahhabi' ideology – the 18th century school of Islamic thought, established in modern-day Saudi Arabia. This Wahhabism and Salafism ideology represents a narrow, rigid and non-unanimously agreed upon version of Islam (see Stanley, 2005). The main factors of Boko Haram's emergence include, among others: responses to the so-called US 'global war on terrorism' which targeted Muslim-majority countries and accompanied a general decline in the living conditions in these countries; the economic challenges and urban and rural decay in Muslim-majority parts of Nigeria; Boko Haram's rejection of secularism, democracy and Western education; and disputes with the Nigerian government and fights over the ownership of the traditional system of education and places of worship (Kyari, 2014).

Abu Bakr Shekau took over the leadership after Yusuf's death in 2009. Since then, Boko Haram's operational impact has extended to Niger, Chad and Cameroon. Shekau's discourse is different from Yusuf's in that it focuses on a wider range of transnational audiences (including security forces and state officials) and communicates strident messages which intensify intra-Muslim tensions and exacerbate inter-state and Muslim-Christian relations in the West Africa region (Apard, 2015; Thurston, 2016). These are realised in the following utterance taken from a threat text, from this thesis's data, communicated by Shekau against the Nigerian Joint Task Force (JTF):

We are prepared for it and we are waiting for you. JTF, 'Kato da Gora,' you are Borno people, aren't you? I am going to kill you; I am going to slit your throats. Allah asked me to kill you, whoever you are, wherever you are. (Shekau 7)

Shekau's discourse could recruit violent actors on a massive scale, motivate popular support for violence, and threaten the stability of Nigeria's federal government and Nigeria's neighbouring countries through acts such as targeted assassination, suicide bombing and hostage taking (Kyari, 2014; Apard, 2015). Boko Haram's terrorist activity has surged in recent years, making it ranked as the second deadliest terrorist organisation in 2019 (after the Taliban national movement), and it remains the deadliest in sub-Saharan Africa and throughout the Lake Chad Basin region of West Africa (GTI, 2020).

1.5.3 Abu Bakr al-Baghdadi and the Islamic State in Iraq and Syria (ISIS)

ISIS (alternatively, Daesh) was established in 2010, initially as ISI (Islamic State in Iraq), by surviving members of al-Qaeda in Iraq and former members of the initially US-trained 'Sons of Iraq' – coalitions of tribal heads and disaffected (formerly, Saddam Hussein's) military officers in al-Anbar province, Iraq, who united to maintain stability in their communities against terrorist groups and pro-Iran militias (GTI, 2020). Following territorial gains in Iraq and ar-Raqqa province in Syria, post the start of the 2011 Syrian revolution, ISIS emerged in 2014 as a proclaimed State in Iraq and Syria, as declared by Abu Bakr al-Baghdadi. Al-Baghdadi, who joined the jihadist groups following the US invasion of Iraq and broke with al-Qaeda in 2014, introduced ISIS as a self-proclaimed 'Islamic State' that represents an envisaged Caliphate in Iraq and Syria, with its own moral order, totalitarian theocracy, self-proclaimed jihadist-Salafist ideology, and antagonistic and oppositional worldview towards the ideologically and/or religiously different 'Others' (Wignell, Tan & O'Halloran, 2017). These are realised in the following utterance taken from an inciting text, from the present thesis, by al-Baghdadi:

And the sons of Islam in the Khilafa State, by Allah's grace, continue to make a firm stand, disavowing their own ability and strength and relying on their Lord, in the face of the alliances of kufr, which include Crusaders, Jews, atheists, murtadeen [i.e. apostates], and Majus [i.e. Iran backed militias]. (al-Baghdadi 2)

Despite its self-proclaimed religious identity, ISIS has been described by a team of anthropologists – tasked by the UN Security Council Committee to study ISIS – as a 'nihilistic' terrorist group (Atran, 2015). Although 75% of ISIS volunteers were encouraged by their friends and 20% were invited to join by family members or relatives, most foreign volunteers had no formal religious education or training (Atran, 2015). Many of the volunteers joined ISIS as "a joyful movement" where joy comes from joining a friend-network, fighting for a cause, and exercising violence and beheading (Atran, 2015, p. 8). ISIS's messages have consistently: (i) targeted the young, particularly the discontented and resentful against authority and those filled with idealism, including highly educated people; and (ii) motivated the masses to fly to regions under ISIS management by eliminating the "grey zone" between who is viewed as outsider/'infidel' and insider/a 'true believer' (Atran, 2015, p. 2). To attract sympathizers and align ISIS interests with youth interests and values, ISIS tends to spread its messages

extensively via the Internet in digital forms of content, including video-recorded statements, periodicals (e.g. *Dabiq*, *Rumiya*) and advertisements. These various values make exploring morality in terrorist discourse essential, given that the jihadist Caliphate model of ISIS has had serious consequences transnationally. These consequences include: (i) fomenting sectarianism and radicalising segments of population of the Middle East and North Africa region; and (ii) incitement towards and perpetration of 'lone wolf' (i.e. people 'inspired' by ISIS and taking the lead to individually do similar acts elsewhere) and group operations in Europe, Africa, Asia and the Pacific region. These present ISIS as being the deadliest organisation over the last decade and the third deadliest terrorist organisation in 2019 (GTI, 2020).

1.5.4 Brenton Tarrant and the far-right terrorism

Extremist far-right ideology represents a major wellspring for terrorism (see e.g. Lutz & Lutz, 2008; DeSa & McCarthy, 2009;). For example, in North America, Western Europe and Oceania, far-right terrorist attacks "have increased by 250 per cent since 2014, with deaths increasing by 709 per cent over the same period" (GTI, 2020, p. 3). A main feature of far-rightist terrorists is their stress on the need for hierarchy as a form of "natural ordering" of social groups in socio-political structures where alleged elite or superior groups should govern and control and the presence of inequalities should be sustained (Lutz & Lutz, 2008, p. 130; van der Valk, 2013). Like the jihadist groups, the far-rightists use violence as a solution to achieve social and political change, draw on shared values and beliefs, and view the world in a way that helps to attract recruits and incite them for violence (FBICD, 2008) – as in the following text taken from Brenton Tarrant's manifesto inciting the killing of the Mayor of London:

Sadiq Khan, the current mayor of London at the time of writing, [is] an open sign of the disenfranchisement and ethnic replacement of the British people in the British isles. This Pakistani Muslim invader now sits as representative for the people of London. Londinium, the very heart of the British isles. What better sign of the white rebirth than the removal of this invader? [...] KILL SADIQ KHAN.

In this thesis, I focus on the messages communicated in the 87-page manifesto, 'The Great Replacement', published by Tarrant. Tarrant is a member of the far (alternative) right, neo-fascist, white supremacist movement, which is a network, based in the USA, which has a presence online and also in several European countries (Steinmetz-Jenkins, 2018; Bevensee

& Ross, 2019; Önnersfors, 2019). Among the 89 deaths attributed to far-right terrorists in 2019, Tarrant's terrorist attacks on two mosques in Christchurch, New Zealand, resulted in the death of 51 persons. Put differently, while far-right terrorism was ranked the second-most fatal after the jihadists, Tarrant's attack was the deadliest far-right single attack, with which New Zealand entered the orbit of transnational right-wing terrorism. While jihadist groups, namely ISIS, have tended to video-record parts of their operations, Tarrant's attack featured livestream violence of his first attack, on Facebook, to maximize its impact and encourage the like-minded towards similar violent acts (Önnersfors, 2019; Wakefield, 2019). In the Manifesto, published 7 minutes prior to the attack, Tarrant communicates threats against various social groups (e.g. the Turks), incites violence against different groups (e.g. Muslims, the democrats), and offers "evidence of a web of supremacist extremism" that seeks to stabilize the 'fibres' that connect them against 'outgroups' (Heim & McAuley, 2019).

1.6 Thesis scope and organisation

Following the introduction provided in the present chapter, this thesis is composed of eight chapters.

Chapter Two critically reviews the literature on approaches and theories relating to threatening communication as an interdisciplinary topic. It considers literature on communicated threats and incitement, as two aspects of risk in terrorist discourse, and the features or variables often examined by threat assessment practitioners.

Chapter Three presents the theoretical foundations upon which this research and its design builds: the social semiotic theory of Systemic Functional Linguistics and corpus linguistics methods.

Chapter Four introduces a detailed description of the research methodology. This includes the data collection and sampling of the corpora of jihadist and far-right terrorist communication; as well as the data analysis procedures, spanning analysis of lexicogrammar, and evaluation and affiliation strategies.

Chapter Five is devoted to the findings related to the first research question, regarding the patterns of lexicogrammatical features characterising the dataset and how they: (i) offer a

way of understanding terrorist texts; and (ii) propose semiotic clues to extremist style of authorship based on the lexicogrammatical patterning that can be found in terrorists' texts.

Chapter Six details the findings relating to the second research question, on affiliation strategies as discursive incitement tactics. It presents the discourse analysis and discussion of the role of patterns of evaluation spread across the contours of the analysed inciting texts. This chapter uses the affiliation analysis to provide evidence of: (i) patterns of engagement in the discursive acts of incitement against outgroups; and (ii) how incitement is enacted by these patterns.

Chapter Seven presents discourse analysis and discussion of the findings relating to the third research question, on disaffiliation and communicated threat texts. It focuses on: (i) illuminating the evaluative structure of the threat texts and the nuances of the evaluative "textbites" (Johnson & Wright, 2014, p. 37; Etaywe, 2021a, 2021b) as evidence of the disaffiliative functions of the texts (i.e. disalignment with the victims), where a threatener communicates on the bases of their alleged 'care' for the ingroup's moral order and from a community-driven vantage point; and (ii) how these textbites map onto and characterize threat texts of various types and discursive functions.

Chapter Eight consolidates and interprets the primary findings of the thesis and conceptualises their relevance to the analysis of terrorist language for forensic purposes. The chapter also reflects upon the thesis limitations and makes proposals for future research.

1.7 Publications related to this thesis

Four publications were produced during the work on this thesis. Etaywe and Zappavigna (2021) emerged from the findings of the first research question conducted on OBL's texts as a case study. It specifically describes how the exploration of discursive patterns of authorial identity offers a diagnostic for a terrorist's personal and relational identities, which are performatively produced or constituted by repeated, attitudinally loaded lexical items. In this publication, a *system and structure* approach (i.e., paradigmatic and syntagmatic, features-based approach) and *value parameter-based* approach were applied. The analytical procedures undertaken in this publication are elaborated in Chapter 4, Section 4.4.3.2, and the findings of this analysis relating to the four terrorists are provided in Chapter 5, Section

5.4. Regarding the examination of structures realising the characteristic discursive themes and conceptual burstiness in the dataset (which form part of the focus of the first research question), the corpus analysis procedures detailed in Chapter 4, Section 4.4.2, and a summary of the findings provided in Chapter 5, Section 5.2 and Section 5.3, were presented at the 74th ‘American Academy of Forensic Science’ Scientific Conference (Etaywe, 2022a) and are now in the process of publication in the *International Journal of Applied Linguistics*. The submitted paper is entitled, ‘Linguistics in terrorism cases: Exploring discursive themes and conceptual burstiness for forensic purposes’.

Another paper by Etaywe and Zappavigna (in the process of publication in *Language in Society*), titled ‘The role of social affiliation in incitement’, emerged from the findings on the second research question, from analysis conducted on Tarrant’s Great Replacement Manifesto as a case study. It specifically uses the analytical model provided in Chapter 4, Section 4.4.3, and describes the affiliation strategies and tactics identified and their functions in incitement texts. These strategies and tactics are elaborated in greater detail in Chapter 6 in relation to the Tarrant, OBL and al-Baghdadi incitement texts. In both co-authored publications, Etaywe proposed the method and undertook the linguistic analysis with feedback from Zappavigna. The writing was a collaborative process between the two authors. Etaywe (2021b) presents the analytical strategy used to investigate the role of evaluative couplings and enacted bonds as entry points to the legitimization of violence in the incitement texts, which is part of the investigation of the second research question. This analytical strategy is presented in Chapter 4, Section 4.4.3.4, and the findings are provided in Chapter 6, Section 6.4.2.

CHAPTER TWO: LITERATURE REVIEW

2.1 Introduction

The substantial cross disciplinary literature on threatening communication attests to the interdisciplinarity of the topic of this thesis. This chapter presents a review and critique of relevant studies. The aim is to survey the main strands of research into threatening communication, as well as linguistic research into relevant interpersonal phenomena and features. This chapter also reviews established investigative practices in violence and efforts to detect and prosecute relevant language crimes, the latter chiefly communicated threats and incitement to violence, including which phenomena and features of those crimes investigators attempt to explore and why those specific phenomena.

Given that terrorist communication is a sophisticated form of communication to research (Baker & Vessey, 2018, p. 255), this review illustrates the areas that have informed my research questions and methodology. Section 2.2 gives an abridged overview of ‘non-linguistic’ studies of threatening communication and the insights they provide into the study of terrorist threatening communication. Section 2.3 focuses on research into linguistic features that analysts aim to identify in their threat/risk assessment practices. Section 2.4 reviews related studies of the discursive practice of communicating threats (i.e. intention to cause harm), as one aspect of threat/risk in terrorist communication. Before the concluding remarks in Section 2.6, Section 2.5 offers a summary of approaches to the study of incitement and hate-fed discourse encouraging violence, as another aspect of threat in terrorist communication.

2.2 ‘Non-linguistic’ studies of threatening communication

There exists a substantial concentration of non-linguistic research into threatening communication. This research belongs to a broad panorama of fields and disciplines, including security, leadership, management, politics, psychology, sociology, anthropology and clinical practice (see, e.g. Turk, 1982; Calhoun, 1998; Baumgartner, Scalora & Plank, 2001; Meloy, 2001; Crelinsten, 2002; Hermann, 2003; Post, 2003; Walker, Schafer & Young, 2003; Weintraub, 2003; Herring, 2004; Nacos, 2007; Meloy & Hoffman, 2014; Atran, 2015). A commonality across these studies is an interest in researching threat as “a perceived

possibility of harm” or, alternatively, as a potential danger or risk (Meloy, Hart & Hoffman, 2014, p. 3), which is the kind of risk argued to be consistent in terrorist communication studied in this thesis.

These studies have focused on behavioural predictors that help to determine whether an offender will be violent, by psychological profiling of offenders. They aim to account for an offender’s tendency towards the use of violence and thus to protect high profile figures (e.g. political officials, public figures, presidents, members of Congress judges, police officers, judges and celebrities) from potential harm. These predictors draw on analyses of an offender’s personal emotions, perceptions, dispositions, motivations, interests, and agendas. They also include determining likely endangered targets and attitudes towards these targets. Clues to these determined elements incorporate fundamental information about elemental parts that inform and shape violent behavior and communication (see, e.g. Milburn & Watman, 1981; Dietz et. al, 1991; De Becker, 1997; Calhoun, 1998; Fein & Vossekuil, 1999; Scalora, et al., 2002; Meloy, Sheridan & Hoffmann, 2008; O’Hair, Bernard & Roper, 2011).

This kind of non-linguistic research also provides insights for forensic linguists into the linguistic features that can be examined to serve in countering violence. Linguistic analysis can contribute to investigating many of these offender’s aspects (e.g. attitudes, feelings, agendas), as will be shown in this thesis. Such forensic contribution by linguists has drawn the attention of governments (e.g. the British government) and agencies (e.g. the FBI) around the world, where linguists working with teams of social scientists help in, for example, investigating offences, identity-verification tasks, counterterrorism, intelligence and surveillance (UK Parliamentary Office of Science and Technology, 2015; Shuy, 2021).

2.3 Threat assessment practices

Viewing threat as the possibility of a behaviour to cause harm or danger (Meloy, Hart & Huffmann, 2014, p. 3), a threat analysis team is often tasked with examining variables that include, *inter alia*, the context of relationship between a threat text author and victims, as well as the possible motives of the threat (Simons & Meloy, 2017, p. 633). This task incorporates a threat assessment process, which is a “detailed examination of the elemental parts of a verbal or written threat to estimate [...] the genuineness and overall viability of the expression of intent to do harm” (Rugala & Fitzgerald, 2003, p. 780; Borum et al., 1999).

Practitioners in this “multidisciplinary” process (O’Hair, Bernard & Roper, 2011, p. 34), specifically within law enforcement frameworks (e.g. Napier & Mardigian, 2003), seek to identify, and build their assessment on, psychological, social and linguistic factors (e.g. level of anger, level of personalisation, evidence of commitment) to help, for instance, in categorising communicated intentions in order to determine how likely a threat will be carried out.

Threat assessment protocols are widely applied, for example, by the FBI Behavioural Analysis Unit-1 (BAU-1) and the United Nations Security Risk Management (UNSRM) system, as detailed in the UNSRM manual (2017). Threat assessment protocols are security protocols which involve language experts, among other experts. These protocols form a process that feeds into the risk management system, i.e. the system of risk mitigation (the *impact* of a dangerous act) and risk prevention (the *likelihood* of the act) (Meloy, Hart & Hoffmann, 2014; UNSRM, 2017). Within these protocols, tools that analyse the language of threat, such as the Terrorist Radicalization Assessment Protocol (TRAP-18) (Meloy & Gill, 2016), are useful for providing warning behaviours based on themes (e.g. grievance) identified in extremists’ communication. Such tools help in assessing individuals (a lone wolf) who potentially may engage in violence. The analysis of language in threats as part of, for example, a workplace threat assessment “can [also] allow employers to initiate procedures to defuse and [control] the would-be perpetrator and, thereby, prevent violence from occurring” (Smith & Shuy, 2002, p. 20). In addition, by incorporating the services of forensic linguists into work on counterterrorism, the FBI BAU-1 seeks behaviourally oriented investigative assistance. This inclusion of linguists, as social and forensic scientists (see Kniffka, 2007; Li, 2011), has been pressing in the light of a surge in the number of threatening communications, specifically threatening communication cases received by the BAU-1 and counterterrorism units worldwide (Fitzgerald, 2007; Shuy, 2010).

2.3.1 Linguistic features that analysts aim to identify in terrorism cases

Analysts of terrorist acts and communication rely on examining linguistic features as indicators of violent discourses, in order to predict violence and to assess threat/or risk to the community (Smith, 2004; Smith, 2006). Features arising from the analysis of language in threats include words and phrases (e.g. auxiliary verbs) that indicate levels of intent, for

example, '**may** shoot' versus '**will** shoot' (Napier & Mardigian, 2003, p. 18). Patterns of words may also support assessments of likelihood. These patterns include, but are not limited to, specialised or field specific words, personal affiliation-specific language, emotional stance (e.g. anger, sadness, anxiety) words, and motivation to violence words, such as words of power and affiliation themes (Rugala & Fitzgerald, 2003; Smith, 2008). Language analysts may also rely on identifying language features such as swearing or pejorative and racist language used as intimidation tactics (Milburn & Watman, 1981; Davis, 1997; Turner & Gelles, 2003; Weintraub, 2003; Baker, 2008, cited in Gales 2010; Mardigian, 2008), mention of weapons, violent verbs, themes of hopelessness, desire or death (Smith & Shuy, 2002; Turner & Gelles, 2003; Almela et. al, 2019), mention of a victim's previous behaviours, focus on victims as wrongdoers, and focus on self as victimised (Turner & Gelles, 2003; Smith, 2006; Mardigian, 2008). That said, most scholarship has focused on behavioural characteristics, which highlights a research gap and the need for understanding the discursive nature of threatening communication – that is, threatening in the general sense of having an instance of dangerous messages, a perceived possibility of harm or a potential danger (e.g. Meloy, Hart & Hoffman, 2014, p. 3).

Although the features mentioned above may exist in a range of violent discourses and may be used to distinguish, for instance, between an abuser from non-abuser or an offender from non-offender (see e.g. Almela et al., 2019), this thesis takes up a set of these features to contribute to the capability of distinguishing terrorist from non-terrorist language users. This contribution is pursued by examining terrorist texts and comparing their results with a sample of texts previously identified as of the terrorist type of violent texts, as will be explained in Chapter Four and shown in Chapter Five, Sections 5.2 and 5.3. In order to determine relevant linguistic patterns indicative of violence and the psychological or sociological background of offenders, analysts also widely use computational tools such as the Linguistic Inquiry and Word Count (LIWC) software (see, e.g. Almela et al., 2019) and the Automated Linguistic Identification and Assessment System (ALIAS) (see e.g. Chaski, 2001; Chaski & Croghan, 2010). Although LIWC cannot be said to be based exclusively on linguistic principles, since it analyses and categorises language based on psychology, LIWC provides a set of empirically predefined categorisations based on the actual use of language. Automation helps to obtain more objective results and regularities in lexicogrammatical features that help to deduce

information or translate information for criminal investigators in relation to different investigative hypotheses (Longhi, 2021). To enhance objectification of analysis of elements of terrorism undertaken in this thesis, corpus/computational analysis tools are incorporated, with the focus being placed on lexis, resonating with Vološinov's (1973, pp. 13-14) view of words as being "the ideological phenomenon par excellence. ...[that] can carry out ideological functions of any kind".

2.3.2 More linguistic features attracting the attention of analysts of terrorism cases

In addition to the language features mentioned above, Shuy (2021) suggests that a successful investigation into terrorism cases requires close discourse analysis. This analysis, according to Shuy, may include examining speech events, speech acts, strategies used to influence an addressee, grammar and lexicon, to help prosecution and intelligence analysts in identifying and attributing language users' agendas, themes and schemas (how language users talk about what is being talked about) and agendas. Aligned with Shuy's argument, discourse analysis tools are also used in the present research to examine the language elements of terrorist discursive acts of threatening and incitement. Instead of focusing on sentence level-speech act as a unit of study (e.g. Shuy, 1993), however, these discursive acts are approached as social semiotic practices in this thesis, where focus is on wording and rhetorical strategies. Focus is placed on wording that construes meaning, and how patterns in meaning choice then construes context (and interacts with society) (Etaywe & Zappavigna, 2021).

To date, limited forensic linguistic research has been undertaken on conceptual burstiness as a discursive marker and a source of intelligence and clues to terrorists' ideology, agenda and affiliation in terrorism cases. This limited attention to this feature persists despite recognition of the usefulness of this language feature in text authorship tasks (see e.g. Akimushkin, Amancio & Oliveira, 2017), in marking genres, topics and authors, and in information and document retrieval (see e.g. Church & Gale, 1995[2008]; Pierrehumbert, 2012). Some scholars have focused on the temporal distribution of repeatedly used words to account for their burstiness in, for example, a talk (e.g. Altmann, Pierrehumber & Motter, 2009); while some other researchers focus on repeated terms at the lexical level and how these terms collocate with themselves and set up textual cohesion in discourses of violence (e.g. Brookes & McEnery, 2020). My take on conceptual burstiness refers to a semantic feature where

groups of the most repeated lexis with close semantic proximity are categorised under same semantic fields or concepts, and that the repetition of these groups of lexis is taken as being driven by the function of terrorist texts and thus as a characteristic of the burstiness of the overarching (sub)categories of concepts in these texts. To elaborate, this concept adds to the existing tools used to understand the discursive nature of terrorist texts. By focusing on the repeated, ideological concepts as realised in the groping of the topmost repeated lexical items in discourse, useful cues can be identified and used to suspect, characterise, and understand the nature of terrorist texts. My uptake of 'burstiness' is akin to Brookes and McEnery's (2020), but it is based on proximity at the semantic level of grouping these lexical items; and 'burstiness' is then used to designate the tendency of words of certain topics to occur more repeatedly than other words in terrorist texts (for more, see Subsection 4.4.2.2 and Section 5.3).

The burstiness feature is extended and examined here as a semantic feature, realised lexicogrammatically, to group repeated lexis (e.g. *kill, die, attack*) with close semantic proximity under same semantic fields or concepts (e.g. violence: violent action, violent cause). Repetition of particular concepts is taken as a characteristic of the burstiness of these concepts and their (sub)categories. This 'conceptual burstiness', as such, is taken as: (i) a marker of the discursive purpose of the use of sets of lemmas in terrorist texts; (ii) an indication of an affiliation, agenda and ideology; and (iii) in Altmann, Pierrehumber and Motter's (2009, p. 1) terms, a "lens on [a violent extremist's] thought and activity". The increased use of words of particular semantic proximity is taken as being a result of an author's modulation of their style to suit the communication situation and their audiences (e.g. Baese-Berk et al., 2021). By examining the most frequent lexical items in a dataset, we use a "powerful tool" to survey the content of the texts (Gómez, 2013, p. 135), describe lexicogrammar of violence (Matthiessen & DeCoursey, 2022) and deduce information about the authors of illegal activities (e.g. an author's extremist group or organisation, what the texts are about, any specific agendas) (Longhi, 2021).

The feature of conceptual burstiness can contribute to the factors that can be used by threat assessors to categorise and identify texts as terrorist threatening texts. Put differently, this thesis contributes to determining the text type and characteristics of the terrorist language, as well as to psycho- socio-linguistic and ideological profiling of terrorist authors. My take on

conceptual burstiness is thus akin to Brookes and McEnery's (2020) use of repeated words to uncover ideologies and claims to symbolic power and lexis encoding religious concepts used by extreme jihadist groups to create identities and licence violence. Unlike Brookes and McEnery who studied the burstiness of repeated terms – and only in jihadist discourse – at the lexical level, focusing on how terms collocated with themselves and set up textual cohesion, in this thesis burstiness is explored (Chapter Five) in texts of jihadist and far-rightist terrorist texts in order to retrieve information for forensic purposes.

Recent corpus-based and discourse analysis research testing whether the linguistic features of violent actors' stances could serve as evidence of commitment to a communicated threat shows no significant correlation between fulfillment of a violent act and any one lexical or grammatical stance feature or combination (see Gales, 2010, 2011, 2013, 2015). This line of enquiry has emphasised the need for strong semantic evidence of threat-intention and commitment. Gales has proposed that analysts pay more attention to lexical and grammatical functions of the stances that authors adopt in their texts and how these functions interact together and serve in understanding discourse. She has specifically proposed the value of close discourse analysis that draws on the Appraisal framework (Martin & White, 2005), a method for analysing evaluative meanings in texts developed within Systemic Functional Linguistics. The Appraisal framework offers way of investigating evaluative meanings as rich interpersonal resources that authors use to construe attitudinal stances and for discourse semantic orientations towards participants. In response to Gales' proposal, I move beyond simple linguistic forms (e.g. will, must) as indications of commitment to violence and, instead, explore stance from a functional perspective grounded in the Appraisal framework as evidence of violent values, hostile attitudes and identities, and as acts of (dis)alignment.

Stance (or appraisal more generally) is a social phenomenon that is related to how an author expresses their violent identity. It is inextricable from the interpersonal functions of terrorist communication and the various aspects of threat, such as incitement to violence (Etaywe & Zappavigna, 2021). However, the functional approach to stance has received limited research in terms of investigations into hostile and terrorist communication. As such, in exploring the distinctive features of language of terrorism, I am aligned with Kniffka's (2007) contention that not only distinctive lexicogrammatical features existing in offenders' repertoire are important but also how offenders use these features in combination and how these features

interact in discourse. In this thesis (specifically, Chapter Five), attitudinal resources are explored in terms of how they operate as discursive markers of authorial, personal and relational identity and as a diagnostic for characterizing these identities in terrorist texts.

In sum, attention paid in this thesis to the lexicogrammatical and semantic levels of analysis is key for successful investigation of terrorist communication, and to providing evidence-based reasons motivating suspicion of terrorism cases and to properly identify key information for intelligence and law enforcement agencies. This focus is aligned with Shuy's (2010, pp. 558-561) suggestion that successful investigation into the lexicogrammatical and semantic features in terrorist discourse is key for: suspecting the likelihood of a terrorist activity or an instance of language users who are engaged in terrorism; identifying characteristic terrorist activity-related themes and topics to determine clues about, for example, intentions and agendas; offering linguistic analyses that are parallel to intelligence analyses; and ultimately, helping law enforcement practitioners to understand the linguistic evidence of terrorism. This thesis contributes specifically to the semantic levels of analysis of terrorist incitement texts and threat texts.

2.4 Main approaches to analysing 'communicated threats'

Communicated threats are menacing utterances or statements that convey an intention to cause harm. They are a primary indicator of risk used by threat assessors and law enforcement practitioners to inform decision makers about when to take appropriate actions aimed at saving lives and property (see, e.g. Rugala & Fitzgerald, 2003; Romano et al., 2011; Meloy, Hart & Huffmann, 2014). This indicative advantage gained through analysis of communicated threats applies to the many types of incriminating threat texts (e.g. extortion, blackmail, ransom notes, hate mail, and terror mail) wherein threat exists as an integral function of the text (Kniffka, 2007; Olsson, 2008). For example, in ransom notes, a criminal threatens to return what is in their possession, dead or alive. This threat component "is really the most important part of ransom note" and is the one to which analysts should pay the closest attention (Olsson, 2008, p. 142). Despite commonalities between threat text types, for example, in terms of how the threat component of these texts operates, threat texts are diverse in character (Olsson, 2008). This diversity makes them of interest to forensic linguists as well as law enforcement agencies, to continue categorising and text typing, i.e. exploring

the characteristic features of threat texts to distinguish between the different text types (Kniffka, 2007, pp. 163-164).

This thesis contributes to analysing and characterising terrorist communicated threats. Communicated threats, as one aspect of the threatening communication produced by terrorists worldwide, have some common features such as fear generation and publicity (Olsson, 2008, p. 145; Tsesis, 2013, 2017). A terrorist conveys their intention to injure a victim and their property or rights. This terrorises victims, unsettling their peace of mind and impacting their rights and freedoms. These actions also cause public inconvenience and endanger people other than the addressed victims (Black, 1995, p. 1154; Smith, 2008; Tsesis, 2013). Terrorists consider their harmful acts as being 'morally' driven and 'justified' (Bandura, 1990, 1999, 2016; Seto, 2002). Investigating this morally-driven and unlawful kind of violence offers a potentially rich source of forensic clues which may assist in better addressing terrorism, by helping policymakers and security practitioners to plan proactive and protective responses.

2.4.1 Reasons for communicated threats

Linguistic research has shown that there are various reasons why threats, as a broad category of speech act, may be communicated, related to particular contexts. These reasons, according to Fraser (1998, pp. 159-160), include the following: to express anger; to be humorous; to intimidate; to make a desired result happen; to challenge authorities; to call attention to someone or something; to save face when embarrassed; to show seriousness of purpose; and to promote movement in negotiations. These reasons span various communicative functions. Some threats can be made with no intention to harm but instead, for example: to control (e.g. a child's) behaviour (Halliday, 1973); to tell authority or adult intervention for the safety of children (Benoit, 1983); to take legal action against a civil wrong unless the threatener receives compensation; to go out on strike until prices are lowered; or for warning purposes (e.g. Storey, 1995; Fraser, 1998). In such instances, threats are legal, albeit very worrisome (Fraser, 1998).

Other threats, however, are illegal and interpreted by threat assessors as 'dangerous', such as those aiming to instil fear or inflict harm on others, and which thus require law

enforcement involvement (Fraser, 1998; Gales, 2013). Instances of illegal threats include threats to expose information unless a bribery is paid (extortion) or to cause injury unless some belongings are handed over (robbery) (see Kniffka, 2007; Olsson, 2008). This thesis is engaged with illegal, dangerous threats communicated in terrorist contexts for various communicative functions, such as challenging authorities, intimidating, instilling public fear, inflicting harm on people or public property, propagation of an extremist ideology, and countering another ideology. This thesis focuses primarily on the morally based discursive functions of terrorist threat texts, as revisited in Subsection 2.4.3, and concerns itself with the discursive construction of purposes (e.g. van Leeuwen, 2008) of threatened acts, given that the discursive construction of purpose can reveal what “is often at the heart of disagreement and conflict” (van Leeuwen, 2008, p. 125).

2.4.2 Terrorist communicated threats as ‘real’ threats

Research on communicated threats distinguishes between what constitutes a ‘real’ threat and a ‘non-threat’, and between ‘bluffs’ and ‘latent’ threats where deceptive language is used (e.g. Pennebaker & Chung, 2011). Focusing on real threats, Pennebaker and Chung (2011), for example, base identification of a ‘real’ threat on a set of language features of truth and deception. They define a real threat as a threat with deliberate intent, communication of harm, fulfilled outcome, forewarning and honesty. Put differently, a real threat carries a deliberate intent to harm others and is made known to the target prior to the harm occurrence. For Martínez (2013, p. 194), a “real threat” is a threat made by social actors who possess coercive power, i.e. actors who can work injury to others, in order to coerce victims. This coercive power is a main element for considering a threat in legal contexts (see Gilbert, 1984, cited in Kniffka, 2007, p. 162). Martínez’s and Kniffka’s view of ‘real’ threat, thus, foregrounds not only the willingness of a threat actor to harm but also the (cap)ability of the actor to harm.

In this thesis, I am concerned with real threats that have been communicated by terrorists, made publicly known to threatened victims, and made by social actors with coercive power. A terrorist threatener’s power is viewed as being a socially construed act that is realised in the threatener’s control over the threat intention and capability to act (see Bourdieu, 1991, p. 8, for the general idea of social construction). The texts considered in this thesis have been

communicated by – in Smith’s (2004) terms – ‘genuine’ violent extremist group members, not by ‘peripheral’ or non-terrorist ideology members. What distinguishes terrorist communicated threats is the alleged moral element that drives terrorist acts (see, e.g. Seto, 2002), a feature visited in Section 3.5 of Chapter Three. My focus on instances of terrorist communicated threats responds to Kniffka’s (2007, pp. 163-164) call for studies to focus on communicated threats with the aim of helping to distinguish more types of threat texts and providing analysis and description thereof, which in turn assists in text legal and linguistic treatment.

2.4.3 Major directions of studies on communicated threats

Linguistic studies of communicated threats have different directions. Two major directions are summarised here.

2.4.3.1 Major direction 1: Text types of threats

The first relates to legal, security and intelligence applications and focuses on classifying the text types of threats (see Olsson, 2008; Gales, 2010). Within this line of enquiry, analysts provide linguistic clues for characterising threat texts, describing offenders’ commitment to threatened acts and so on (e.g. Gales, 2010). Research along this line widely applies computational tools such as ALIAS (see Chaski & Croghan, 2010) which help to assess and classify threats texts. However, since I am concerned with investigating attitudinal meanings in communicated threats as evidence of hostile identities, I contend that computational tools tend to overlook some interpersonal meanings, particularly implicit meanings, which are difficult to detect automatically because they tend to be context-sensitive and open-ended (Millar & Hunston, 2015). Therefore, a close, manual discourse analysis of texts is necessary. This textual analysis will enable the capturing of patterns of meaning which are a manifestation of ideology (see also Verschueren, 2012).

Recent linguistic research into threatening communication emphasises the value of close text analysis when investigating communicated threats, and focuses on describing threat text types in relation to their functions in society. For example, Bojsen-Møller et al. (2020) characterise threatening communication as a genre that generally carries strong connotations of intimidation, fear, aggression, power, and coercion; and they belong to a wider category of

illicit genres – which disrupt and upset society. In addition, Gales (2010), who has applied corpus-based and discourse analytic approaches to stancetaking in workplace communicated threats, particularly suggests future research into violent attitudes be carried out from a functional perspective in order to provide “a more holistic picture of how [...] intent [is] demonstrated, how interpersonal relationships are negotiated, and how meaning is created”. This thesis takes up Gales’ recommendation to study appraisal in terrorist communicated threats, in Chapter Seven (as well as in inciting texts, as detailed in next section), as “intersubjective activity” (Haddington, 2006, p. 74). Appraisal in threat texts is studied in relation to how social ‘disaffiliation’ is enacted.

2.4.3.2 Disaffiliation in communicated texts

Traces of the concept of ‘disaffiliation’ are found in existing literature on communicated threats but are not fully theorized or investigated, as will be revisited in Chapter Three (Theoretical Framework) and showcased in Chapter Seven. Previous research (e.g. Culpeper, 2011, p. 233) has referred to the role of “coercive impoliteness” in achieving “realignment of values between the [threat] producer and the target such that the producer benefits or has their current benefits reinforced or protected”. In addition, Gales has found that the patterns of appraisal resources could unveil some role in achieving “disalignment” between threateners and their victims (Gales, 2011, p. 30), and could provide identification of justifications of threats (Gales, 2010, p. 196). In this thesis, a fuller scale of analysis of how language is used to forge value disalignments is pursued.

2.4.3.3 Major direction 2: The Pragmatics of threats

The second main direction of research on communicated threats is in the area of Pragmatics (see, e.g. Benoit, 1983; Shuy, 1993; Storey, 1995; Fraser, 1998; Shon, 2005; Adolphs, 2008; Limberg, 2009; Salgueiro, 2010; Schiller, 2010; Culpeper, 2011; Berk-Seligson & Seligson, 2016). This line of enquiry tends to focus on the internal properties of single-sentence utterances, conceived as the speech act of ‘threatening’, with a “directive-commissive” illocutionary point (Salgueiro, 2010, p. 214); that is, these utterances count both as attempting to get the threatened to (not) do something and as a commitment by the threatener to undertake the course of action represented in the propositional content (e.g.

Searle, 1999). Recent pragmatics research into threat utterances has established a set of their typical features. A threat may be considered to be pragmatically explicit if it manifests certain language features: conditionality structure; futurity signals; violent verbs; mention and focus on participants; mention of weapons; and swear words; as realised in an example utterance, "I'm going to kill you [roaches], you'll see" (Muschalik, 2018, pp. 181-182). Absence of some features (e.g. conditionality, futurity, and violent verbs) indicates vagueness (e.g. "Maybe it's time for me to get a gun") (Muschalik, 2018, pp. 181-182). Some studies suggest that forms and internal properties of threat utterances are context- and function-dependent. For example, threats have been found to be mostly conditional (see, e.g. Fraser, 1998; Culpeper, 2011) in threats of manipulative function (Muschalik, 2018). However, they are mostly non-conditional in religiously aggravated hate-crime data, as identified by Culpeper, Iganski and Sweiry (2017). This discrepancy in internal features of threat utterances has recently led researchers (e.g. Muschalik, 2018) to emphasise that the context-function-language relationship should move analysts beyond sentence-level formal features towards considering the functions of threat utterances. The present research responds to this call by focusing on: (i) the discursive functions of threat texts; and (ii) on the elements that help to determine how dangerous a threat is. Regarding the latter focus, this research does this by examining textual elements that: communicate information about the mode, time, target, and /or place of a threatened action; and, ultimately, help to classify threat texts into, for example, direct or veiled threats – a framework that is law enforcement-based and not originally linguistic in nature (see e.g. Napier & Mardigian, 2003 as cited in Gales, 2010).

Since the function of a threat cannot always be determined at the sentence level and the linguistic "form, [and a threatener's] intention and ability" might not be "necessarily relevant" to an investigation (Storey, 1995, p. 80) such as the present study, attention needs to be drawn to the co-text of a threatening speech act in order to account for the wider linguistic context. Responding to this, Muschalik (2018) identified two functions of threat: manipulation (e.g. "If you call the police, I will kill you") and retaliation (e.g. "You made a mistake. You will die hard"). While previous research operating at the sentence level (e.g. Martínez, 2013) accounts only for the coercive aspect of the manipulative function of threats, Muschalik has extended these functions, emphasising the significance of considering the larger linguistic context of speech acts in order to examine their threat functions. The present research, however, takes

on a discourse analysis approach, considering that functions such as manipulation are inherently discursive dimensions which focus on polarized lexicogrammatical structures of positive self-presentation and negative other presentation (e.g. De Saussure & Schulz, 2005; van Dijk, 2006).

Building on Muschalik's categories of threat functions, in this thesis the entire text will be analysed to better account for the nuanced discursive functions of terrorist communicated threats. Terrorist texts might be devoid of or include more than the conventional ways of communicating threats (e.g. 'if...then' or command structure) (Miller, 1987). Thus, I argue for Hasan's (2016, pp. 66-67) contention that the "speech act status of utterances quite often cannot be determined entirely by examining the sentence internal properties". This insight calls for a complementary perspective that employs text-based analysis of the discursive practice of threatening to understand how threats may be spread across the "contours" of an entire text (see Miller, 1987, p. 46). However, unlike Muschalik who categorised the functions of communicated threats solely depending on the temporal sequence of events, this thesis additionally concerns itself with the attitudinal and moral motivation of the communicated threats, and the bonds 'tabled' (i.e. made available) in discourse (Zappavigna, 2018), as a basis for categorizing threat functions – which have received limited attention. This focus sets my approach as complementary to Muschalik's, where Muschalik departs from the point of whether a threat utterance is articulated before or after an offence, building on Aijmer's (1996, p. 98) "anticipatory" and "retrospective" classification of the functions of the apology speech act.

The thesis focuses specifically on the moral meta-value of 'care' in terms of an ingroup's ideological and physical territories. The "cultural moral orders" of a social group often set expectations and roles for 'care' via the social positioning of social actors or groups (van Langenhove, 2017, p. 5; Etaywe & Zappavigna, 2021). Analysis of this underlying morality in this thesis contributes to the scarce research into the motivation of threats and their purpose in various contexts (see e.g. Storey, 1995; Culpeper, Iganski & Sweiry, 2017). Muschalik's (2018, p. 134) two "macro-functions" of threat provide a departure point towards a more fine-grained analysis of function-based (sub)categories, given the influence on the latter on the linguistic choices by a threatener, which is something overlooked in the literature (Muschalik, 2018, p. 179). In contributing to this literature, attention is drawn in this thesis to

the link between the nuanced, attitudinal meaning-making choices and the disaffiliative discursive functions of communicated threat texts in terrorist contexts, an area of research that has also received limited attention. To map fine-grained tactics that are used to forge a threatener-victim disaffiliation and to serve the various discursive functions of the threat texts, focus is placed on the patterns of attitudinal meanings and their ideational targets.

2.5 Main approaches to the study of violent discourse as incitement

Incitement is another aspect of threats in terrorist communication (Tsesis, 2013, 2017) where language can serve as a primary indicator of ‘dangerous’ activity or an author of a terrorist text. Determining the textual features of incitement aids investigators’ awareness of the language elements that may indicate that there is an instance of ‘dangerous messages’ which are intended to promote, encourage and justify harm (Sinclair, 2021). This is likely to help prevent violence and resist calls to illegitimate/unlawful violence. Texts with an incitement function have been approached from various perspectives in linguistics. Research focusing on the characteristics of the language of incitement and on understanding how hate-fed incitement is enacted has used tools and principles from (critical) discourse analysis and a pragmatics toolbox.

2.5.1 Discourse analysis and pragmatic analysis approaches

Discourse analysis approaches focusing on grammar, lexicon and argumentation strategies have shown how inciters use language to encourage harmful actions against outgroups (e.g. Prideaux 1999 [2009], 2011; Al-Saaidi, 2017; Zghayyir, 2017; Ascone, 2020). In van Dijk’s (2015) terms, these studies provide insights that are typically concerned with the way an inciting text and talk in the social and political context enact, reproduce, legitimate and resist social-power abuse and inequality. The work in this area has suggested that inciters use language to generate attitudinal alignments, enact intergroup power relations, and legitimate power abuse and inequality. Such work has also revealed key dimensions that are critical to forensic linguistic studies. These dimensions are: (i) the functional context of meaning-making (May, Sousa-Silva & Coulthard, 2021); (ii) the discursive positioning and legitimation of particular groups; and (iii) the role of ideologies and relations of power in addressees’ beliefs and social relations (Coulthard, Johnson & Wright, 2017). All of these dimensions are considered in this thesis.

Crucial insights into the characteristics of incitement texts have also emerged from pragmatic analysis approaches focusing on speech acts. This literature positions incitement as a form of coercive “impoliteness” (Culpeper, Iganski & Sweiry, 2017, p. 19) – where the concepts of face-attack and face loss are key elements (Tracy, 2008) – for instance, in terms of religiously aggravated hate speech expressed against particular groups such as Muslim groups. According to this perspective, inciters use explicit resources such as imperative and hortative constructions as rhetorical strategies for inciting illegal behaviour (e.g., utterances such as ‘*KILL SADIQ KHAN*’ and “Let’s overthrow the government” (Kurzon, 1998: 591-592)). Speech act analyses have also noted that utterances can have a degree of “ambiguity” or indirectness even in aggravated hate speech and terrorist contexts (Jaconelli, 2017, p. 248; Macdonald & Lorenzo-Dus, 2020). For example, the decontextualised utterance, “fuck the Koran”, is interpreted as ambiguous in terms of the extent to which it is an incitement to physical violence or merely an expression of negative opinion about the Koran (Culpeper, Iganski & Sweiry, 2017, p. 20). This accords with the position that the “speech act status of utterances quite often cannot be determined entirely by examining the sentence internal properties” (Hasan, 2016, pp. 66-67), and that “indirect”/“opaque” incitement can play a role in “the commission, preparation or instigation of acts of terrorism” (see Jaconelli, 2017, p. 246). For instance, in the example just given, without accounting for the rhetorical function of the expletive and the iconicity of ‘Koran’, the kinds of interpersonal positioning that are functioning in the service of incitement in a text may be missed (e.g. Jaconelli, 2017). This gives rise to a research gap, to which this thesis responds by considering the important role of evaluative language in inciting texts, specifically in enacting social affiliation as grounded in SFL literature (explained in Chapter Three).

I argue for a text-based analysis of the practice of incitement that analyses the interpersonal meaning patterns across entire texts. This thesis adopts the position that incitement is a social semiotic practice where language is used to convince, and that obedience – in Gibson’s (2013, p. 305) terms – is unlikely when direct orders are given, especially when given by terrorists, given the disdain that a society may feel for terrorists (Khosrokhavar, 2014). Reliance on imperative and hortative constructions alone is thus likely to fail unless – in Poggi’s (2005, p. 313) terms – a connection of the incited act to an individual’s other beliefs and values is established. In addition, just as a threat text might be devoid of conventional or explicit ways

of communicating ‘threats’ (e.g. ‘if...then’ or command structures) (Miller, 1987; Muschalik, 2018), so too might an incitement text be devoid of explicit hortative and directive constructions (see e.g. Sinclair, 2021). This emphasises the need for a complementary linguistic approach to account for the argument constructed in the service of incitement, which is an aim of this thesis. Although previous research (e.g. Kurzon, 1998) has noted that an inciter may use a series of utterances to build an argument the accumulative effect of which advocates or encourages a crime, there is still scarce systematic study of this argumentative influence. This thesis seeks to establish a link between patterns of interpersonal meanings, specifically evaluative language elements, to account for their rhetorical function in the service of inciting for violence. This analysis is aligned with recent literature (e.g. Thompson & Alba-Jues, 2014, p. 4) on how an evaluative construction of a text serves to construe, promote and challenge certain values to serve the inciting act. The close study of how incitement functions in terrorism context is taken as involving attending to the “goals and beliefs” (Poggi, 2005, p. 297) that are expressed by the terrorist as they attempt to influence, motivate and ‘bond’ with putative incitees (i.e. the potential audience of their texts). It is this affiliative connection with the putative incitee, and how it is constructed through choices in evaluative meaning, that is the focus of this thesis. This thesis adopts Poggi’s (2005, p. 300) argument that evaluations are beliefs about whether or how much some object, person or experience is a useful means to some goal, and that it is through positive and negative evaluation that putative audiences cognitively compute the usefulness of an action (i.e. violent actions) towards achieving a goal.

2.5.2 Affiliation in incitement

Sociological research has suggested that creation of social affiliations and that social alignments around particular values, theorised as joint cause-and-action networks, play a pivotal role in terrorists’ incitement to violence (see e.g. Atran 2011; Ginges & Atran 2014). The domain of discursive psychology has also provided some insight into how attitudes, beliefs, stereotypes, categories and positioning might be constructed and managed within the social practices of persuasion and incitement (see, e.g. Potter, 2012; Humă, Stokoe & Sikveland, 2019). These studies emphasise the role of rhetorical devices such as position taking in evoking agreement and positive reactions from audiences. For example, Wood (2000, p. 539) stresses that attitudes are embedded in social relations, and that change

or resistance in attitude is generated by motives (e.g. a social group's values and interests). These motives could be related to oneself or others, which consequently influences the reception of messages and the consequent moral responses. Wood (2000) reiterates that – based on the social identity view (Tajfel & Turner, 1979) – in inter-group relations the ingroup (including its values and interests) serves as a reference for social comparison. To establish and maintain a favourable self-view, people tend to shift their attitudes to align with positively valued groups and to deviate from negatively valued groups. This deployment of ingroup versus outgroup comparison and contrast is appealing to this thesis, since it can help in understanding why a terrorist may choose to propose a particular value of an ingroup in their inciting messages. That is, such a deployment can help explain why memberships and differentiated ingroups and outgroups are constructed and how they serve to create commitment to a terrorist network's intentions (for similar arguments, but from the lens of the 'leader-member exchange' theory of leadership, see e.g. Graen & Uhl-Bien, 1995; Gerstner & Day, 1997).

Insightful for this thesis is also Reicher, Haslam and Rath's (2008, p. 1313) social identity model which considers 'affiliation' in terms of what drives people to support one another in committing a collective hate crime against outgroups. This collective act against an outgroup can be enacted via identification with an ingroup, exclusion of an outgroup whose presence or acts are considered a threat, and celebrating the eradication of the outgroup (Reicher, Haslam & Rath, 2008). A hate act is thus carried out because it is seen as a 'right' thing to do. Determining which exact linguistic resources and (dis)affiliative strategies can be used in inciting ingroup members to violence is an aim to which this thesis contributes. This thesis assists in providing a fuller understanding of how terrorists use language to generate social and action networks, an under-explored area in both research and law enforcement (Atran, 2015). While recent research stresses the importance of studying group values and identity (dis)alignment when studying interpersonal phenomena (see, e.g. Wood, 2000; Gibson, 2013; Spencer-Oatey & Kádár, 2016; Parvaresh & Tayebi, 2018; Kádár, Parvaresh & Ning, 2019; Parvaresh, 2019), research does not provide a detailed account of the linguistic resources used in value-(dis)alignment for incitement purposes – a gap contributed to in this thesis.

In line the with Humă, Stokoe and Sikveland's (2019) conclusion that persuasion involves promoting (2019) alignments in order to manage how an addressee receives requests or

proposals, I argue that a terrorist in an inciting text seeks to construe shared values and promote value alignment via particular affiliative strategies. By these strategies, an inciter manages incitees' readiness to receive and carry out proposed violent actions. The inciters' language, specifically evaluative language features used in discourse, is designed in response to or in an accommodation to the characteristics of the ingroup addressees (see also Bell, 1984, pp. 162/167). The practice of incitement is taking place in a context where participants engage in group favouritism, categorisations and othering, based on a dichotomous representation of groups and their values (Leets & Giles, 1997; Reynolds, Turner & Haslam, 2000; Leets, 2002).

By foregrounding the affiliative nature of inciting texts, this thesis acknowledges the effectiveness of terrorist groups in fomenting emotions in their messages in order to provoke hostility and incite violence towards outgroups. Terrorists' entering into the "emotional marketplace" (Wright-Neville & Smith, 2009, p. 85) has been found to be achieved through "emotion-based narratives in their recruitment and radicalisation strategies" (Kriner, 2018, p. 22). These strategies act as both a trigger for violent political action and as a means for justifying a terrorist ideology (Wright-Neville & Smith, 2009; Schmid, 2014). Ways of feeling and emotion-based talk play a major role in influencing people's relations, attitudes and actions (Bednarek, 2009a). In this thesis, incitement in terrorist communication is viewed as being language designed to persuade, arouse, compel and/or encourage those addressed to commit violence (see Kurzon, 1998; Gordon, 2018; Jaconelli, 2018). The inciter and incitee are taken as being – in Firth's (1957, p. 186) terms – active participators in creating and maintaining cultural values. Put differently, they are "deontic" participants (Searle, 2009, p. 9), morally coerced, permitted, required, authorised, entitled or "devoted" to protecting and maintaining their group's interests as value-serving agents (Atran, 2016, p. 192).

2.5.3 Evaluative language and affiliation in incitement

By foregrounding the role of evaluative language, this thesis enables a linguistic exploration of the causal relationship between negotiated values and incited-violent action. Such a relationship has been emphasised by research in sociology, anthropology and psychology in accounting for people resorting to terrorist acts (see, e.g. Ginges & Atran, 2013; Pretus et al., 2018; Hamid et al., 2019). This causal relationship view is crucially important for the

complementary perspective of this thesis which foregrounds the affiliative function of evaluative language in inciting texts (Chapter Six), viewing incitement as particular patterns of attitudinal meaning-making linguistic resources that an author deploys to construct, manage and promote communities of shared values and to encourage violence towards outgroups. Focus on these patterns in far-right extremist discourse (e.g. Tarrant's manifesto in this thesis) also contributes to recent research into hate speech (e.g. Marsters, 2019) which seeks to identify language patterns in the context of violent behaviour carried out by the authors of hate speech who went on to commit violence.

This linguistic approach also builds on literature in the area of legal studies on incitement. However, the analysis of language in incitement texts in these studies emphasises the '(dis)affiliative' role of evaluative expressions in incitement by using alternative terms (e.g. 'glorification' of Self, and 'demonization' of *Other*) (see, e.g. Cotler & Grossman, 2009; Bayefsky & Blank, 2018; Gordon, 2018). The following evaluation-based techniques of incitement to "lawless actions" (Pew, 2015) serve the inciting rhetorical functions (Gordon, 2018, pp. 12-14):

- Glorification of past violent acts of 'Our' social group, as in terming a shooting attack an 'act of heroism';
- Accusing victims of the same act that the perpetrator is performing, as in the following example taken from incitement within the context of the Rwandan genocide crime: "They only want to exterminate us. They have no other aim. Are we really waiting till they come to exterminate us?";
- Dehumanisation, as used in the Hutus' dehumanisation of the Tutsis, in the Rwandan genocide context, by referring to them as '*cockroaches*'.

Cotler and Grossman (2009, pp. 21-30) have also identified the following techniques in their study of state-sanctioned incitement by Iranian officials against Israel:

- Delegitimization: which works by signalling out the targeted outgroup "for opprobrium and enmity warranting their demise";
- Demonisation: where the incited-against are portrayed as inspirations from the 'devil' (e.g. '*flag of Satan*').

These evaluative techniques have a rhetorical effect. For example, the combination of dehumanisation with demonisation has a dual rhetoric purpose. It makes the incited-against appear less than human and more threatening, and thus provides a “warrant” for violence (Cotler & Grossman, 2009, pp. 24-25).

In incitement, these kinds of communal alignment and warrants are mobilized via moralizing discourses that encourage people to commit collective hostile actions against threatening outgroups for the good of the “virtuous” ingroup (Reicher, Haslam & Rath, 2008, p. 1326). This kind of moralisation of discourse is also trackable in right-wing populist discourse (for more, see Wodak, 2015). Linguistic studies of incitement have been influenced by these ideas, discussed in discursive psychology and legal literature, as well the concept of membership categorization for understanding how ‘us’ versus ‘them’ groupings are formed (see Sacks 1992; Higgins 2007). Membership categorisation in discourse can always be established for “category-bound features” for analysing these groupings (Antaki & Widdicombe, 1998, p. 4).

In sum, there exist various approaches to inciting texts. Different linguistic strategies can be employed by authors in order to persuade receivers of an ideology or an act (De Saussure & Schulz, 2005), particularly when a choice is intentional on the part of the speaker/writer (van Eemeren, 2005, p. xi) and aims “to induce into error” or to have the receiver adopt a behaviour consistent with the author’s interest (De Saussure, 2005, p. 119; Rigotti, 2005, p. 69). While critical discourse analysis-based, discursive psychology-based and legal study-based research into incitement has referred to the role of social value-alignment, ‘Us’ versus ‘Them’ construction of social groups, and the group favouritism concept in the practice of incitement, other research (e.g. within the framework of impoliteness) has stressed the need for a complementary perspective that focuses on the rhetorical function of evaluative language and its role in interpersonal positioning. This thesis approaches the study of incitement in terrorist contexts with a complementary dimension that is key to a fuller realisation of incitement and understanding of the role of social affiliation in incitement to violence. The Affiliation framework, as grounded in Systemic Functional Linguistics (explained in the next chapter), is proposed in this thesis to provide systematic linguistic investigation of incitement-enactment and to illuminate the nuances in interpersonal meaning-making and affiliative strategies used in the practice of incitement. Just as communicated threats never operate outside the context of threatener-threatened interpersonal relations and attitudes

(Storey, 1995), inciting texts never operate outside the context of inciter-incitee interpersonal values, relations and worldviews, which tend to be encoded in evaluative language.

2.6 Conclusion

This chapter has contextualized the current thesis in relation to research into: (i) the practices of examining the elements of violence within the area of threat assessment; and (ii) two aspects of threat: communicated threats and incitement to violence. This contextualization has served to establish and justify the theoretical approach employed by this thesis (Chapter Three), and to present its application in the methodology (Chapter Four). After introducing this chapter, Section 2.2 reviewed interdisciplinary, non-linguistic studies of threatening communication, with a focus on the insights that these studies offer for forensic linguists into the features that can be examined to help identify offender's aspects such as violent attitudes and agendas. In Section 2.3, well established practices within the multidisciplinary field of threat assessment, and on the language of features of violent discourse and terrorism, have informed this thesis on language features to examine and methods to use. It was demonstrated that computational and corpus analysis tools present effective tools for exploring linguistic patterns as clues for violent intentions.

Although the work that has been conducted on (terrorist) threatening communication, and the two aspects of threats of interest, shows significant progress, a number of areas remain to be empirically verified. For example, little is known about the role of social (dis)affiliation in terrorist texts. Reviewing the main approaches to analysing communicated threats and threats' functions, in Section 2.4, has exhibited room for this thesis chiefly to: (i) approach the role of appraisal resources in forging disalignment or alternatively social disaffiliation; and (ii) focus on the discursive functions of threat texts. Reviewing research into violent discourse as incitement, in Section 2.5, highlighted a niche to contribute to via this thesis, specifically by approaching the tactics of incitement as (dis)affiliative tactics which can also be explored by focusing on the role of appraisal resources in enacting social (dis)affiliation. It was demonstrated that SFL tools of appraisal not only can provide indications of violent values and hostile identities (as in Chapter Five, Section 5.4) but also can serve as resources for enacting value (dis)alignments, when considered within the Affiliation framework, in the

contexts of incitement to violence and communicated threats. These resources and contexts will be fully demonstrated in Chapters Six and Seven, respectively.

CHAPTER THREE: THEORETICAL FRAMEWORK AND APPROACH

“Language is as it is because of its function in the social structure” (Halliday, 1973, p. 65)

3.1 Introduction

Emphasising the usefulness of the functional approach to forensic linguistic enquiry, May, Sousa-Silva and Coulthard (2021, p. 1) contend: “When Halliday wrote ‘language is as it is because of what it has to do’ [...], a functional theory of language was born, giving us a perspective of meaning-making that is grounded in social practice and in the many varied and complex contexts in which we find ourselves”. This perspective applies to terrorists’ social semiotic practices and the language of violent extremism, where texts are – in Bourdieu’s (1991) terms – created from and situated within the socio-historic period in which they are composed. As such, terrorist texts need be investigated via a framework that views language as part of a larger semiotic system of meanings, central to which are an author’s culturally and morally informed attitudes, values and worldviews.

The present research falls within the general domain of ‘language as evidence’ as discussed by, for example, Coulthard and Johnson (2007). In this domain, analysts of linguistic evidence, firstly, examine instances of communication to reveal or determine meaning (of e.g. lexicogrammatical choices and utterances therein) and, secondly, pursue the identification of the characteristics of the language user (e.g. through the socio- and psycho-linguistic profiling of texts producers) (Gibbons, 2009). Within this domain, linguists seek: (i) to provide “proof of understanding” as grounds for how an utterance or a text should be understood in certain contexts; and (ii) to obtain insights into the style of an author of a set of texts through exploring linguistic patterns (Kniffka, 2007, p. 54). The kinds of linguistic analysis involved within this domain include of “phonetic and phonological, morphological, syntactic, lexical, discursal, textual and pragmatic” features in a dataset (Coulthard & Johnson, 2007, p. 121). That said, there are no ready-to-use tools and approaches, or a particular set of features to examine, that suit every case or question. Considering this analytical challenge, the aim of the rest of this chapter is threefold. Firstly, it presents the underlying theoretical frameworks on

which this research is based. Secondly, arguments concerning the usefulness of adopted tools and frameworks are presented, by drawing on a critical review of the relevant literature, to justify the application of these tools to a specialised corpus of terrorist statements. Thirdly, the chapter describes the empirical basis of this research and its designed toolkit. Following the tradition of Coulthard & Johnson (2007), Coulthard (2010) and Prideaux (2011) in forensic linguistics, the term ‘toolkit’ is used in this thesis to refer to the selection of analytical tools, from different theoretical and analytical models (i.e. the descriptive linguist’s toolbox), that are necessary to approach the text types analysed.

3.2 Main approaches to written texts in Forensic Linguistics

To analyse publicly available terrorist texts, this thesis uses corpus analysis methods and draws on Appraisal and Affiliation frameworks as discourse analytic methods that are appropriate to texts used in terrorism contexts. In so doing, the thesis follows well established practices within the broad area of ‘language as evidence’ where a linguist chooses “an eclectic selection of tools and a developmental approach to methodology that is necessary” to the text types and the context of their use (Coulthard & Johnson, 2007, p. 14). This thesis adopts a selection from a lexical, semantic and discoursal or textual toolkit, and examines their pragmatic functions. That is, a study of different levels of linguistic analysis is mobilized to identify, characterize and describe the sample terrorist texts, given that “interpretation of any particular text is governed by a variety of [linguistic] factors” (Prideaux, 2011, p. 39). This selection is akin to Prideaux’s (2009, 2011) toolkit which is created to examine hate-fed language texts. Unlike Prideaux’s toolkit of qualitative analysis, the toolkit in this thesis is grounded in SFL and computational techniques, put into a coherent analytic instrument to allow for a necessary systematic analysis of multiple aspects of terrorist discourse.

In forensic linguistics, there are two main methodologies to written text authorship (identification) analysis: the cognitive and the stylistic approaches (Grant, 2010). Debate about the significance of each method for the field of forensic linguistics (see, e.g., Crystal, 1995; Chaski, 2001, 2013; Grant & Baker, 2001; McMenamin, 2001; Olsson, 2008; Grant, 2010; Johnson & Wright, 2014) aims at finding a set of accepted, reliable and scientifically valid methods to be used in text analysis tasks. Central to the debate is that, firstly, any linguistic analysis for forensic purposes should use approaches, tools, methods and

techniques that are “generally acceptable”, i.e. based on tested theory and subjected to peer-review and publication (McMenamin, 2010, p. 504). In this thesis, the Appraisal and Affiliation frameworks, grounded in the SFL theory, and two computational text-analysis tools (LIWC and AntConc), are taken as accepted methods and tools – as explained in Chapter Two and in this chapter, Sections 3.3 and Section 3.4. Secondly, central to the debate is the concept of ‘idiolect’– “which rests on psycholinguistic or sociolinguistic theory” (Grant & Woodhams, 2007, p. 1; Coulthard, 2004).

In the cognitive approach, linguists (e.g., Coulthard & Johnson, 2007) argue that operating with the theory of idiolect is fundamental, and that any related method of analysis has to be reliably and quantitatively tested (Chaski, 2001). They assume that an individual has a particular structure of cognition which manifests in the language they produce, and that this idiolect will manifest itself through idiosyncratic choices in speech and writing and choice of vocabulary. A popular example of the usefulness of idiolect is the ‘Unabomber’ case, where the similarities in concepts (thoughts) and repeated lexicogrammatical selections and co-selections in the left-wing terrorist Theodore Kaczynski's texts were useful for the FBI's identification of Kaczynski's identity (Coulthard & Johnson, 2007; DeSa & McCarthy, 2009). Aligned with the cognitive approach's emphasis on quantitative analysis, this thesis explores characteristic vocabulary choice in my dataset, and statistics-based analysis of lexical and conceptual choices is carried out (as detailed in Chapter Four, Sections 4.4.1 and Section 4.4.2).

In the forensic stylistics approach (see e.g., McMenamin, 2002, 2010, 2021), linguists consider a theory of idiolect to be useful but not so necessary that we take it as an absolute notion. What is necessary, instead, is to focus on the distinctive rather than unique style of a set of texts within an inquiry (Olsson, 2008, p. 31). What makes an individual's text or speech identifiable is their style and style markers (e.g. lexical and semantic variations), pictured in McMenamin's ‘forensic stylistics’ theory (see McMenamin, 2002). Since the stylistic approach takes up the sociolinguistic view of style, cross-individuals’ socio-historic differences (e.g. ethnicity, geography, gender, age) are taken as the basis for accounting for differences in style markers and repertoires of choice. This stylistic approach is also of interest to the present research. Focus in this thesis is placed on the patterns of semantic features, chiefly the co-patterning of attitudinal meanings and general ideations (e.g. ingroup versus outgroup social

actors) as collocative values realised in lexicogrammatical structures. I am specifically concerned with a terrorist's evaluative signature (e.g. Etaywe & Zappavigna, 2021), or alternatively "appraisal signature" (Martin & White, 2005, p. 208), manifested as "idiolectal reconfigurations of meaning-making potential" that are observed in a set of texts. As such, the patterns of choice from the semantics of attitude are observed as a path through the network of systems of a language that an author habitually selects in a terrorist context. Since attitude-ideation coupling is the key unit of analysis in both my appraisal and affiliation analysis (as explained in Section 3.4), with style being thought of as 'coupling disposition' (Zappavigna, 2018) or evaluative disposition (Etaywe & Zappavigna, 2021) which is determined by the functional and ideological needs of the text producer and by "the norms of the socially appropriate genre of these functions" (Birch & O'Toole, 1988, p. 1). In Zappavigna, Dwyer and Martin's (2008, p. 171) terms, focus on the characteristic use of couplings in a terrorist context allows for identifying and describing patterns in: the paradigmatic options across metafunctions, since patterns of the same type of coupling "are likely to reoccur across a text or a set of texts under analysis"; and the syntagmatic options, "since items that are coupled are likely to occur very near each other logogenetically".

3.2.1 Mixed approach proposed

Considering the discussion of the two approaches above, a mixed (quantitative-/qualitative) approach is adopted in this thesis to go beyond the limits of any single, separate approach. While some features can be explored entirely qualitatively (e.g. lexical choices), exploring other features might be accessible only via a qualitative analysis (e.g. Wright, 2014), as in the appraisal and affiliation analysis. In this thesis, I adopt a mixed approach so that the tools used suit the nature of the features and the research questions. The mixed approach here presents a complementary approach that bridges the gap between the cognitive and stylistic approaches. The use of statistical and computational tools, such as LIWC (Almela et al., 2019), that are defined clearly in advance and are amenable to clear objective definition (Chaski, 2001, 2005, 2006, 2013) allows for determining, prior to approaching the texts, which set of features or markers to explore and based on which predefined categories. This quantitative analysis also allows for enhancing the objectivity of the findings (Nini & Grant, 2013).

The use of qualitative analysis of appraisal and affiliation by focusing on the attitude-ideation couplings also allows for a systematic analysis of coupling disposition and a terrorist's evaluative signature. This qualitative analysis is aligned with Nini and Grant's (2013, p. 180) proposed SFL-based theory of idiolect, where idiolect is viewed as being "the path through the network of systems of a language that an individual habitually selects in a certain context because of their unique sociolinguistic background". To account for the linguistic evidence of enactment of the practices of incitement or threatening, I argue that there are instances of linguistic evidence (particularly those related to semantic features) which cannot be approached quantitatively due to inherent characteristics (for a similar argument for a qualitative approach, see also Olsson, 2004). These characteristics include the rhetorical argumentative/persuasive strategies and the pragmatic functions of utterances or structures (Prideaux, 2011). Evidence may also emerge from meaning that is construed by the interaction of linguistic choices (Kniffka, 2007), as in the case of interaction of ideations with attitudinal meanings in this thesis, which interaction is difficult to detect computationally. In these situations, which are all relevant to this thesis, qualitative evidence would be given primacy over quantification, given that the qualitative linguistic approach (namely, discourse analytic approach) "has its foundations in the linguistic theories of language variation" and can provide valid linguistic explanation and evidence (e.g. Wright, 2014, pp. 20-22; Heydon, 2005, 2012, 2014; Coulthard, Johnson & Wright, 2017). Discourse analysis is, thus, crucially important because this thesis deals with texts underpinned by ideologies, hence requiring tools the hallmark of which is – in Baxter's (2010) terms – recognition of the variability in authors' discourses and that a discourse is context-dependent, wherein language is used for various functions and its use has variable consequences, depending on the audiences, purposes and contexts of language use.

Considering the above discussion and critique, a research design that combines quantitative tools (corpus analysis tools) and qualitative tools (discourse analysis tools) is adopted in this thesis. This mixed approach is a well-established practice in forensic linguistics (see Coulthard, Johnson & Wright, 2017, p. 207). Given there are no specific techniques applicable to all questions of all forensic investigations (Grant, 2008), what we need for the analysis of any set of texts is a selection from the "descriptive linguist's toolbox" that fits the nature of features and questions under investigation (Coulthard, 2010, p. 20).

3.2.2 Proposed properties and devices to examine in the terrorist texts

Terrorism is a complex, sociopolitical construct (Bhatia, 2009), within which terrorists produce texts that are sophisticated and difficult to research (Baker & Vessey, 2018). Terrorist texts are made up of social, psychological (Borum, 2003) and linguistic phenomena (Baker & Vessey, 2018), and to approach this type of discourse requires a nuanced investigation of discourse-specific properties and features. Inspired by Prideaux's (2009, 2011) linguistic enquiry of aggressive communication and hate messages within the domain of 'language as evidence', an established starting point for analysing texts with threat and/or incitement functions is to consider these texts:

- To be, firstly, an exhibition of properties that reflect certain thematic focus, lexical selection, attitudes, rhetorical force, presuppositions, assumptions and values;
- To be, secondly, constructed by using various linguistic, stylistic and rhetorical devices.

In addition to these properties and devices, I add a statistical analysis phase. These proposed properties and devices, used in text production, can guide audiences on how they may understand or construct an interpretation from a text (Prideaux, 2009). However, unlike Prideaux's entirely qualitative investigation, adopting a complementary, mixed approach better fits my research questions and provides more objectivity and different views.

3.2.3 Proposed tools to approach the features and devices used in the terrorist texts

Due to the nature of discourse features and questions under investigation, I adopt diverse tools synthesised to yield systematic analysis of the features proposed in previous subsection. Specifically, I propose the use of corpus analysis tools (described in Section 3.3) to examine

- patterns of lexical choices, thematic and conceptual focus, and patterns of attitudinal meanings (the focus of Research Question One).

The corpus linguistics analysis phase aims to establish "ground truth" data and gain reliable, replicable qualitative analysis (Chaski, 2013, p. 376). The findings from the investigation of these lexicogrammatical features are taken as discursive markers of the dataset. Similar to

Parodi (2008) and Saldanha (2009), corpus linguistics is taken here as a method by means of which linguistic patterns of any type can be investigated (e.g. Sinclair, 1998) for forensic purposes (Almela et al., 2019).

In addition, I propose the use of SFL tools and system networks (described in Section 3.4) to investigate

- choices in rhetorical and (dis)affiliative strategies.

These choices are taken as grounds for understanding the terrorist texts and as evidence of engagement in the discursive practices of incitement and threatening – the focus of Research Questions Two and Three. Engaging with these properties and rhetorical tactics offers insight into, and a diagnostic for, the characteristics of the terrorist public statements.

In sum, the methodological paradigm of this research is based on one key assumption, which is: terrorists' ideologies and ethnicity, and the sociocultural framework within which a terrorist (group) operates, have a fundamental impact on the strategic choice and function of linguistic resources as well as interpersonal relation-enactment. I contend that contextual differences (e.g. geography, ethnicity and extremist group ideology) between terrorists influence their discourse features – which is aligned with Nini and Grant's (2013) contention on the impact of contextual differences on patterns. Accordingly, there may exist observable similarities and differences across each terrorist's set of texts in the strategic choice of the discursive markers and rhetorical strategies manifesting in their discourse. These choices will mark terrorist threatening communication at the lexicogrammatical and semantic levels and provide semiotic clues of the enacted language crimes and performed identities. The overall similarities are assumed to be originating from: the authors' personal attributes that are realised in their language production; their ideological violent agenda; and the norms of the inciting and threatening terrorist discourse. Similarity or variation in linguistic production is taken as – in Butler's (1988, p. 97) terms – “the product of adaptability” and meeting the communicative purposes in a speech event (e.g. Olsson, 2008; Grant, 2010).

3.3 Corpus analysis tools for a forensic analysis

Corpus linguistic (CL) analysis is known for its focus on one or more corpora. CL is an applied linguistics empirical method whereby target texts can be analysed to identify patterns of

meaning and language structure use (Anthony, 2013). CL also helps to interpret results and feature-functions (Biber, Conrad & Reppen, 1998; Biber & Conrad, 2009). The term ‘corpus’, in this thesis, refers to a collection of terrorist threatening texts that are processed computationally for forensic linguistic research purposes (similar to Almela et al., 2019). Linguists need computer tools empowered by analytical techniques to assist in identifying and counting linguistic features within corpora, be they small or large (Coulthard, Johnson & Wright, 2017). These tools analyse language based on two main principles, empiricism and technology, which enables a valid, reliable, replicable and more objective exploration of language features (Anthony, 2013; Coulthard, Johnson & Wright, 2017).

One of the most widely used CL tools is AntConc (Anthony, 2019a). AntConc is free computer software equipped with standard corpus methods that help to identify and analyse linguistic features within a corpus. These corpus methods include, but are not limited to, the following (Anthony, 2019b):

- **A ‘word list’ option:** which assists in identifying word frequency;
- **Key-word-in-context (KWIC) concordances:** which help to analyse the context, i.e. word(s) to left and/or right of frequent words;
- **Concordance plot:** which serves in identifying the position of words intra-textually and inter-textually;
- **Cluster/n-grams and collocates:** which help to explore contiguous sequences of words.

These features, *inter alia*, of corpus analysis tools attest that affordances of CL methods can serve to illuminate dimensions of discursive features and meaning that are useful to my investigation. CL combines both qualitative methods (e.g. KWIC or concordance line, since it allows for exploring a word’s behaviour in context) and quantitative methods, and provides analysts with an approach that renders more objective insights and that meets “the standards of producing rigorous empirical results” (Coulthard, Johnson & Wright, 2017, p. 26). Due to the rigour rendered by AntConc functions, AntConc is used in my investigation – akin to Longhi’s (2021) use of corpus and digital humanities tools – to identify regularities and patterns in the dataset.

Another powerful text analysis tool used in text analysis tasks and data annotation of discourses of violence is Linguistic Inquiry and Word Count (LIWC) (Pennebaker et al., 2015). LIWC is proprietary software that requires a fee-paying licence. LIWC enables the extraction of different linguistic and psychological features from natural language texts by searching and calculating the percentage of words (e.g. buy, economy and wealth) within various categories (e.g. 'money' category) within any given file of texts (Pennebaker & Chung, 2007). LIWC searches for predefined "accepted" sets of psycholinguistic and semantic categories realised at the lexical level and based on the LIWC inbuilt dictionary (Almela et al., 2019, p. 3). LIWC provides algorithms of words related to a number of conceptual categories and semantic fields. The weight of each category depends on the proportion of explored words assigned to each category. Although LIWC's categories were created with the help of English-speaking judges, LIWC is a valid tool for analysing texts created in other languages, or translated into English, as in Almela et al. (2019) and Pennebaker and Chung (2007), respectively. Although LIWC categorises language based on assumptions coming from psychology, LIWC provides a set of empirically predefined categorisations based on the actual use of language. In addition, while LIWC does not code all words if they are not in its dictionary – that is, so some concepts might be missing from a LIWC-based analysis – LIWC's use has been proven crucial in: providing computerised lexical pattern analysis; assessing threatening communication and aggressive behaviour; and predicting and tracking persons' attributes and ideological motives through their linguistic production and lexical choice, with a high standard of reliability (Grant, 2008; Pennebaker & Chung, 2011). LIWC's predefined categories are useful for assessing threatening communication and aggressive behaviour (Pennebaker & Chung, 2011) and can inform investigators about "what kind of psychological person(s) wrote [a text]?" (Grant, 2008, p. 223).

Nevertheless, analysis with a focus on semantic properties "cannot always delegate text processing to machines" and requires the analyst's input on various factors (Knoblock, 2017, p. 298). Therefore, additional (sub)categories of lexis are introduced in this research to better account for the dataset. To provide more robust semantic evidence of violent-intention and commitment thereto, more attention has also been given to attitudinally loaded lexis and their functional patterns (see e.g. Gales, 2010), or alternatively, patterns of attitudinal meanings. Given the role of ATTITUDE types (e.g. AFFECT) in exploring types of ATTITUDE that may

characterise an author's textual style (Argamon & Koppel, 2010), I adopt Gales' (2010, 2013) suggestion of investigating the functional patterns of attitudinally loaded structures by using the Appraisal framework (Martin & White, 2005), briefly outlined in Section 3.4.1. However, I examine these patterns in repeatedly used lexical items that are identified computationally. This aims to add to the linguistic research that seeks to bridge the gap between cognitive, computational and functional stylistic approaches to authorship analysis (see, e.g. Argamon & Koppel, 2010, 2013; Nini & Grant, 2013; Canning, 2014; Johnson & Wright, 2014). As such, I investigate lexical features proposed by literature on discourse of violence and threat assessment, as well as patterns of attitudinal meanings as language features of terrorist threatening communication. ATTITUDE is an inextricable phenomenon, from the interpersonal function, of terrorist threatening communication, and analysing patterns of attitudinal meanings adds to the limited research on patterns of attitudinal meanings as markers of violence and hostile identities. In this research, I argue that a terrorist's "personal" (e.g. aggressive) and "relational" (e.g. distant) identities (Tracy & Robles, 2002, pp. 21-24) are – using Bednarek's (2010, p. 251) terms on performing identities – "performative[ly]" produced or constituted by repeatedly used attitudinal lexical items (lemmas).

As such, three of the main aspects of corpus analysis that are used for forensic purposes, and in the present research, are (Almela et al., 2019):

- **Frequency:** which provides a more quantitative perspective by providing the number of a word's (or a string of words') occurrence in a corpus. For example, "[h]igh frequency lexicon could discriminate the works of authors from each other" (Olsson, 2008, p. 37);
- **Concordance:** which is a more qualitative standpoint;
- **Annotation** (tagging).

While frequency and concordance have been touched upon above, annotation deserves elaboration. Corpora can be annotated at different levels (e.g. lexical, semantic, syntactic), depending on the features of interest and questions of investigation. Feature annotation can be carried out entirely computationally, semi-computationally, or manually. While fully automated analysis might be the most objective, a manual annotation might be considered the most accurate (yet extremely time-consuming), and a semi-computational approach

might be desirable in particular when it is justified as in forensic uses (Almela et al., 2019). In this thesis, I use all three forms of annotation at different phases of analysis (see Section 4.4.2 of Chapter Four). This mix of annotation aims to provide a more comprehensive description of the corpus, to better account for those groups of lexicogrammatical features discovered during the close linguistic analysis phase, and to account for the semantic functions of a range of attitudinally loaded lexical items, which offers a more semantically rich analysis.

In sum, computational/corpus analysis tools – see Sousa-Silva (2018) for more on these terms – are used to offer reliable, replicable and more objective analysis of language features. These tools (namely, LIWC and AntConc) are typically employed in forensic studies, and are useful for text-typing and linguistic profiling of authors through enabling empirical examination of lexicogrammatical features in a corpus of terrorist public statements. Corpus analysis tools assist in producing empirically recognizable patterns of meaning, and in quantitatively examining predetermined features. Together, the search for lexical patterns, for words grouped in particular conceptual and grammatical (e.g. pronouns) categories, and for patterns of meanings underlying repeated, attitudinally loaded lexical items in a terrorist context, introduces a powerful tool for exploring and distinguishing terrorist threatening communication. “Foregrounding” most frequent lexical items, concepts and meanings provides more substantiation to the interpretation of terrorist texts and to threat assessors’ decisions on text evaluation (Fialho & Zyngier, 2014, p. 333). Patterns in lexicogrammatical structure and attitudinal meanings are taken in this thesis as the set of language features that assist in the linguistic profiling of authors, in characterising terrorist threatening texts in the dataset, and in providing semantics-based evidence of an author’s engagement in violence.

3.4 Systemic Functional Linguistics (SFL) and related tools

SFL is a theory of language with its own frameworks and tools of analysis, which envisages language as a social semiotic activity that makes meaning intersubjectively (Halliday, 1973, 1978). In SFL, language is envisaged as a system for enacting and construing meanings of different types (Halliday & Matthiessen, 2014). Language enacts our social relations, that is, it manages our interactions with other people, social networks and identities. Language also construes our sense of reality, including recognising and naming categories of phenomena

and their inter-relationships. These roles of language in relationship-enactment and reality-construction are of particular interest to this thesis.

3.4.1 Social structure, ideology and values from an SFL perspective

Fundamental to SFL, therefore, is the social nature of language, where choice of linguistic resources also enacts and reflects the social structures wherein these resources occur. SFL considers the social structure as “one aspect of the social system [of meanings]” (Halliday & Hasan, 1985, p. 4). Of interest to this thesis is to consider social structures of moral essence (van Langenhove, 2017). Within a text, language both expresses and symbolises the social and moral system, creating and being created by it (Halliday, 1978). This perspective of social structure and creating social systems is key to our understanding of the construed and negotiated moral values and moral orders, visited in Section 3.5, which are crucially relevant to understanding the “morality of terrorism” (Seto, 2002, p. 1262). Key to this understanding is the SFL view of the underlying ideologies and value systems (of enacted relations) which are part of any ideology (Hunston, 1993). The enacted relationships are “defined in the value systems and ideology of the culture” (Halliday & Hasan, 1985, p. 5).

Ideologies and values in SFL are ubiquitous in language, and are realised by lexicogrammatical patterns (Lukin, 2019, p. 75). That said, I argue that evidence of morally driven practice of incitement or threatening can be established on lexicogrammatical patterns that construe interpersonal meanings and values and that enact relations. I argue, however, that values are part of ideologies. I also adopt a social semiotic perspective on the terrorist text authors and their ideologies. That is, an ideology comprises “relational models”, i.e. a group’s worldview that is related to classifications of kinds of social agents, objects, and other phenomena, and “actional models” which are concerned with what actions are required, permitted or forbidden to kinds of social agents in order for a social actor to serve an ingroup’s interests and values (Hodge & Kress, 1988, p. 3).

3.4.2 Functionality, systematicity and semantic orientation

SFL, as a model of language that explores meaning making in its functional context, is a theory that is: functional, systemic and semantic in orientation. It is functional in the sense that it positions language use within its social context as the central focus of its inquiry. Drawing on

the anthropologist Malinowski's work on types of context, later theorised and elaborated by Firth (1950), SFL distinguishes between the context of situation and the context of culture (e.g. Hasan, 2016, pp. 55-56). An author of a text selects from the options which the culture – as “a semiotic system” – makes available to them based on the specificity of situation (Zappavigna, Dwyer & Martin, 2008, p. 167).

SFL is systemic since it models language by applying system networks of interrelated sets of options in meaning that are organised paradigmatically (Halliday & Matthiessen, 2014). Figure 3.1, in Section 3.4.1, demonstrates an example of system network. System networks enable analysts to “specify explicitly which options at a particular level of the language can be combined in the ‘selection expression’ describing a given stretch of language” (Butler, 1988, p. 87). Mapping the patterns of co-selection across system networks to make meaning also has distinction-/style-marking potential. SFL tools enable analysts to systematically capture explicit and implicit patterns of meaning and ideology-shaped texts (Fowler, 1996).

SFL is also semantic in the sense that it conceptualises language as a resource for making meaning and as one of human culture's systems of meaning (Halliday & Hasan, 1985). The emphasis on semantics and on paradigmatic relations, as two of the key language properties, has made SFL “extremely successful as the basis for various practical applications in stylistics” (Butler, 1988, pp. 97-98). SFL is, therefore, well-tailored to answering questions related to evidence of meaning making and patterns of meaning within specific contexts (Nini & Grant, 2013; Zappavigna, Dwyer & Martin, 2008) such as the terrorism context.

3.4.3 The notion of metafunction

One of the key tenets of SFL as semantics-oriented theory is Halliday's (meta)functional principle. This principle posits that language is organised in relation to social context to make three kinds of meanings or functions, termed metafunctions (Halliday & Matthiessen, 2014; Martin, 2010, p. 12):

- **Ideational meaning:** which is for construing our experience and knowledge of the world, and building “field”, i.e. it focuses on the social process, institutional activity and our participation in life and social processes;

- **Interpersonal meaning:** which is for enacting social relations and expressing attitudes, and building “tenor”, i.e. it relates to social positioning, and interpersonal relations, affinity, power and solidarity;
- **Textual meaning:** which is for “texturing” the inextricable interpersonal and ideational meanings in relation to “mode” (the nature of the form of contact), organising meanings of these two metafunctions into coherent units.

In this thesis, I am concerned with interpersonal meanings – in social processes and terrorist activities. I also view a text as: (a) “a semantic unit” made of meanings which are expressed, or coded, in words and structures; and as (b) “language that is functional”, i.e. “doing some job in some context” (Halliday & Hasan, 1985, p. 10). The fact that interpersonal and ideational (meta)functions are always espoused entails that I will be examining more than one (meta)function at a time, and an investigation of a text’s total meaning potential will, thus, offer a more robust analysis (see also Canning, 2014, p. 47). However, I argue that, by examining interpersonal meaning-making resources in particular in terrorist context, a linguist can work out what a text is doing in terms of incitement and threatening. According to Jeffries (2014, p. 409), “the best way” to set a textually constructed meaning in context is to base it in Halliday’s (meta)functions as a general model of linguistic meaning. I examine the choice of words and structures that encode interpersonal meanings – i.e. lexicogrammatical choices that realise semantics (Hasan, 2019) – and enact interpersonal relations (e.g. inclusion or exclusion).

That said, acts of ideological positioning, of building values and communities and of negotiating these communities, are of relevance to this research and are phenomena inextricably involved in the investigation of terrorist communication and its inciting and threat-communicating functions. This makes the concept of appraisal inevitable, to better account for the distinctive ways in which a terrorist communicates and how their communication gives rise to patterns in attitudinal meaning types and identifiable evaluative disposition. “Appraisal always involves the negotiation of solidarity” and alienation (Oteíza, 2017, p. 457), and is a means whereby a language user (dis)aligns themselves with people holding (dis)similar social positions (White, 2011). The following subsections present the Appraisal framework (Martin & White, 2005) (Subsection 3.4.1) and the theory of affiliation

(Knight, 2008, 2010a, 2010b, 2010c, 2013; Martin, 2010) (Subsection 3.4.2), as the SFL frameworks and tools most relevant to this thesis.

3.4.4 The Appraisal framework

A theoretical framework of evaluative language is crucial to interpreting and understanding interpersonal, attitudinal meanings in discourse. The Appraisal framework (Martin & White, 2005) is a model of evaluative language developed within the social semiotic paradigm of SFL, for analysing how interpersonal meanings, for example, stances and personae, are construed in language and function in social context. The framework is useful for capturing delicate interpersonal meanings and investigating the rhetorical mechanisms of ideological positioning of and value alignment with audiences (White, 2006; Macken-Horarik & Isaac, 2014; Inako, 2015; Liu & Hood, 2019), making the framework crucial to my project.

The Appraisal framework offers a discourse semantic approach to evaluative language. This approach is modelled as three interacting systems of meaning: *ATTITUDE*, which concerns values for construing positive/negative stances; *GRADUATION*, which deals with values of grading evaluation; and *ENGAGEMENT*, which considers how the author engages with other voices (Martin & White, 2005, pp. 35-44). The present research is primarily concerned with the *ATTITUDE* system and, thus, with stances towards phenomena, including “the entities, happenings, or state of affairs being construed by the text” (White, 2015, pp. 44-45).

3.4.4.1 The ATTITUDE system

My focus on the *ATTITUDE* system is driven, firstly, by the system of attitudinal meanings giving us “a framework for mapping feelings as construed in [discourse]” (Martin & White, 2005, p. 42), and, secondly, the *ATTITUDE* system is the primary Appraisal system used in the Affiliation framework (explained in Section 3.4.5). In the *ATTITUDE* system (see Figure 3.1), a square bracket represents a choice between options (an ‘or’ relation), as in *AFFECT*, *JUDGEMENT* or *APPRECIATION* options within the *TYPE* system, while a brace represents simultaneous choices (an ‘and’ relation). The *ATTITUDE* system encompasses three simultaneous systems: *TYPE*, *EXPLICITNESS* and *POLARITY*. In other words, an author’s choice of an attitudinal meaning-making resource involves a selection of *ATTITUDE* types, a choice of *EXPLICITNESS* (inscribed or invoked, i.e. explicit or implicit), and an option from within *POLARITY* (positive *ATTITUDE* or negative

ATTITUDE). In this thesis, the coding for polarity is based on an extremist-ingroup perspective of socially (un)accepted values.

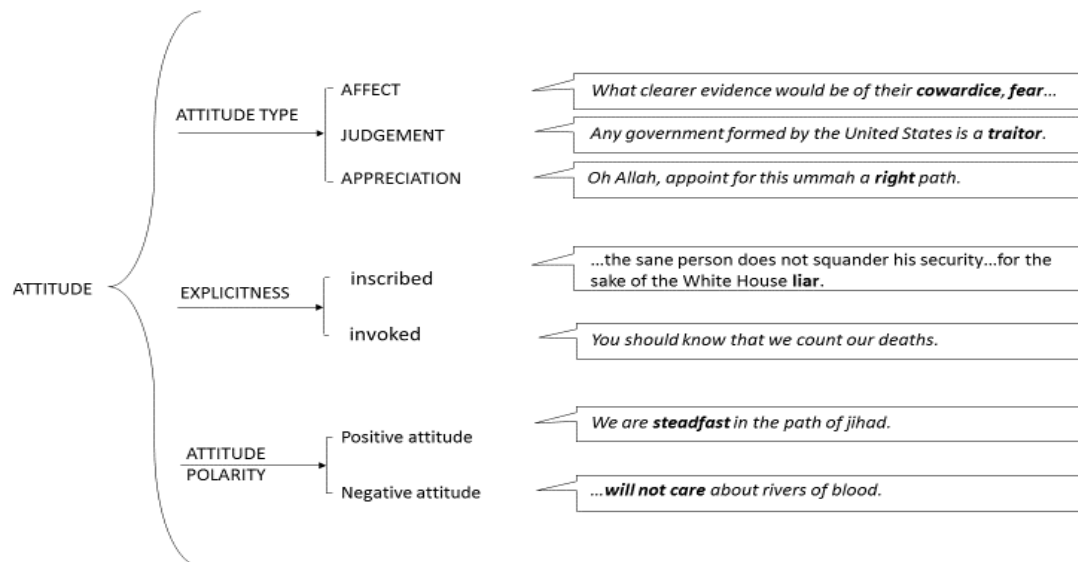


Figure 3.1: Attitude system (adapted from Martin & White, 2005)

The ATTITUDE system is used to investigate three “ways of feeling” and evaluative values, pertinent to three semantic regions traditionally referred to as emotion (AFFECT), ethics/morality (JUDGEMENT) and aesthetics (APPRECIATION) (Martin & White, 2005). Extracts from Osama bin Laden’s statements in the boxes in Figure 3.1 are example realisations of the features in the network:

- AFFECT: resources and features for expressing emotional reactions and states (e.g. ‘you **have brought joy to the hearts of Muslims**’), which can be further subcategorised into (UN)HAPPINESS, (IN)SECURITY, (DIS)SATISFACTION and (DIS)INCLINATION.
- JUDGEMENT: resources and features for construing assessments of behaviour in terms of how we should behave or not, some of which get formalised as rules and regulations set by a society, state or a religious institution. Judgements are divided into those dealing with values of social esteem (e.g. ‘We are **powerful**’) (subcategorised as NORMALITY, CAPACITY and TENACITY) and those oriented to values

of social sanction (e.g. 'He is **corrupt**') (i.e. subcategories of VERACITY and PROPRIETY).

- APPRECIATION: resources for estimating the value of things, events, processes and products in terms of aesthetic dimensions (e.g. 'Your jihad is **commendable**'), and includes REACTION (resources of impact and quality), COMPOSITION (harmony and order) and VALUATION parameters.

ATTITUDE can be modulated in terms of explicitness and polarity. ATTITUDE can also be up or downscaled by the system of GRADUATION and attributed to textual persona or other voices through the system of ENGAGEMENT (Martin & White, 2005). Mapping some realizations that are suggested by Martin and White (2005), White (2006) and Knight (2010c) for invoking attitude can, thus, provide a fuller account of examined attitude, particularly in relation to the interpretation of a text as informed by social affiliation theory (detailed in Subsection 3.4.2). This includes mapping the flagging (i.e. realisations of GRADUATION), affording (realisations of ENGAGEMENT), and provoking mechanisms. Most relevant to this research are affording and provoking mechanisms. Affording mechanisms include the attribution strategies used to endorse or distance an author from the construed value position, inclusive and exclusive pronouns (e.g. 'we' and 'they', respectively), and naming. Pronouns and names are taken as involvement resources that provide evidence of shared group knowledge and as resources deployed to negotiate values (Knight, 2010c). Provoking mechanisms include: realisations of quotations, proverbs, iconic names, and general cultural knowledge, as common ways of sharing a social/cultural membership or interest; and realisations of idioms and allusions/intertextual references to meaning, events or entities, as linguistic constructions that iconically represent associated memberships (Caple, 2010; Knight, 2010c). What stands behind the interpersonal 'charge' of these references is a process of iconisation (Knight, 2010c, p. 167).

The SFL principle of "iconisation" occurs when "ideational meaning is discharged and interpersonal meaning charged" (Martin, 2010, p. 21; Martin & Zappavigna, 2013) through various forms of semiosis (e.g. a proverb, a flag, a cross, a name of a leading figure, a religious text). An icon is formed when the ideational meaning of an object or an activity diminishes, and members of a community focus on the icon's emotional importance as a rallying device

or something that symbolises the community's unity (Martin, 2004). Wignell, Tan and O'Halloran's (2017) multimodal analysis of the ISIS online magazine Dabiq found that ISIS tends to use icons as attitudinal meaning-making resources and as a means of forging alignment of individual identities with ISIS's (Salafist) identity, reinforcing shared values, and excluding outgroups (Wignell, Tan & O'Halloran, 2017). This makes the principle of iconisation, as well as affording and provoking mechanisms, essential to my investigation of attitudinal meaning and relation enactment in terrorist communication. This thesis focuses on icons as realised within the lexicon.

With this power of the Appraisal framework in mind, the ATTITUDE system is appropriately situated to identify nuanced functions of interpersonal meanings within different genres (Schleppegrell, 2012; Millar & Hunston, 2015), including the threatening communication genre (e.g. Gales, 2010, 2011, 2013) and incitement in the terrorism context as demonstrated in this thesis. For example, through the Appraisal resources, an author can encode their stances, and by examining these resources a linguist can decode these stances and provide semantic evidence of threat function and justification (Gales, 2010, p. 196, 2011). Through evaluative resources, an audience can also be incited against an outgroup (see, e.g. Cotler & Grossman, 2009; Gordon, 2018). Thus, the ATTITUDE system offers an analytic resource that allows for a well-structured analysis of the delicate attitudinal meanings that fall within the interest of the present research. In the remaining sections and chapters, and in line with Hasan's (2010, pp. 277-278) and McMenamin's (2002, p. 101; 2010) view of encoding and decoding, I will use the term *encoded attitude* to refer to the ATTITUDE construed by an author as a result of context activation of meaning and meaning activation of wording. I will use *decoded attitude* as a term describing the outcome of the process of providing an account of repeated lexicogrammatical forms (i.e. wording) that construe meaning and the meaning choice that then construes context (similar to Etaywe & Zappavigna, 2021).

3.4.5 Affiliation theory

In my approach to the morally founded, discursive practices of terrorist communication, I adopt the general theoretical orientation that the ideological struggles of individuals and groups are manifest in the meanings and social values that are contested in the texts they produce (see Verschueren, 2012, pp. 7-10). Having said that, a theory of how meanings and

values – taken as interpersonal bonds in terms of the social relations that meanings and values enact (Zappavigna, 2014) – are construed and offered for negotiation in terrorist texts is crucial. A “direct link” exists between values and evaluative language which is essential for negotiating community and social affiliations (Thompson & Alba-Jues, 2014, p. 6; Bednarek, 2006; Martin, 2008; Millar & Hunston, 2015). In addition to the positioning and appraising functions of the evaluative language, an evaluative act also has a (dis)alignment function (Du Bois, 2007). This value-alignment act plays a significant role in discourses of violence and hate, particularly when the values have moral backing (Culpeper, Iganski & Sweiry, 2017).

The inextricable link between attitudinal meanings and forging alignment to construct social affiliation has received extensive attention in SFL research over the last decade (see, e.g. Knight, 2010b; Martin, 2010; Zappavigna & Martin, 2018; Zhao, 2020). The Affiliation framework was developed within Systemic Functional Linguistics (SFL), arising out of work on how social bonds are negotiated in conversational interactions (Knight 2010a, 2010b). Previous social semiotic studies of affiliation have focused on communication in contexts such as conversational humour (Knight, 2010b) and job interviews (Zhao, 2020). Extending this work to account for the affordances on online communication, Zappavigna (2011, 2019) developed the concept of ‘ambient’ affiliation, a key dimension of which is communing affiliation, that is, the sharing of social bonds in the absence of a direct exchange, for instance in mass hashtagging practices (Zappavigna & Martin, 2018). This dimension, for the purpose of this thesis, and the Affiliation framework are extended to terrorist discourse analysis for forensic purposes.

3.4.5.1 The main analytical unit in the Affiliation analysis

The main analytical unit used in an Affiliation analysis to investigate how values are negotiated in texts are couplings of ideational and attitudinal meaning through which interactants or audiences discursively co-identify (Knight 2010b). As such, the main assumption of the afore-stated SFL studies is that social values or bonds are realised in discourse as ‘couplings’ (Martin, 2010) of ideational and attitudinal meanings through which participants discursively co-identify (Knight, 2010b). This is based on Martin’s insight that we do not simply affiliate with feelings but with feelings about phenomena “and the activities [people] participate in, however abstract or concrete” (Martin, 2008, pp. 57-58). The concept

of coupling is central to account for the association between attitudinal meanings and their attitudinal targets (i.e. they cannot be divorced from each other) – presenting the two meanings as being always about something and addressing someone (Halliday & Matthiessen, 2014, p. 30).

Therefore, the key unit of analysis of discursive (dis)affiliation or co-identification is the ideation-attitude coupling, alternatively referred to as “evaluative couplings” (Knight, 2010c, p. 159). For example, the following extract incorporates a coupling of the ‘government formed by the United States’ with negative JUDGEMENT [ideation: government formed by the United States/attitude: negative JUDGEMENT], instantiating a ‘US is bad’ bond. This bond is considered the “minimal social unit” (Knight, 2010b, p. 45) which is then made available for negotiation:

*...any government formed by the United States is a **traitor**.*

In this example, a coupling realises a bond, and affiliation can be thought of as an act of “alignment to the couplings” (Han, 2015, p. 30; Zappavigna & Martin, 2018) – as a form of alignment against, for example, US credibility. This perspective on social affiliation draws on Martin and White’s (2005) Appraisal framework to explain how attitude in these couplings is realised through evaluative language across three semantic regions: AFFECT, JUDGEMENT and APPRECIATION – explained earlier in Section 3.4.1. This perspective is related to this thesis. For example, a terrorist addressing an ingroup’s audience in an incitement text, I argue, will attempt to be strategic in their couplings. Terrorists will “make the right decisions about what to textualize” and will keep the ideational meaning within a limit that guides the audience on how to understand a text (Coulthard, 1994, p. 4). Coupling interpersonal meanings with experiences that are relevant to ‘ideal’ audiences can generate an audience’s favourable inferences and guide the audience to understand the messages from a group ideology’s perspective. This makes exploring, within a coupling, “what is at stake when one stance is chosen over another” (Martin & White, 2005, p. 92) crucial to my investigation of (dis)affiliation in terrorist texts.

I also argue that a pattern of couplings can offer evidence of why they were selected in the first place, i.e. as entry points to and evidence of the rhetorical tactics of (dis)affiliation in terrorist communication. A pattern of couplings realises a pattern of bonds, and bonding is

concerned with the ways that language “negotiate[s] the potential that *feelings* have for aligning readers into ‘overlapping communities of attitudinal rapport’” (Caple, 2010, p. 116). According to Knight (2010b), such negotiation may take the form of: communing the bond by rallying around the coupling that realises a bond which a community's members share; condemning it by rejecting the coupling that realises an unshareable bond; or laughing it off by deferring the coupling (which realises unshared bond) to commune around another, which is more acceptable to the tenor of the interaction. In this thesis, forms of negotiating bonds, as used in terrorist texts, and patterns of bonds are explored.

Patterns of bonds offered in a text can invite supporters of the same worldview to form a network of supporters. Patterns of bonds/values can also disalign threatened victims. Using a coupling approach, an author's tendency to (dis)affiliate can be thought of as a form of evaluative or coupling disposition (Zappavigna, 2018; Etaywe & Zappavigna, 2021). In adopting the coupling approach, I argue for Caldwell's (2010, p. 76) contention that couplings' meaning potential can reinforce particular ideological networks, maintain the higher-level ideological (e.g. religious or racial) networks, and present polarising bonds that help to explain to culture outsiders and concerned agencies why some texts are polarising. Moreover, I argue for couplings' potential to intensify calls for affiliating with deployed values in texts and axiologising around ideations (Zappavigna, 2011). Through couplings, a text author can establish themselves as an affiliative and supportive participant of a social group's or other participants' values, and can create in the addressees' minds a favourable impression of themselves (Zhao, 2020) and their extremist organization. Likewise, an author communicating a threat against outgroups can establish themselves as disaligned with the excluded 'others'. In adopting a coupling approach to (dis)affiliative tactics, couplings in incitement texts and communicated threats are viewed as being strategically deployed so that ingroup participants can co-identify and ultimately support violent acts.

Drawing on the SFL theory of affiliation, I argue that (dis)affiliation strategies serve to present opposing social groups / actors as opposing networks of values. This opposition is enabled by ascribing evaluative categories to 'Us' versus 'Them' in inciting texts or 'Us' versus 'You' in communicated threats (Tann, 2010). With clusters of construed bonds, we end with categories of an outgroup's phenomena bundled together on one negative side, while on the positive side we have an ingroup's members invited to position themselves and to identify

with the author, in a polarising scene of categories (Tann, 2010, p. 180). The tendency of bond construction would also be built on moral bases.

3.5 Morality in terrorist texts: bonds at stake

Morality is key to understanding human behaviour, including terrorists' use of evaluative acts. These evaluative acts are not only situationally constructed but also morally informed, i.e. they are moral evaluative acts (Parvaresh & Tayebi, 2018). As such, the patterning of coupling attitudinal meaning with ideational targets in terrorist texts can be thought of as acts that are socially and morally constructed and have the potential to either establish alienation or "establish solidarity with the addressee" on moral bases (Thompson & Alba-Jues, 2014, p. 4). This contention is aligned with Seto's (2002, p. 1262) argument that, besides the social and political causes for terrorist attitudinal acts, terrorist acts "have intensely moral elements". These moral elements can bind people together and drive them (Haidt, 2013) to collective, hostility-fed crimes, where terrorist actions are seen as an endeavour to uphold or defend moral values that terrorists consider central to their life and identity (Bandura, 1990).

In this thesis, I adopt White's (2006) contention that, via evaluative ideological positionings, a text constructs a model of social and moral order – an order, I argue, that serves in justification of violence. That is, a text constructs "a model of what is normal and aberrant, beneficial and harmful, praiseworthy and blameworthy, and so on", and thus of what is (dis)approved of social actors (White, 2006, p. 38). I argue that, with the direct link between values and evaluative language (Thompson & Alba-Jues 2014), a terrorist text can construe and offer a model of moral order that derives from, *inter alia*, "cultural moral orders" (van Langenhove, 2017, p. 5). Thus, evaluative couplings that realise key bonds at stake form and have their roots in a moral order, that is: "any system of obligations that defines and organises the proper [...] relations among individuals and groups in a community" (Davis, 2008, p. 17, cited in Parvaresh & Tayebi, 2018, p. 92). These obligations form a set of norms, assumptions and expectations that guide an ingroup member's sense of what is good and bad (Culpeper, 2011), and how people should treat one another (Decety & Cowell, 2014). Therefore, extremist networks with different or competing moral orders to those of victims tend to invoke moral values common to those of the wider sociocultural ingroup in order to justify their attitudinal positions and violent actions (Graham et al., 2011), where violence is

framed as a response to – in White's (1997) terms – a moral order disruption or a threat to or breach of a group's moral order.

This framing of violence, as well as placing emphasis on the (e.g., religious, ethnic) sources of a group's moral order, are taken as role players in justifying communicated threats and incitement to violence. Identifying the construed moral values assists in interpreting what links social structure to people's (in)action (van Langenhove, 2017), and in exploring what binds incited people into their roles, duties and mutual obligations (cf. Graham et al., 2011) and brings them into an “engagement in a common [moral] enterprise” (Watts, 2010, p. 57). Within a framework of inter-group moral struggle and with the moral values’ intersubjective nature and relativity to audiences, a set of construed bonds can determine the desired and subsequent response (see Thompson & Alba-Jues, 2014, pp. 4/13) to a threat of the ingroup audience. The construction of struggle, and the legitimization of and coercing into violence within this struggle (e.g. Cap, 2017), might be constructed by drawing on the traditional rhetorical strategies of appeal to the addressees’ emotions (pathos), appeal to the addressees’ reason (logos), and appeal to the writer's character or his authority-based argument (ethos) (Poggi, 2005). These appeal strategies are adopted in this thesis to add an interpretive lens on how an author legitimizes the incited-for violence and influences the incitees’ attitudes and action. These appeal strategies are always there in any persuasive text (Poggi, 2005), can influence an audience's attitudes, beliefs, values and actions (Selzer, 2003; Poggi, 2005), and allow for using them simultaneously while using multiple approaches (e.g. Jucker, 1997).

In this thesis, the instantiated bonds and realising evaluative couplings are taken as activators of cultural/ideological moral orders, activators that draw on an ingroup's “basic moral perspective” (i.e. assumptions and predisposition) (Parvaresh, 2019, p. 79). These moral orders prescribed often include meta-values (i.e. moral foundations) about, for example, ‘loyalty’ to an ingroup, ‘care’ for the group's members, and ‘respect’ towards the ‘hierarchy’ in the group (van Langenhove, 2017, p. 5). These meta-values are adopted in this thesis as they can provide a coding frame to provide clues relating to the moral reasoning of aggression and what values underpin or regulate violence. Drawing on recent research into the morality of social actions and evaluation suggesting that evaluation in conflict contexts is sustained by universal yet culturally and contextually sensitive moral foundations (see e.g. Kádár,

Parvaresh & Ning 2019; Etaywe & Zappavigna, 2021; Etaywe, 2022), the following meta-values are related to this thesis (Haidt & Kesebir, 2010; Spencer-Oatey & Kádár, 2016; Ståhl, Zaal & Skitka, 2016):

- 'Ingroup/loyalty', 'authority/respect', and 'purity/sanctity' (or degradation) meta value: which are concerned with relational links;
- 'Harm/care', 'fairness/reciprocity' or cheating, and 'liberty/oppression' meta-values: which are relating to interpersonal and inter-group treatment.

Mapping the meta values that underpin the negotiated bonds of each author will sensitise us to the relationship between morality and the (dis)affiliative function of terrorist texts. Speakers or writers from different cultural groups can vary in the extent to which they emphasise (i.e. construct and appreciate) a particular meta-value that underpins their evaluative acts (see also Haidt & Graham 2007; Spencer-Oatey & Kádár, 2016, for similar argument). In addition, since the role of meta-values in social life and actions is regulatory, examining these meta-values provides information about the “emotional bases” of evaluations and the “deliberate reasoning processes” of actions and relations (Graham et al., 2011, p. 368; Spencer-Oatey & Kádár, 2016).

3.6 Conclusion

The main aim of this chapter was to provide the theoretical foundations of the present investigation of terrorist texts, and to establish the empirical and theoretical approach used in this thesis. Section 3.1 contextualised this investigation within the domain of ‘language as evidence’. In Section 3.2, two main theoretical approaches to authorship analysis were reviewed, the need for a complementary, quantitative and qualitative approach was emphasised, and a rationale for the kind of features and devices that this thesis explores was provided. Section 3.3 presented the related corpus analysis tools and the functions (e.g. frequency, and concordance) that serve this forensic linguistic analysis. It was emphasised that employing computational tools for analysing previously determined features would provide reliable and objective findings.

In Section 3.4 SFL was demonstrated to be an effective, reliable and appropriate theory for the study of meaning and interpersonal phenomena in the terrorist context from a social

semiotic perspective. SFL's systems provide well-defined sets of options in meanings organised paradigmatically, in terms of "what could go instead of what" in real contexts (Halliday & Matthiessen, 2014, p. 22). It has been emphasised that SFL tools can offer a robust basis for reliable and valid application in forensic contexts, assisting in (Canning, 2014, p. 64):

- Providing insights into texts by examining linguistic patterning and functions through an amalgam of metafunctions;
- Supplementing the author's linguistic and psychological profiling, and "offering profitable analyses in the field of criminology".

Section 3.5 justified the need for the concepts of moral order and meta-values in order to obtain an interpretive lens on moral reasoning of violence. In sum, this chapter has set the stage for the research design. Building on this theoretical framework, the next chapter details the methodological approach and the research design of this thesis.

CHAPTER FOUR: RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

4.1 Introduction

While Chapter Three has detailed the theoretical background and empirical basis of this research, Chapter Four focuses on the dataset and data analysis procedures. In so doing, the contribution of this chapter is three-fold. Firstly, it gives an overview of the corpus and the corpus design criteria (Section 4.2). Secondly, it presents the sampled texts for each of the four terrorist authors (Section 4.3). Thirdly, it explains in detail the research design in terms of both the methodological approach and data analysis procedures that were implemented in order to address the research question (Section 4.4).

4.2 Overview of the corpus

The dataset explored in this thesis consists of 20 terrorist public statements (40,093 words) produced by four terrorists affiliated with four extremist groups. The sample of written texts is from the period following the September 11 attacks on the USA in 2001. This era is of a global significance in terms of the shift in focus of international security towards transnational terrorism, and in terrorist motivations, agendas and geographical spread (Smith & Zeigler, 2017). The statements are “manifestos” that express the key goals, values, and intentions of these groups (Smith, 2004, p. 419; Miller, 1987). The four terrorists included in the dataset are:

- Former al-Qaeda leader Osama bin Laden (hereafter, OBL) (10,017 words);
- ‘Jamatu Ahlis Sunna Lidda’awati wal-jihad’ (The Group of People of Sunnah for Preaching and Jihad)/Boko Haram leader Abubaker Shekau (hereafter, Shekau) (10,048 words);
- Former ISIS leader Abubaker al-Baghdadi (hereafter, al-Baghdadi) (10,028 words);
- Far right member Brenton Tarrant (hereafter, Tarrant,) (10,000 words).

Statements by each of these authors form the four sub-corpora grouped by author (Table 4.1).

Table 4.1: Overview of the dataset

Author (group)	Text code	Title/topic	Word count
Osama bin Laden (al-Qaeda)	OBL 1	A message to the American People (2004)	2163
	OBL 2	A message to Iraqis in particular, and Muslims in General (2003)	1569
	OBL 3	A message to the American People (on Aggression on Iraq) (2003)	1154
	OBL 4	A message to the Muslim Ummah (2001)	802
	OBL 5	A message to the People of Iraq in Particular, and Muslims in General (2003)	2187
	OBL 6	A statement on Prince Abdullah bin Abdulaziz's Initiative for Peace with Israel (2002)	1705
	OBL 7	A message to the Pakistani people (2001)	437
	OBL 8	A message to the Afghan people (2002)	546
Abubaker Shekau (Jamatul Ahlis Sunna Lidda'awati wal-jihad/Boko Haram)	Shekau 1	Tired of this calamity – a message to the Nigerians, General Rogers, and youth vigilante (2018)	679
	Shekau 2	Chibok girls kidnapped; we are in-laws – a message to President Buhari (2018)	898
	Shekau 3	Victory in Maiduguri attack, and conditions for ceasefire – a message to General Buratai (2017)	898
	Shekau 4	Defying the Nigerian government, Buhari, people of Chibok, people of Kanu, Kaduna, and El-Zakzaky (2016)	624
	Shekau 5	A Message to Sanusi Lamido Sanusi, Emir of Kano (2014)	1072
	Shekau 6	Threat to sell abducted schoolgirls (2014)	2246
	Shekau 7	Attack on the Giwa camp (2014)	2521
	Shekau 8	A message to Goodluck and to the CAN president (2012)	951
	Shekau 9	A message to the people of Kano (2012)	159
Abubaker al-Baghdadi (ISIS)	al-Baghdadi 1	This is what Allah and His messenger promised us (2016)	3885
	al-Baghdadi 2	Give glad tidings to the patient (2018)	6143
Brenton Tarrant (Far Right)	Tarrant	The Great Replacement – namely the following sections: Addresses to various groups; Introduction; General Thoughts and Potential Strategies; In Conclusion (2019)	10,000

Although the primary dataset initially consisted of 26 statements (constituting a 63,042-word corpus), the final corpus size was produced after a data cleaning process and normalising the frequency at 10,000 words/sub-corpus. This manageable corpus size was also motivated by the qualitative focus of the project and the need for manual analysis of discursive patterns.

Forensic linguists often work with preconstructed datasets, regardless of its size, in order to analyse language used as evidence (Shuy, 2011). While the number of texts per groups is not equal, due to the authors' production rate and the length of individual texts, the overall word count for each author is relatively equal, due to normalisation, at 10,000 words. Table 4.1 shows an overview of the dataset (20 public statements), including text codes (labels for quick reference to a text in analysis), and text titles or main topic. Since text analysis tools such as Linguistic Inquiry and Word Count (LIWC) rely on word-matching, the texts were cleaned before processing. Specifically: a spell-checked version of the dataset was used; contracted forms were written in full and normalised across texts; website links and translator interpretations were removed; quotations not embedded in an author's own words were removed – that is, quotations from, for example, a religious text that a terrorist uses to open their texts with, following Pennebaker and Chung (2007), to focus on the terrorists' words and style. Otherwise, in-text citations and quotations were left in the qualitative analysis for they play a role in positioning, affiliation bonding and legitimation.

Tarrant's manifesto (TAR1) was written in English, while the remaining were translated texts, provided by the legitimate sources detailed in Section 4.3. Since no translations of OBL7 and OBL8 were available via any source, I, a native speaker of Arabic and a recognised translator, translated these two texts in their entirety. To maintain consistency in the use of terms and their sociocultural reference within OBL's eight texts, the accuracy as well as faithfulness of the translations in conveying socially and culturally shaped lexical and semantic choices was checked and adjusted where needed. Existing translations of OBL1-OBL6 were reviewed for 'faithfulness'. For example, Quranic and prophetic expressions were made consistent by referring to the official translations provided at 'quran.com' and 'sunnah.com'; for example, the Arabic word 'murtad' was not always translated into 'apostate', and the translations occasionally confused apostate (murtad) and infidel (kafir). These polarising and evaluatively loaded lexical items are key Islamic terms and concepts. They form part of the symbolic capital with which the author construes identities and legitimises violence (Brookes & McEnery, 2020), hence accuracy was essential to the research aims. For example, confusing the identification of an infidel with an apostate, or dropping the translation of any of these terms in a sentence, would present the author of the texts as an outsider who lacks essential knowledge, which would be unfaithful to the source texts.

4.2.1 Corpus design criteria

The corpus used in this research is a real-life set of forensic texts. This is in keeping with the key role of a forensic linguist to linguistically profile, compare, describe and/or interpret real-world textual data in investigative cases. The texts are implicated in terrorist/criminal contexts and are suitable for examining meaning, comparing patterns of linguistic choices, and linguistic profiling of their authors. My dataset is a 'specialised corpus' of compelling and typical instances of terrorist threatening texts with two main functions (intentions): incitement and communicated threat. The aim is to showcase how a set of a terrorist's texts may be approached to answer my research questions, contributing to efforts to understand and counter potential real-world cases. As such, because my approach is aimed at serving the needs of forensic linguistics, it draws on corpus linguistic methods but does not seek to be a full-fledged quantitative corpus-driven study (that is, a study driven by statistical analysis of features without consideration of more qualitative discursive parameters). I do not seek to analyse diachronically an author's overall texts, nor do I aim to investigate a single author's overall linguistic features throughout their entire writings.

Authors were selected in order to provide transnational representation of terrorist groups, across different geographical, sociocultural, socioeconomic and political contexts, during the post 9/11 attacks era. The aftermath of 9/11 attacks created greater distrust between the American and Arab (and Muslim) societies (Miller, 2015). There was also a resurgence of extremist groups such as Boko Haram in response to what is known as 'the US global war on terror'. This war has been viewed as precipitating a decline in the living conditions in Muslim-majority countries and is associated with ongoing inter-group confrontations (Kyari, 2014). After the 9/11 attacks, the US President George W. Bush declared the war in Afghanistan and Iraq as a war of ideas and a war in arms. He also referred to the war as a 'crusade' – a term which, in the Muslim world is associated with cultural, physical and economic invasion that aims to subjugate Muslims and desecrate Islam (Ray, 2017). In addition, much of the world regards Washington as a terrorist regime or an external threat to their societies, ideas and values (Chomsky, 2002).

The choice to include authors in the corpus was also made based on ideological backgrounds. It was informed by recent argument regarding so-called 'jihadist' and far-right terrorism (see,

e.g. Atran, 2019). That is, despite the death of OBL and al-Baghdadi, 'Jihadist' groups are poised for rejuvenation, mobilising the disaffected because of ongoing socio-political conditions and the rise of the far-right 'adversary' (Miller, 2015; Atran, 2019). Far-right supremacist terrorism has also risen sharply, "to more than one third of terror attacks globally, even accounting for every extremist killing in the US in 2008", meaning that, in the post 9/11 era, the religious and ethno-nationalist ideologies are working as if they are a "deadly duet" (Atran, 2019). Terrorists from both ideologies appeal to sociocultural values and use similar versions of jihadists' reasoning to justify violence as a moral virtue. For example, they appeal to values such as transnational brotherhood, dying for the group's survival, or adherence to white Christian identity (FBI Counterterrorism Division [FBICD], 2008; Atran, 2019). These similarities between terrorists of opposing ideologies raise the question of how similar or distinct the discursive markers (e.g. discursive themes) and linguistic strategies (e.g. othering, affiliation) are within texts of terrorists of these two ideologies – an area of focus in this research. The violent character of extremists of both ideologies, and the use of moral values in justification of violence, make my data compelling instances of terrorist threatening texts that fit the aims of this thesis.

4.3 Overview of the authors and their sampled texts

This section provides an overview of the authors and the four sets of texts that were sampled for inclusion in this corpus. Since the dataset includes only publicly available texts, no privately owned data, and no human participants, the ethical considerations involved in compiling the corpus were limited. The texts included were all made publicly by terrorists through several open access websites.

4.3.1 *Osama bin Laden and his statements*

Osama bin Laden (OBL) was an "ascetic adversary", dedicated to a global struggle against the United States (Miller, 2015, pp. 4-9). OBL's texts are characteristic of a persuasive discourse of violence, and have been effective in inciting violence, legitimising threats and terrorist agendas, and echoing the individual and collective concerns of Muslim-majority countries (Miller, 2015; Zghayyir, 2016). The texts thus form an authentic data source that suits the aim of this research, of exploring threatening discourse. The set of OBL statements address multiple audiences in America, and audiences that belong to Muslim communities in Pakistan,

Afghanistan, Iraq and worldwide. These public statements were produced over 2001-2006. During this period, violence, represented in different forms (chiefly, suicide attacks), was largely perpetrated by al-Qaeda (Pape, 2005). The public statements were released via the al-Bayanat jihadist internet website and the Al-Jazeera news network in Arabic. The original Arabic texts of al-Qaeda's statements were accessed via the publicly available 'al-Archive al-Jami', the Collective Archive, issued by the al-Buraq al-I'lamiyah media corporation in 2007 (see e.g. FBIS Report, 2006).

The texts analysed were English translations drawn from the CIA Foreign Broadcast Information Service (FBIS) report, accessible via Wikipedia and the Al-Jazeera online archive. Missing parts from the translations, as identified when compared with the original texts, were translated by the researcher (given Arabic is my first language and my background as English-Arabic translator). Some sentences from the introductory and concluding parts of the original Arabic texts were missing in the translated transcripts. These missing components were added to the texts, while also ensuring that consistency in the use of terms and their sociocultural references was maintained.

4.3.2 Shekau and his statements

Soon after Shekau took over the lead of Boko Haram from Mohammad Yusuf, Shekau's statements demonstrated a different discourse from Yusuf's. Shekau focuses on a wider range of audiences that include officials, decision makers and cross-border audiences (e.g. Niger, Chad and Cameroon), in addition to Boko Haram's followers or victims in northern Nigeria (Apard, 2015). Shekau's discourse uses "strident messages" that intensify intra-Muslim tensions and exacerbate Muslim-Christian conflict in the region (Thurston, 2016, p. 5). Shekau's statements were produced over 2012-2018. His discourse recruited violent actors on a massive scale, generating popular support for Boko Haram's violence and threatening the stability of Nigeria's federal government and Nigeria's neighbouring countries. This included provoking acts such as: targeted assassination, suicide bombing, and hostage taking (Kyari, 2014; Apard, 2015). This made Shekau's statements a good candidate for the purpose of my research.

The English translation of Shekau's statements were released for open and public access by Nigerian media outlets, namely, 'Sahara Reporters' and 'Premium Times'. His translated discourse is also accessible through the 'Counter Extremism Project' and has received increasing attention by peer-reviewed research (e.g. Apard, 2015). I analysed the English translations extracted from the aforementioned Nigerian media outlet websites/online archive.

4.3.3 Al-Baghdadi and his statements

Al-Baghdadi's discourse involves an antagonistic and oppositional worldview (Wignel, Tan & O'Halloran, 2017). Al-Baghdadi's sub-corpus was comprised of statements that were produced over 2016-2018. They were translated into English by ISIS's Al-Hayat Media centre and made publicly available on the Internet in, for example, an ISIS English-language magazine, titled Rumiya. The texts address ISIS's members and Sunni Muslim communities worldwide. Al-Baghdadi's discourse tends to entice the young, particularly the discontented and resentful against authority, and those filled with idealism. It is aimed at inspiring sympathisers to execute violent acts as a means for achieving desired goals of rebelling against authorities and ideologically different 'others', and for establishing the 'Khilafa' (Atran, 2015), making al-Baghdadi's texts compellingly suitable for the purpose of my investigation.

4.3.4 Tarrant and 'The Great Replacement' manifesto

Tarrant is a far-right, 'lone-wolf' terrorist (Önnerfors, 2019). The title of Tarrant's manifesto, 'The Great Replacement', is an homage to the 'great replacement' theory popularized by the French critic Renaud Camus. The great replacement theory argues that native white Europeans are subject to extinction and replacement in their countries by the non-white people such as Muslim immigrants (Heim & McAuley, 2019). The 87-page manifesto (see Tarrant, 2019) is suited to the purpose of this research given its threatening and inciting messages.

Tarrant's messages address various social groups. For example, he communicates threat to the Antifa/Marxists/Communists, and the Turks. He also incites Christian and European men and women, through messages detailing his thoughts and strategies for confrontation against

a wide range of audiences, such as political leaders, immigrants, NGOs, CEOs of businesses and the democrats. The manifesto is written in English and was made publicly available online a few minutes prior to Tarrant's terrorist attack in Christchurch, New Zealand, in 2019. The question-answer section of the manifesto was not included in the dataset since it belongs to a different genre type and does not provide a continuous stretch of language that addresses a particular audience.

4.4 Data analysis procedures

As explained in Chapter One, the present research aims to empirically investigate: (a) the patterns of lexicogrammatical features of terrorist threatening communication as discursive markers realised in a set of terrorist public statements; and (b) the role of interpersonal, attitudinal meanings in social relation-enactment, particularly the discursive practices of incitement and threatening as social semiotic practices. To reiterate, the analysis is shaped by the following three specific questions:

- **The discursive features of the language of extremism in terrorist public statements:** How do the patterns of the following lexicogrammatical features discursively mark an author's violent extremist style and identity: structures realising discursive themes; conceptual burstiness; and repeated, attitudinally loaded lexical items?
- **Affiliation (ingrouping) strategies:** Which affiliation strategies and tactics are employed as discursive incitement tactics? How does the appraisal signature of a terrorist function within inciting language – i.e. what patterns of bonds are tabled as bases for *affiliation*? How can analysing affiliation strategies inform our understanding of how terrorists incite violent acts?
- **Disaffiliation (outgrouping) strategies** How does the appraisal signature of a terrorist manifest and function in terrorist threat texts? What kinds of patterns of bonds are tabled as bases for *disaffiliation* with the victims? What does the analysis reveal about the discursive functions of threat texts and the 'moral' justifications and purposes of threats?

As has been established in Chapter Three, corpus linguistics (CL) methods (following Almela et al., 2019; Longhi, 2021) and Systemic Functional Linguistics (SFL) together constitute the

main approach employed in this research. Both CL and SFL provide systematic tools that enable patterns of lexicogrammatical structures and patterns of meanings to be examined and described at different linguistic levels. My approach integrates the interests of forensic linguistics in authorship analysis (specifically, in criminal profiling, and authorial identity and style): with the affordances of corpus linguistic methods such as close inspection of concordance lines and frequency information; and the system networks of the SFL Appraisal system. The aim is to use methods that serve to illuminate dimensions of meaning and discursive features that are useful to forensic linguists. Evidence in this thesis is provided by focusing on lexicogrammatical structure selection, attitudinal meanings, and ideation-attitude coupling.

4.4.1 Corpus analysis, and Systemic Functional Linguistic discourse analysis of the dataset

This section details the methods used to undertake the corpus/computational analysis and to identify the patterns in the discursive features of the corpus of terrorist public statements. This section also details the SFL discourse analytical methods utilised to provide evidence of the role of affiliation in the discursive practice of incitement, as well as evidence of the discursive functions of communicated threat texts. Section 4.4.2 describes the methods of analysis of the lexicogrammatical features in the corpus (the focus of Research Question One). Section 4.4.3 describes the methods of analysis of the role of social affiliation in incitement to violence (Research Question Two). Section 4.4.4 describes the methods of analysis of the role of disaffiliation in communicated threats (Research Question Three). For the purpose of corpus analysis of lexicogrammatical features, entire texts were converted into TXT files prior to the computational analysis. For focus on the two aspects of terrorist threatening communication, i.e. communicated threat and incitement purpose, the set of texts was divided into:

- Texts with incitement function, summarised in Section 4.4.3;
- Texts with communicated threats, i.e. texts conveying the intention to inflict injury on people, property, rights or peace of mind of others, summarised in Section 4.4.4.

Table 4.2 presents a summary of the toolkit used in examining the corpus of terrorist statements (similar to Prideaux, 2009, 2011 analytic instrument construct). The table provides a kind of map or catalogue of the components used in the analysis. The toolkit is explained in detail in the following subsections.

Table 4.2: A toolkit for terrorist text analysis

Principle	Relevant components and functions	Primary reference tools and methods
Lexical selection, thematic focus, and conceptual burstiness Attitudinally loaded lexical items selection	Revealing pattern evidence of the discursive markers of terrorist texts, indicators of authors' agenda, motives, engagement in terrorism, ideology and affiliation Revealing a diagnostic for performed personal and relational identities	- Computational/'corpus tool-based text analysis' (e.g. Almela, 2019; Longhi, 2021), using LIWC and AntConc - The Appraisal framework (Martin & White, 2005)
Semantics (of social affiliation) & Discourse analysis	Revealing semantics-based evidence of affiliation strategies used as discursive incitement tactics, and revealing an author's ideological schemas, and moral reasoning of incited violence	- Coupling approach and the Affiliation framework (Knight, 2010) - Complementary tools and methods: the traditional rhetorical strategies (Poggi, 2005), (de)legitimation strategies (Van Leeuwen, 2007, 2008), moral foundations of evaluation (e.g. Kádár, Parvaresh & Ning, 2019; Etaywe & Zappavigna, 2021; Etaywe, 2022)
Semantics (of social disaffiliation) & Discourse analysis	Revealing semantics-based evidence of disaffiliation tactics used for particular discursive functions, the evaluative structure of threat texts, moral and attitudinal positioning as reasoning of a threatener-victim disalignment, and the purpose of threatened acts	- Coupling approach and the Affiliation framework (Knight, 2010) - Complementary tools and methods: the social actor representation strategies (Van Leeuwen, 1996, 2008), discursive construction of purpose of social actions (Van Leeuwen, 2008), threat types (Gales, 2010), the Appraisal framework (Martin & White, 2005)

4.4.2 Terrorist public statements corpus analysis of characteristic lexicogrammatical features

This subsection describes the data analysis procedure undertaken for examining:

1. the lexical selection,
2. thematic focus,
3. the repeated, attitudinally loaded lexical items as form-based patterns of attitudinal meanings.

The findings are taken as lexicogrammatical features that characterise the terrorist type of the dataset and as clues that contribute to the linguistic profiling of text producers. The findings are taken as discursive markers of the overall dataset's violent intentions and authors' engagement in terrorism. The extraction of these makers is computer-assisted, and the goal is thus – in Woolls' (2021, p. 593) terms – “different from using very large corpora to generate information about general, genre or register usage norms”. Prior to the close text analysis part of this project, it was considered useful to obtain a synoptic insight into their semantic orientation, agendas, ideological perceptions, and personal and relational identities, as observed in each terrorist's sub-corpus. That said, internal variation across the texts is also referred to and discussed where significant. I have also sought to compare the discursive themes and conceptual semantic categories of sub-corpora (i.e. the four data sets) in order to explore how similar or distinct the patterns of features which the authors draw on are. I approached these features in three phases, as detailed below.

4.4.2.1 Phase I of lexicogrammatical feature analysis: Fully automated lexical selection and thematic analysis

This phase of analysis was fully automated, providing information about the characteristic semantic orientation of the authors, based on categorising lexical choices into a predetermined set of thematic (i.e. conceptual) categories. The findings of this phase provide evidence about style (i.e. patterns of choice) and motives for aggression, using Linguistic Inquiry and Word Count (version LIWC2015), which is a valid framework to study language patterns and offer accurate results based on objective techniques (Pennebaker et al., 2015). This analysis also provides us with an account of the features that indicate instances of terrorist threatening texts and signal that language users are engaged in terrorism and expression of violent intentions. The LIWC analysis was carried out in two steps. In the first step, the following variables/categories and reference/'known' loading factors (adopted from Pennebaker & Chung, 2007) were examined:

- Pronouns: I (i.e. first-person singular pronouns, including me, mine, and my), we (first person plural pronouns), you (second person pronouns), they (third person plural pronouns), and he/she (third person singular pronouns).
- Affect: positive emotion (e.g. joy); negative emotion (e.g. awful); anger words (e.g. kill).
- Social processes: family, and humans.
- Death.
- Achievement.
- Money.
- Religion.

The reference sample results are related to a corpus of 17 files of public statements by five different terrorist groups. This reference sample was identified previously by Smith (2004) as a sample of ‘terrorist’ groups’ documents. The reference sample of ‘terrorist’ texts was the result of Smith’s content analysis and comparison of ‘terrorist’ with ‘nonterrorist’ groups’ texts. This reference sample included statements from five different terrorist groups: Sicarii group of ancient Palestine (2 texts), the Front du Liberation du Québec (1 text), the Shining Path of Peru (4 texts), Hamas (1 text), and the Army of God (9 texts). This sample gave a representation of a range of time periods, ideological backgrounds and geographic locations. However, unlike the dataset of this thesis that provides a ‘transnational’ representation of terrorists from the most lethal ideologies, the reference sample gives a representation of ‘domestic’ terrorist organisations. Nevertheless, the reference corpus results can still provide analysts with an indication of the likelihood of someone engaging in terrorism, and they can help to differentiate terrorist texts from other texts (Pennebaker & Chung, 2007). As such, a statistical comparison is provided between my specialised sub-corpora and Smith’s reference ‘terrorist’ controls to establish evidence of authors’ engagement in terrorism.

In the second step, I widened the automated thematic investigation to include complementary variables that better account for my data (similar to Almela et al., 2019). The variables included two broad categories of content themes:

1. **Social and personal concerns:** including work, leisure, home, religion, money, death, swear, social processes, family and friend.

2. **Drives:** motives that encourage goal-oriented violent behaviour. These drives (or alternatively, drivers) are:
 - a. Affiliation: concerned with maintaining relations with others.
 - b. Achievement: concerned with orientation towards a certain goal.
 - c. Power: associated with level of aggression and impact on others in texts.
 - d. Reward: concerned with personal benefits.
 - e. Risk: concerned with tension and uncertainty.

Then a statistical comparison between authors' datasets was provided. The distribution of sub-corpora across the thematic categories was also explored.

4.4.2.2 Phase II of lexicogrammatical feature analysis: Lexical selection and conceptual burstiness

This analysis explored a broader and more nuanced array of patterns of lexical features and conceptual categories than provided by LIWC. The identified patterns offer more evidence of textually encoded ideological perceptions and semantic fields that terrorists tend to draw on to legitimise violence. To provide a way of determining more themes and (sub)categories for semantic domains of groups of words, the AntConc program (version 3.5.8.0) (Anthony, 2019a) was used to explore the most frequent lexical items in each sub-corpus. Using AntConc, a list of most frequent words was generated. To enable a broad overview of most frequent words from sub-corpora, the number of times of occurring words was set to a minimum of 10. Words with the same occurrence counts, such as *cause*, *force* and *Mujahid** in the al-Qaeda sub-corpus, or *support*, *destroy*, *traitor* and *immigrant* in the Tarrant's sub-corpus, carried the same frequency of occurrence and thus were grouped together as words of similar frequency. Counts of synonyms such as *messenger* and *prophet*, *America* and *United States*, *brother* and *brethren*, *Allah* and *God/lord*, or *iman* (Arabic word used intertextually) and *belief* were added to each other to make one entry/lexical item. The resulting lists indicate the semantic groups of the most frequent 32 lexical items observed in each sub-corpus, producing a list of 264 lemmas (totalling 8659 repetitions, 21.65%, of the entire corpus).

The focus on topmost used lexical items offered a basis for a more conceptually, semantically rich analysis to supplement the LIWC analysis. Repetitions of certain terms of particular concepts could foreground particular themes and conceptual categories and their ‘burstiness’ – *and thus* characterise a terrorist ideology/identity and agenda and provide evidence of a key part of the symbolic capital used by the terrorists to legitimise violence and of the repertoire of concepts the terrorists relate to (e.g. Brookes & McEnery, 2020). The new generated lists of lexical items of each sub-corpus thus became the focus of the complementary analysis for establishing similarities and differences across authors based on the patterns of underlying concepts and their burstiness. The findings provide an indication to lexical choice specific to terrorist threatening texts, and lexis encoding concepts from the terrorists’ ideologies. Repeated lexical items with close semantic proximity are grouped under same semantic fields, taking this burstiness as: (i) a marker of the discursive purpose of use of these sets of terms in the terrorist texts; and (ii) an indication of an ideology, affiliation, agenda and stance.

The generated words were examined in relation to two main sets of features. Firstly, I examined to what extent sub-corpora drew on similar and/or distinct (ideology-specific) words, social actors (participants), (sub)themes and (sub)concepts, presenting each author’s semantic preference as examined in concordance lines. In response to this aspect, normalised frequency of each sub-corpus’ list of top frequent lexical items were provided and frequencies across sub-corpora compared. The most frequent word(s) as found across sub-corpora were compared. The primary participants were explored by identifying the most frequent names, adjectives (e.g. *Muslim*/Islam**, *America**) and top frequent pronouns that refer to them (as checked in pronouns concordance lines), and then compared across sub-corpora. To identify the running themes/concepts, words that evoked particular intertextual worlds (e.g. politics, religion) or semantic subjects or domains of experience they revolve around (e.g. the military) (cf. Bazerman, 2003), or that encode related concepts (e.g. Brookes & McEnery, 2020), were grouped together – as explored in their concordance lines. The groups were described manually, offering a more semantically rich analysis (see, e.g. Huckin, 2003) to those produced through LIWC-based content analysis. The identified themes were, then, described and discussed in relation to how they indicate to a terrorist’s violent agenda, ideology and affiliation (i.e. social membership).

Since three authors of my data sets proclaim themselves to share one common, master religious ideology (extremist Salafi Jihadism), a more nuanced categorisation of 'religion' as a theme is essential. To distinguish apart these terrorists' texts based on more delicate religious concept-based semantic fields of words, I sub-divide religion-themes into different levels of abstraction according to their conceptual levels, adopted from Brookes and McEnery's (2020, p. 362) categories of religion-semantic fields:

- Adherence: a key element of adherence to faith.
- Authority: which might be cited to justify argument.
- Conflict: spiritual or physical struggle, as in 'fitnah'.
- Negative: an act perceived as negative in the religion.
- Positive: an act evaluated as positive within the religion.
- Spiritual: reference to spiritual or supernatural entity or place.
- State: reference to geopolitical entity.
- Them: reference to non-Muslims.
- Us: reference to Muslims.

The category list was, as yet, left open for any emerging categories in order to better account for the analysed dataset. Repetition of particular subordinate or super-ordinate concepts was taken as characteristic of burstiness of these concepts – taking burstiness as a function of the discursive purpose to which words are put in the texts (e.g. to introduce a concept, such as jihad, and persuade the audience of it) (e.g. Brookes & McEnery, 2020).

For words encoding aggression, death and military concepts, I have labelled the super-ordinate category as 'violence and military', while proposing sub-categorising the words into the following - as informed by Roget 21st Century Thesaurus's (2005) index of concepts:

- Expressions of physical destruction cause (e.g. destroy, kill, bombardment);
- Expressions of physical (or psychological) action (e.g. invade, fight, incite);
- Expressions of the military (action, object, organization, field) (e.g. brigade, defence, battle).

For words encoding the areas or extent of impact of aggression on others, I labelled these under the 'power' superordinate category. These words provide evidence of authors'

semantic orientation and evidence of agenda of control. 'Power' related words are sub-categorised under four subcategories: geopolitical power, socioeconomic power, ethnonationalist power, and environmental control.

The second aspect of examination in AntConc generated lists is the most frequent speech words found repeatedly used in the lists. The use of speech verbs (and nominalisation) is studied as a language feature that realises intertextual practices. Patterns of speech words can signal a practice of attribution (namely, direct quoting) as a means of legitimization of ideological perceptions and building assumptions of consensus and identity, given that sayings often address an ingroup's 'ideal' audiences (see, e.g. van Leeuwen & Wodak, 1999; Seals, 2012). The occurrences of speech verbs were counted and compared across sub-corpora. The patterns of speech verbs (and their grammatical realisations) and quotes within the co-text of the speech verbs' concordance lines were explored, and supplemented with a manual close text analysis of the quotes. The concordance lines were examined to uncover the identities that an author attempts to construct or maintain, "yield[ing] social formations" (Agha, 2005, p. 4), and the propagated "truth claims and narratives" which lay the foundation for what may be typically defined as a group's ideology (e.g. Hodges, 2015, p. 53). The quotes were discussed in relation to three patterns of meaning of attribution strategies (Thetela, 2001, p. 362; White, 2006), to:

- Indicate that the quoted text is incontrovertible fact;
- Disown or distance the endorsement of what the source is saying; and/or
- Add to the texts the flavour of the source's own words.

4.4.2.3 Phase III of lexicogrammatical features: Lexical form-based patterns of attitudinal meaning

This phase focuses on exploring patterns of attitudinal meanings of repeated, attitudinally loaded lemmas, to provide evidence of encoded attitude and to get at the performative nature of personal (e.g. aggressive) and relational (e.g. distant, superior) identities performed in the set of texts. Similar to Etaywe and Zappavigna (2021), my approach aims to identify factors in dimensions such as stances towards phenomena, people and behaviours introduced in the text. This approach accounts for dimensions of terrorist personae such as

(in)tolerance, aggression, and opposition to or support of particular phenomena. What we learn about an author's salient attitudes such as judgements and construed personal and relational identities can indicate violent intentions in texts.

To allow a premise for exploring aggressive identities and associated personal and relational identities, attitudinally loaded lexical items were explored. In addition to the attitudinal lexical items already included in the lists generated in Phase II, AntConc was used again to generate a wider frequency list of attitudinally loaded lemmas that were used more than once. To disambiguate those items that were not used attitudinally, the evaluative load of words and their specific meanings were explored in their concordance lines. The items of the same stem, for example, *destr** (destroy, destroying, destruction) and *hypocr** (hypocrite, hypocrisy) in the OBL sub-corpus, were grouped together under one lexical entry.

Procedures for identifying the patterns of attitudinal meaning: In order to provide evidence of salient attitudinal meanings (in terms of frequency) that colour the performatively achieved personal and relational identities in sub-corpora, the Appraisal framework (particularly the Attitude system explained in Section 3.5 of Chapter Three) was used to decode these repeatedly used lexical items. The generated list of attitudinal lemmas of each sub-corpus was sorted and tabulated manually, and was examined by:

- Classifying attitudinal items into: AFFECT, JUDGEMENT and APPRECIATION, their corresponding subcategories, explicitness (inscribed vs. invoked), and polarity (positive vs. negative);
- Summarizing Appraisal choices in terms of total attitudinal items, total items of AFFECT, JUDGEMENT, APPRECIATION and their subcategories;
- Interpreting the Appraisal items.

The following codes of major ATTITUDE types, subtypes, polarity and explicitness (Figure 4.1) are used for manual labelling of the identified attitudinal features.

AFFECT	Af (AFFECT), Af/I (AFFECT: DIS/INCLINATION), Af/H (AFFECT: UN/HAPPINESS), Af/Se (AFFECT: IN/SECURITY) and Af/Sa (AFFECT: DIS/SATISFACTION)
JUDGEMENT	J (JUDGEMENT), J/N (JUDGEMENT: NORMALITY), J/C (JUDGEMENT: CAPACITY), J/T (JUDGEMENT: TENACITY), J/V (JUDGEMENT: VERACITY) and J/P (JUDGEMENT: PROPRIETY)
APPRECIATION	Ap (APPRECIATION): Ap/R (APPRECIATION: REACTION), Ap/C (APPRECIATION: COMPOSITION) and Ap/V social (VALUATION)
Polarity	+ (positive), - (negative) Following Gales (2011), the polarity of negatively loaded lexical items such as <i>deport</i> (in, e.g. <i>deport all non-Europeans</i>), <i>kill</i> , <i>fight</i> and <i>destroy</i> , which yet carry a positive urge for an ingroup's members, is coded as follows: - (pos). Thus, '-' means that an author uses a lemma with negative load that is largely fixed and stable across a wide range of contexts, while '(pos)' refers to its being positive and justified for the author
Explicitness	S (inscribed), V (invoked)

Figure 4.1: Codes used in manual labelling of the attitudinal features

The summary of findings of Appraisal choices across sub-corpora was then provided to describe the account of encoded attitude resources. The resulting, repeatedly used attitudinally loaded lemmas are taken to describe the lexical aspect of textually encoded attitude, and as evidence of how linguistics can “get at the performative nature of identity by studying **repeated discursive patterns** which is what corpus linguistics is about” (emphasis in original) (Bednarek, 2010, p. 251). While I note that the lexical form-based patterns of attitudinal meanings offer part of the overall lexicogrammatical forms that encode appraisal (which are explored in full when approaching Research Questions Two and Three), the attitudinal meanings focused on, realised in lemmas in a concordance, “nevertheless show some positive, negative or otherwise evaluative meaning associated with the node” (e.g. Mahlberg, 2014, p. 383). An author’s attitudinally loaded lexical items offer “a way of reading between and beyond [lexical] formal properties” (Canning, 2014, p. 63).

The appraisal analysis undertaken examined: repeated attitudinal lexis (387 lexical items totalling 2802 occurrences in the corpus) – given that encoded attitude is often realised lexically (Eggins & Slade, 1997); and patterns of ATTITUDE types (and polarity), and their attitudinal targets (hereafter, AT) (i.e. who/what is appraised) (e.g. Bednarek, 2009b). The evaluative lexis conveys the attitudinal values; and the AT provides the tool for identifying

corresponding general social actors and corresponding categories (e.g. Liu & Hood, 2019), be it ingroup or outgroup categorization. This approach moves us from focusing on words in an author's repertoire to addressing how words function once used together, and what potential connection may exist between configurations of features in dynamic structures and units of linguistic behaviour (see also Kniffka, 2007, pp. 67-68, for a similar argument). For example, in

*...mobilise the Ummah to go to the streets on demonstrations and civil disobedience until the fall of the **traitor regimes** (OBL 6),*

'*Traitor*' is the attitudinal lexis. Its function is negative JUDGEMENT; that is, it negatively judges the act of the AT ('*regimes*').

Procedures to account for the construed personal and relational identities: Since the attitudinal meanings identified are predominantly of the JUDGEMENT type, the concordance lines of items of JUDGEMENT underlying the personal and relational identities were the focus of my examination. The repeated judgmental lexical items and their corresponding JUDGEMENT subcategories alongside their social actors' ATs were identified, using the concordance lines. This provides an account of 'Our' ATs versus 'Their' ATs and 'Our' actions versus 'Their' action's categories – which helps to analyse who is represented as valuing which action/value.

To add an additional lens for the discussion of how attitudinal lexical items map onto broader sociocultural values, the repeated JUDGEMENT loaded items were categorised as per the underpinning larger sociocultural values that characterise each author's violent rhetoric – using the following social value categories proposed by Smith (2004):

- Dominance and aggression: valuing fighting, punishing, retaliating and victory.
- Morality and truthfulness: valuing being good in a moral sense (doing the right or wrong), and valuing truth-speaking and acting.
- Justice and tolerance: valuing equality, fairness, people's rights, diversity, and absence of hostility.
- Culture and religion: valuing religious beliefs and practices, and a group's traditions.

Given that the nature of the dataset makes it difficult to dissociate the construed identities from a group's or audience's master identities, the concept of membership categorization is drawn on to explain the author's aggression in relation to broader ideational categories of attitudinal lexical items and interpersonally construed identities. With this in mind, to focus on who values what, the identified patterns of JUDGEMENT are discussed in this thesis in relation to two broad categories: judging 'Their' (i.e. outgroups'/opponents') actions, and judging 'Our' (ingroup's) actions. This 'We-They' distinction helps to account for how an author views the world and appraises participants, propriety of participants' behaviours, whether they live up to socially desirable (to author) values and moral regulations, and how they ought (not) to be. Findings of tendency of attributing values to the ingroup versus the outgroup(s), as realised co-instantiation of ATTITUDE type with the participants' ATs are discussed as:

- Features of an author's relational identity (i.e. construing his identity as distant from/or superior to 'Others' vs. close to an ingroup's members); and
- Features of an author's personal identity (i.e. constructing his identity as aggressive and antagonistic towards 'Others' vs. caring towards an ingroup's members).

To account for the reasoning of an author's construed personal and relational identities, the construed stance is discussed in relation to, firstly, the authors' 'relational' and 'actional' models of ideology (cf. Hodge & Kress, 1988), which are manifested in two variables of attitude. The first is relational attitude, where values were attributed to self and others and associated phenomena other than actions. The second is actional attitude, where the author attributed values to social actors'/groups' actions through the lens of whether these actions are dis/approved of. Stances are also discussed in relation to any constructed meta-values (e.g. care, loyalty) as cultural reasoning of aggression. Finally, the repeatedly used form-based functions and identified clues for the global function of texts, i.e. threat and incitement functions, have been taken as drivers for exploring the role of interpersonal, attitudinal meaning-making resources in enacting social (dis)affiliation in relation to these two functions.

4.4.3 Analysis of affiliation strategies, in inciting texts, as discursive incitement tactics

This subsection describes the discourse analysis procedure undertaken for examining the rhetorical strategies of affiliation used in incitement for violence. This description includes:

- the annotation of the incitement texts for their evaluative couplings;
- the grouping of the evaluative couplings, the principle of this grouping, and mapping the enacted bonds (realised by these bonds) onto the corresponding affiliation strategies;
- the moral reasonings regulating the evaluative couplings underpinning the incited-for-violence;
- two rhetorical functions of the evaluative couplings: evaluative couplings as entry point to legitimization of, and coercing into, violence.

The aim of this examination is to provide evidence of the authors' stances and "appraisal signature" (Martin & White, 2005, p. 203) – i.e. a terrorist's evaluative style – as well as their moral underpinnings when engaged in the discursive practice of incitement, and to offer a model for a fuller understanding of how incitement text or utterances operate in terrorist context. My focus is on the affiliation strategies – i.e. how language is used to forge value alignments, that is, to influence networks of interpersonal relationships, provoke hostility, and encourage violence towards certain groups or social actors. The focus in this thesis is on how a text axiologically and ideologically unfolds. The following are the steps of analysis with focus placed on the social dimension of interpersonal, attitudinal meanings that have consequences for the networks of social relationships, duties and obligations thereto, and the lives of the inciter, incitee and the incited-against. It is worth reiterating that the inciter and incitee are thought of here as being – in Firth's (1957, p. 186) terms – active participators in creating and maintaining an ingroup's cultural values. The analysed incitement texts are OBL2, OBL4, OBL5, OBL6, OBL7, OBL8, Bagh1, Bagh2, and Tarrant messages (except for 'To Turks' and 'To Antifa/Marxist/Communists' messages which communicate threats), where it is the addressed audiences who are invited and urged as agents to commit violent actions.

4.4.3.1 Annotating inciting texts for their evaluative couplings

The approach adopted for understanding how each terrorist attempted to build solidarity and forge alignments with the incitees while enacting disalignment with the incited-against outgroups is an Affiliation analysis as grounded in Systemic Functional Linguistics (for more details, see Section 3.4.5, Chapter Three). The main analytical unit used in the Affiliation analysis to investigate how values are negotiated in texts are couplings of ideational and attitudinal meaning, through which audiences discursively co-identify (e.g. Knight 2010c). An example of an attitude-ideation coupling in the dataset is a negative attitude (shown in bold) targeted at immigrants (shown underlined) in the following excerpt taken from Tarrant's manifesto:

*...what few know is that Rotherham is just one of an ongoing trend of **rape and molestation** perpetrated by these [immigrants] [immigrants / - JUDGEMENT] ... **KILL THE RAPISTS, HANG THEIR FAMILIES.***

According to the Affiliation model, this ideation-attitude coupling can be said to table a bond which we might gloss as 'immigrants are bad: rapists and molesters'. This bond serves as a moral basis for inciting the killing of immigrants, following incidents such as the Rotherham scandal of organised child sexual abuse that occurred in the town of Rotherham, South Yorkshire, England. The dataset was annotated for ideation-attitude couplings as follows:

- AFFECT dotted-underlined,
- JUDGEMENT underlined,
- APPRECIATION double-underlined,
- Polarity coded as '+' for positive polarity, and '-' for negative polarity.

The Appraisal framework, specifically the ATTITUDE system, was used to analyse and systematically account for evaluative meanings. Couplings were annotated following Martin, Zappavigna, Dwyer and Cléirigh's (2013) square brackets notation style:

[ideation: <<>>/attitude: <<>>]

This notation style allowed for in-text annotation (see Appendices B1 and B2 for example analyses). Square brackets were used to suggest that ideation and attitude are fused together to construe the value that is tabled – i.e. made available in discourse (Zappavigna, 2018) – as

bases for perception and legitimization of violence, and as an entry point to and linguistic evidence of the social values negotiated, the social action of affiliation, and the positioning of outgroups as a threat. I argue that, through these couplings, an inciter attempts to bond and align the ingroup's members to these couplings (which realise the construed values), and that the couplings thus allow for investigating the rhetorical effects associated with positionings and "exploring what is at stake when one stance is chosen over another" (Martin & White, 2005, p. 92). Couplings were also taken as constituents of and characteristic of the central clusters of bonds within the incitement texts.

The bonds tabled, realised by these couplings, were then grouped into localized patterns or broader networks of values. The ideational targets that were repeatedly appraised, such as people (e.g., *Americans, immigrants*) or ideas and abstractions (e.g., *democracy, jihad*), were then aggregated into ingroup-centred (where positive values aligned with collocated ingroup ideations) versus outgroup-centred constellations (where negative values disaligned with collocated outgroup ideations). In so doing, I follow Doran's (2019) use of the 'axiological constellation' concept, which allows for grouping the who (i.e. the general ideations) with the what (i.e. ideas, terms and abstractions related to the general ideations) that are being repeatedly appraised, negatively or positively, in and across each terrorist's set of texts, into axiological constellations.

The identified constellations provide a synoptic perspective on the opposing value systems of the ingroups and outgroups, making explicit the networks of key shared bonds into which incitement texts invite incitees. In Systemic Functional Linguistics, these constellations can be interpreted as networks of bonds that constitute the value systems of language users and their communities. In Doran's (2019) terms, through these networks of shared bonds, the addressed audiences (i.e. the incitees) can distinguish between who is a threat, support, insider, outsider and so forth. The collocative values in each terrorist's texts are grouped into patterns of bond clusters (e.g. Zappavigna, 2014), where a pattern of collocative values refers to a localized bond cluster in which a general ideation (e.g. Muslims, immigrants) collocates with a general positive or negative value. These patterns assist in: realising the overall prosodic structure resulting from this unfolding of collocative values in each text; and providing insights into the unfolding categories of ideational targets and related attitudes in discourse, thus the field of a text, what or whom a text is taking a stance about, and who is,

on one hand, good, victim and incited for violence, and who, on the other hand, is bad, victimiser and incited-against. The opposing social groups are thus viewed in a text as being opposing networks of values, and the axiology of the incitees who are constructed as being at risk can turn out to be their foundation in driving towards violence, turning the inter-group conflict into an axiological and valuation issue.

4.4.3.2 Grouping the evaluative couplings

The identified couplings were grouped in terms of the bases on which attitude-invoking resources instantiated a bond and whether a bond was of communing or alienating function. Regarding the bases, they include the following principles which enabled the unpacking of interpersonal meaning and identifying the bases of tactics used in bond instantiation:

- Expansion and projection as general semantic relations which Zhao (2020) has identified as contributing to how axiological affiliation is built in texts.
- The SFL principle of iconisation, whereby icons such as celebrated persons, things, or rituals provoke ATTITUDE (Martin & Zappavigna, 2013).
- The principle of 'relationality', whereby inclusive and/or exclusive pronouns or names of social actors afford ATTITUDE (Martin & White, 2005), as does the use of different ideations where an ideation acquires social meaning in relation to other ideations available in discourse based on 'similarity/difference' relations (Bucholtz & Hall, 2005, p. 598).
- The principle of indexicality, whereby identity is constructed by indexes such as names or labels as interpersonally charged ideation, and which provokes ATTITUDE (Bucholtz & Hall, 2005; Jeffries, 2014).

Regarding the functions of bonds, the bonds were mapped onto the corresponding affiliation strategies. That is, the affiliation strategies used as incitement tactics were identified and classified in terms of whether they enacted an ingrouping strategy, referred to as 'communing', or outgrouping strategy, referred to as 'alienation'. The focus on affiliation in relation to the tabled bonds and enacted values thus departs from an 'ingroup'-driven vantage point, and has two orientation points:

- 'Ingroup'-oriented strategy: which is concerned with tabling bonds aimed at forging solidarity, sympathy, consensus and shared membership, and at preserving ingroup values. This strategy is labelled as communion. The use of the term communion for this strategy was inspired by: (i) Firth's (1964, p. 112) view that "promotion, establishment, and maintenance of communion of feeling" is one of the major interpersonal functions of language; and (ii) Martin's (2002, p. 196) contention that "[w]e express feelings in order to ... build relationships" and that we do not express our feelings "unless we expect the person we are talking with to sympathize or empathize with us".
- 'Outgroup'-oriented strategy: which is concerned with the 'opposing' values and identities construed for distancing and excluding 'outgroup' members. The term alienation references Martin's (2002, p. 196) contention that, when attitudes are not shared but are rejected, "a sense of alienation sets in" because bonds are positioned as unshareable. These negative, opposing values function by creating tension with an ingroup's values, which requires rejection of the violating values and violators as a step towards the ingroup members' co-identifying as members and defenders of shared values. This is about rejecting the outgroup members due to – in Knight's (2010c) terms – the semiotic tension through violating 'Our' bonds.

In sum, communion and alienation are taken as the affiliation strategies employed as discursive incitement tactics and their inciting functions across the OBL, al-Baghdadi and Tarrant incitement texts. The categorization of couplings based on their underpinning principles also enables identification of the tactics (i.e. linguistic resources) used for both communion and alienation. The resulting tactics and how they operate in incitement against outgroups are, then, described, and exemplified in this thesis. Specifically, I focus on how these strategies promote and reinforce particular ideological networks and polarising bonds, that is, how they intensify calls for communing around a shared bond and alignment with deployed values and with the inciters as affiliative members.

4.4.3.3 The moral reasonings of the incited-for-violence as regulators of evaluative couplings

Using a complementary interpretive lens, the moral grounds that each terrorist tends to endorse are explored in order to better understand the alleged moral justifications for

hostility and violence incited against particular social groups. The moral meta-values underpinning the couplings, and how these moral themes compare or contrast across the three terrorists, can also sensitise threat assessors to what triggers the moral evaluations, and how an activation of a moral foundation can invite an activation of a set of social roles and a reasoning for violence. Six moral meta-values were considered in order to sensitise us as to the moral assumptions and considerations underpinning the ideation-attitude couplings (see Section 3.5, Chapter Three). The meta-values are:

1. ingroup/loyalty;
2. authority/respect;
3. purity/degradation;
4. harm/care;
5. fairness/reciprocity;
6. liberty/oppression.

Each meta-value was taken as a moral framework (i.e. basis) of evaluative couplings/bonds that an author tends to construct in their texts. Findings can sensitise us about the relationship between morality and the affiliative function of incitement texts, through foregrounding the recurrent themes that serve the moral coerciveness of these texts (see e.g. Cap, 2017). For example, to illustrate how values associated with ingroup/(dis)loyalty may influence the creation of evaluative couplings, consider the following excerpt from OBL6 inciting against the Saudi regime:

*Before that, **he** [Prince Abdullah of Saudi Arabia] betrayed the two holy mosques [he/ - JUDGEMENT] when **he** allowed the Americans to enter the country of the two holy mosques [he/ - JUDGEMENT] under the false allegations of the need for their assistance...*

In this excerpt, OBL negatively evaluates Prince Abdullah for an act of betrayal, loyalty to the Americans at the expense of Muslim lands, and using the Saudi (Muslim) lands to target Iraq and other Muslim countries militarily. The JUDGEMENT-based couplings realise the ‘bad/treacherous Prince Abdullah’ bond, and they are deployed – in Ståhl, Zaal and Skitka’s (2016) terms – in response to signs of disloyalty and to serve the purpose of preserving a strong coalition against outgroups. Put differently, in Haugh’s (2015) terms, the ingroup/loyalty meta-value underpins the interpretive and evaluative process and has a bearing on how the inciter expects the ingroup members to act.

4.4.3.4 Evaluative couplings as entry points to legitimization of and coercing into violence

Using another complementary interpretive lens, two rhetorical functions of evaluative couplings are considered, in terms of their function in coercing (i.e. generating fear and sense of insecurity, and demanding action of the ingroup members), and the legitimization of violence and delegitimization of outgroups. The aim is to focus on these rhetorical functions as social, discursive practices that take couplings as resources deployed as a basis for perception and action and as a clue to the “ideological schema[s]” (van Dijk, 1998a, p. 258/9; Shuy, 2021) of the inciters. This is aligned with: (i) Cap’s (2017) argument that the positive presentation of self (i.e., the ingroup) and negative presentation of outgroups is a key strategy to construct threats and generate fear, which ultimately serves in coercing into particular actions and legitimizing these actions as a joint enterprise; and (ii) Malešević’s (2019) argument that terrorists require a degree of ideological justification and exploitation of social bonds to legitimate their violent actions and mobilize support. Bonds in incitement texts are thought of as an entry point to the legitimization, or interchangeably legitimization, of violence (similar to Etaywe, 2021b).

To obtain a nuanced understanding of how couplings are strategically deployed to play a role in coercing an ingroup’s audience into violence and legitimating the incited-for violence as shared “goals and beliefs” (Poggi, 2005, p. 297), two phases of analysis were undertaken:

- Firstly, the utterances with ‘coercing’ function were identified – namely, the utterances suggesting violent courses of action, via e.g. commanding and recommending.
- Secondly, a multi-level discourse analysis was undertaken to explore the ‘(de)legitimation’ function, focusing on the utterances and texts segments where evaluative couplings were used. Consider the following ‘evaluative textbite’ (Etaywe, 2021a, 2021b) extracted from Tarrant’s manifesto inciting the killing of immigrants:

...but what few know is that Rotherham is just one of an ongoing trend of rape and molestation perpetrated by these [immigrants]....

This example construes the ‘immigrants are bad: rapists and molesters’ bond to serve as a moral basis for inciting the killing of immigrants following incidents such as the Rotherham

scandal of organised child sexual abuse that occurred in the town of Rotherham, South Yorkshire, England, in 2010 but which took local authorities a long time to act against the reported perpetrators. This condemning bond is realised lexicogrammatically by the [immigrants/ - JUDGEMENT] coupling, or alternatively by a hyperbolic negative reference to immigrants' act of rape and molestation as '*an ongoing trend*', which is the precise dynamic employed for delegitimation.

Adopting van Dijk's (1998a) argument that legitimating 'Us' within the context of social conflicts implies delegitimizing outgroups via discursive acts that may "follow the categories of the ideological schema" of the ingroup and challenge the identity of the outgroups, van Dijk's themes/categories of delegitimation are utilized to tabulate the themes of (de)legitimation. These are: 'Our' versus 'Their' membership, actions, goals, norms and values, social position, and access to 'Our' social resources (van Dijk, 1998a, pp. 258-259). These themes enable us to describe *what* is being (de)legitimated to serve the legitimacy of violence. In the extract above, immigrants' 'action' is what is delegitimated. Then, to explore the pattern of *how* (de)legitimation is enacted, that is, based on which grounds or references to ideological reasons, the precise dynamics were tabulated under van Leeuwen's (2007, 2008) semantic-functional strategies of critique and (de)legitimation. In so doing, I align my analysis with van Dijk's (1998a, p. 255) argument that a successful investigation into (de)legitimation should include exploring the "references to [e.g. moral or ideological] reasons and to courses of action that had or have to be taken because of contextual constraints, causes or opinions". The following van Leeuwen strategies are used for this purpose:

- Moralization: which refers to legitimization by reference to specific value systems.
- Rationalization: which is concerned with legitimization by reference to goals of social actions.
- Authorization: which is involved in legitimization by reference to authority.
- Mythopoesis: which refers to legitimization that is conveyed through narratives whose outcomes reward or punish actions.

In the same extract above, the dynamic of (de)legitimation is thus categorized under 'moral evaluation'.

Finally, the bonds were mapped onto the modes of argumentation – logos (rational arguments), ethos (authority-based arguments) and pathos (appeal to incitees' emotions). This was done, firstly, to explore the evaluative style at the rhetorical structure level (e.g., Johnstone, 2009) in each inciter's texts. Secondly, these modes enable an analyst to argue (similar to Poggi, 2005) that exploring these modes enables understanding of the tendency of each inciter in attending to his incitees' goals and beliefs to raise the value of the violent actions proposed and to strengthen the believability of the link between violence and the ingroup's interests – that is, whether the tendency is via rational arguments, appealing to shared ethos, or appealing to incitees' emotions. Tarrant above constructs his ethos and presents himself as a credible person who knows what few know and an ethical character who is against rape and molestation (see Appendices C, D and E for more examples on the (de)legitimizing functions in the OBL, al-Baghdadi and Tarrant inciting texts, respectively). The top-bottom annotation of bond in the example is [ethos: delegitimation of action: moral evaluation]. This form of notation allows for capturing: firstly, the mode of argumentation that gears up the (de)legitimizing bonds; secondly, what is (de)legitimated; and, finally, the bases for which grounds (de)legitimation is made (Etaywe, 2021b).

It is worth reiterating here that in forensic linguistics (as detailed in Chapter Three), socio-cognitive frameworks as well as social semiotic frameworks are accepted. This is why the analytical toolkit here brings together concepts of, for example, van Dijk (1998) and van Leeuwen (2007). Both scholars stress the role of language in (de)legitimation in terms of constructing answers to why 'we' did/should do something, why we should do it in 'X' way, and why an action is allegedly reasonable or socially acceptable. Since this thesis is concerned with the context of social conflicts and opposing social groups, van Dijk's (1998a) criterion and categories of membership and (de)legitimation remain also useful for the forensic purpose of description of language use in the dataset. The toolkit also synthesises the modes of argumentation (e.g. logos) since they enable the description of style associated with stance-taking (thus, appraisal and affiliation) at the rhetorical structure level (see e.g., Johnstone, 2009). This investigation of these traditional rhetorical strategies of argumentation is also consistent with SFL perspective of language: the persuasive usage of language both construes a reality and positions people in relation to that reality (Virtanen & Halmari, 2005); and SFL views language as being a system for construing a sense of reality (including recognising and

naming categories of phenomena and their inter-relationships) and a system for relation enactment.

4.4.4 Analysis of disaffiliation in communicated threats

This subsection describes the discourse analysis procedure undertaken for examining disaffiliation in the communicated threats of terrorists. It explains the procedures for exploring the patterns of bond types that characterize the 'appraisal signature' (i.e. the evaluative style) of a terrorist's threat, and how these patterns serve the process of disaffiliation (i.e. forging disalignment) between the primary social actors, namely, threateners and their victims, regardless of the threat type. This section explains the procedures followed to identify:

- the evaluative discourse structure and the primary social actors;
- the threat types and threat purpose;
- the patterns of disaligning bonds, the tactics used to gear up these bonds, and the discursive functions for which these bonds are employed.

To explore how disaffiliation is enacted in the service of threats, identification of the co-patterning of evaluation and ideation couplings was used to determine the key social bonds at stake – following the same annotation conventions detailed in Subsection 4.4.3.1. These disaligning bonds (e.g. 'a victim is incapable') are taken as an entry point to a threatener's disaffiliation from the victims, and as linguistic evidence or basis of – in Gales (2010, p. 196) terms – a "threat justification". Focus on evaluative couplings as the main units of analysis also enables us to reveal: the point of a threat text, and the positive and negative construction of threatener and victims. The threat texts analysed are OBL1, OBL3, Shekau 1, Shekau 2, Shekau 3, Shekau 4, Shekau 5, Shekau 6, Shekau 7, Shekau 8, Shekau 9, and Tarrant's messages 'To Turks' and 'To Antifa/Marxist/Communists' (taken from his 'addresses to various groups' section). Each of these texts communicates an author's undertaking to carry out an action and that the author (or their extremist organization) is the agent of the threatened action (for similar characteristics of threat texts, see e.g. Martínez, 2013; Muschalik, 2018). The following subsections explain the phases of analysis undertaken.

4.4.4.1 Identifying the evaluative discourse structure and the primary social actors

To obtain a lens on how evaluation in the terrorism context enables a terrorist to express the point of their narrative, the evaluative discourse structure of the threat texts was explored (for similar exploration, see Chilwa, 2017). The structure that each terrorist tends to build in their texts is described in terms of the common and/or distinctive components the texts have, in three main phases: an introduction; a main body; and a conclusion. The findings regarding the introductions and conclusions are discussed first, followed by a summary of references to the primary social actors constructed in the texts of each threatener. The main body phase was analysed, as described in Subsection 4.4.4.3, to obtain a fuller understanding of how evaluation enables a terrorist to promote a positive/negative construction of the social actors, and their actions and processes, for disaffiliative purposes and particular discursive functions.

To identify the primary social groups of participants in discourse and their power relations, a critical examination of the representation of social actors and the relationships between them (van Leeuwen, 1996, 2008) as realised in each terrorist's threat texts was carried out. The ways each group is referenced were then outlined and tabulated. The aim is to reveal: the social actors in terms of who is included in a threatener's group or the threatened groups; whom the targets of violence are; the range of victims specified or genericised; the sociopolitical and ideological/religious affiliations of the participants; and how the representation strategies used in discourse serve to reinforce the power of the threateners, in terms of participant role configurations.

4.4.4.2 Identifying the threat types and threat purpose

To enhance our understanding of the role of representation of the powerful self and the ingroup-oriented profit or rationale behind threatened violence: (i) the types of threats constructed in each text were identified; and then (ii) the discursive construction of purposefulness was critically examined. The threat types were categorised, following Gales' (2010) threat types, into the types summarised in Figure 4.2.

• Direct threat: where the language of a text clearly identifies an action (or mode, e.g. defamation, car bombing), time, a target and/or place – at least two or more elements need be present. Propositions of direct threats, such as "<i>We will continue the martyrdom operations inside and outside the United States...</i>" (taken from OBL 3), were thick-underlined (see Appendices F, G and H of threat text analysis). In this example, we have textual elements that convey information about the mode (martyrdom operations), the target (the Americans) and the place (inside and outside the United States).
• Veiled threat: where the language does not clearly state the action, time, target and/or place, and there is no condition the victim needs to fulfill, as in: "<i>The people of Kano, you are in trouble</i>" (Taken from Shekau 4). Utterances of <u>veiled threat</u> were dash underlined.
• Conditional threat: where the threatened action is presented as being contingent on the victim's performance of some action or behavioural compliance, as in: "<i>But if you attempt to live in European lands, anywhere west of the Bosphorus...we will kill you</i>" (taken from Tarrant's manifesto). Utterances of <u>conditional threat</u> in the dataset were wave-underlined.

Figure 4.2: Threat types

Regarding the constructed purposes of threatened acts, the local co-text of the identified utterances of threat types was critically examined and categorised into van Leeuwen's (2008) purposes of social and discursive actions. These are:

- **Goal-oriented action:** where a threatener does 'x' in order to do, be or have 'y', such as to prevent oppression or to establish caliphate.
- **Means-oriented action:** where the action is represented as a means to an end; that is, a threatener achieves 'y' by 'x'-ing, where 'x' serves as a pathway to achieve 'y', as in the use of martyrdom operations by al-Qaeda as a mechanism to weaken the Americans.
- **Effect-oriented action:** where the purpose is the outcome of an action that enables or causes the actions of other people than the threatener, as in a threat to continue jihadist operations so that the Americans terminate their operations in Iraq.

I argue for van Leeuwen's (2008, p. 125-136) contention that the analysis of the discursive construction of purposefulness can provide clues to motivations and goals of actions, and what constitutes "the heart of disagreement and conflict".

4.4.4.3 The discursive functions of the threat texts and the patterns of disaligning bonds

While analysing the construction of the threateners and their victims as a binary opposition – in terms of the attitudinal bases for threatener-victim disalignment – focus is placed on the victims and the social features or values coupled with the victims. Aligned with Hurt and Grant's (2019) analytical value of a focus on victims as the main topic of violent discourse, I focus on victims as the target of value-disalignment (with threateners) and social disaffiliation. Adopting the coupling approach to disaffiliation, the evaluative couplings of 'Our' versus 'Their' ideational targets (and the construed bonds) were identified. The threateners and their victims were taken as general ideations or attitudinal targets that facilitate disalignment and (re)positioning by acting as loci of attitudinal and moral evaluations. For example,

"You Christians cheated and killed us [Muslim Nigerians] to the extent of eating our flesh like cannibals"

incorporates a coupling of the 'You Christians' with negative JUDGEMENT, annotated as [ideation: You Christians/ attitude: negative JUDGEMENT (PROPRIETY)] and instantiating the 'Christians are bad: cheaters and killers' disaligning bond in the context of Shekau's threat against the president of the Christian Association of Nigerian.

By reference to the types of ATTITUDE (JUDGEMENT, AFFECT, APPRECIATION) and their associated subcategories (e.g. PROPRIETY, CAPACITY), the types of bonds and their ideological ground – be it ethical (i.e. JUDGEMENT-based) or value-based (i.e. APPRECIATION-based) – or emotional basis were categorized. For example, the bond in the extract above is a PROPRIETY-based bond. Identifying the types of bonds allows us to explore which attitudinal bases tend to receive a heightened rate of use and which bases are used frequently to justify disalignment and ultimately a "threat justification" (Gales, 2010, p. 196), and for which discursive functions. Through the disaffiliative function of construed bonds, a threatener is thought of as using the evaluative couplings to disalign with victims and to establish morally driven exclusion of the victims, while communicating intention to harm, terrorise, generate fear, unsettle peace of

mind, or challenge or injure them or their properties. The style of bonding is thought of as a form of evaluative coupling disposition; that is, positive 'we' versus negative 'they' construction serves in presenting social groups in discourse as opposing networks of bonds that cause interpersonal tension and morally justified violence.

For examining how the disaligning bonds contribute to the discursive functions of threat texts and how these bonds are geared up to serve these functions, I argue that the patterns of disaligning bonds are enacted such that a threatener not only justifies their violence but also has their community's benefits, interests or moral orders protected or reinforced. As such, my approach is, firstly, aligned with Culpeper's (2011, p. 252) and Culpeper, Iganski and Sweiry's (2017) arguments suggesting that morally backed value-alignment acts can play a significant role in hate-fed discourses of violence, and in (re)balancing relations or redressing a moral breach such as grievance against members of an ingroup. Secondly, I argue that the moral ground for disalignment departs from a terrorist's alleged care or responsibility for their ingroup (e.g., Wilkins (1992[2005])); that is, disaffiliation and threatened violence depart from a community-driven vantage point. Considering this argument, three discursive functions are explored: deontic retribution; ethical manipulation; and the boulomaic function (summarised and exemplified in Figure 4.3).

Deontic retribution: which refers to a threat that comes in response to disruption of the ingroup's moral order or to a danger against the ingroup's status or physical and ideological territories. This is inspired by Searle's (2009, pp. 8-9) concept of "deontic powers" which refers to "rights, duties, obligations, requirements, permissions, authorizations, entitlements, and so on", by which, I argue, a social actor's (e.g. a terrorist's) behaviour may be justified or morally motivated in order to protect and maintain the ingroup's interests. As such, the moral view of 'Self' as a threatener is that of a deontic (i.e. value-serving) agent who is obliged or permitted to retaliate. For example, in "<i>...we witnessed the <u>injustice and tyranny</u> of the American-Israeli coalition against our people in Palestine and Lebanon</i>", OBL tables the propriety-based bond, 'America is bad: unjust and tyrant', to enable construction of the retribution form of justification of al-Qaeda's 9/11 attacks on America – that is, threatened acts are constructed as being in response to the unjust practices of the US-Israel coalition against the Palestinians and the Lebanese.
Ethical manipulation: which refers to a threat that serves in preserving a threatener's ideological or physical territories and that is made to: (i) deter the victims from performing an action or taking a position that is unfavourable to the threatener's ingroup; or (ii) compel the victims to stop an action that is disadvantageous to the threatener's ingroup. Since this function concerns itself with the outgroups' actions, judgement-based evaluations of these actions are considered ethics-based (see Martin & White, 2005), hence, an ethical type of manipulation. In this function, bonds are mobilised to force behavioural compliance or to negotiate avoidance of threatened acts. For example, in "<i>every state that <u>does not play with our security</u> has automatically guaranteed its own security</i>", OBL tables a propriety-based bond, 'States of America are secure if not threatening 'Us'', to manipulate the Americans' participation in the war against Muslim countries – that is, the threat of repeating the 9/11 attacks is constructed to serve to compel the American troops to stop their war already being waged in Iraq.
Boulomaic function: which involves symbolic identity-damage (e.g. religious, ethnic or racial identity), where couplings instantiate bonds that discredit the threatened, or which involves a 'fantasy' level of desire (AFFECT) to cause harm, merely since the threatened belong to a different social category. The purpose is to frighten the threatened and to disturb their piece of mind, but with no coercion. Via this function, a threatener's symbolic benefit is achieved by damaging the victim's symbolic power, and there is no reference to the victims' actions or pursuit to force behavioural compliance.

Figure 4.3: A summary of the discursive functions of threat texts

This categorisation of threat discursive functions is aligned with Muschalik's (2018) functions of threat, and is inspired by Culpeper, Iganski and Sweiry's (2017, pp. 22-23) concept of master "identity attacks" and by Hurt and Grant's (2019) concept of violent fantasies and pledge to harm. In addition, what links these three discursive functions is the rhetorical parental node, that is, public intimidation, fear generated, aggression exercised, and the underlying moral and attitudinal reasoning. To obtain a fine-grained categorisation of the discursive functions and how the threat texts function, a complementary form of analysis was carried out, examining how the following tactics were used to gear up the disaligning bonds and to serve in achieving the manipulation and retribution functions: discrediting (e.g. D'Errico & Poggi, 2012); blaming and denying; and (de)legitimizing (e.g. Hansson, 2015). The pattern of bonds used as a basis for disaffiliation, the tactics used, and the three discursive functions, are discussed and exemplified in the thesis as realised in each terrorist's set of threat texts.

4.5 Conclusion

The chief function of this chapter was to account for the key aspects of the research design and the analytical procedures of the thesis, based on the theoretical foundation established in Chapter Three. The chapter detailed the following types of analysis that were undertaken on the dataset:

- **Corpus analysis** of the discursive features of the language of extremism;
- **Affiliation analysis** of the incitement texts;
- **Moral rhetoric analysis** of incitement;
- **Disaffiliation analysis** of the communicated threat texts.

Having attended to the methodology and its details – as summarised in Figure 4.4 – for exploring the features of the language of violent extremism and two social phenomena (i.e. two key aspects of threat of this language, namely, incitement to violence and communicated threats), Chapters 5-7 present the findings of this exploration. The analysis and discussion of the findings regarding the patterns of language features across the terrorists texts are undertaken in Chapter Five, which ends with the characteristic patterns of repeated, attitudinally loaded lexical items. Chapter Six extends the attitudinal meaning analysis with close attention to the patterning and functions of ideation-attitude coupling in enacting social

affiliation in incitement texts. Chapter Seven focuses on the patterning and functions of ideation-attitude couplings in enacting social disaffiliation in communicated threat texts.

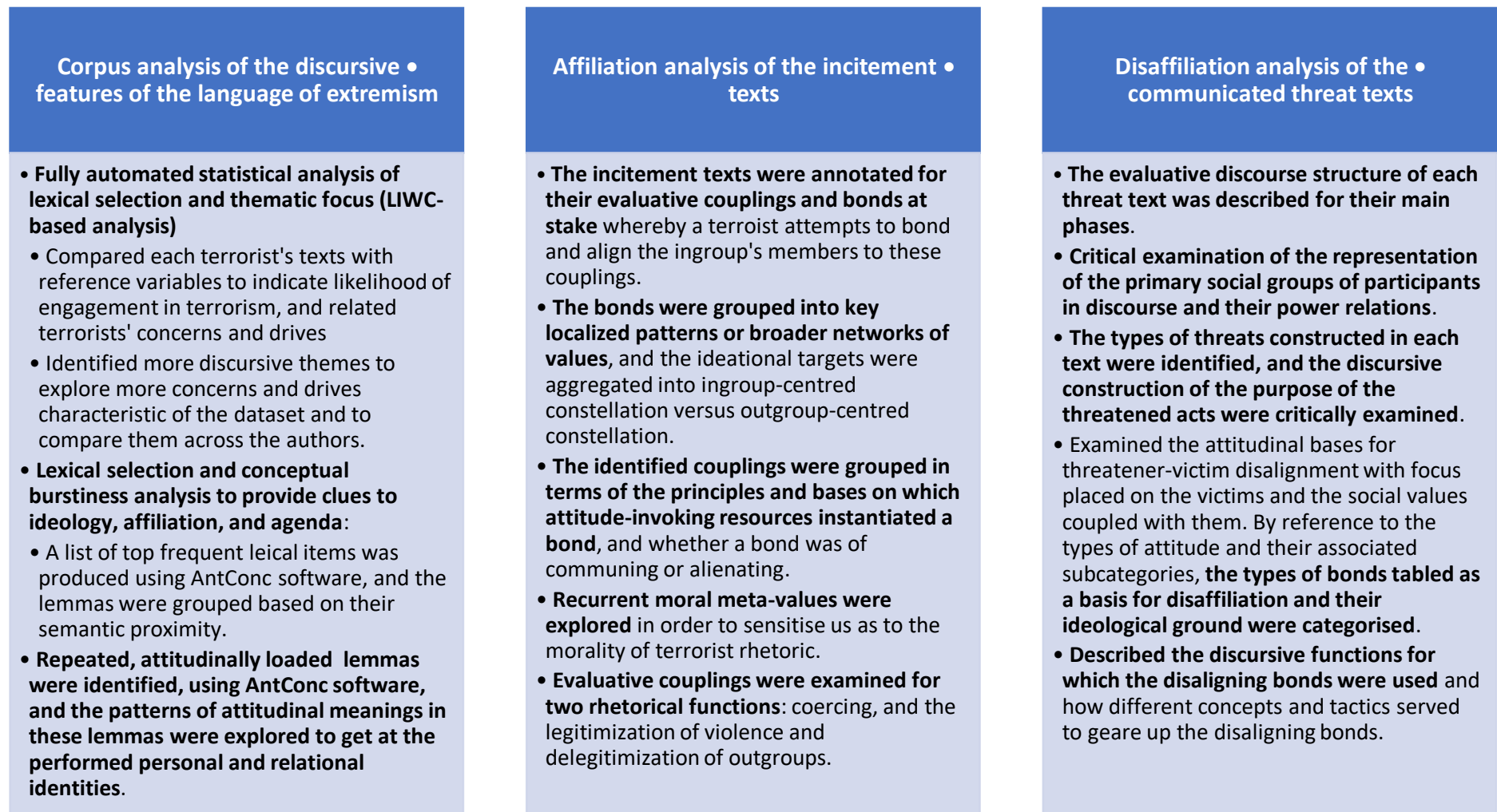


Figure 4.4: A summary of main steps involved in the data analysis

CHAPTER FIVE:

FINDINGS 1 – PATTERNS OF LEXICOGRAMMATICAL FEATURES AS EVIDENCE IN TERRORIST PUBLIC STATEMENTS

5.1 Introduction

The Theoretical Framework chapter detailed the role lexicogrammatical features can play in psycholinguistic and socio-linguistic profiling of text producers and in exploring threatening communication. This chapter presents the analysis of the lexicogrammatical features explored in this thesis as discursive markers of the language of extremism, as realised in the dataset of terrorist public statements. The aim is to gain insights into the features of the language of extremism as used by each author of the corpus. Patterns of lexicogrammatical features are compared across sub-corpora, including how patterns of lexical forms, their conceptual categories, and underpinning attitudinal meanings vary across sub-corpora. Findings offer a way of understanding terrorist public statements, by paying more attention to “the lexical zone” of “the lexicogrammar of violence” (Matthiessen & DeCoursey, 2022, p. 1).

This chapter reports and discusses the findings in three main sections. Section 5.2 engages with the patterns of lexical selection and thematic focus in the sub-corpora as resulting from the Linguistic Inquiry and Word Count (LIWC)-based corpus analysis. The findings of this section provide evidence of the authors’ engagement in terrorism, and linguistic evidence of their style, concerns and motives or drivers for aggression. Section 5.3 presents the results of analysis of the most frequent lexical items (hereafter, LI) by using the AntConc concordancing software. These results offer more clues to the terrorists’ ideologies, identities and agendas. Section 5.4 is concerned with the function of repeatedly used attitudinal LIs and their use in decoding the most frequently salient type of ATTITUDE in the sub-corpora, with the aim of exploring the personal and relational identities construed in each sub-corpus.

5.2 Patterns of lexical selection and discursive themes focus

This section reports on the lexical choices and thematic focus of the texts in the dataset, and how these choices compare across the sub-corpora. It demonstrates how variation in these linguistic choices can serve as evidence of engagement in terrorism, and of authors’ concerns and motives. LIWC-based analysis and statistical comparison are used in Section 5.2.1 to

compare the authors' choices, with Smith (2004) acting as reference corpus. The patterns across the sub-corpora are investigated in Section 5.2.2. It is worth reminding that the four authors' sub-corpora are balanced with 10,000 words.

5.2.1 Evidence of engagement in terrorism: Comparing the four sub-corpora with Smith's (2004) reference controls

This analysis provides an account of the features that indicate terrorist texts and language users with terrorist intentions. The evidence is based on statistical patterns of lexicogrammatical choices, as compared with Smith's (2004) reference corpus of terrorist statements (Table 5.1). As explained in Section 4.4.2.1 of Chapter Three, reference corpus controls are the result of Pennebaker and Chung's (2007) LIWC-based psycholinguistic thematic and content analysis of the corpus of 17 files, which Smith (2004) identified as representing a sample of 'terrorist group' documents based on content analysis and by comparing his results for 'terrorist' and 'nonterrorist' violent group documents. Table 5.1 presents comparison of a set of features for the sub-corpora: pronouns, affect, social processes, and content categories. (Note: equal to or stronger than known factor loading of each feature or category is indicated in bold).

The comparison reveals that, for almost all the categories, the texts look like terrorist texts. Despite showing lower levels of use of the 'money' theme and first-person pronoun category, the results largely reveal higher levels of use of lexical forms of the other categories, indicating a significantly higher level of extremity than the reference corpus. Firstly, the use of pronouns in the specialised sub-corpora indicates feelings of insecurity and threat, and a heightened sense of opposition and personalisation, attesting to the texts being produced by terrorists as shown when comparing patterns of pronoun use with the reference corpus. For example, Shekau's sub-corpus tripled the reference corpus use of first-person pronouns (e.g. I, me, my): consider instance 1 below of Shekau's use of these pronouns. More prominent use of first-person plural (e.g. we, us, our) was demonstrated in Shekau's and Tarrant's texts – see instances 2 and 3, respectively. Shekau used first-person pronouns two and a half times more than the reference corpus, showing more statistically significant determination in demarking 'Our' group in opposition to outgroups, as well as focusing on self as undergoing others' wrongdoings (see, e.g. Turner & Gelles, 2003; Mardigian, 2008, cited in Gales, 2010).

Table 5.1: Comparing patterns in sub-corpora with reference controls

Categories	Sub-corpora				Controls
	OBL	Shekau	Al-Baghdadi	Tarrant	
Pronouns					
First person singular	0.64	2.51	0.14	0.32	0.83
First person plural	1.81	4.90	1.02	2.22	1.95
Second person	1.81	5.66	3.07	2.19	0.87
Third person singular	1.40	0.86	1.72	0.04	1.37
Third person plural	1.83	1.36	2.84	2.36	1.43
Affect					
+ emotion	3.72	2.23	2.95	3.16	2.03
- emotion	3.70	3.20	3.62	3.36	1.87
Anger	1.97	2.09	1.86	1.73	0.89
Social processes: humans and family	12.01	19.31	12.45	11.99	9.29
Content					
Religion	4.45	4.71	4.71	0.58	1.89
Money	0.51	0.35	0.29	1.10	0.58
Death	0.84	1.24	0.77	0.51	0.64
Achievement	1.60	1.12	1.89	2.38	0.81

Strikingly, the rate of use of second-person pronoun category (e.g. you, your) was significantly higher in all sub-corpora, with Shekau using them almost five times more than the reference corpus, reflecting a more heightened sense of ‘personalisation’ (see also Gales, 2010; Rugala & Fitzgerald, 2003) – i.e. focus on the addressees, be they incitees or threatened victims, in instances 4-5, respectively. This category presented a common variable/indicator of engagement in terrorist violence. The use of third-person singular (e.g. he, him) was more statistically salient in OBL’s and al-Baghdadi’s texts – see instance 6. Third-person plural was more used in all sub-corpora, except for Shekau’s (instance 7). Al-Baghdadi used third-person plural the most. This stand-out use of third-person pronouns is a predictor of extremism and

suggests that the authors are defining their groups to a large degree by the existence of opposing parties (see Pennebaker & Chung, 2007):

(1) *I am still strong and ready to carry on the work of God.*

(2) a. *The government of Nigeria cannot end what **we** are doing; they can only die trying.*

b. *...know that for me there are two categories of people in the world: those that are with **us**, and the rest.*

(3) ***We** are coming for Constantinople, and **we** will destroy every mosque and minaret in the city.*

(4) *Therefore, know, O ahl al-sunna in Syria, that if **you** wish to live in honour and dignity, **you** have no choice but to return to your religion and to waging jihad against your enemy. (al-Baghdadi)*

(5) *I want **you** [Antifa/Marxist/communists] in my sights. I want **your** neck under my boot. (Tarrant)*

(6) *Here **he** [Bush] is in a critical situation.*

(7) ***They** [Israelis in Palestine] terrorise the women and children, and kill and capture the men. (OBL)*

The findings on the use of person pronouns, thus, reveal that authors of the sub-corpora were engaged in terrorism and related acts such as othering, inclusion/exclusion, divisive opposition and personalisation – some of which concepts/acts are visited in Section 5.4 and Chapters 6 and 7. The increased rate of use of person pronouns has been established as a common “lexical element” (see Muschalik, 2018, p. 100) of terrorist threatening communication; and these terrorist texts are interpersonal texts par excellence (see also O’Keeffe, Clancy & Adolphs, 2011, p. 44). I make a note here that while the reference (domestic terrorism) corpus’s control percentages help establish evidence of having texts that look like terrorist texts, the difference in percentages in the international terrorism texts may help us understand the nature of international terrorist texts in which a more heightened, divisive use of pronouns (namely, the ‘we’, ‘you’ and ‘they’ pronouns) serves to mark the international terrorists’ attention to particular social groups.

A second common piece of evidence of engagement in terrorism was in lexis relating to affect and social processes. All authors used more words of positive and negative emotions than the

reference corpus. The negative category (e.g. *punish, lose*) was used more than the positive category (e.g. *care, glad*) in the sub-corpora (see Examples 8-9) – see Figure 5.1, 1.A, 1.B and 1.C. This realisation is explicitly evident in Shekau’s texts which show that negative emotions were far higher than the controls while five texts showed fewer positive emotions than the controls (as marked in red in Figure 5.1, 1.B). This striking increase in use of affect LIs indicates authors’ engagement in terrorism. The higher rate of negative emotions (together with anger) presents negativity as a typical feature of the sub-corpora. The rate of emotions also indicates that the four authors are more emotionally attached to topics and audiences. While positive and negative emotions (e.g. *glad* vs. *hate*) are more salient in OBL’s texts, the anger category (e.g. *kill, death*) is more evident in Shekau’s. That said, two of Shekau’s texts show a marginal decrease in anger by comparison with the control corpus, as did one text by OBL (as marked in red in Figure 5.1, 1.A), emphasising the importance of considering a set of thematic indicators when examining terrorist texts instead of a single indicator and stressing the importance of considering cross-text variation. Unlike Shekau, Tarrant’s text shows the lowest use of anger words. Also more significant across the sub-corpora, words referring to humans and family as a ‘social processes category’ were also more significant than those of reference corpus. Altogether, the analysis of affect and social processes reveals more evidence that the sub-corpora were more significantly and typically terrorist, and that authors relied on the emotional element in their strategic use of language, which helps to realise rhetorical functions such as appealing to audiences’ emotions in polarisation, mobilisation, invoking ingroup involvement, and invoking the feelings of victimhood and blameworthiness (cf. Baider & Constantinou, 2014). The affect lexicon indicates authors’ engagement in emotional labour or, as put by Wright-Neville and Smith (2009, p. 85), the “emotional marketplace”. It indicates reliance on a ‘channel’ to steer the audience’s ways of feeling towards a shared action (Breeze, 2020), a rhetorical function further explored in Chapter six.

(8) *Fitnah is that your sons be **killed** upon something other than the religion of Islam, for the sake of supporting the taghut and nationalism.* (al-Baghdadi)

(9) *This stripping of wealth and prosperity in order to feed and develop our cultural competitors is an act of civilization terrorism [...] for the benefit of those that **hate** us.* (Tarrant)

Figure 5.1: Cross-text variation in the use of the affect theme words

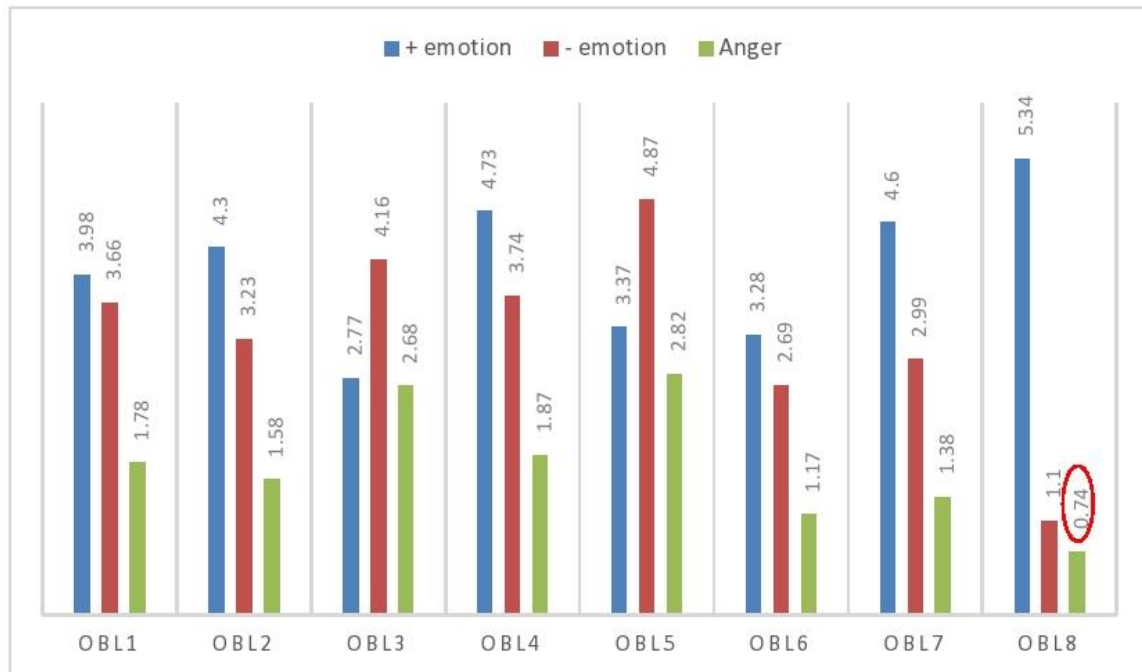


Figure 5.1, 1.A: The use of positive emotions, negative emotions, and anger across OBL's texts

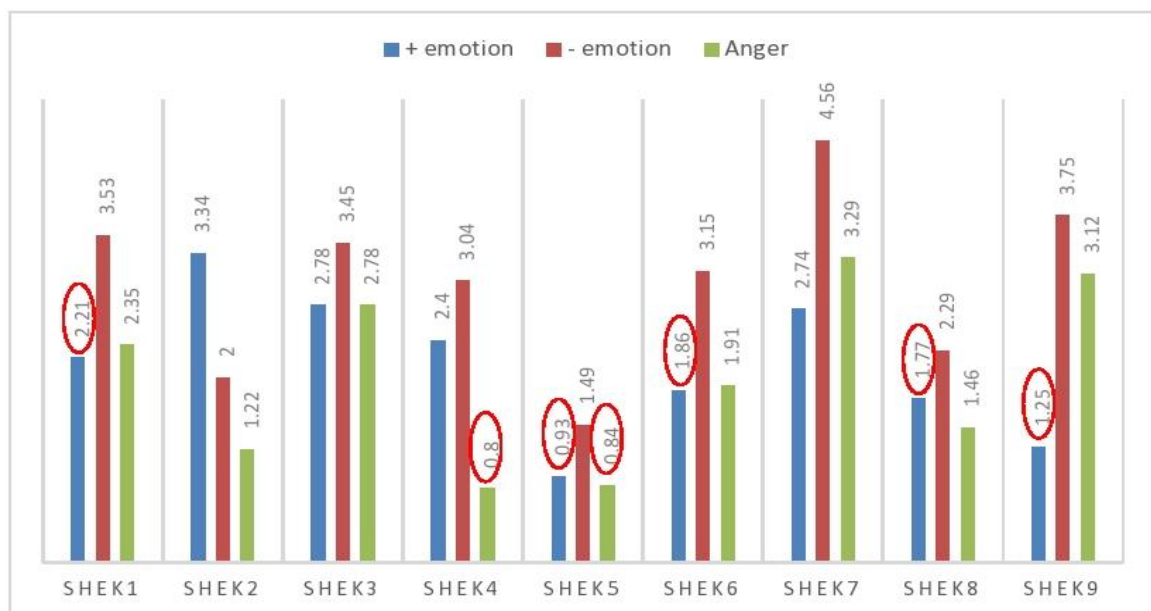


Figure 5.1, 1.B: The use of positive emotions, negative emotions, and anger across Shekau's texts

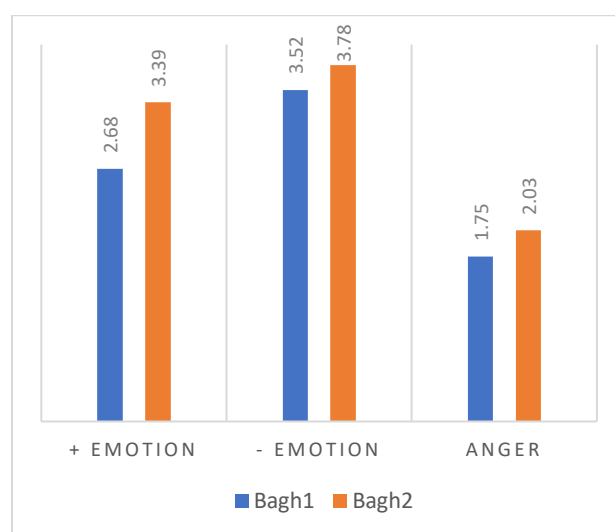


Figure 5.1, 1.C: The use of positive emotions, negative emotions, and anger across al-Baghdadi's texts

Another strong clue of engagement in terrorism is displayed in the frequency of use of content thematic categories realised lexically and grammatically – see Figure 5.2 for cross-text variation in thematic categories. While the religion theme, doubling the reference rate, and the death theme were more salient in the OBL, Shekau and al-Baghdadi texts, the money category was more significant in Tarrant's text (Examples 10-12) but was completely absent from two of Shekau's texts and one of OBL's texts (as shown in Figure 5.2, 2.B). These findings provide evidence for categorising al-Qaeda, Boko Haram and ISIS leaders as more violent persons who are of a religious ideology-orientation, i.e. they base their violence on 'obligations' towards a master identity and "(mis)readings" of authoritative religious texts (cf. Baker & Vessey, 2018, p. 274). While the 'religion' theme in Tarrant's manifesto is used less than in the reference corpus, this theme remains statistically significant as realised in his lexical choices (e.g. *irreligious*, *mosque*, *minaret*, *god*, *church*, *Pope*, *worship*, *Christian*, *atheistic*). Similar to the jihadists' reference to '*paradise*' as the hereafter reward for jihad, Tarrant references '*Valhalla*' (which is, in Scandinavian mythology, a hall ruled over by the god Odin where half of those who die in combat travel upon death): '*I will see you in Valhalla*'. This suggests that, while terrorism of the far-right Tarrant is motivated in part by religious intolerance, yet this terrorism foregrounds drivers such as 'achievement' and 'money' as the

main themes. Money almost doubled the reference frequency, revealing that Tarrant is the most concerned of the authors with economic status and a group privilege. The money theme also appears more frequently in OBL's texts than in Shekau's and al-Baghdadi's. The 'achievement' category – instance 13 – was strikingly common among all authors. Achievement tripled in Tarrant's text and almost doubled in the remaining sub-corpora, in comparison to the reference corpus. These findings indicate some of the ideological/cultural reasoning and motives of violence; while more reasoning and (meta) values motivating violence will be visited in Chapters Six and Seven.

(10) *This [jihad] is the path of our **Prophet** Mohammad, **Allah's** peace and blessings be upon him.* (religion: OBL)

(11) *The belligerent murtad among you is caught off guard and taken in broad daylight from his house in order to meet **death** in spite of his reluctance.* (death: al-Baghdadi)

(12) *Do not **pay** [taxes] to have your people destroyed.* (money: Tarrant)

(13) *Kidnap and bring them to us. Our course is to **establish** our caliphate and die doing that.* (achievement: Shekau)

Figure 5.2: Cross-text variation in the use of content themes words

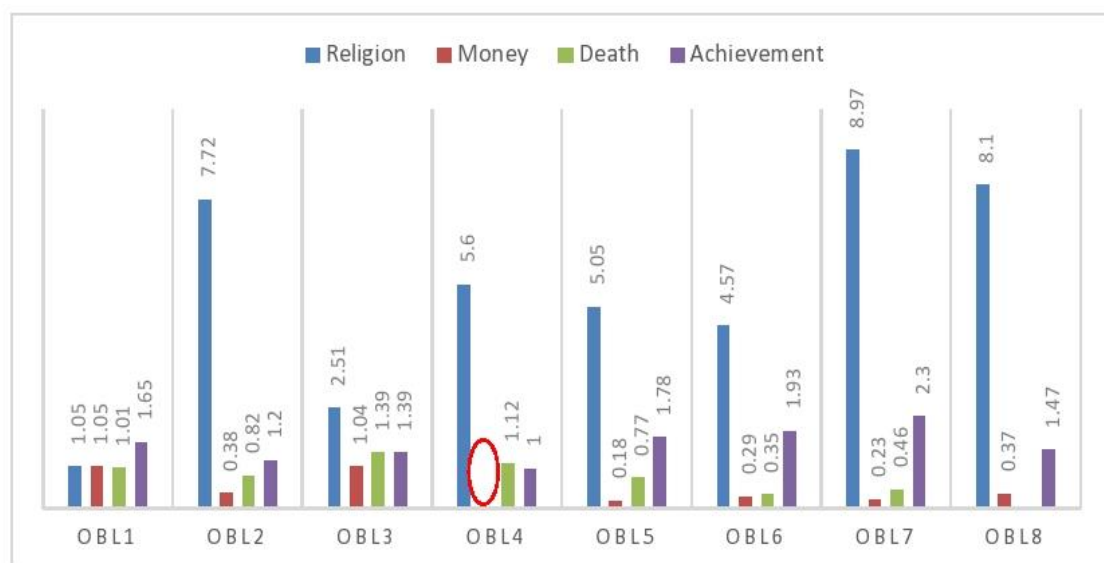


Figure 5.2, 2.A: The use of religion, money, death and achievement concepts across OBL's texts

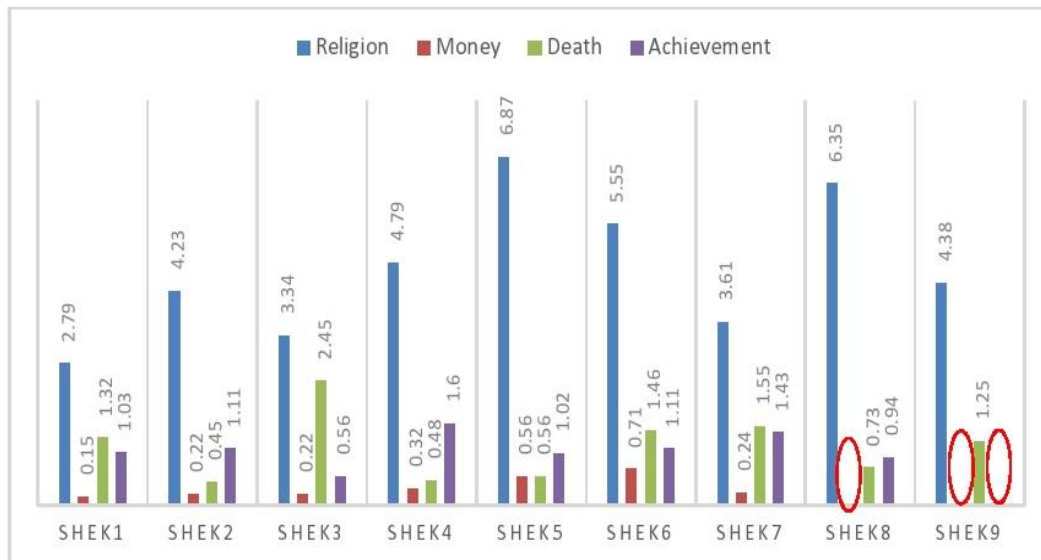


Figure 5.2, 2.B: The use of religion, money, death and achievement concepts across Shekau's texts

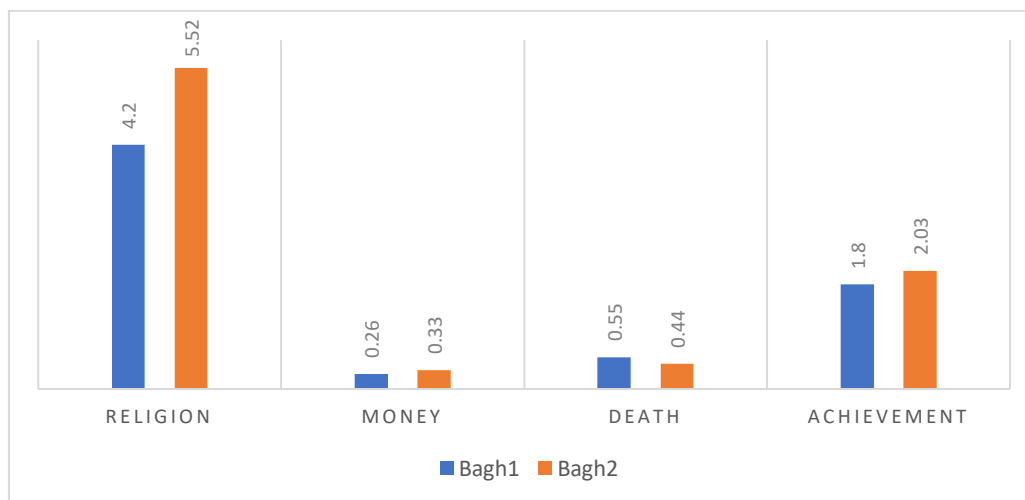


Figure 5.2, 2.C: The use of religion, money, death and achievement concepts across al-Baghdadi's texts

So far, comparison in these authors' texts of the examined set of lexical features with the reference corpus has shown that all the texts in the dataset are terrorist in nature. These features include divisive use of pronouns, dominant employment of negative emotions and anger words, and lexicons of religion, money, death and achievement themes. The use of

these kinds of linguistic resources can foment anxiety, provoke antagonism and incite violence (see, e.g. Baider & Constantinou, 2014; Ebner, 2018), as will be explored further in Section 5.4 and Chapter Six. Patterns of more thematic categories compared across the four authors are reported next.

5.2.2 Evidence of characteristic concerns and drivers across the four sub-corpora

This subsection focuses on two broad sets of content-related themes in order to investigate how lexical choices, realising thematic focus, characterise terrorists' concerns and drivers, and how these characteristics compare across the sub-corpora. The first set of themes is concerned with the 'social and personal concerns' categories: work, leisure, home, religion, money, death, swearing, and social (including family and friends). The second deals with 'drives' (or alternatively, drivers) categories which describe what encourages violence as a goal-oriented behaviour: affiliation, achievement, power, reward and risk (Table 5.2). (Note: Strongest factor loading for each theme indicated in bold).

The analysis shows that the four authors vary in terms of the frequency-based salience of their concerns and drivers categories. Regarding statistically significant 'concerns', OBL was the most concerned out of the four authors with concepts of 'home' (e.g. *families, houses*) and 'friendship'. Shekau most strikingly uses the themes of religion, death, social (e.g. *fight*) and family (e.g. *daughters*). The al-Baghdadi texts demonstrate more reference to religion – although equal to Shekau's use. The Tarrant text uses the concepts of work, leisure (e.g. *arts, media*), money (e.g. *wealth, earn, income*) and swearing (e.g. *scum*) more significantly – see instance 14. Concerning drivers categories, OBL uses words of 'risk' (e.g. *fear, die*) more prominently. Shekau uses words that concern affiliation more significantly – see instance 15. Tarrant uses the themes of achievement (e.g. *victory, control, better*), power (e.g. *invader, wealth*) – see instance 16 – and reward considerably more than any other author.

(14) *These same children will one day become teens, then adults [...] practicing the cultural and religious practices of the invaders, taking our peoples **lands, work, houses** and even attacking and killing our children.*

(15) *Everyone knows what **Christians** did to **Muslims**, not once or twice.*

(16) *Millions of **invaders** landing on our shores, **conquering** our towns and without a single shot fired in response.*

Table 5.2: Comparing concerns and drivers thematic categories across sub-corpora

Content themes	Sub-corpora			
	OBL	Shekau	Al-Baghdadi	Tarrant
Social and personal concerns				
Work	1.54	1.64	1.04	2.68
Leisure	0.27	0.21	0.26	0.40
Home	0.27	0.11	0.08	0.20
Religion	4.45	4.71	4.71	0.58
Money	0.51	0.35	0.29	1.10
Death	0.84	1.24	0.77	0.51
Swear	0.03	0.05	0.01	0.06
Social	12.01	19.31	12.45	11.99
Family	0.42	0.54	0.38	0.25
Friend	0.19	0.11	0.11	0.01
Drivers				
Affiliation	2.69	6.09	1.74	3.20
Achievement	1.60	1.12	1.89	2.38
Power	4.23	3.78	4.03	4.80
Reward	1.05	0.63	0.93	1.17
Risk	0.96	0.70	0.90	0.88

Despite variations in statistical salience and prominence of themes between the authors, commonalities were identified (see Figure 5.3). Figure 5.3 presents a chart of distribution of sub-corpora into theme variables. The chart presents ‘social’ and ‘religion’ as dominant concern themes in OBL, Shekau and al-Baghdadi texts, while social and work are the most prominent in Tarrant’s text. The chart also shows power and affiliation as the most significant drivers themes, which supports Smith’s (2008) finding that power and affiliation are associated with levels of aggression as well as indicating the ideological and cultural reasoning of violence. Unlike the increased rate of social, religion and work categories, the swearing category is the least frequent variable amongst all sub-corpora. Swearing (including abusive terms) is not significant in the OBL and al-Baghdadi sub-corpora; however, it is so in Tarrant’s (e.g. *scum*, *vipers*) – as in instance 17 communicated prior to Tarrant’s attack on the Muslims – and in Shekau’s (e.g. *sheep*, *ape*, *spider*, *stupid*, *rats*, *pigs*, *mad*, *liar*, *evil*, *curse*), used for example after Boko Haram’s attack on the Giwa military barracks in Maiduguri. Despite that

the significance of using the swearing category varies from a terrorist (group) to another, these findings demonstrate that violent acts include swearing, profanity and other offensive language, either before the act, during, or after the act, to describe the victim and the violence itself – which provides empirical evidence to law enforcement practitioners' claims in this regard (e.g. Davis, 1997).

(17) *You burn the nest and kill the **vipers**, no matter their age*

Figure 5.3 visualises how the conceptual categories compared across the sub-corpora. OBL uses home, friends, and risk themes more frequently than other authors. Shekau uses religion, death, family and affiliation categories more than any other author, presenting him as being the most verbally violent. Affiliation is more frequent in Tarrant's than in the OBL and al-Baghdadi texts, as realised by words such as *West, Europe, traitors, immigrants, anti-white* and *non-European*. For Tarrant, achievement, power and reward (for violence, be it socioeconomical, environmental reward) are the drivers categories found to be most present. Work, money, leisure and swearing concern categories are most present in Tarrant's sub-corpus. The findings indicate that 'power' relations and authority in society, and the 'welfare' of the ingroup (see also Sykes, 1988; Haidt & Kesebir, 2010), were a main focus of Tarrant whose violence was driven by social struggle and intention to control social power, and economic and social ordering, or to impose division between social groups in terms of privileges and rewards (cf. Lutz & Lutz, 2008, p. 130).

In sum, as has been established in many forensic computational/corpus linguistic studies (see e.g. Almela et al., 2019), this section paid particular attention to patterns of lexical choice and their thematic categories, that is, how these categories characterise the terrorist type of the datasets. Comparison of findings with the reference corpus as well as among the sub-corpora provided evidence of terrorist texts, authors' engagement in terrorism, and their characteristic concerns and drivers, by relating words to explicit meanings and LIWC conceptual categories. Repeated themes were stimulated by and signalled an author's violent ideology (cf. van Dijk, 1995, p. 282).

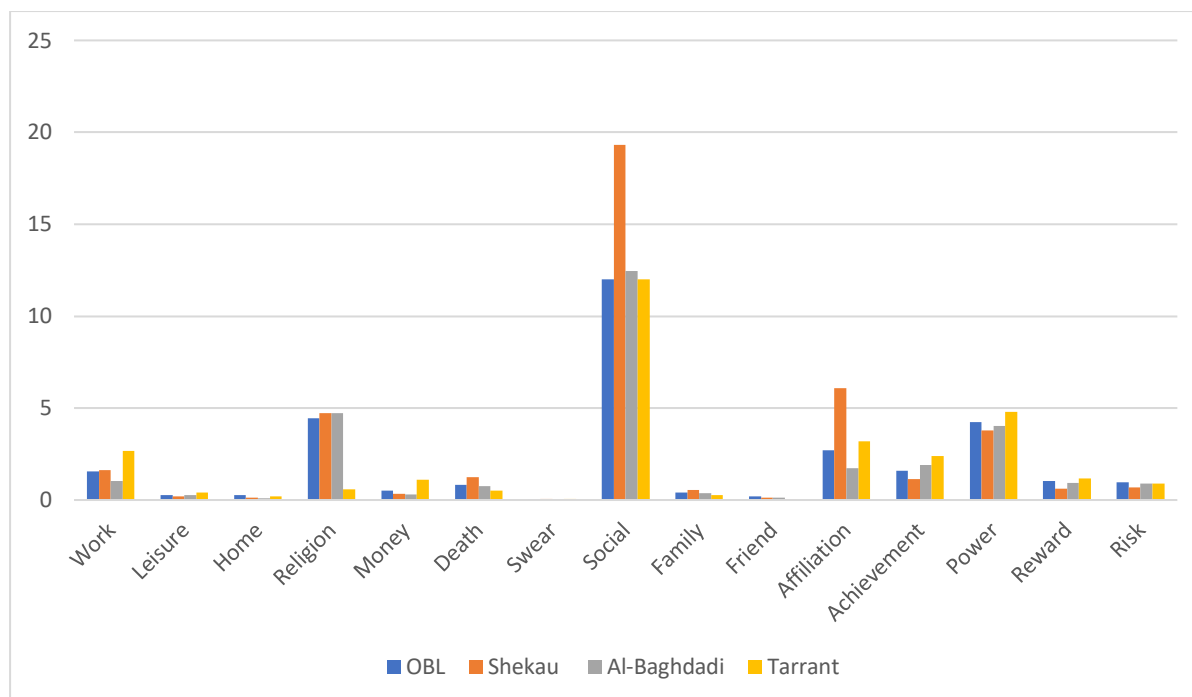


Figure 5.3: Distribution of theme variables across sub-corpora

Nevertheless, the datasets might have comprised patterns of implicit as well as explicit meanings (e.g. attitudinal meaning categories) that were not computationally captured by LIWC, which will be the focus of Section 5.4. Furthermore, some frequently used lexical items are either categorised simultaneously under more than one category (e.g. *jihad* and *Muslim* categorised under affiliation, power and religion) or overlooked; for example, religious terms of othering of Arabic origin such as *taghut* and *nusayri* are un-categorised. This justifies the need for the more nuanced analyses undertaken in Sections 5.3 and 5.4. In addition, words could have been included in the death or power categories if a closer investigation of co-text (concordance lines) was enabled by LIWC (e.g. *harvest* and *eat* collocating with someone's throat/neck/flesh, in Shekau's sub-corpus). Moreover, negative concepts (e.g. *kill*), concerns (e.g. religious concern such as *kafir*) or drivers (e.g. affiliation such as *CEO* or *White*), when considered in relation to the words they tend to co-occur with, can provide more insights into the datasets. For example, co-occurrences of *kill* (e.g. *KILL YOUR LOCAL ANTI-WHITE CEO*) (emphasis in original) in Tarrant's sub-corpus can uncover linguistic behaviour of a causal relation that is concerned with power, hierarchy, (in)justice and so forth – as nicely put by

Almela et al. (2019, p. 9), “at least in the authors’ cognition”. This linguistic behaviour is visited in Section 5.4.

Furthermore, words (e.g. attack, fight) in the power category may be argued to be categorised differently to better account for their pragmatic functions in terrorist texts. In other words, these LIs can be thought of as, for example, encoding the concept of threatened or incited-for ‘violence’, or alternatively encoding the values of aggression upheld by an author (see, e.g. Muschalik, 2018; Smith, 2004). To overcome these issues, the top frequent words were sorted and (sub)categorised manually by using AntConc, and analysed for their collocates (Section 5.3). This analysis can contribute to the improvement of LIWC categories.

5.3 Patterns of frequent lexical items as evidence of characteristic conceptual burstiness

Two patterns of burstiness have been identified: repetition of similar superordinate semantic categories as realised in different words in a sub-corpus; and the use of a specific concept or term over and over near the initial mention of it in an utterance. Focusing on the first pattern, this section reports on the findings from analysing and categorising the most frequent lexical items in the sub-corpora. Findings are described in terms of how LIs provide clues to terrorists’ lexical choices and encode ideological motivation and perceptions, a violent agenda, and ideology/master identity (see e.g. Shuy, 2010). The analysis is more semantically rich than the LIWC analysis and includes additional thematic categories.

5.3.1 An overview of ideology-specific sets of words as evidence

Before delving into the thematic categories of lexical clues, an overview of prominent words alongside their normalised frequency (for each sub-corpus) is provided. The normalised frequencies of the most frequent words across the sub-corpora are as follows: 16.29% (OBL), 27.35% (Shekau), 22.83% (al-Baghdadi) and 20.12% (Tarrant). While the authors tend to repeat their top LIs with different rates, they all show a trend of repetition – which serves as a cue of prominence of co-occurring ideological concepts at least in the authors’ cognition.

The most frequent words varied depending on the authors’ ideology. For religious ideology-oriented terrorists, besides their increased use of person pronouns, the three terrorists use the lemma *Allah* most frequently, that is, 1.56%, 2.17% and 2.03% in OBL, Shekau and al-Baghdadi, respectively (see Figure 5.4). For the far right-oriented terrorist Tarrant, the word

people (1.06%) is the most frequent lemma. The repeated use of the word *people* and its collocates in the Tarrant sub-corpus is a statistically significant kind of re-occurrence, which allows for cohesion in texts by focusing on people of different ethno-national backgrounds. This kind of lexical cohesion helps Tarrant – in Canning’s (2014, p. 47) terms – to structure his perceptions of social relationships. In these kinds of text, the divisive ‘our’ people versus ‘their’ people distinction, as well as the concept of European ethnicity, are central to fomenting anxiety and legitimising violence. See, for example, the following collocates: *replace our **people**; replace the white **people**; their **people**; voting against the wishes of our **people**; taking our **peoples** lands* (emphasis added).

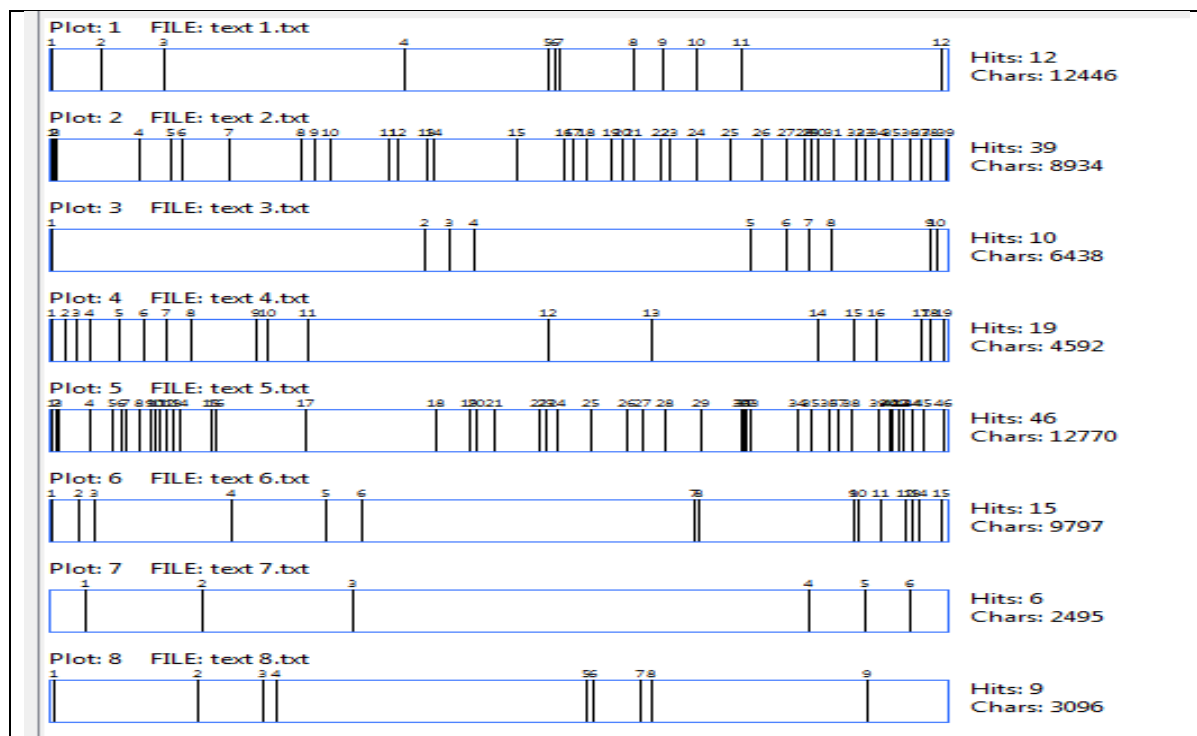


Figure 5.4: Example dispersion plot of the lemma ‘Allah’ as found in OBL’s texts

Considering terrorist text producers and audiences as participants in the ‘theatre’ of terrorism (Önnerfors, 2019), the repeated use of lemma *Allah* by authors of religious ideologies aids their performance. Firstly, the lemma reflects the master identity or affiliation of the authors. Cluster analysis shows that *Allah* is mostly contextualised in supplication (e.g. *O Allah, make the best among us our leaders*), in direct quotes that signal addressing ingroup audiences, and in Islamic formulaic expressions such as, *Allah’s willing, by the name of Allah*, and *praise is*

due to Allah. Concordance lines reveal that *Allah* is used in “interdiscursivity” (Lehman, Sułkowski & Cap, 2019, p. 9), which helps to establish an author’s identity. Secondly, the lemma enables the realisation of the rhetorical function of portraying the authors as if they are acting according to the law of Allah, and serves as support to managing the grounding of the authors’ argument – in Goffman’s (1956, p. 4) terms – in an assumed “working consensus” point of obedience to ‘Allah’. The repeated use of the lemma demonstrates – in Brookes & McEnergy’s (2020) terms – the ‘burstiness’ of a religious ‘icon’ that rhetorically intensifies invoked belongingness and author-ingroup audience alignment (cf. Wignell, Tan & O’Halloran, 2017).

The extremist nature of the dataset emphasises the need to explore the primary participants (i.e. social actors). The findings show that OBL mentions the names Muslims (0.80) and America (0.60) explicitly and constructs them as primary participants. Shekau presents Muslims (0.51), Nigeria* (0.32) and Christians (0.17) as the main rival social actors. Al-Baghdadi constructs ahl al-Sunnah (0.26) and ISIS (0.30) as the ‘legitimate’ Islamic State of ahl al-Sunnah, as a main participant opposing the rest of the world. By this construction, al-Baghdadi presents the world as divided into a camp of ‘faith’ opposing a camp of ‘kufr’ (i.e. infidelity), where the latter includes the *Crusaders*, *Jews*, *atheists*, *polytheists*, *murtadeen*, *Majus* (Iran), and *Shiite*. Tarrant constructs the white Europeans (1.05), politicians (0.21), and immigrants (0.18) as the primary participants, who are involved in a struggle over controlling the European countries and their resources. The explicit naming of and pronominal reference to rival primary participants imbues texts with a heightened intensity of polarisation.

Identified among the most frequent LIs are words that paint the violent character of the texts and that signpost justification of violence. The most frequent word that encodes violence in each sub-corpus is *fight* (0.41) in OBL’s and (0.23) al-Baghdadi’s, *kill* (0.66) in Shekau’s, and *die/death* (0.32) in Tarrant’s. In addition, the speech verb *say** and its nominalisation is also salient in frequency of use, colouring the texts of OBL (0.50), Shekau (0.90) and al-Baghdadi (0.34) with an attribution pattern of, for example, saying and quoting that endorses and justifies violence – as elaborated in Subsection 5.3.2.4.

As a final note in this overview, the top words described in this subsection introduce us to the four main categories that feature in the lists of most frequent LIs in the sub-corpora. These

categories are religion, power, 'violence and military', and the attribution pattern of 'saying' category which signposts power and violence but in different intertextual "guises", as explained in Subsection 5.3.2.4 (cf. Baker & Vessey, 2018, p. 271). The prominence of these four main categories in the datasets has shown the texts to be extremist in nature as compared with the findings from fully fledged corpus linguistic studies on the lexical categories of extremist texts (e.g. Baker & Vessey, 2018). Delving into these four thematic categories of lexical clues, in the next subsections of Section (5.3.2), supports previous research findings and exemplifies how these clues provide evidence of terrorists' semantic choices, and ideological perceptions and agendas.

5.3.2 Conceptual (sub)categories

In this subsection, superordinate categories of repeatedly used concepts/LIs are described in order to explore the characteristic 'burstiness' of these categories in the datasets. Identified subordinate categories of these words are also described. Findings display – in Brookes and McEnery (2020, p. 359) terms – the feature of "burstiness" of the most frequent words in terms of their collocational strength and the repetition of their super- and sub- ordinate conceptual categories. This burstiness feature is taken as an indication of ideological motivations of violence, affiliation or identity, and agenda such as the agenda of political control of others. This is because burstiness in terrorist texts is a function of "the discursive purpose to which [these words are] put in these texts" (Brookes & McEnery, 2020, p. 359). The terrorist threatening communication drives the burstiness of particular word categories; that is, terrorist texts drive the use of different forms that occur in, and thus share, the same "semantic fields" (e.g. Brookes & McEnery, 2020, p. 363). As such, the burstiness of the four categories of the most frequent LIs aids in marking the prominent semantic fields and uncovering the global functions of most frequent LIs in the datasets. These functions include generating fear of the sources of threat against an ingroup 'symbolic power' (cf. Bourdieu, 1989, 1991) system such as a religion or a political/ethnonationalist system, and legitimization of a violent act or provoking hostility against religiously or politically different 'others'. The findings are described and compared in the following subsections.

5.3.2.1 The 'religion' category: A feature in OBL, Shekau and al-Baghdadi's texts

Lemmas with explicit reference to the 'religion' category varied across the sub-corpora; however, similarities appeared in terms of their subcategories, i.e. their semantic fields, as summarised in Table 5.3. OBL's most frequent LIs referring to religion are 4.52% of the most frequent words (i.e. 8659 words out of 40,000 words) in the entire corpus, presenting 'religion' as a statistically significant and semantically prominent category. Shekau's words that revolve around religion also presented this category as a significant semantic field, making up 5.45% of the most frequent words. However, the most frequent reference to 'religion' within the most frequent lemmas appears in al-Baghdadi's sub-corpus, making up 7.23% referring to the Muslim world and categorisation of people of different faiths. These results, as such, present the three authors as making frequent use of religious concepts to indicate their master identity (i.e. an Islamic ideology) as well as an ideological motivation for 'othering' and opposition.

Sub-categorising the religious concepts into different levels of abstraction (i.e. semantic fields) reveals a range of commonalities and differences in the semantic orientation (i.e. choices) of the authors. For example, the most frequent religious LIs in the OBL sub-corpus are centred around eight fields: adherence, canon, authority icons, conflict, positive (acts), state, Them, and Us. In other words, the analysis shows that OBL's texts exhibit burstiness of words from a range of categories, which indicate oppositional texts that rest upon a religious ideology defining who 'we' and 'they' are: 'we' are Muslims (Us), driven by Islam (canon), who accept and obey our authorities (e.g. *Allah* and *Mohammad*) and are engaged in Jihad (conflict) against two main identity groups, the crusaders and the Jewish (Them), until we establish our state. Concerning Shekau, his lemmas revolve around seven sub-categories: adherence, canon, authority, conflict, Them, Us, and bonds (between Muslims, that is, brethren), indicating oppositional texts that drive the burstiness of subcategories that rhetorically help to define 'Us', via 'our' religion and authorities, and present 'Us' as being in conflict with *Christians*, the *infidel*.

Table 5.3: Religion-subordinate categories and semantic fields realised in sub-corpora

Category	Instances in OBL's	Instances in Shekau's	Instances in al-Baghdadi's
Adherence	Religion/ <i>deen</i>	Religion, follow, worship	Religion/deen, path, guidance, tawhid
Canon/heavenly laws	Islam, Jewish	Islam(ic), Christians	Islam(ic),
Authority	Allah, Mohammad	Allah, prophet	Allah, SWT, prophet/messenger/ Mohammad, books
Conflict	Jihad	-	Jihad
Negative	-	-	Kufr (infidelity), rafida (rejectionist), shirk (polytheism), Nusayriyya, apostacy
Positive	Martyrhood, mujahid	-	Mujahid
State	Ummah	-	Khalifa, ummah
Them	Crusade(rs)	Infidel	Unbelievers, kafir/atheist, rafidi, mushrik (polytheist), Nusayri, murtadeen/apostate
Us	Muslim	Muslim(s)	Muslim, Sunnah/ahl al-Sunnah, believers, slaves
Bond	-	Brother, brethren	Brotherhood

In contrast to OBL and Shekau, al-Baghdadi's most frequent religious lemmas present a wider set of semantic fields. Al-Baghdadi's texts exhibit the burstiness of words of ten semantic sub-categories, distinguishing his texts with more explicit concepts of the 'negative' and 'Them' categories. The burstiness of 'negative' words such as *Kufr* (infidelity), *rafida* (rejectionist), *shirk* (polytheism), *Nusayriyya*, *apostacy*, and 'Them' lemmas (e.g. *Unbelievers*, *kafir*/atheist, *rafidi*, *mushrik*, i.e. polytheist, *Nusayri*, and *murtadeen/apostates*), allows for the "negative othering" role of the dataset (Baker & Vessey, 2018, p. 264). These terms, while categorising the world based on the ISIS' version of beliefs, mark the ideologically polarising and confrontational nature of al-Baghdadi's dataset.

Besides the othering and polarising functions of these lemmas, the authors' reliance on the 'religion' concept indexes the authors' trans-national identity and presents them to ingroup audiences as insiders and – in Malešević's (2017, p. 271) terms – "legitimate conveyor[s]" of these concepts and ideas. Despite the fact that their use of religious concepts is "almost never popularly absorbed" as presented in their terrorist datasets (Malešević, 2017, p. 271), the 'religion' category and sub-categories have so far shown what kind of clues, as well as rhetorical functions, the strategic repetition of the most frequent lemmas can offer. While acknowledging that the authors' use of these concepts can be subject to theological renouncement and widely resisted "(mis)reading" and misinterpretation (Baker & Vessey, 2018, p. 272; Brookes & McEnery, 2020), the terrorists' increased use of these words does not eliminate the usefulness of these concepts in characterising terrorist semantic orientation and ideological perceptions.

Making use of lemmas of particular conceptual categories has, thus, its identity construction implications (e.g. Kitzinger & Mandelbaum, 2013, p. 176), besides the function of religious value-(dis)alignment with audiences, as will be explored in Chapter Six on 'affiliation'. The use of words such as 'infidel' and 'jihad' in the OBL sub-corpus, for example, not only construes the identity of 'infidel' others (e.g. ...*a camp of infidelity*) but also "marks off socially and ideologically distinct areas of experience" (Fowler, 1991, p. 84), of what al-Qaeda's members are doing, as an assumed mark of 'true' faith (e.g. ... *blessed jihad*). Labelling as such undergoes an ideological decision (see also Thetela, 2001) in terrorist texts, and labelling also indexes the terrorists' worldview. Religious lexicons can provide a clue to the premise of confrontation with 'others' (e.g. between Christians and Muslims, see instance 18).

(18) ***Christians** cheated and killed us [Muslims] to the extent of eating our flesh like cannibals.* (Shekau)

In addition to burstiness at the super- and sub- ordinate category levels, a kind of burstiness also exhibited in the use of a specific concept over and over in close proximity to the initial mention in an utterance. Consider *kufr* in instance 19. This use has a rhetorical effect of emphasising the negative other as well as inviting audiences to attitudinally position themselves, that is, to polarise audiences on a master identity basis. This burstiness is enforced by collocating with other negatively loaded religious discourse lemmas, *shirk*, *zanadiqa*, and *batiniya* (underlined in example below), which contradict the concept of *tawhid*. As such, burstiness also emphasises the centrality of ‘adherence’ to religion and *tawhid* (i.e. worshipping and obeying only Allah) as a value underpinning inclusion/exclusion. The burstiness of, for example, *kufr* in instance 19 below entails the absence of *tawhid*. *Kufr* burstiness enables encouraging violence based on what al-Baghdadi terms ‘actualisation’ of *tawhid* (see instance 20, underlined), that is, realising/materialising one’s rejection of *kufr*. This actualisation includes punishing religiously different ‘others’, pursuit to be ruled by the Sharia law and in the khilafah (of ISIS), and rejection of treaties signed with the religious ‘others’.

(19) *The **kufr** of this deviant sect did not stop at their committing shirk with Allah in constitutions and legislations, contending with Allah in His rule, and consenting to the **kufr** of the nations of **kufr**. Its **kufr** continued until it became a sect having no religion, like the zanadiqa and Batiniya.*

(20) *Therefore, know, O ahl al-sunna in Syria, that if you wish to live in honour and dignity, you have no choice but to return to your religion and to waging jihad against your enemy, for what matters is not just that one carries a weapon. Rather, [what matters] is the actualization of **tawhid**, making one’s al-wala wal-bara sincerely for Allah, not accepting anything other than the rule of the shari’a, and dying in the pursuit of achieving that...*

In summary, the ‘religion’ category provides evidence of the prominent semantic fields that characterise the semantic orientation of the OBL, Shekau and al-Baghdadi texts. The ‘religion’ (sub)category also offers clues of the authors’ deliberate presentation of competing ideologies and ideological perceptions, and how the terrorists strategically depend on “cultural [religious] framing” of the world in order to “ideological[ly] penetrat[e]” ingroup audiences’ micro-world and mobilise a degree of public support (Malešević, 2019, pp.

184/187). Burstiness of concepts attests to the rhetorical purpose of repetitions in the set of the most frequent 'religion' lemmas in terrorist threatening communication, as well as to how terrorist threatening communication drives this kind of lexical repetition. The 'religion' category also offered clues for the master identity of the text producers. The analysis has shown the role of "identity work" in shaping the authors' lexical selection (cf. Tracy & Robles, 2002, p. 7): authors' religious ideologies have influenced how they write and how they label phenomena, presenting the words as markers of an identity category. It has also been argued that the popularly challenged use of religious words by the terrorists attest to "ideologies [being] always *doubly determined*" and that they owe their extremity and aggression to the "function of sociodicy" and the specific sociopolitical interests of the text producers (Bourdieu, 1991, p. 169).

5.3.2.2 The 'power' category: A feature in the four authors texts

Analysis of the most frequent words also demonstrated clues to the extent of impact or areas of interest that authors aimed to influence. In this subsection, I label words encoding these areas in the 'power' category, in order to provide clues to the authors' semantic orientation and their agendas of control and dominance. The 'power' words are sub-categorised under four domains of power: geopolitical domain; socioeconomic domain; ethnonationalist domain; and environmental control domain. The realisations of these agenda-related sub-categories vary across sub-corpora. While the geopolitical and socioeconomic domains persist across the four sub-corpora, the ethnonationalist and environmental domains exist only in Tarrant's.

The most frequent lexicons that invoke the geopolitical and socioeconomic worlds and evoke related meanings provide clues to the transnational interests of the four authors and their extremist organisations and to the proposed alternatives. These transnational interests provide evidence of the global ideologies and agendas of the authors/organisations (see also Baker & Vessey, 2018). Alternatives are contextualised as being realisable through violent means. For example, OBL uses words that name or describe: particular geographies (e.g. *Iraq, America, Afghanistan, world, countries, and land*); the domain of politics (e.g. *government, leader*, Bush, White* as in the White House, *Palestine, and Ummah*), in the context of talking about issues of legitimacy of regimes and political systems, freedom and tyranny; and

economics, as in the texts mentioning *Iraq*, with oil presented as envisaged by America as 'cold booty'. While *Iraq* names a geopolitical area against which America waged a war for political reasons, the same war, as perceived by OBL, is waged for economic reasons and control over Iraq's oil. Consider instance 21 where underlined lemmas encode socioeconomics and those in bold encode geopolitics, overlapping both agendas at one time, and how OBL is proposing a violent alternative to democratic solutions. Geopolitical interest is also emphasised in instance 22 where a violent alternative (e.g. *fighting...*) is offered, instead of 'invalid' *peaceful, democratic solutions*, in response to illegitimate governments or Jewish/Crusader invasions.

(21) ***Bush*** thought that ***Iraq*** and its *oil* are a *cold booty*.

(22) Voices in ***Iraq***, as there were in ***Palestine***, *Egypt*, *Jordan*, *Yemen*, and other ***countries*** before, have called for a *peaceful, democratic solution* in dealing with the apostate governments or invaders of the Jewish and Crusaders instead of *fighting for the cause of Allah*.

In Shekau's sub-corpus, a set of lemmas also invoke geographies and the world of politics that ranged from national, through regional, to international arenas. Shekau's most frequent geopolitical lexicons include *Nigeria**, *world*, *message*, *Maiduguri* (a city in Nigeria), *Jonathon* (a Nigerian President), and *democracy*. The range of lexicons signal the regional/African and global ideology of Boko Haram as well as its political interests in presenting a religious version as alternative to democracy, the latter which is described (see instance 23) with a negative religious word (e.g. *paganism*). Socioeconomic lexicons are again inseparately presented from the geopolitical world. These lemmas include *people*, *work**, *education*, *slaves*, *sell* and *Chibok* (a Nigerian town whose girls were abducted by Boko Haram). These lemmas reflect Shekau's agenda to influence the social and economic lives of people. Analysis of concordance lines has shown that Shekau presents his extreme, violent alternatives to geopolitical and socioeconomic issues, as in instances 23-24 below.

(23) Everyone knows that ***democracy*** and the constitution is *paganism*.

(24) I had promised to put an end to your [oil] ***refinery***.

Al-Baghdadi's lemmas refer to geographical areas and sociopolitical topics that span the world. The most frequent geopolitical lexicons include *lands*, *state*, *Iraq*, *Syria*, *nations*,

leaders, rule, affairs and *Sham*. His geopolitical lexicons cover areas in the Muslim world (e.g. *Khilafa*, which is a geopolitical project), the Middle East (e.g. *Sham*), Africa, Asia (e.g. *alSalul*, i.e. the Saudi monarchy), *Europe* and *America*. The most frequent words collocate with words such as *secularise, secularist, wealth, corruption, ministers, politics, sanctions* and *tyrannical*, bringing geopolitics and socioeconomics together. Al-Baghdadi's lexicons point to ISIS involvement in violence around the world and its global ideology.

For Tarrant, 968 occurrences of the most frequent lemmas colour his semantic orientation and agenda areas. These lemmas realise the following domains:

- Ethnonationalist: which includes *European, West, Western, divers*, ethnic*, White, racial/race, nationalism, change*;
- Geopolitical and sociopolitical: which includes *politic*, world, Lands, Europe, nations, and (United) States*;
- Socioeconomic: which includes *society, societal, social(ly), man/men, people, birthrate, future, labour, immigrants, immigration, cities, live/lives/living, population, increase/increasing, children, fertility, media, group, mass, strength, strong, support, wealth, corporate/ corporation, work/ workers, culture/ cultural replacement*);
- Environmental: which includes *natural, nature, and environment**.

Repetitions of these lemmas display burstiness of the concept of 'power' and its related semantic domains. As such, these lemmas attest that 'victory' and the concept of power in the far-right terrorist's agenda is contingent on the notion of race, the white, or European-ness. Examination of, for example, the lemma *race* shows its burstiness as repeatedly used in collocating with words that:

- Show sources of fear of the author, that is, the occurrence of ***racial*** *replacement*, becoming a ***racial*** *minority*, the increasing others' ***racial*** *birthrates*, ***racial*** *diversity* which breeds ***racial*** *enemies*;
- Divide people into an 'our' race versus 'their' race dichotomy (e.g. *my race, our race, enemies of our race, and race traitors*).

- Legitimise violence for master identity-protection, due to perceived legitimate racial divides or confrontation between peoples (e.g. *racial violence*, *racial divides* and *racial warfare*).

Frequent words that fall within the concept of race (e.g. *White*, *European* and *Western*) also contribute to the burstiness of the ethnonationalist semantic field, by emphasising the ethnonationalist identity of the author and his agenda for sociopolitical and socioeconomic hierarchy-preservation. Consider, for example, the word *white* collocating with social, political and economic domain-lexicons (in bold):

- *anti-white **states***, *none-white scum*, *anti-white **scum***, *anti-white **CEO***, *White genocide*, *White **markets***, *anti-White **media***, *White **people***, *White **nations***, *White **population***, *anti-white **politicians***, and *White **rebirth***.

Western is also used to define 'our' phenomena, for example, *Western country*, *economy*, *men*, *nations*, and *world*. This burstiness of the concept of *race* plays a rhetorical role in legitimising actions against racially different 'others', for whom the burstiness of words such as *divers** is negatively employed:

(25) *The more diverse a group becomes, the less equal it becomes. **Diversity** is anathema to equality. One cannot exist with the other. **DIVERSITY IS UNEQUAL, HIERARCHIES ARE CERTAIN.*** (bold added)

The concept of *diversity*, as such, is contextualised as something to blame and to fight against, for the good of the White. In addition to *diversity*, the burstiness of the ethnonationalist semantic field is also reinforced by concepts such as *replace** which correlate to the concept of race and ethnicity, to construe others as threat to the ingroup (e.g. ***replace the white people***, *racial **replacement***, *ethnic **replacement***, ***replacement of the white***). This threat construction is emphasised by the repeated use of *invade* which co-occurs with non-Europeans and *immigrants* who are viewed as *ethnic competitors* and 'opponents' in the *ethnic battleground*. This threat-construction rhetorically assists in generating fear, in ingroup audiences, of *becoming an ethnic minority* or *ethnically replace[d]*. This serves in supporting the violent alternative (e.g. killing and deporting 'opponents') and creating an *ethnic unity* to achieve 'our' victory and sustain 'our' power.

Within this struggle for the European-ness of political, economic and social domains, European nationhood, as well as culture, as a superordinate ‘power’ concept is argued. This power concept is realised in collocates such as: *cultural competitors, cultural heritage, cultural divides, cultural minority, cultural replacement, cultural suicide, native European population*; while ‘others’ are viewed as *occupying Europe, racially cleanse Europe*, and so on. Burstiness of the European/ white ‘power’ concepts, as such, enforces the function of Tarrant’s messages of protecting the race instead of prioritising the ‘individual’ (see instance 26), race superiority, and *retak[ing] Europe*, even by force, across all domains.

(26) *In this hell the individual is all and the **race** is worthless [...].*

Another key lemma in Tarrant’s dataset is *immigrant/immigration*, which is also related to economic concepts such as *work/labour*. Repetition of this lemma reinforces Tarrant’s messages about the negative impact of non-Europeans on European workers’ ‘rights’ and ‘dignity’. The burstiness of this lemma also enables framing non-Europeans as being responsible for – in Tarrant’s terms – *industrial labour replacement*, and being a threat to nature and the environment due to the high fertility rate of non-Europeans (see instance 27). These findings provide support to recent corpus and discourse analyses of the white supremacist discourses (e.g. Szenes, 2021) which present immigration and environment as common grievances.

(27) ...Continued **immigration** into Europe is environmental warfare and ultimately destructive to nature itself...

The use of lemmas such as *immigration* and *diversity* in Tarrant’s dataset illustrates Bourdieu’s (1991, p. 40) argument that there are no “neutral” or contextually independent words. These lemmas are used frequently to enable the exclusionary and polarising functions of Tarrant’s dataset, emphasising Biber et al.’s (1999, p. 969) contention that all the interpretations of “purely lexical expressions of stance depend on the context and shared background”. So far, ‘power’ words have been demonstrated in terms of how they intersect and relate to more than one domain. This intersection ultimately intensifies the burstiness of the ‘power’ category in a way that reinforces feelings to defend ‘our’ race, nations, economy, environment and political system, and to restore or maintain – in Sykes’ (1988) terms – the ‘welfarization’ and prosperity of people of ‘our’ race.

(28) *It is not just a matter of our prosperity, but the very survival of our **people**.*

The results of the analysis of ‘power’ lemmas used by the four authors attest to the terrorists’ tendency to strategically deploy these terms repeatedly and in a way that links their threatening communication “with grassroots micro-universes” of audiences (cf. Malešević, 2019, p. 189), that is, with domains that influence public and individual life in order to gain support. Lexical choices provided clues to terrorists’ agendas of influence, which depart from “already existing political cleavages” (Malešević, 2019, p. 190) and extend that influence to different walks of life of the public. The means of violence for realising these agendas can be realised lexically, as discussed in the following subsection.

5.3.2.3 The ‘violence and military’ category: A feature in the four authors texts

Analysis of the most frequent words presents lexical choices in the semantic domain of violence and conflict, including military terms invoking the world of violence, which are taken as clues to the authors’ semantic orientation and violent ideology. These words play a role in shaping a common violent, oppositional tone of the datasets (see, e.g. Muschalik, 2018; Turner & Gelles, 2003; Zghayyir, 2016). The ‘violent’ lemmas are sub-categorised into three sub-ordinate concepts: physical destruction cause; physical or psychological action; and military concept. These are summarised in Table 5.4.

In OBL’s dataset, all the three sub-categories are identified. For example, *kill* is used as a physical destruction cause resource to describe what participants have brought about against one another – further elaborated in Section 5.4 (see instance 29). *Fight*, by contrast, encodes the meaning of violent physical action (to be) perpetrated (instance 30). Lemmas such as *war** (e.g. *warplane*), *forces*, *bombs*, *invade* and *martyr** invoke the world of the military (see instance 31).

(29) *...**kill**ing the Americans with bullets, knives, stones, etc.*

(30) *...it has become clear to us from our defence and **fight** against the American enemy...*

(31) *...we gained experience in guerrilla **warfare** and attrition warfare.*

The same sub-categories of 'violence and military' are identified in Shekau's, al-Baghdadi's and Tarrant's datasets, realised by the most frequent lexical items as exemplified in Table 5.4.

Repetition of the three sub-categories of violence explicitly shapes the violent semantic orientation of the authors. The sub-categories also help to identify the violent ideology of the authors who propose violent solutions to 'reality'. Consider, for example, instance 32, where al-Baghdadi presents ISIS with its coercive capacity (underlined) as well as death (in bold) as a solution for winning against 'crusaders'.

(32) *O Ahl as-Sunna! **After Allah, you have nothing but the Islamic State to protect your religion, safeguard your authority, and bolster your strength, a state wherein you can either live with glory or die with dignity**, without the lowly Rafida, wicked Nusayriyyah, and vile atheists daring to touch your honor.*

Violent solution is prescribed through the repeated use of the lemma *jihad*, mainly by OBL and al-Baghdadi, to invoke a religiously coated violent action concept. That said, while this lemma intrinsically refers to a struggle against aggressors, declared by the 'legitimate' ruler/Caliph of Muslims, when there is no peaceful alternative for self-defence (Afsaruddin, 2020), terrorists used the lemma to religiously license their acts because they consider the current rulers of Muslim nations to be 'illegitimate'. Repeated use of *jihad* is the ideologically decided 'labelling' of violent actions (cf. Thetela, 2001, p. 354), which uncovers "competing ideological perceptions" of inter-group conflicts (cf. Malešević, 2019, p. 184).

Unlike OBL and al-Baghdadi, *jihad* is not frequently used by Shekau. It only appears once in the Shekau sub-corpus, excluding the name of his movement which includes the word *jihad* by default. Shekau, instead, frequently uses lemmas such as *slaughter* – in addition to *fight* and, less frequently, *kidnap* and *take* which collocate, for example, with *hostages*. Shekau's use of lemmas such as *cut* and *slaughter* serves in maximising the attention of his audiences, amplifying fear and trauma, and presenting adversaries (e.g. the Nigerian government) as incompetent by utilising words that invoke "memorable, and thus high-impact forms of violence" (Malešević, 2019, p. 189).

(33) *I swear, I am going to **cut your throats**.*

Table 5.4: ‘Violence and military’ sub-categories exemplified as realised in sub-corpora

Violence and military sub-categories	OBL	Shekau	Al-Baghdadi	Tarrant
Words of physical destruction cause	Kill, destroy	Kill, <i>cut/slit/harvest</i>	Destroy, die/death, kill	Die, destroy, kill
Words of physical or psychological action	Fight, jihad	Fight, slaughter	Fight, fear, jihad	Fight, radicalize
Words of the military (action, object, organization, field, etc.)	War*, forces, bombs, invade, ally/allies, martyr*, crusade*	War, (a)live*, barracks	Enemy, support, war, crusade*, victory, wage, battle	Invade, attack, enemy, victor*, support, loss/lose

Note: cut/slit/harvest were counted as one entry/lemma since they are used alternately in the translation with the same collocation (e.g. *cut/slit/harvest someone’s throat/neck*)

In addition, examination of concordance lines of lemmas such as *kill* also uncovers collocation with ‘memorable’ forms of violence in other sub-corpora, intensifying the violent nature of datasets. For example, *Kill* collocates with, *inter alia*, *knives* (instance 29 above) in OBL’s sub-corpus. In the Tarrant dataset, a command to *kill* ‘high profile enemies’ is suggested to be perpetrated through asymmetric, primitive ways of communicating violent messages (see instance 34). This contextualised use of words attests to the coercive capacity that characterizes the authors’ use of “asymmetric violence” (Malešević, 2019, p. 189), wherein Tarrant, for example, encourages ethnic *soldiers* [to] *fight*, while OBL encourages the fight of *soldiers of Allah* – which demarks their ideological reasonings for violence.

(34) ...*TATP packages strapped to drones, an EFP in a motorcycle saddle bags, convoy ambush rammings with cement trucks...*

In sum, the analysis has shown that the four authors frequently used a set of words that belong to three sub-categories of the semantic domain of violence and military. These words provided clues for recognising the terrorist threatening communication and indicating a picture of asymmetric violence. The violent lemmas and conceptual subcategories define – in Leets and Giles’ (1997, p. 262) terms – the “fighting words” component of the datasets. The findings offer support to Zghayyir’s (2016) findings concerning al-Qaeda’s use of military words, and extend the same feature to Shekau, al-Baghdadi, and the Far-rightist Tarrant. The use of language and language aggression, in the light of patterns of these violent lemmas and conceptual categories, is thus understood as ideological, and discourse as a site for the articulation of the authors’ violent ideology. A lens onto sources of authority and legitimising of violence has been identified by examining the incorporated voices in the dataset, as signalled by ‘say’ as a characteristic category of the dataset.

5.3.2.4 The ‘saying’ category: A pattern of attribution practice in the jihadists texts

The use of the speech verb ‘say’ is identified as a language feature marking an attribution pattern in the OBL, Shekau and al-Baghdadi sub-corpora, with specific syntactic patterns and pragmatic roles (cf. White, 2006; Szczyrbak, 2016; Baker & Vessey, 2018). The speech verb ‘say’ serves as – in Szczyrbak’s (2016) terms – a signpost to stances and ideological perceptions/perspectives. It also plays a role in challenging standpoints and presenting self as powerful. Speech verbs signpost terrorists’ reliance on the practice of attribution/direct

quoting as a means of legitimization, endorsement and acknowledgement (see e.g. van Leeuwen & Wodak, 1999; White, 2006) of violence through (Thetela, 2001; White, 2006): indicating that a quoted text is incontrovertible fact; distancing from the endorsement of what a source is saying; or adding to the text the flavour of a source's words. Besides this, 'say' serves, in the analysis, as a signpost for yielding insight into the datasets as persuasive and argumentative texts that capitalise on quotes from authoritative sources to reconstruct a 'reality' or build the assumption of consensus on a society's shared values and identity, given that quotes often address an ingroup's 'ideal' audiences and table quotes as "truth claims and narratives" (cf. Hodges, 2015, p. 53; Thetela, 2001; Bazerman, 2003; Seals, 2012). In the following, these findings are described and discussed as identified in relation to each author.

5.3.2.4.1 Speech verbs used by OBL

OBL showed a rare use of – in White's (2006) terms – distancing locutions. He used 'claim' five times. The use of 'claim' brings into his dataset the voice of 'adversaries' – chiefly Americans, the 'far enemy', and some Arab officials, the 'near enemy' (Miller, 2015) – and allows for distancing the endorsement of their propositions and presenting OBL as withholding support for the proposition. For example, in instance 35, the use of 'claim' enables OBL to negatively frame Bush's voice and raise doubts about the worthiness of his speech or deny the truth of it, while preparing the audience to accept OBL's proposition.

(35) ...[Bush] **claiming** that this [sending US soldiers to war in Iraq] is in defence of international and American peace and hiding the true motive.

By contrast, 'say' is the most frequent saying word and the dominant speech verb (50 occurrences), demonstrating two major syntactic realisations and playing specific interpersonal and ideological roles. 'say' appears in third person-oriented realisations such as 'Allah said' and first person-oriented realisations, namely, 'I say'. The third-person structure is used with an iconic sayer (e.g. Allah, prophet Mohammad, a companion of prophet Mohammad, and a culture-specific poet) or an anonymous proverb to legitimise violence by drawing on the power of the sayer, which is "a power capable of maintaining or subverting the social order" (Bourdieu, 1991, p. 170). Consider instance 36, where 'say', in a message inciting the Iraqi people to Jihad against the US led coalition, is preceded by the nominal attribution *Allah*, besides the adnominal *praise be to*. This revered/divine 'icon says' structure

is used when OBL addresses Muslim communities that take a revered/divine icon's voice as a must-obey voice. The use of this structure also signposts the author's identity which attains its meaning by virtue of the symbolic identity of the voices. These quotes are often meant for and decodable by ideal audiences (cf. Seals, 2012, p. 236) of OBL, and the means whereby the author and his audiences' ideologies about jihad become reinforced. Consider instance 37, where 'say' signposts instances whereby OBL also reinforces the assigned truth-status of his incitement messages by attributing his assertion to a collectively accepted source of – in van Leeuwen and Wodak's (1999) term – authorisation; i.e. legitimating the value of jihad, thus capitalising on audiences' cultural predispositions towards the sayer.

(36) *Praise be to Allah who **says**: "O Prophet, fight against the disbelievers and the hypocrites and be harsh upon them".*

(37) *Allah knows that had I found a way to reach your areas [to join your Jihad], I would have taken it. How would I not do so while we know that our prophet, Allah's peace and blessings be upon him -our example- **said**: "By the One in Whose Hand is my soul, were it not that it would be too difficult for the Muslims, I would never have stayed behind from any expedition that went out in the cause of Allah."*

That said, the word 'say' can be thought of as a signal for some voice being incorporated to rhetorically give "scriptural warrant" (Brookes & McEnery, 2020, p. 365); that is, to give a clue that a key saying of an 'accepted' authority has been used to justify violence and a voice has been deployed to serve as a 'background' (see Bazerman, 2003, pp. 87-89) to the author's argument about violence, and as 'evidential standing' to heighten the warrantability of the proposition (e.g. White, 2006). Nevertheless, what 'say' flags in a dataset offers an opportunity to focus on textual components that have been strategically decontextualised, such as a Quranic verse as in instance 36 (see Nabulsi, 2011), and re-entered into a new "social circulation" (cf. Hodges, 2015, p. 43) so as to serve the rhetorical function of incitement to 'Jihad'.

Concerning the first person-oriented realisations, 'I say' is the only construction used in this sub-corpus, presenting OBL as a powerful, authoritative voice who controls a discourse. The construction, by juxtaposing 'a religious icon says' structure, also presents OBL as a leader enjoying – in Heritage's (2012) and Morek's (2015) terms – an epistemic status, that is, the status of the knowing person or the expert in religio-political territories of knowledge, as well as an epistemic stance, that is, possessing a degree of certainty of knowledge and

commitment to the ‘truth’ of propositions. By repeatedly using the ‘I say’ construction prior to declarative sentences, OBL enhances his epistemic stance (cf. Morek, 2015, p. 241) as a powerful figure who addresses ingroup audiences by, for example, greetings (see instance 38), and outgroup audiences by, for example, threatening (see instance 39). In other words, a pragmatic function of incorporating this structure is to index the author’s position and authority regarding the propositional information.

(38) *I send my greetings of peace and **say** to you [people of Iraq] that: Today, you are the soldiers of Allah, the arrows of Islam, and the first line of defence of this Ummah.*

(39) *In conclusion, I **say** to the American people: Allah willing, we are continuing fighting you.*

5.3.2.4.2 Speech verbs used by Shekau

Shekau uses ‘say’ on 90 occasions while he uses ‘tell’ in 21 places. ‘Tell’ is used in four structures, ‘I tell’, ‘you tell’, third person (e.g. Allah, Nigerian government) ‘tell’, and ‘who told’. ‘Allah’ and ‘I’ are used as ingroup and powerful actors who give commands and guidance (see instances 40-41), while the voices of ‘you’, ‘they’ and ‘who’ are represented in a negative light (see instance 42). Focusing on the salient use of ‘say’, there are first person-oriented realisations (I/we say), second person-oriented realisations (you say), and third person-oriented realisations (they say).

(40) *Allah has already **told** us and warned us about everything you are going to put us through.*

(41) *This is why as leader of this sect I **tell** you to repent.*

(42) *The government should stop **telling** all these lies.*

In the I/we say construction, Shekau’s marks himself as a powerful deictic centre by two practices. The first is by positioning himself in a challenging standpoint, for example, challenging the Nigerian government through declaring his determination to abduct the Chibok girls (see instance 43), where ‘I’ encodes in the saying, a “commitment to [one’s] organization’s” (cf. D’Aprix, 1988, p. 268, cited in Sherblom, 1990, p. 46) role in a conflict. The second is by presenting himself as a leader who, equivalent to Bush, makes a ‘declaration’ about a change in the status quo (Searle, 1999) and who is up to a political and violent

challenge against ‘outsiders’ (see instance 44). ‘We say’ is also used to construct Shekau’s religious ideology by merging himself in the inclusive ‘we’ and collocating the lemma *God/Allah*, as in instance 45.

(43) *I will hold [girls] and **say** I am the owner.*

(44) *Here is what Bush once said, and we will repeat it here. He said all the fights going on in Iraq and Afghanistan are Christian war, crusade - it is a known issue - and that they will crush Afghanistan; today I will **say** my own. To the people of the world, everybody should know his status, it is either you are with us Mujahedeen or you are with the Christians.*

(45) *That is why we **say** our way is not that of the mortal being, but that of God.*

Second person-oriented realisations are used to portray the addressed opponents negatively, which rhetorically allows for justifying the author’s standpoint. Consider instance 46 where Buhari, a Nigerian President, is negatively represented as a liar. While the ‘I/we say’ structure signposts the terrorist’s voice as powerful and determined, the ‘you say’ structure is used to shift the standpoint towards criticising what is said or done by the victims and thus challenging as well as damaging their symbolic/social power (see instance 47).

(46) *You [Buhari] are lying to the people, collecting their money and **saying** you will free their children and you know you are lying.*

(47) *You [Sultan of Kano, and Jonathon] **say** you are going to catch us? No one is going to catch us.*

In third person-oriented realisations, Shekau tends to incorporate third party’s voice to validate/endorse his acts or to invalidate an opponent’s message. For example, Shekau endorses his acts by incorporating his interpretation of Islamic meanings while referring his interpretation to prophet Mohammad or God as sources of incontrovertible facts/meanings (see instance 48). By contrast, when referring to what outsiders say, Shekau refutes what opponents say, for example, about defeating Boko Haram (see instance 49), initiating disagreement with what ‘others’ say and instead presenting his own saying and clarification; which is a practice linked to enactment of power and discourse control (see also Szczyrbak, 2016, pp. 158-160).

(48) *This is a war against Christians and democracy and their constitution; Allah **says** we should finish them when we get them.*

(49) *My brothers, I would like to clarify one last point. They say on radio and elsewhere that they fought us and defeated us in some areas. That is a lie.*

5.3.2.4.3 Speech verbs used by al-Baghdadi

Despite his repeated use of *state**, al-Baghdadi tends to use *say* (35 times) as the most frequent lemma. This lemma is primarily used with authoritative sources of quoted assertions – a feature shared with OBL. Sources are iconic sayers, namely: Allah, prophet Mohammad, and narrators or interpreters of religious texts. ‘say’ in al-Baghdadi’s dataset signposts components that uncover al-Baghdadi’s ideology of violence and how he perceives the relationship between himself as an ISIS leader and his audiences. For example, in instance 50, al-Baghdadi, who has declared himself as ‘legitimate’ leader of his ‘Islamic State’, signposts a saying by Allah to warn against not obeying al-Baghdadi or his deputies. In instance 51, al-Baghdadi also deploys a saying, triggered by ‘Allah says’, to encourage ISIS fighters to stand fast in jihad and to accept killing ‘adversaries’ and being killed as a Godly test of a man’s ‘true’ belief. In so doing, al-Baghdadi centres his message around his understanding of the interpretation of the word ‘test’ in the Quranic verse (see the double underlined text in instance 51). Al-Baghdadi relies on his “(mis)readings” of signposted religious texts (cf. Baker & Vessey, 2018, p. 274) and bases his argumentation on his interpretation of quoted texts which he takes as incontrovertible facts. Such texts offer cognitive evidence of drivers (e.g. personal mis/readings) behind terrorist acts; which emphasises the value of examining speech verbs and their contexts.

(50) And our Lord forbade us and warned us against differing and becoming divided, saying, “And do not be like the ones who became divided and differed after the clear proofs had come to them. And those will have a great punishment” ...

(51) He [Allah] also says, “And We will surely test you until We make evident those who strive among you and those who are patient, and We will test your affairs”. In his interpretation of this ayah, Imam at-Tabari states, “[Allah says], “We will surely test you,’ O believers, with killing, and with jihad against the enemies of Allah...”.

In al-Baghdadi’s dataset, the repeated use of ‘say’ determines the rhetorical functions of attribution in terrorist threatening communication. This is done by manipulating audiences’ perception of “generally circulated” intertextual meanings (cf. Bazerman, 2003, pp. 86-87) and presenting al-Baghdadi’s assertions as if they are “religious obligations and/or divine

messages” which, by complying with authoritative texts, can “transcend social consciousness and social obligations” (e.g. Schbley, 2006, p. 292). This practice of attribution and explicit, though decontextualised, quoting provides clues for what exact words in terrorist datasets have been utilised to endorse and glorify violence (cf. Holbrook, 2015, p. 60); that is, words flagged by the *say* speech verb. In addition, *say* signposts “manifest intertextuality” components which mark the identity version of the author (cf. Lehman, Sułkowski & Cap, 2019, p. 9; Fairclough, 1992), given that the decontextualised quotes are part of a ‘symbolic’ social system (Bourdieu, 1989, 1991) – that is, Islam. *Say* marks a strategic deployment of Quranic or prophetic sayings that rhetorically function as the ultimate ‘truth’ of ideological perception of self and ‘others’ and the source of actions that need to be followed.

5.3.2.4.4 Speech verbs and Tarrant’s style

Unlike OBL, Shekau and al-Baghdadi, the Tarrant sub-corpus does not show a frequent use of speech verbs. He instead uses two main techniques to incorporate other voices: internet website links such as links to lists of Wikipedia entries that ‘support’ his claims about, for example, events of violence against European women; and incorporating quoted texts of religious and political leaders and inserting the names of sayers (e.g. Pope Urban II, a military and political figure, Sir Oswald Mosley, and a pro-white writer Rudyard Kipling). These voices serve in legitimising what Tarrant perceives as rooted in religious, ethnic and ideological opposition. Reviving these voices adds to Tarrant’s messages the flavour of historically political, military and religious texts, such as the flavour of the first Crusade confrontations by using words of Pope Urban II.

While not using speech verbs frequently, direct quoting/attribution by Tarrant is a resource employed in the context of – in Hardy and Phillips (1999, p. 3) terms – “dialogical struggle” over values in order to help formulate and reinforce perceptions of the social world and to persuade ingroup members to enact violence and radical change. The incorporated voices could lend the call for violence a historical legitimisation. For example, the words of Pope Urban II lend Tarrant’s messages a religious obligation, and forge relationships and consensus, drawing on mutual ideologies about the value of Christianity and preserving the European lands and cities against ‘invaders’. Citing the Pope’s words about restoring Jerusalem invites

Tarrant's ideal audiences to determine their position in response to his words about restoring the European cities, as Tarrant puts it.

(52) *ASK YOURSELF, WHAT WOULD POPE URBAN II DO?*

In sum, the speech word *say* is most frequently used by OBL, Shekau and al-Baghdadi. It is the dominant choice in these three datasets. This supports Baker and Vessey's (2018) finding that the 'say' category could characterise discourse of terrorists from religious ideologies. The frequent deployment of the saying resource to flag authoritative voices aids in building – in Foucauldian terms (see, e.g. Foucault, 1980, p. 131; Lorenzini, 2015) – a "regime of truth", i.e. a divine authority-backed separation between what is taken as 'truth' and what is error, which demands believers in that 'truth' to obey divine messages and take them as religious obligations (Schbley, 2006). Repeated use of *say* (e.g. in 'I say') allows for presenting participants as deictic centres of varied values of veracity or epistemic stance as well as authoritativeness (cf. Szczyrbak, 2016, p. 163). The findings also offer support to earlier research showing that the use of speech verbs can mark attribution patterns in conflict discourse (e.g. Thetela, 2001). *Say* is identified a key attribution feature of the authors from religion-oriented ideologies.

The findings also second Szczyrbak's (2016) contention that *say* is a resource that plays key pragmatic roles in discourse. In the terrorist datasets, 'say' signposts the exercise of power, identity construction, expression of ideological perceptions, and legitimation of violence. 'say' operates to enhance an author's epistemic status which is a "fundamental and unavoidable element in the construction of social action" (Heritage, 2012, p. 1). Flagging quotes by 'say' presents a resource for identifying authors' religious identity; that is, saying provides a clue to the practice of drawing on shared ideologies as a way of talking to audiences, which enables exploration of what kind of audiences the author is targeting and what is the common ground through which an author is reaching their different audiences (cf. Seals, 2012, p. 236) to legitimise violence. In the next section, salient patterns of violent attitudinal meanings and evidence of authors' personal and relational identities are shown.

5.4 Exploring personal and relational identities through patterns of ATTITUDE

This section focuses on patterns of attitudinal meanings of attitudinally-loaded lemmas that occur repeatedly (i.e. more than once) in the dataset. The aim is to showcase how approaching identity as factoring in attitudinal functions can help to understand identity, by acting as a complementary tool for analysing terrorist discourse – as shown in previous work (Etaywe & Zappavigna, 2021). The findings here offer support to previous research showing that particular identities tend to become more salient under conditions of stress, conflict and lack of security (e.g. Suleiman, 2006; Etaywe, 2022b). ‘Aggressive’ and ‘distant’ are the two main identities in all authors’ stances towards outgroups. Authors also demonstrate variation in the extent to which they repeat attitudinal lemmas and commonalities in salience (of ‘counts’) of ATTITUDE types. Al-Baghdadi uses more repeated, attitudinal lemmas than any other author, using 171 lemmas repeatedly (totalling 1012 occurrences). Conversely, OBL tends to use the least number of repeated, attitudinally-loaded lemmas, using 45 lemmas repeatedly (totalling 339 occurrences) – see Table 5.5 for more details. In OBL’s sub-corpus, lemmas frequent between 2 and 41 times (exemplified in Figure 5.5). In Shekau’s sub-corpus, lemmas repeat between 2 and 67 times. In al-Baghdadi’s sub-corpus, lemmas repeat between 2 and 46 times. In Tarrant’s, lemmas repeat between 2 and 35 times. The most frequent lemmas are in the semantic domains of violence (e.g. *death*) and hate (e.g. *replace*). This repetition of attitudinal lemmas marks sub-corpora with a range of attitudinal values and meanings (i.e., functions such as judging actions), emphasising the need to examine:

- Patterns of encoded ATTITUDE across sub-corpora, and the most salient encoded ATTITUDE, that is, salient in terms of frequency of use;
- Sets of sociocultural values on which these lemmas draw;
- Who values what, and ultimately the construed personal and relational identities.

Table 5.5: Overview of examined attitudinally-loaded lemmas, and occurrences

	OBL	Shekau	Al-Baghdadi	Tarrant	Total
Number of lemmas	45	98	171	73	387
Occurrences	339	774	1012	677	2802

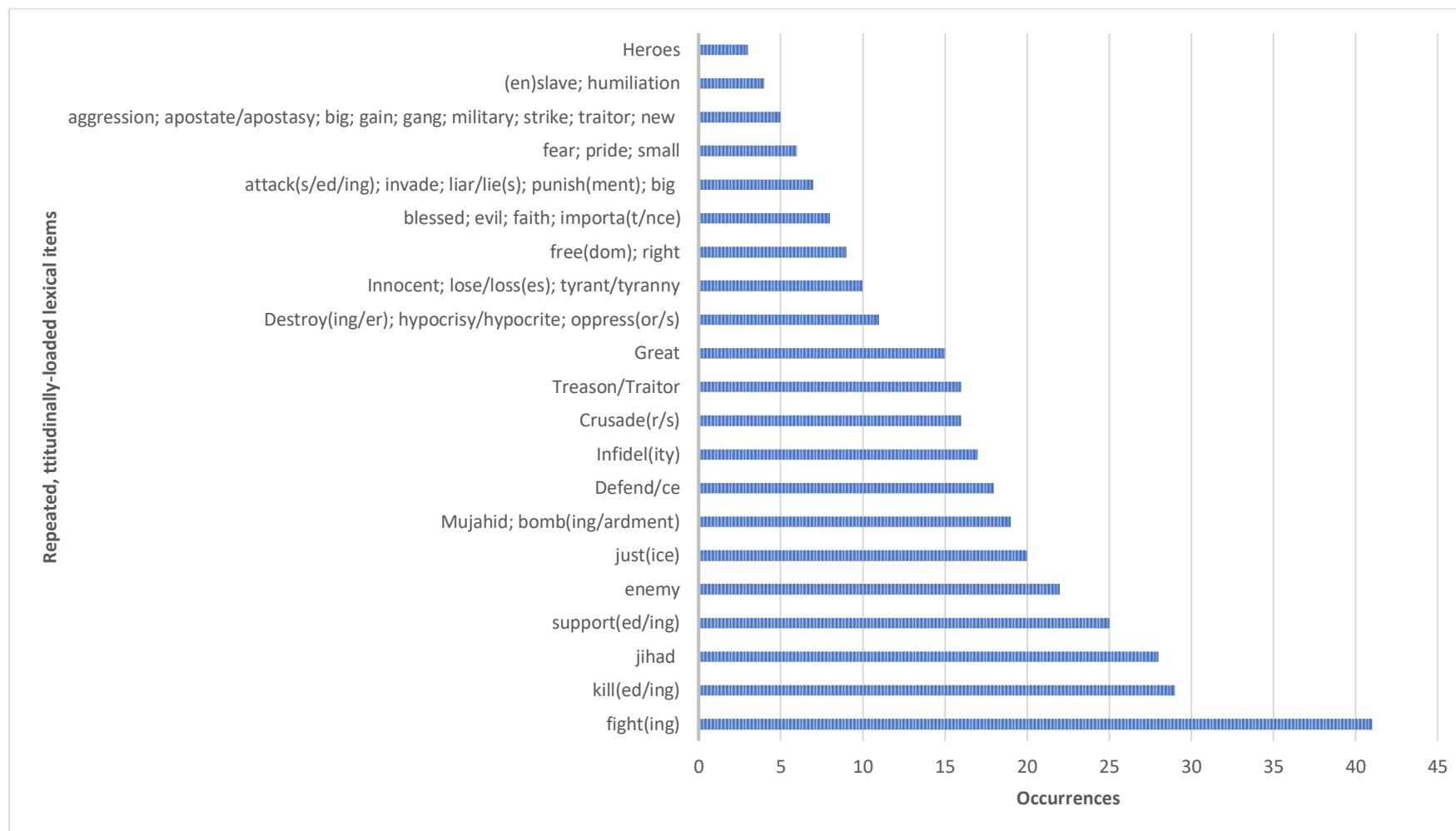


Figure 5.5: Example of groups of repeated, attitudinally loaded lexical items as identified in OBL's sub-corpus

A summary of encoded attitudinal features, in terms of their type categories and subcategories, polarity and explicitness, is displayed in Table 5.6. (Note: most used feature indicated in bold). This is followed by a descriptive summary of total choices of ATTITUDE types and their interpretation.

Table 5.6: Summary of repeated, attitudinally loaded lexical items across sub-corpora

Authors	Category	%	Polarity (+/-)	%	Explicitness (S/V)	%
OBL	J	82.23	-	77.77	S	95.55
	Ap	13.33	+	22.23	V	4.45
	Af	4.44				
Shekau	J	64.00	-	69.40	S	78.60
	Ap	23.00	+	30.60	V	21.40
	Af	13.00				
Al-Baghdadi	J	66.70	-	58.48	S	68.42
	Ap	13.40	+	41.52	V	31.58
	Af	19.90				
Tarrant	J	57.53	-	68.49	S	73.97
	Ap	38.35	+	31.51	V	26.03
	Af	4.12				

Analysis shows that all authors are very interpersonally involved in their communication. The general tendency of repeated attitudinal lexicons is of negative polarity, inscribed ATTITUDE, and JUDGEMENT type of attitudinal meaning. JUDGEMENT type is, thus, identified as the most salient type. That is, the majority of repeated, attitudinally loaded lexical items are negative and judgmental. By contrast, the category of AFFECT type is identified as the least used in the corpus. Noticeably, OBL displays more use of explicit and negative choice of lexis than any other author. APPRECIATION is more used by Tarrant, followed by Shekau. All authors favour JUDGEMENT, that is, assessing people in terms of their conformity to an author's desirable behaviour (ideological, religious and ethnic) standards. Given the salience of the choice of JUDGEMENT type, this warrants further investigation as salient encoded ATTITUDE (see Subsections 5.4.2 and 5.4.3).

The increased frequency of JUDGEMENT contributes to constructing the “aloof, cool verbal style” of authors, which is linked to their controlling behaviour (see Weintraub, 2003, p. 145). Increased JUDGEMENT and decreased AFFECT indicate having datasets with a less affective mode of violence (see Meloy, 2001, p. 1212) and more antipathy towards the outgroup’s social actors, distancing authors from emotional or sympathetic connections and strengthening their overall appearance of ideological determination (see Gales, 2010, p. 249). The repeated use of violent judgmental words can be thought of as being indicative of “predatory violence” that is ideologically motivated to gratify desire for power, territorial dominance/control and revenge (see Meloy, 2001, p. 1212; Meloy et al., 2004, p. 1088). That said, before delving into JUDGEMENT, it is worth providing a general description and interpretation for choices of APPRECIATION and AFFECT. This is because APPRECIATION is identified as being used far more than AFFECT in Tarrant’s and Shekau’s sub-corpora, while in al-Baghdadi’s sub-corpus affectual choices are more than appreciative choices, warranting highlighting the discursive function of this use.

5.4.1 AFFECT and APPRECIATION in the dataset: Encouraging and justifying violence

The authors deploy repeatedly a set of lemmas that encoded AFFECT and APPRECIATION in order to rhetorically encourage and justify aggression. While OBL couples positive AFFECT with *mujahidin* as a source of positive emotion (e.g. *pride*) to endorse their jihad, he couples negative AFFECT with the American troops (e.g. *fear*, an instance of INSECURITY) to belittle their power (see instance 53). OBL also uses lemmas of the negative APPRECIATION type to evaluate opponents’ (e.g. *crusade*) and the ingroup’s phenomena such as the Muslim ummah’s wealth and Iraqi oil that are targeted by the opponents (e.g. *cold booty*). Put differently, OBL’s deployment of AFFECT and APPRECIATION serves in encouraging followers and constructing the outgroup as a threat.

*(53) Third, it has become clear to us [...] that, in combat, the enemy mainly depends on psychological warfare [...]and] on the intense air strikes so as to conceal their most prominent weakness points, which are **fear**, cowardice...*

Al-Baghdadi deploys lemmas of APPRECIATION, chiefly of the IN/VALUATION type, to colour the ingroup’s things as worthwhile and the outgroups’ as negatively appreciated, for example: *deed* of the ‘mujahidin’ is coupled with *noble/nobility*; the reward of engagement against

'adversaries', alternatively, *the enemy of Allah*, is positively appreciated (e.g. *great*); and provinces (*Wilayat* and *lands*) taken over by ISIS are coupled with *blessed*. Conversely, 'adversaries' are coupled with *falsehood*, Arab rulers allied with *the Romans* and *the Jews* with *dogs* (consider instance 54), and the *Rafida* (Iran and its followers) are coupled with *filthy*, thus dehumanising and devaluing 'others'. This use of APPRECIATION accomplishes a rhetoric function, that is, providing a warrant for violence by making adversaries appear less than human (cf. Cotler & Grossman, 2009, pp. 24-25).

(54) *O ahl al-sunna in Jordan [...] Where are the men of power? so that they can make the puppet of the Romans and **dog** of the Jews understand who the sons of Islam are, and who the mujahideen are...*

Besides APPRECIATION, al-Baghdadi uses repeated affectual lemmas. These are dominantly of the IN/HAPPINESS category (e.g. *condole*, *congratulate*, *sorrow*, *rejoice*, *distress*, and *pleased*), followed by lemmas encoding the IN/SECURITY type (e.g. *tribulation*, *relief*, *loss*, and *horrors*) and the INCLINATION type (e.g. *desire*, *ambition*, and *hopes*). Such instances present opponents as a threat and with *ambition* to take over the ingroup's physical and ideological territories (see instance 55), while *distress* and *condole* couple with the ingroup's ideations to present them as undergoing the influence of others' illegitimate ambitions. The ingroup's addressees are encouraged to prove themselves to be *jealous* for their religion by fighting to defend it.

(55) *Crusader Europe has not ceased in their **ambition** to attack the cradle of the Khilafa and fortress of Islam in Iraq and Sham...*

Deploying more affectual ATTITUDE in his repeated lemmas than OBL and Tarrant, Shekau chiefly uses the IN/SECURITY subcategory (e.g. *fear*, *mercy*, *assure*, *release*, *free*, *safe*, and *peace*) to describe social groups' security circumstances. Positive AFFECT is coupled with Allah and Boko Haram's supporters. Shekau, however, constructs himself as a person with, for example, no *mercy* and no *love* towards intended victims. In instance 56, his language presents himself to victims with more antipathy, emotional distance and ideological determination to cause harm to outgroup members.

(56) *God has not said we should **love** such a person.*

Shekau uses APPRECIATION-loaded lemmas repeatedly in the form of insults or swear words that are organised around certain lexical fields such as animals. Shekau couples adversaries with

negative VALUATION by likening them, for example, to *sheep, spider, dogs, pigs* and *rats* (see instances 57-58). This kind of “identity attacks” (Culpeper, Iganski & Sweiry, 2017, p. 22) regarding aspects of personal identity reveals an ideological reworking of feelings towards others into propositions about the value of others (cf. Martin & White, 2005, p. 45). These are examples of dehumanising groups in order to provide a warrant for violence against them (cf. Cotler & Grossman, 2009). By contrast, positive APPRECIATION couples with an author’s group’s things (e.g. path, sharia, Allah, book, worship, creed, prophet) as realised in lemmas such as *holy, good, great, proper* and *right*. This ‘Us’ versus ‘Them’ APPRECIATION distinction has a rhetorical effect of demonising victims and their things, as realised in lemmas such as *paganism, bastards, danger* and *fake*, which targets aspects of others’ master identity (e.g. religious aspects such as being *infidel*; and political aspects such as a social group’s *constitution*) as a way to denigrate victims and provide exclusion/inclusion on political and religious grounds (cf. Cotler & Grossman, 2009; Leets & Giles, 1997; Mateo & Yus, 2013, p. 89). This APPRECIATION-based coupling functions as a mechanism for releasing “doses of aggressiveness” (Mateo & Yus, 2013, p. 91) and heightened doses of identity attacks, evidencing the author’s intentions towards others.

(57) *Any infidel is a **sheep** to be sold.*

(58) *The information I have for you today concerns the attack [on] the [...] barracks of the **pigs** [...] **dogs** [...] or the barracks of the **rats**!*

Tarrant uses AFFECT less frequently in repeated lexicons, with a focus on the IN/SECURITY subcategory as realised in *fear* coupled with, for example, inaction towards non-Europeans – see instance 59. This use enhances the incitement function of Tarrant’s dataset and the mobilising towards violence.

(59) *The only thing you will have left to **fear** is inaction.*

Unlike other authors, Tarrant demonstrates more deployment of repeated APPRECIATION-lemmas preferencing the IN/VALUATION sub-category. IN/VALUATION lemmas couple with threatened or incited-against targets by, for example: likening them as *vipers* and *scum*, which rhetorically serves in legitimizing violence against de-humanised ‘others’; coupling others’ phenomena such as ‘labour’ with negative value such as *cheap*; coupling social phenomena such as being an *egalitarian* community, a *minority*, the *black*, *multicultural*,

immigrant/immigration, and policies focused on the *individual*, with negative values. This use devalues others and related social phenomena to serve in justifying violence against them, as in instance 60. The increased frequency of repeated instances of APPRECIATION reveals that Tarrant is concerned with the value of things from his ideological perspective. Notably, the terrorist threatening genre here has played a role in “the re-semanticization of words” (Gales, 2010, p. 63), i.e. in terms of their polarity. For example, *minority*, *immigrants* and *diversity*, which are largely neutral lexical items across discourses, have witnessed a shift into negative meaning in Tarrant’s messages – consider instance 61 which exemplifies how repeated use of, for example, the immigrants/immigration lemma serves in constructing a membership category, to rhetorically establish “category-bound features” from which an ingroup’s audiences can infer negative values that are textually associated with this category and align with the opposite categories (cf. Antaki & Widdicombe, 1998, pp. 3-4).

60. *When you discover a nest of **vipers** in your yard, do you spare the adolescents? [...] No. You burn the nest and kill the **vipers**, no matter their age.*

61. *Mass **immigration** will disenfranchise us...*

So far, rhetorical functions of the deployment of lemmas of the AFFECT and APPRECIATION types have been emphasised. Functions include presenting ‘others’ as a source of negative emotions and threat, and dehumanising others by attacking particular aspects of personal and master identities. Analysis of APPRECIATION lemmas (e.g. *dogs*), or alternatively swear/profanity words, has emphasised the importance of considering the context of these words to better account for their functions in threatening communication (cf. Kniffka, 2007). The following subsection focuses on JUDGEMENT as the salient ATTITUDE type that colours the entire corpus, constructs terrorists’ personal and relational identities, and serves in legitimating violence.

5.4.2 The authors’ personal and relational identities: Encoded JUDGEMENT as evidence

The repeated JUDGEMENT lemmas in the datasets accord with four social value-categories proposed by Smith (2004) as being characteristic of a terrorist group’s rhetoric. These categories are summarised in Table 5.7:

Table 5.7: Social value categories characterising JUDGEMENT lemmas in the dataset

Social value category	Examples from the dataset
Dominance and aggression: values which colour the datasets with participants valuing fighting, punishing, retaliating, and victory.	These values are clearly realised in all sub-corpora. OBL's include instances such as <i>kill, tyrant/tyranny, oppressor, defence, strike, aggression, invade, punish, attack</i> and <i>destroy</i> . Shekau's uses, for example, <i>catch, take, end, attack, strength, arrest, burn, defeat, destroy, enemy, finish, and chase</i> . Al-Baghdadi's includes <i>fight, war, revenge, destroy, and sacrifice</i> . Tarrant's includes LIs such as <i>radicalise, destroy, control, lose, remove, replace, defeat, deport, assault, survive, and sovereignty</i> .
Morality and truthfulness: values which colour the datasets with participants valuing doing the right or wrong thing and valuing truth-speaking and acting.	OBL's sub-corpus uses words such as <i>steadfast, hero, liar, gang, traitor, faithful, and hypocrite</i> . Shekau's includes lemmas such as <i>liar, deceive, pledge, betray, patient, loyal, and cheat</i> . Al-Baghdadi's uses LIs such as <i>preserve, aid, truthful, criminal, treachery, and righteousness</i> . Tarrant's includes <i>traitor, rape, pedophile, (drug) addict, greed, and suicidal</i> .
Justice and tolerance: values which colour the datasets with participants valuing, for example, equality, fairness, people's rights, diversity and absence of hostility.	OBL's sub-corpus uses words such as <i>free, (en)slave, tyrant, innocent, and unjust/injustice*</i> . Shekau's uses <i>innocent, and (to) force</i> . Al-Baghdadi uses <i>tyranny, evil, forgiveness, prison, captivity, justice, and right to security</i> . Tarrant utilises <i>anti/against, diversity, hate*, and equality</i> .
Culture and religion: values which colour the datasets with participants valuing particular religious beliefs and practices as well as the group's traditions.	OBL's sub-corpus uses lemmas such as <i>jiḥād, apostacy/apostate, and infidel*</i> . Shekau's includes, for example, <i>faithful, submit to Allah, and convert from a religion</i> . Al-Baghdadi's deploys <i>faith/iman, shirk/mushrik, murtad/apostacy/apostate, hypocrisy, kafir/ kufr, infidel*, rafidi</i> (Iran and its Shiite allies), <i>nusairi</i> (the Assad regime), and <i>majusi</i> (Iran, the Zoroastrians). Analysis of Tarrant's sub-corpus, however, does not show any repeatedly used JUDGEMENT lemmas that belong to this value category, emphasising the insignificance of these values for the far-rightist author.

This categorisation indicates a shared tendency among the four authors in terms of basing their choice of JUDGEMENT-lexicons along distinct parameters of value. This finding supports Thetela's (2001) contention that a pattern in value-based lexical selection can rhetorically characterise the ideological perception-semantics in a dataset. This lexical selection also serves as an indicator of rival identities/values and ideologically opposing poles in discourse, and signals authors' ideological perceptions. The repeated JUDGEMENT lemmas also offer support to earlier research findings (e.g. Smith, 2004) that lexical choices in terrorist groups'

statements are more likely to be centred around socio-cultural values of aggression, morality, justice, and culture and religion.

A close examination of JUDGEMENT lemmas reveals that some lexicons in the ‘culture and religion’ category such as *jihad* and *mujahid* – which are praised values in the Islamic moral order, when justified, legitimate, and aimed at restoring justice and thus doing what is ‘right’ (Afsaruddin, 2020) – can be simultaneously categorised as a ‘dominance’ value in terms of restoring sovereignty over one’s lands, as well as under ‘morality’ and ‘justice’ categories. Likewise, lemmas in the ‘justice and tolerance’ category such as *tyranny* and *enslave* can be simultaneously labelled as ‘dominance and aggression’, and ‘morality’ categories, respectively. This overlap contributes to presenting the ‘dominance and aggression’ and ‘morality and truthfulness’ categories as the two salient features of the semantic domains and values of the repeated, attitudinal lexis. Nevertheless, this overlap requires more nuanced analysis of the words’ co-text – i.e. in concordance lines; see Figure 5.6 which shows an example of concordance lines of the *infidel** lemma as identified in Shekau’s dataset – and exploration of what JUDGEMENT lemmas of an ingroup’s and outgroup’s actions reveal about inter-group conflicts. An important aspect of this investigation is to identify who is represented as valuing which values. Such representation is a rhetorical technique that is strategically used by terrorists to positively or negatively appraise social actors and to justify actional and relational ATTITUDES. The representation of self and others constructs and uncovers: authors’ relational (e.g. being morally distant) and personal (e.g. aggressive and hostile) identities; and the purpose as well as the ideological/cultural reasoning of the terrorist groups’ existence and acts. The representation gives valid grounds for investigators to suspect terrorist violence (Smith, 2004, p. 431) and to “mark off socially and ideologically distinct areas of experience” of the author (Fowler, 1991, p. 84).

e killed for following democracy, all of them are infidels. I will tell Muslims what Allah wants them to
 privilege and temerity above all people. If we meet infidels, if we meet those that become infidels according
 to the killing and slaughtering them, if you meet infidels in battlefield brethren, just harvest their necks
 followers do the work in Maiduguri. We killed the infidels in the Giwa barracks. Here are people who, surpris
 yours, should we not do Allah's own? Any infidel is a sheep to be sold, Jonathan, if I
 went there and God helped us to chase the infidels. It is not our doing; but God's. We
 are alone, take your weapons and slaughter the infidels: Jonathan, Obama, and the others. Come! We are wa
 until the time that you will get majority over infidels of the world. And you will get it, Allah
 on my mother Aisha and wife of Prophet. You infidels of the world, you have met a trouble, we
 tes are infidels! Whoever follows democracy is an infidel! People in Saudi Arabia do not follow Islam. They
 Allah on the need for us to break down infidels, practitioners of democracy, and constitutionalis
 e of Germany like Margret Thatcher. Ndume are all infidels. Saminu Turaki said he is representing mediation,
 are infidels! Whoever follows the Qadiriyya is an infidel! Shiites are infidels! Whoever follows democracy
 and you go to western schools, you are an infidel. So, your fasting and prayers are waste of time.
 Maiduguri, where God has assisted us to chase the infidel soldiers and gave us victory over them. The soldi
 and repent and come to worship because. Like the infidel soldiers are not sparing your lives so shall we
 , it is permitted to take the wife of an infidel. Soon, we are going to take those women and
 am is my brother. Stupid Jonathan, no matter your infidel status you will be surprise. Until the land is
 ; they are believers who belong to a tariqa are infidels. The Tijani are infidels! Whoever follows the Qad
 from the Koran and the Sunnah. The Izala are infidels; they are believers who belong to a tariqa are
 , let us slaughter and kill! The Prophet cut the infidels' throats and killed them. His companions did too,
 say it. Whoever seeks praise is a liar, an infidel. We are going to kill them; we are going
 is a message to Muslims to wage war against infidels who are not doing what Allah said. Those who
 follows the Qadiriyya is an infidel! Shiites are infidels! Whoever follows democracy is an infidel! People
 belong to a tariqa are infidels. The Tijani are infidels! Whoever follows the Qadiriyya is an infidel! Shi

Figure 5.6: Example of concordance lines of *infidel lemma**

Given that the analysed datasets are predominantly of judgmental ATTITUDE, I describe them as being normative JUDGEMENT-based texts, i.e. they comprise evaluations that derive from particular social standards on good behaviour (cf. Thetela, 2001; Verschueren, 2012). In these datasets, authors draw a distinction line between participants based on whether their actions are (un)acceptable or (un)necessary according to the underpinning value system of each author – a similar finding to the one Gales (2011, pp. 33-34) identified in the texts of the terrorist group Army of God. Table 5.8 shows a short version of repeated lemmas of JUDGEMENT, corresponding JUDGEMENT subcategories and participants' ATs (i.e. attitudinal targets) underlying this pattern of distinction, and their personal and relational identities, as identified in the concordance lines of OBL's dataset. More extended versions of the four authors' repeated lemmas of JUDGEMENT underlying personal and relational identities, in the texts of the four terrorists, are provided in Appendixes A.1, A.2, A.3 and A.4.

Table 5.8: Frequent expressions of JUDGEMENT underlying personal and relational identity

Attitudinal lexis	JUDGEMENT	Attitudinal target
Fight	- P (pos)*	- act performed by the author's group
	- p	- act performed by the US troops
Kill	- P (pos)	- act performed by the author's group
	- P	- act performed by the US and US allies
Jihad	+ P	- act performed by the author's group
Support	+ P	- act by whoever on the side of (i.e. with) America; act by whoever on the side of 'infidel' parties; act by the US towards Israel - act by the author's group
Infidel(ity)	- P	- heads of Islamic states; parties such as the Arab Socialist Ba'th and Socialists in Baghdad or Aden; non-Muslim camp fighting against Muslims; everyone who cooperates with the United States or its allies - act of war waged by America and its allies; forces of the new Jewish Crusade
Crusade(r)	- P	- the US forces and their allies - the war by the US - Bush the senior; Bush the junior
Traitor(ous)	- P	- act of Prince Abdullah bin Abdelaziz (of Saudi Arabia) - Iraq and Arab governments - the toppled and new president of Iraq - all Arab governments - any government in the region formed by the United States - Arab rulers
Destroy	- P (pos)	- act performed by al-Qaeda
	- P	- act performed by Israel supported by the US - act performed by the US
Hypocrisy/hypocrite	- P	- US led-forces - rulers of Arab countries
Oppress(or)	- P	- Americans - Arab rulers
Innocent	+ N	- women and children affected

* '(pos)' indicates lemmas that encode acts and concepts that are valued, justified and positive in the eyes of the author; however, these lexicons are of negative 'attitudinal inscription'; i.e. in White's (2006) terms, they carry a negative attitudinal value that is largely fixed and stable across a wide range of contexts.

This judgmental burstiness of repeated attitudinal lemmas shows a pattern, in the four authors' datasets, of codification of attitudinal stances and actions in social sanction and

social esteem values. The dominating inscribed negative JUDGEMENT of ‘Our’ and ‘Their’ ATs serves in setting the threatening tone of the datasets as explicit, ethics-based confrontational datasets that seek to affirm inter-group dis-alignment and contested values and ethicality. The increased use of the IMPROPRIETY type has coloured the picture of the datasets with a high degree of improper behaviours and violent attitudes/intentions. The patternings of personal and relational identities towards victims are construed in terms of (un)ethicality; i.e. in terms of what complies with or defies an author’s view of the social system and social necessity. Positive/negative positioning of participants, as well as construing related identities, is achieved by endowing social actors with semantic roles (see, e.g. Sykes, 1988; van Leeuwen, 1996; White, 2006) and basing evaluative language on an author’s value system.

Patterning of representation of ‘Our’ versus ‘Their’ actions serves the goal of presenting menacing ‘others’ – in Ochs and Taylor’s (1995 cited in Bucholtz & Hall, 2005, p. 596) terms – as ‘problematisers’ and ‘Us’ as ‘problematisees’. This pattern serves in othering problematisers, and provides moral reasoning for violent responses underpinned by the meta-value of ‘care’ for ‘harm’ imposed on ‘Our’ group; thus presenting the author as close with and caring towards an ingroup’s problematisee and distant from problematisers. For example, in instance 62, outgroup ATs (underlined), as agents of negatives processes *fight*, *kill* and *invade* (in bold), are judged for their IMPROPRIETY.

(62)

a. They [Bush and his supporters] came out to **fight** Islam under the falsifying name of ‘fighting terrorism’. (OBL)

b. ...the Government that is **fighting** Islam with the Christian Association of Nigeria who are **killing** Muslims... (Shekau)

c. They raid your lands under the pretext of waging war against the Islamic State, then they do not depart until they have either **killed** your men and taken your women and children prisoner or until they have driven them out. (al-Baghdadi)

d. This Pakistani Muslim invader [Sadiq Khan] now sits as representative for the people of London. (Tarrant)

This patterning serves in indicating authors’ feelings of victimisation and their hostile intentions to victimise others. This patterning rhetorically builds the authors as being in antagonism with outsiders (e.g. ‘crusaders’ and their allies, in OBL, al-Baghdadi and Shekau’s

datasets, and the ‘anti-white’ in Tarrant’s), and serves in legitimising consequent aggression as acceptable acts. That said, while othering the menacing participants, the authors also couple themselves with acts of *fighting*, *killing* and so on, implying that they endow both sides with the IMPROPRIETY value. However, the authors draw a line of distinction between ‘our’ *fight/killing* and ‘their’ *fight/killing/invasion* based on a cultural group-specific value system: through this value lens, ‘they’ are considered the ‘legitimate enemy’ and ‘we’ are constructed as doing the ‘right’ thing. For example, in al-Baghdadi’s and OBL’s texts, ‘They’ fight for the cause of Taghut, Kufr and the oppressor while ‘We’ fight for the cause of Allah, faith and the oppressed. This attitude, seen in instance 63, is contradictory to many ‘our’ versus ‘their’ situations in which the defined opposing groups are separated by a positive versus negative asymmetry (see, e.g. Reynolds, Turner & Haslam, 2000).

(63)

- a. We incite our brothers to **fight** you [the Americans]. (OBL)
- b. We **killed** the infidels in the Giwa barracks. (Shekau)
- c. **KILL** ANGELA MERKEL, **KILL** ERDOGAN, **KILL** SADIQ KHAN. (Tarrant)

In such instances, aggression is also founded on the contrast between the perceived negative aspects of the opponents’ personal and master identities and the claimed positive aspects of the author’s master identity (see, e.g. Cotler & Grossman, 2009; Musolff, 2015). In this sense, attitudinal stances are viewed as acts of personal and relational identity. With instances 62 and 63 in mind, the line of distinction here is facilitated by presenting ‘our’ fight as being ethical and desirable – targeting transgressive Americans (a), infidels (b), and the anti-white (c) – while ‘their’ fight is condemned as unethical, presenting violence within the framework of an inter-group ethical struggle wherein ‘others’ value aggression, and with adversarial ideologies encroaching on ‘our’ ideological and physical territories (see Cap, 2017, pp. 16-17). This technique provides a moral reasoning for ‘our’ aggression, based on the meta-value of ‘care’ for ‘harm’ imposed upon ‘Us’ and concerns about ‘Our’ suffering.

This patterning of ‘Our’ versus ‘Their’ acts is consistent in concordance lines of lemmas such as *fight*, *kill*, *destroy*, *attack*, *hurt*, *war*, *remove*, *defeat*, *die* and *deport* in the OBL, Shekau, al-Baghdadi and Tarrant datasets (see Appendixes A.1, A.2, A.3 and A.4). In OBL, for example, ‘we’ are constructed as being in aggression with: demonised and dehumanised ‘others’ who

are described as *allies of Satan*, *crusaders* and *disbelievers* and thus are out of ‘our’ circle of religious belief; and people from outside ‘our’ ethnonationalist identity (e.g. *the Romans*, and *the Americans*). Apparently, OBL’s construed distant relational identity goes hand in hand with categorising people and according to their aspects of personal and master identities. Similarly, Shekau construes his aggressive identity – alternatively, actional attitude – to target, for example, Nigerian officials and security forces as well as Christians who possess different master (political and religious) identities. Al-Baghdadi constructs his aggressive identity against those targeting ahl al-Sunna (i.e. on a religious basis) such as the Saudi monarchy, Iran-backed militia against Sunnis in Syria and Iraq, and ‘crusade’ coalition against ISIS. Tarrant, as well, urges to violent acts against religiously or ethnically different or menacing targets such as mosques, the anti-white CEOs, the anti-white officials, the Turks, immigrants and their children, and drug dealers.

Despite coupling IMPROPRIETY with ‘Our’ group, ‘Our’ acts are contextualised as violent actions that are in response to what ‘others’ have done or are doing to ‘Us’, thus presenting ‘our’ acts as morally backed. The dichotomous representation of actions, for example, ‘we-they’ kill and whom the victim is, emphasizes – in du Bois’ (2007, p. 140) terms – the dialogism and thus subjectivity in texts. For example, OBL justifies the destruction in instance 64 by presenting it as a punishment for what the Americans were doing in Lebanon and other Muslim countries, presenting ‘loyalty’ to wider sociocultural group and concerns about harm inflicted upon the group as reasoning for the IMPROPRIETY values and construed aggressive identity. Aggressive distant identity construction is also facilitated by judgmental burstiness at the utterance level, as in instance 65 where Tarrant deploys multiple instances of JUDGEMENT (e.g. *control*) to rhetorically facilitate constructing others’ threat to ‘Our’ ‘authority’ and hierarchy in inter-group relationships. This construction serves in justifying Tarrant’s aggression and controlling behaviour and commands (in, e.g. instance 66) as being backed by his loyalty and concern about maintaining the authority of his social group.

(64) *[I]t triggered in my mind that we should **punish** the **oppressor** in kind, and should **destroy** towers in America so that they taste some of what we tasted, and they refrain from **killing** our women and children.*

(65) *Democracy is mob rule and the mob itself is ruled by our own enemies. The global and corporate ran press **controls** them, the education system (long since fallen to the long march through the institutions committed by the Marxists) **controls** them, the*

*state (long since heavily lost to its corporate backers) **controls** them and the anti-white media machine **controls** them.*

(66) *Destabilise, then take **control**.*

A main patterning is the use of lemmas of positive attitudinal inscription to describe ‘Our’ and ‘Their’ actions, as realised in, for example, *defend*, *support*, *loyal*, and *protect*. While there is a causal link between, for example, ‘defend’/‘defence’ for both ‘our’ and ‘their’ ATs, ‘their’ defence is framed negatively through a distinction facilitated by the broad categorisation of ideations (ATs). In other words, ‘their’ ATs “facilitate positioning by acting as loci of moral valuations that may translate to moral expectations, and these expectations in turn afford [negative] interpretations of social actions associated with [‘their’] categories, inducing further evaluations” (Tann, 2010, p. 175). Based on this understanding, these lemmas are found to be constructing opposing sides of ‘our’ versus ‘their’ ATs. Examining collocates, ‘defend’ in OBL’s dataset, for example, is found to be constructing ‘us’ as follows: ‘we’ defend *vulnerable sons, brothers, and sisters in Palestine and in many Islamic countries*, and ‘our’ sanctities. Conversely, the Americans are represented as *lacking a fair cause to defend*.

The same line of distinction applies to remaining similar lemmas. For example, OBL, in use of *support*, mentions that: ‘they’ support one another *to kill Muslims*; they support the *butcher against the victim and the aggressor against the innocent child*; but ‘we’ support the oppressed, *the Mujahidin*, and so on. Similar patterning, of ‘our’ *support* to pro-white politicians and “brother [European] nations” moving towards radical change and taking cities back from non-Europeans, is identified in Tarrant’s messages. Shekau, as well, constructs Boko Haram as a group of people who *defend* themselves, God and what Allah said, whereas the remaining Nigerians *defend* their country of an ‘illegitimate’ political and educational system. Shekau also presents that, while Boko Haram is *loyal* to Allah, Nigerians are *loyal* to Nigeria – in a rivalry political situation, see instance 67. Al-Baghdadi also construes his supportive identity towards the ingroup as realised in *support* concordance lines: while non-ISIS-affiliated Muslims are depicted as supporting and protecting *the taghut and nationalism* and America is supporting *atheist Kurds, taghut and nusayriyya*, ISIS is constructed as supportive of ‘the oppressed in the prisons of the *Safawiyyin* and *murtadeen*, *the religion, Khilafah*, and *their brothers in religion*’ – see instances 68-69. For al-Baghdadi, ‘others’ are

protectors of the Cross and murderers of ahl al-sunna in bilad al-Sham, thus a source of aggression and injustice to the ingroup.

*(67) Our second message is to attack anyone who pledge to Nigerian [as] his country, to be faithful, **loyal** and honest, and serve Nigeria. (Shekau)*

*(68) ...the factions of apostasy surrendered the territories of ahl al-sunna and became a means of **support** for the Crusaders and the Nusayriyya in uniting their efforts to wage war against the Khilafa State in Iraq and Syria. (al-Baghdadi)*

*(69) O Ahl as-Sunna! After Allah, you have nothing but the Islamic State to **protect** your religion...*

To conclude this point, the analysis shows that despite the typically positive meaning of lemmas such as *defend* and *support*, the polarity of its attitudinal value tends to change according to the social actors who are being defended and supported, i.e. those in the “beneficialised” role (van Leeuwen, 1996, p. 43). This basis of distinction rhetorically serves in constructing the four terrorists as close with and caring towards the ingroup’s members. However, when the same act is used in relation to others’ acts, the cause and moral motive is questioned by the author, making ‘our’ acts of defence ethically grounded, acceptable and reasonable, unlike ‘their’ acts, which thus justifies authors’ antagonistic identity towards ‘others’.

This antagonist/protagonist identity is also enhanced in religious ideology-oriented terrorists’ datasets by presenting ‘self’ as defenders of ingroup values in upholding *jihad* as a ‘permitted’ means of resisting evil and defending the state/ummah (cf. Wignell, Tan & O’Halloran, 2017). Besides attitudinal lemmas that serves presenting the authors as in an “activated” role (van Leeuwen, 1996, p. 43) and on the side of the ingroup’s ‘beneficialised’ actors, the authors, as beneficialisers, deploy the lemma *jihad* as an ideology constituent that generates from the ‘actional’ models of the ingroup’s ideology to sustain the ummah’s “relationships of both power and solidarity” and the desired social order (Hodge & Kress, 1988, p. 3). As such, the aggression value loaded in *jihad* is backgrounded in relation to the significance of the cause of jihad as part of “perceived religious obligations and/or divine messages [that] transcend social consciousness and social obligations” (Schbley, 2006, p. 292) – see instance 70. The representation of jihad as a value offers a “juxtaposition to the positive/negative alignment of social actors” (Gales, 2011, p. 36); and this positive alignment is obviously pursued in words

that positively collocate with *jihad* and *mujahid* such as **courageous** *mujahidin*, **faithful** *mujahidin*, and **blessed** *jihad*, or when *jihad* is contextualised morally, i.e. to punish *oppressors* and *aggressors* (see instance 64 above).

(70) Hence, **Jihad** must continue until the rise of an Islamic government which rules by Allah's religion. (OBL)

The analysis also reveals a pattern of depicting rulers and officials of Muslim countries as morally aligned with outsiders (e.g. America) and thus also morally distant, through using the same lemmas for, for example, America and the rulers. This is well shown in the lines of lemmas *hypocrite*, *infidel*, *oppressor*, *tyrant*, *unjust*, *enslaving*, *lying* and *apostate* in Appendixes A.1, A.2 and A.3 – see, for example, the use of *tyrant* in instance 71 by al-Baghdadi.

(71) ...the **tyranny** and **disbelief** of the state of Al-Salul [Saudi monarchy] – may Allah disfigure them – is no longer hidden from anyone, even your children.

These attitudinal lemmas coupling negative JUDGEMENT with officials' and rulers' actions serve as – in Cotler and Grossman's (2009) and Leets and Giles' (1997) terms – a rhetorical mechanism for delegitimisation and defamation, whereby social actors' personal aspect identities, which are associated with their interactional identities, as rulers are attacked. Labelling rulers as, for example, tyrants is an attack on their values of justice; while using *infidelity/disbelief* is also an attack on a master/religious identity aspect. These IMPROPRIETY-based "face attacks" on rulers implicate "an absence of a desirable identity [and] the presence of a disvalued one" (cf. Tracy, 2008, p. 176), which serves in legitimising violence and mobilising followers against 'others'. To justify aggression, Shekau also uses, for example, *infidel* repeatedly to couple IMPROPRIETY with non-Muslims worldwide, Muslims under the Nigerian constitution or accepting democracy and 'western' schools, and the military (in, e.g. Giwa barracks), thus demonising and othering them.

This patterning of deliberate attack on aspects of master identities of people, as a victimising, delegitimising and othering technique, is more prominent in the al-Baghdadi dataset. The pattern of attacking people's religious identity is driven by a worldview of the division of the world into 'Us' versus 'Them', based on his (re)definition and (mis)reading of religious register terms which he deploys to license aggression (see also Brookes & McEnery, 2020; Wignell,

Tan & O'Halloran, 2017). Religious attitudinally-loaded terms reinforce the positive/negative positioning and representation of social actors based on the inclusionary/exclusionary categorisation that these religious technical terms realise. For example, lemmas in bold (in instances 72-73) are not only endowed with activated roles, “passivat[ing]” (van Leeuwen, 1996, p. 44) Muslims physically (i.e. by waging war); the use of these lemmas itself also represents ‘Them’ as an ideological ‘other’ and threat to ‘Our’ religious ideology (underlined). Increased use of these lemmas serves in intensifying IMPROPRIETY-based “manufacturing” of fear from and opposing stances towards ‘others’ in order to defend self (e.g. Cap 2017, xi), and serves the “coercive” (cf. Sachs, 2013, p. 2) function of these texts in seeking to affect the ingroup audience’s stances to support, for example, ISIS in its fight.

*(72) Indeed, the enemies of Allah — the Jews, Christians, **atheists**, **Rafida**, **apostates**, and all the nations of disbelief — dedicated their media, wealth, armies, and vehicles to wage war against the Muslims.*

*(73) Here is Halab, facing the most tyrannical and vicious **Nusayri** campaign with **kafir**, **Magian** [i.e. Majusi], and Russian support, through which they aim to establish an alternative, **Nusayri** entity, all in the midst of the treachery of the **apostate** factions, which [...] strive to remove Allah’s rule from the earth for the sake of the interests of their masters and backers from among the nations of **kufr**.*

The legitimising and coercive function of these religious attitudinal lemmas derives from authoritative sources/texts whose power is invested in the terrorist context, and enables authors to create favourable “identities which licence violence” (Brookes & McEnery, 2020, p. 351). Given that a “word in language is half someone else’s” (Bakhtin, 1981, pp. 293–294), terrorists use the terms of religious language to benefit from their ‘symbolic capital’ which derives from the symbolic power of Islam as a religion. Terrorists’ reliance on a set of powerful attitudinal terms can be thought of as a deployment of an ‘intertextual IM/PROPRIETY’ resource which derives from a divine source of these lexicons – and which can evoke a social group’s discourse and inter-group relationships based on what terms are used. A term such as *shirk/mushrik* can be viewed as being a symbolic logic of classifying and labelling the good and bad, the inside and outside, and a logic of inclusion and exclusion and consequent aggression – see instance 74 (taken from al-Baghdadi’s dataset) where *shirk* and *nifak* (i.e. polytheist and hypocrisy), which couple ‘they’ with IMPROPRIETY, set the stage for the opposing PROPRIETY values of *tawhid* and *iman*. Terrorists’ investment in the power of technical terms,

“consecration or revelation”, their powerful source (e.g. Allah) and their intertextual IM/PROPRIETY value form a powerful resource that can maintain a desired ‘reality’ or subvert the targeted social order (cf. Bourdieu, 1989, p. 23; Bourdieu, 1991, p. 170). The same exclusionary, legitimising and polarising function of use of these lemmas applies to other lemmas such as *taghut* (tyrant) and *alSalul* (a name for a historical figure who betrayed Prophet Mohammad, used to label the Saudi regime).

(74) *Their **shirk** and **nifaa** will never overcome your **tawhid** and **iman**.*

In sum, repeated lexical form-based analysis of patterns of attitudinal meanings has demonstrated how attitudinal meanings can help to decode attitudinal stances and get at authors’ personal identities and relational identities. The findings show not only that terrorist actions could be aggressive, but also their linguistically realised attitudinal stances and identities – a finding proportionate with Janicki’s (2017) view of aggression which includes all kinds of phenomena (behaviours, activities, situations, attitudes, etc.). Judgmental language can establish inclusion and exclusion status, determine power relations, and establish ideologically opposing poles – coalitions and enemies (e.g. Leets & Giles, 1997; Mateo & Yus, 2013). The analysis has offered strong support to earlier research showing that terrorist groups and their affiliates engaging in aggression tend to view opponents as morally distant, or alternatively lower in morality and themselves as morally superior (e.g. Bandura, 1999; Palmer, 1995). The findings have also emphasised Smith’s (2004, p. 431) suggestion on the usefulness of examining how authors describe their groups’ and opponents’ ATs, as grounds for suspicion of terrorism and terrorist identities.

5.5 Summary of Chapter Five

This chapter has discussed the analysis of lexicogrammatical choices in the corpus of terrorist public statements, including lexical selection, discursive themes, and patterns of attitudinal meanings. It has capitalised on the power of corpus analysis tools and the SFL system of ATTITUDE to provide empirical evidence of the characteristic features of terrorist threatening texts. The focus has been on repeatedly used lexicogrammatical choices and their functions. This analysis has shown the properties of terrorist threatening communication and how these compare across the authors’ sub-corpora. The chapter has demonstrated how these properties are evidence of authors’ violent intentions and engagement in terrorism. It has

also established that the choices of lexical structure, conceptual (sub)categories, and lexis-based patterns of attitudinal meanings in terrorist datasets can provide evidence of authors' ideological perceptions, semantic orientations and identities/affiliations.

The findings emphasise that a critical approach in investigating terrorist communication is to treat it as a social semiotic activity (see e.g. van Leeuwen, 2008) in order to obtain a fuller understanding of the ideological struggle in terrorist discourse. Attitudinal stances have been shown in this chapter to work as cues for the characterisation of authors, which is in accord with Culpeper's (2001) findings, and to establish grounds for identifying an author's personal and relational identities. Repeated attitudinal meanings provide clues for resources whereby authors depict themselves as embodying particular (e.g. violent/hostile) values and ways of feeling that provide a premise for attacking particular aspects of outgroup members' personal and master identities. These clues and resources add up to useful tools that practitioners in the terrorist threat assessment field can use. Actions related to social sanction and social esteem values were identified as being "critical to the formation of social networks" and in legitimising actions (Martin & White 2005, p. 52). In Chapters 6 and 7, closer attention is drawn to ideation-ATTITUDE couplings used in the negotiation of social (dis)affiliation in incitement texts and communicated threats.

CHAPTER SIX:

FINDINGS 2 – SOCIAL AFFILIATION IN TERRORIST PUBLIC STATEMENTS – AFFILIATION STRATEGIES AS DISCURSIVE INCITEMENT TACTICS

6.1 Introduction

Chapter Five has underscored the need to treat ‘terrorists’ threatening communication as a social semiotic activity in order to fully account for the role of attitude in the formation of social and action networks. The previous chapter also revealed the extent to which violence and hostility in the dataset are contingent on how the texts construct the master identities (e.g. religion, ethnicity) of the audiences. This makes drawing on the concept of membership categorization crucial when examining how affiliation is enacted through patterns of values (see e.g. Etaywe & Zappavigna, 2021). This chapter foregrounds the role of patterns of evaluative couplings – including ideations invoking attitudinal response (Knight, 2013) manifesting across the contours of the analysed inciting texts – in enacting incitement to violence against outgroups. The chapter illuminates the nuances of evaluative semantics in contribution to forensic linguistic research seeking to understand hostility-fed terrorist discourse, and specifically how evaluative couplings can provide entry points to and linguistic evidence of the negotiation of social values, the social action of affiliation, the positioning of outgroups as a threat, and engagement in the act of encouraging and legitimating violence.

The dataset has been analysed for evaluative couplings, as detailed in Section 4.4.3 of Chapter Four, in response to the second research question of this thesis. The aim is to explain (i) how affiliation strategies function as discursive tactics for inciting violence and (ii) the bond clusters that are construed in the dataset to enable the addressed audiences to distinguish between ‘good’ insiders and ‘bad’ outsiders. Using a complementary interpretive lens, this chapter also aims to identify: firstly, the moral foundations that each terrorist tends to endorse; and secondly, the rhetorical functions of evaluative couplings in terms of coercion and the legitimation of violence. This focus on evaluative couplings enables exploration of a terrorist’s evaluative style as a coupling disposition, or alternatively ‘appraisal signature’, manifested as “idiolectal reconfigurations of meaning-making potential” (Martin & White, 2005, p. 208). This focus also helps to reveal a terrorist’s (dis)affiliative positions and stances for organizing and polarizing communities. The focus on the polarity of evaluative couplings

also enables us to see the linguistic resources and values guiding the analysis of the inciter-incitee alignment, given that the positive/negative (i.e. good/bad) polar axis is a linguistic parameter fundamentally related with rhetorical and ideological functionality (e.g. White, 2006; Thompson & Alba-Jues, 2014).

The model of inciting communication in this thesis presents incitement as an activity in which evaluative couplings at the stratum (i.e. level) of discourse semantics are realized as configurations of wording/ lexicogrammar. These couplings are used to table bonds through which the inciter attempts to convoke the incitees into communities of bonds. Bonds enact the contextual and moral foundations of interpersonal relationships, and ultimately have the axiological and ideological function of legitimating violence and coercing people into performing violence. In Martin's (2010) terms, by focusing on the evaluative couplings we can see the relationship between the reservoir of meanings in a culture and the repertoire that the inciter can mobilize. That is, we can see an inciter entering from the bond entry point (which is the minimal social unit) into negotiation of social relations (Knight, 2010b), and constantly connecting and aligning themselves into increasingly larger communities of values (i.e. 'bond network' e.g. mujahidins' or kinship's network) that are connected to the less negotiable bonds of 'master' ideological networks.

6.1.1 Chapter structure

This chapter discusses the findings on affiliation strategies deployed in the service of incitement in three main sections. Section 6.2 offers a global lens on the key affiliation strategies employed as discursive incitement tactics and their inciting functions across the OBL, al-Baghdadi and Tarrant incitement texts. That is, this section shows how the enacted bonds, negotiated by these tactics, serve to build ingroup membership, construct outgroups as a threat, influence the networks of interpersonal relationships, and stir up emotions and provoke hostility and violence towards the outgroups. The clusters of bonds tabled in and across the texts of each terrorist are also summarised, revealing how the bonds contribute to constructing the world in discourse. Examples are drawn from the incitement texts analysed.

Section 6.3, next, discusses the global picture of the recurrent moral meta-values underpinning the couplings which realise the bonds, and how these themes compare or

contrast across the three terrorists. The aim is to argue for the moral foundations behind bond-enactment: what triggers them, and how an activation of a moral foundation can invite an activation of a set of social roles. It also explores how evaluative couplings help to reveal the moral reasoning behind the incited violence and the moral coerciveness in the incitement rhetoric. Section 6.4 then unpacks how each terrorist has drawn on various modes of persuasion to gear evaluative couplings towards three rhetorical functions. These are: legitimating Self/ingroup's actions; delegitimizing outgroups; and coercing (i.e. generating fear and sense of insecurity, and demanding action of the ingroup members). The aim is to focus on these rhetorical functions as social, discursive practices that take couplings as resources deployed as a foundation for perception and action and to serve these functions, within a framework in which the inciter and incitees are thought of as deontic participants and value-serving agents.

6.2 Affiliation strategies and bond clusters across the inciting texts

The analysis shows that each terrorist tends to invite the addressee to take sides and affiliate with the ingroup which is constructed through evaluative couplings construing a 'We versus They' world. The evaluative couplings serve – in Du Bois' (2007) terms – as intentional public acts with a (dis)aligning function. Put differently, the evaluative couplings operate by continuously promoting 'Our' community of positive, shared values in opposition to communities of unshared values. This affiliation strategy influences the addressees' likelihood of aligning with 'Our' community and related positively charged experiences. This strategy simultaneously promotes disaligning with the outgroups' negatively charged counterparts. This (dis)aligning effect also encourages the addressee to pursue some value-serving actions and goals. This persuasive influence accords with previous research on promoting value alignment as persuasive conduct (see e.g. Humă, Stokoe & Sikveland, 2019; Wood, 2000).

Grouping the deployed couplings as patterns of bonds tabled for negotiating inter-group relationships (see Section 4.4.3.2) reveals two primary affiliation strategies aimed at persuading the incitee to align with the inciter:

- Communion: an *ingroup-oriented* strategy concerned with tabling bonds aimed at forging solidarity, sympathy and consensus, and at preserving ingroup values.

- Alienation: an *outgroup-oriented* strategy where certain bonds are positioned as unshareable in order to exclude an outgroup, creating a tension between an ingroup and an outgroup's values.

Table 6.1 summarises the affiliative strategies as used in the incitement texts. It also includes a manual count of each time a bond was realised by a single coupling in a clause or by a series of co-textual couplings realising the same bond. The table shows that OBL, al-Baghdadi and Tarrant deployed similar communion and alienation strategies. While there were the same tactics (i.e. linguistic resources) used for both communion and alienation strategies (see Sections 6.2.1 and 6.2.2), the 'kinship affirmation' tactic was utilized only in communion.

Table 6.1: Social affiliation strategies utilised in the incitement texts

Affiliation tactics	Total occurrences			Affiliation strategies					
				Communion			Alienation		
	OBL	Bagh.	Tarrant	OBL	Bagh.	Tarrant	OBL	Bagh.	Tarrant
attitudinal expansion	86	102	153	46	70	77	40	32	76
iconisation	48	55	5	40	52	4	4	3	1
attitudinal projection	15	30	-	14	26	-	1	4	-
kinship affirmation	14	7	6	14	7	6	-	-	-
indexical labelling	13	10	24	4	4	9	9	8	15
authorisation	6	5	3	5	5	-	1	-	3
adequation	6	-	1	1	-	-	5	-	1

The aim of the subsections to follow is to show how attitude invoking resources are used to forge inciter-incitee alignment around shared bonds or couplings realising these bonds, and how these resources serve to generate conflict via enacting bonds in discourse. The subsections also show that the inciting texts, while communing, tend to alienate outgroups simultaneously through the tactics of alienation, that is, disalignment – with negative

unshared bonds or couplings realising these bonds of an outgroup – is forged. My argument accords with previous research showing that collective hostility-fed actions are developed via (i) identification with the good ‘We’ and (ii) exclusion of the bad ‘They’ whose presence or acts constitute an ideological and physical threat to ‘Us’ (see e.g. Cap, 2017; Reicher, Haslam & Rath, 2008). Throughout this chapter JUDGEMENT is underlined, APPRECIATION is double underlined, and AFFECT is dotted underlined.

6.2.1 Communion and alienation tactics and their functions

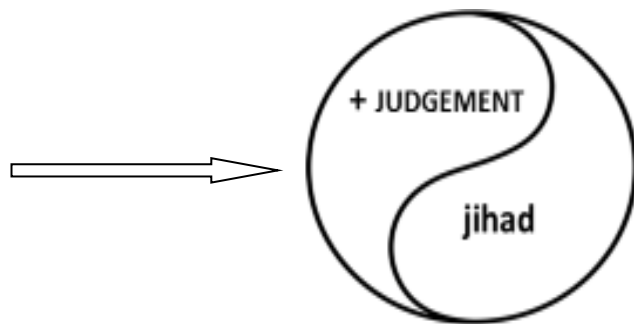
6.2.1.1 Attitudinal expansion tactic

Attitudinal expansion was deployed by the terrorists to forge alignment via deploying subsequent couplings that emphasise the same bond. Based on the concept of expansion as a general semantic relation (see Zhao, 2020), these couplings operate by: **enhancing** (i.e. supporting a positive ATTITUDE through providing another instance of the same ATTITUDE type and polarity towards the same ideation e.g. jihad); **elaborating** (i.e. specifying or clarifying an ideation or a positive ATTITUDE); and/or **extending** (i.e. supplying a new ATTITUDE type with consistent polarity), where couplings in a series of evaluations extend one another in attitudinal value via inscription and invocation. I use ‘attitudinal expansion’ as a cover label for the use of any of the enhancement, elaboration, and extension sub-tactics. Consider Example 1 in which supportive, positive judgment-based couplings are mobilised in enhancement of the positive value of *jihad* in OBL8, where OBL incites the Afghan people for jihad – as visually shown in Figure 6.1. These instances of [jihad/ + JUDGEMENT] couplings contribute to marking the text and construing a ‘good jihad’ bond cluster – a concept revisited in Section 6.2.3 – in discourse, promote the basic ingroup value of protective jihad via saturating its positive charging, and serve as “coordinated choices from [the] system network” (Martin, 2010, p. 39) that facilitate aligning OBL with his addressees as members of the same community that positively perceives jihad.

(1)

Verily, it is not unknown to you the position of jihad in the religion. [...] By jihad, ¹pride and dignity are attained in this world and the hereafter, ²homelands are preserved, ³sanctuaries are protected, ⁴justice, security and prosperity prevail, ⁵prestige is cultivated in the souls of the young, ⁶kingdoms are constructed, and ⁷the banner of the right flutters above every other banner.

- 1 [jihad / + JUDGEMENT]
- 2 [(jihad) / + JUDGEMENT]
- 3 [(jihad) / + JUDGEMENT]
- 4 [(jihad) / + JUDGEMENT]
- 5 [(jihad) / + JUDGEMENT]
- 6 [(jihad) / + JUDGEMENT]
- 7 [(jihad) / + JUDGEMENT]



affiliation: communion: attitudinal expansion $\supset$ jihad is good: protects values; and occupies a highly valued position in Islam

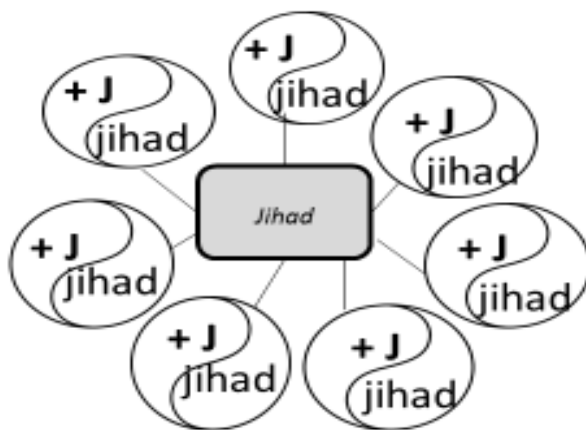


Figure 6.1: Attitudinal enhancement of jihad bond

Example 2 is taken from OBL2 inciting the Iraqis and Muslims to undertake jihad against the US-led coalition in Iraq. OBL begins by coupling the addressees (*you*, i.e. Iraqis) with positive APPRECIATION (realised by *hail*), which invokes a positive JUDGEMENT of the Iraqis' jihad. Expanding this initial evaluation of *you* in [*you* (Iraqis)/ + APPRECIATION] in an act of attitudinal

elaboration, OBL then further specifies the ideation *you* by using *your effort* and *your...jihad* (2⁻¹, and 2⁻²) as more specified sub-ideations evaluated by the same positive APPRECIATION. I note here that, in 2⁻², we also have an instance of ‘recoupling’ (see Szenes, 2017), where [jihad/ + APPRECIATION] coupling realised in *blessed jihad* is recoupling with the initial *hail* (you) while clarifying ATTITUDE and reinforcing [+ APPRECIATION] with another [+ APPRECIATION]. All these APPRECIATION -based couplings thus fall under jihad. See Figure 6.2 which visually represents this form of attitudinal elaboration and recoupling.

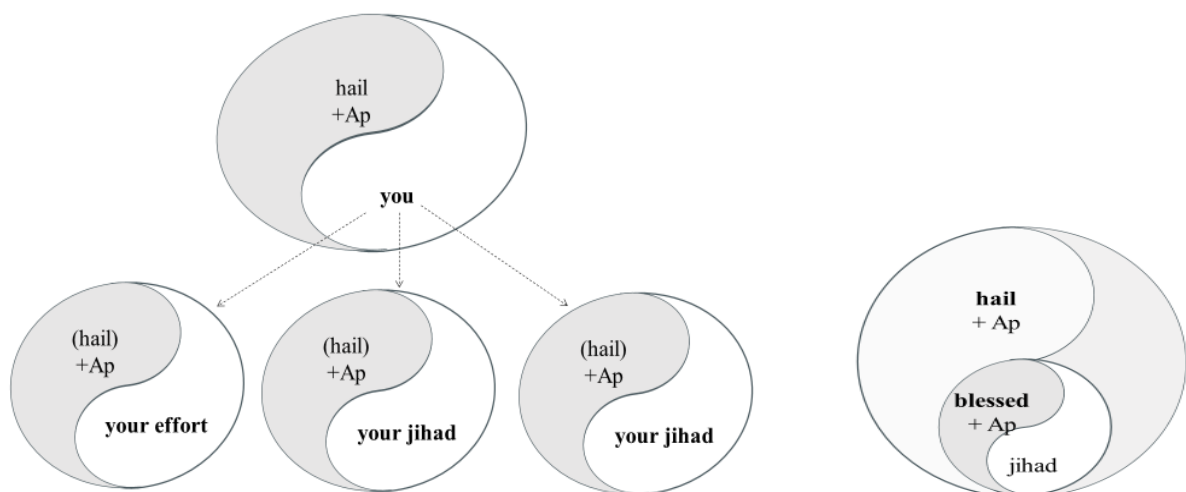
(2)

¹I *hail* you [Iraqis], your effort, and your ²*blessed* Jihad, for you have massacred the enemy and...

1 [you, your effort, and your jihad / + APPRECIATION]

2 [(Iraqis') jihad / + APPRECIATION]

affiliation: communion: attitudinal expansion $\supset$ jihad is good



(a) Specifying the ideation

(b) Reinforcing recoupling, clarifying an attitude

Figure 6.2: Forms of attitudinal elaboration working in tandem

Al-Baghdadi also used attitudinal expansion. Consider Example 3, taken from al-Baghdadi 1, inciting the Sunni Muslims for jihad against the Shiite (*the Rafida*, i.e. pro Iran-militias), the *Nusayriyyah* (i.e. pro al-Assad troops) and *atheists* (i.e. the US-led military coalition targeting ISIS). Al-Baghdadi enhances the positive attitudinal value of ISIS via a series of positive

APPRECIATION-based couplings whereby he tables the bond 'ISIS is a protector of Islam' or 'ISIS is a means for Muslims' glory and dignity'.

(3)

¹O Ahl as-Sunna! After Allah, you have nothing but the Islamic State to protect your religion, safeguard your authority, and bolster your strength, ²a state wherein you can either live with glory or die with dignity ...

1 [the Islamic State / invoked + APPRECIATION]

2 [a state / invoked + APPRECIATION]

affiliation: communion: attitudinal expansion $\supset$ ISIS is good: a protector of Islam; and a means for glory and dignity

Tarrant also used this kind of attitudinal expansion to promote identification and solidarity. Consider Example 4, where Tarrant justifies radicalising young Western men and women to acts of violence. Tarrant deploys a series of APPRECIATION-based couplings (including APPRECIATION invoked via JUDGEMENT) of Western young men and women, to align Tarrant and the young Western incitees with the positive value of the radical path proposed. While devalorizing weakness and multicultural, egalitarian and individualistic ideas which young men and women actively *decry* and *mock*, Tarrant construes 'strength is good' (via radical option) as a shared bond which men and women actively *worship*.

(4)

*¹So these young men and women see this suicidal nihilism ²and isolate themselves from this **mainstream**, "**multicultural**", **egalitarian**, **individualistic** insanity ³and look for allies anywhere **they** can find them, in the flesh or online [...] ⁴**They** decry weakness, ⁵mock fecklessness ⁶and worship strength, ⁷and in **this** worship of strength they radicalize and find the solution.*

1 [nihilism / - APPRECIATION]

2 [(these young men and women) / + JUDGEMENT]

[mainstream, "multicultural", egalitarian, individualistic / - APPRECIATION]

3 [(these young men and women) / + JUDGEMENT]

4 [they / + JUDGEMENT]

5 [(they) / + JUDGEMENT]

6 [(they) / + JUDGEMENT]

7 [(this) / + APPRECIATION]

affiliation: communion: attitudinal expansion $\supset$ multiculturalism, egalitarianism and individualism are bad; strength is good/solution

To alienate outgroups, each terrorist also tends to use the attitudinal expansion tactic. Consider OBL, in Example 5-a, where he alienates the USA and the pro-America political leaders – in a step towards disaligning from them and justifying the positive value of jihad as a *must* to be rid of their threat. OBL tables the ‘America is bad/US-formed governments are bad’ bond for negotiation by coupling *any government formed by the United States* with [- JUDGEMENT] realised by *traitor and collaborator*. Then, he reinforces the same negative bond via attitudinal enhancement, coupling *the governments of Karzai [of Kurdistan] and Mahmud Abbas [of Palestine]* (as examples) with [- JUDGEMENT]. OBL reinforces this negative value with an example of a ‘treacherous’ act, *the Road Map* peace initiative between the Israelis and the Palestinians. OBL simultaneously uses attitudinal elaboration, specifying the ideation (i.e. the act of annihilation of jihad by Mahmud Abbas) by coupling anew ideation (i.e. Abbas’ support for *the Road Map*) with [- APPRECIATION] as realised in *a new ring in the chain of conspiracies*. OBL further clarifies the [ATTITUDE] by coupling the Road Map with [- JUDGEMENT] realised in *abort* and then coupling it with – in Szenes’ (2017) terms – ‘inverting’ recoupling: [intifadah (i.e. the Palestinian uprising)/ + APPRECIATION] to maximize the negative image of the alienated governments. See Figure 6.3 for a visual display of this recoupling and how the Road Map is negatively evaluated through re-evaluating [+ APPRECIATION] as [- JUDGEMENT].

(5)

a. *It is no secret that **any government formed by the United States** is a traitor and collaborator government like all governments in the region, including the governments of Karzai and Mahmud Abbas, ²**which** were created to annihilate Jihad. ³**The road map** is nothing but a new ring in the chain of conspiracies ⁴to abort the blessed Intifadah.*

affiliation: alienation: attitudinal expansion ∇ America is bad; US-formed governments are bad; peaceful solutions are bad

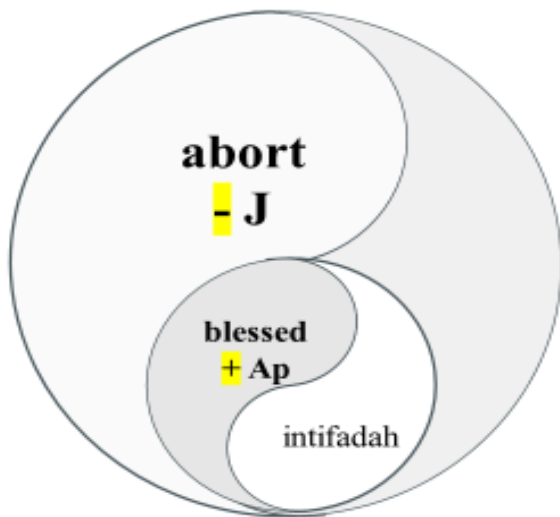


Figure 6.3: Inverting recoupling working in tandem with attitudinal elaboration to reinforce the negative image of Others

Like OBL, al-Baghdadi and Tarrant used the attitudinal expansion tactic. Al-Baghdadi uses it to (i) construct outgroups (i.e. the coalition forces targeting ISIS in Iraq and Syria) as a threat targeting the Sunnis, their land and religion, and (ii) to negotiate the ‘the coalition forces are bad’ bond (Example 5-b). In this example, al-Baghdadi reinforces the negative value of outgroups via attitudinal enhancement, using four negative JUDGEMENT-based couplings. In alienating immigrants, Tarrant also uses attitudinal expansion, as in Example 5-c where he deploys a series of negative JUDGEMENT-based couplings of the immigrants to negotiate the ‘mass immigration is destructive’ bond.

b. ...¹they [our enemy] embark on war and ²declare it against Allah, His Messenger, and His religion, ³harm His slaves and awliya [i.e. believers], ⁴and strive to expel them from the land, which belongs to Allah...

[they (the coalition forces) / - JUDGEMENT] x 4

affiliation: alienation: attitudinal expansion $\supset$ the coalition forces are bad

c. ¹Mass immigration will disenfranchise us, ²subvert our nations, ³destroy our communities, ⁴destroy our ethnic binds, ⁵destroy our cultures, ⁶destroy our peoples.

[mass immigration / - JUDGEMENT]

affiliation: alienation: attitudinal expansion $\supset$ mass immigration is destructive

6.2.1.2 Attitudinal projection tactic

Attitudinal projection was used by the terrorists to forge alignment by linking bonds available in the events of saying (i.e. quotes) with the content of the inciting text, providing support to the bond tabled for negotiation. This tactic is based on the concept of projection as a general semantic relation (see Zhao, 2020). Put differently, this tactic operates by tabling a bond for negotiation and then by incorporating intertextually – in Lemke’s (2004, p. 6) terms – a “co-orienting” text, that is, a quote that shares with the inciter’s text the same attitude and value-orientation viewpoint towards the same ideation (e.g. believers). Consider Example 6 where, in the indented prophetic saying, the ability to fight and be killed is coupled with positive AFFECT (*wish*) realising the ‘jihad is a wish’ bond. This positive view of jihad serves to endorse and reinforce OBL’s deployed couplings (in 6^{1,2,3}) through recoupling (as visually displayed in Figure 6.4), which altogether reinforce the positive charge of jihad and align the inciter and incitee with jihad.

(6) (focus on the indented quote)

¹*I [...] envy you for the Jihad you are in.* ²*Allah knows that had I found a way to reach your arenas, I would have taken it.* ³*How would I not do so while we know that [...]* ⁴*The Prophet also said:*

*“By the One in Whose Hand is the soul of Mohammad, I **wish** I could fight in the cause of Allah and **be killed**, then **fight and be killed**, then **fight and be killed**.”*

1 [you / + AFFECT]

2 [you / invoked + AFFECT]

3 [you / invoked + JUDGEMENT]

4 [**fight (and be killed)** / + AFFECT]

affiliation: communion: attitudinal projection $\supset$ Jihad is a wish

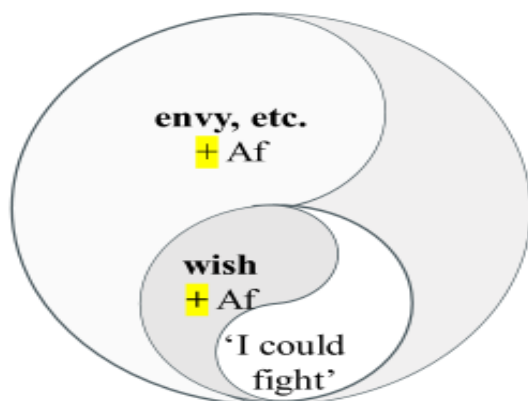


Figure 6.4: Projected coupling reinforcing the positive charge of jihad bond

Like OBL, al-Baghdadi utilized attitudinal projection as in Example 7, taken from al-Baghdadi 2, which encourages the Sunnis and pro-ISIS fighters to remain steadfast in jihad. While al-Baghdadi initially deploys his APPRECIATION-based couplings that realise the ‘good jihad and martyrhood’ bond, he uses a projected bond (i.e. ‘tasting tribulation and patience on them is good’ bond) in the indented quote of the Salafist scholar, Ibn Qayyim, to reinforce the positive value of jihad/ martyrhood as being a distinguisher between true believers and hypocrites. As such, this projected coupling reinforces the negotiated value of steadfastness in jihad through a stance-endorsing action, and invites alignment with it.

(7) (focus on the indented quote)

¹*So there is no path to bring honour to this religion after believing in Allah and singling Him out with worship except through **waging battle**, and through **the love of attaining shahada** [i.e. martyrhood] on His path, and by **disgracing His criminal, disbelieving enemies** everywhere. [...]Ibn Qayyim enumerated some of these wisdoms [of tasting tribulations]. ²He states,*

"Among them is that the truthful believer is distinguished from the lying munafiq [i.e. hypocrite] ...

1 [Waging battle...attaining martyrhood... / invoked + APPRECIATION]

2 [(**tasting tribulation**) / invoked + APPRECIATION]

affiliation: communion: attitudinal projection $\searrow$ jihad and martyrhood are good;
patience in jihad is good

Via exploiting bonds existing in “manifest” intertextuality that serves endorsement (Lehman, Sułkowski & Cap, 2019, p. 9; Kristeva, 1980), attitudinal projection serves to reinforce alignment with a shared belief and ideology. This manifests as strewing the bonds construed by the inciter together with the projected bonds throughout the text in a pattern of semantic relation that rhetorically promotes the negotiated bonds.

To alienate, OBL and al-Baghdadi also used attitudinal projection. For example, OBL, in 8-a, negotiates the ‘America is bad’ bond and alienates *whoever helped America...to kill Muslims in Iraq* by initially coupling them with [- JUDGEMENT] (i.e. describing them as *apostate*). The apostacy attribute has its ideological consequences such as permitting the killing of the apostate and taking away their property. In order to endorse this negative bond, OBL deploys a Quranic quote that projects the same negative orientation towards *whoever is an ally to them* [the Jews and the Christians], by coupling them with negative APPRECIATION realised in *he*

is one of them. Al-Baghdadi, in 8-b, negotiates the 'al-Assad, Iran and the Russians front is bad' bond and the 'the Sahwa (i.e. awakening) factions supporting al-Assad are bad' bond, and condemns the Sahwa factions and their leaders cooperating with al-Assad troops by describing the al-Assad front as *jahili* [i.e. pre-Islamic] banner, in a negative APPRECIATION-based coupling. This negative bond is endorsed by a prophetic quote projecting a negative APPRECIATION-based bond concerning those fighting for their factions and not for Islam.

(8) (Focus is on couplings in projection)

a. We also make it clear that **whoever helped America ... to kill Muslims in Iraq**, he must know that **he is an apostate**, outside of Islam circle, and it is permissible to take away their property and spill their blood. Allah said:

*"O you who have believed, do not take the Jews and the Christians as allies. They are [in fact] allies of one another. And **whoever is an ally to them among you** - then indeed, **he is [one] of them**. Indeed, Allah guides not the wrongdoing people."*

[whoever is an ally to them / - APPRECIATION]

affiliation: alienation: attitudinal expansion $\supset$ US allies are bad; America is bad

b. What is it that you are fighting for now that you are among those who are sacrificing themselves under a blind, jahili banner? Muslim reported in his Sahih that the Prophet said,

*"Whoever fights under a banner of blindness, becoming angry for the sake of a faction or calling to a faction or supporting a faction, and is then killed, then **it is a death of jahiliyya**.*

[(al-Assad front) / - APPRECIATION]

[it (the death of those fighting under a jahili or faction banner) / - APPRECIATION]

affiliation: alienation: attitudinal projection $\supset$ leaders of Sahwa factions are bad – cheaters to the Sunnis in Syria

As such, the bonds projected to endorse a terrorist's negotiated bond are strewn to foster the general semantic, negative presentation of outgroups, in an 'Our/Their' coalition paradigm that is based on religious reasoning. The projected couplings encourage taking sides against those considered 'outsiders'.

6.2.1.3 Iconisation tactic

Iconisation was employed by the terrorists to forge alignment by deploying bonding icons, that is, ideations which crystallize, symbolize and provoke shared values and attitudes, so that these icons work as rallying devices towards the inciter-incitee's shared values. In other words, with these icons, the inciter and incitees can co-identify, and a particular bond network

can be established. The analysis shows three primary types of icons used repeatedly by the three terrorists. Using Martin and Zappavigna's (2013) and Knight's (2010a; 2010b) terms, these types are: hero icons (e.g. *prophet Mohammad, Pope Urban II, Saladin*); creed icons (e.g. *Islam, Christianity*, verses from holy books, *Valhalla*); and symbolic objects (e.g. *Hagia Sophia, al-Aqsa Mosque*).

To exemplify their functions in forging alignment and networking, consider Examples 9-12. In Example 9, OBL deploys the ideations (in bold) *Mohammad* (a prophet), *Sa'd, Al-Muthanna, Khalid* and *Saladin* (iconic Muslim leaders in jihad against Arab polytheists, Persians, and Crusaders) as models to follow and heroes who symbolize the Islamic values of jihad, martyrdom and nationhood. Ideations such as these facilitate affiliation through their interpersonal charge (i.e. [invoked + APPRECIATION]) focus, provoking related values as an embodiment of the act of 'Our' prophet (Example 9) and 'Our' pious predecessors (Example 10), and axiologising around their line of jihad. Similar deployment of heroes was also identified in al-Baghdadi's texts.

(9) *This [jihad] is the path of our Prophet Mohammad ...*

[the path (of jihad)/ invoked + APPRECIATION]

affiliation: communion: iconisation $\searrow$ jihad is good – a prophetic path

(10) *O grandchildren of Sa'd, Al-Muthanna, Khalid, Al-Mu'anna, and Saladin, ...*

[grandchildren (Muslims in Iraq) / invoked + APPRECIATION]

affiliation: communion: iconisation $\searrow$ mujahidin are good – the pious predecessors' followers

The creed icons, by invoking and referring to particular creed, also enable negotiation of contested bonds. Consider Example 11 where al-Baghdadi calls the Sunnis in the Arabian Peninsula to consider the conditions of the Sunnis in Iraq, Syria and Yemen in a step towards aligning themselves with the Sunnis' concerns and invoking rage and jealousy in them. Investing in the *ahl al-Sunna* ideation, al-Baghdadi used it as a rallying resource towards creed-unity and core practices (e.g. jihad) of self-defence.

(11) *O ahl al-Sunna in the peninsula of Muhammad [...] Where is your jealous rage for your religion and your umma?*

[ahl al-Sunna in the Arab peninsula / invoked + APPRECIATION]

affiliation: communion: iconisation $\searrow$ ahl al-Sunna in the peninsula are Islam defenders

Deployment of symbolic object-icons is evidenced in using ideations referencing iconic buildings and cities. In Example 12-a, *Baghdad* is used by OBL to invoke its historical significance for Muslims, that is, being the home of the Caliphate of the Muslim community and people under its dominion, following the death of Prophet Mohammad. This icon thus helps to establish a statehood bond network, and thus to co-identify and align the incitees in Baghdad with dispositions associated with the must-defend-home of Islamic identity. Similarly, in 12-b, OBL uses the *al-Aqsa* mosque which symbolizes Muslim community worship-practices and identity, thus promoting a higher level ideological/ religious bond network and activating the value of jihad to protect the mosque and, generally, Palestine. This ideological use of icons is not limited to the Salafist terrorists. Tarrant also used, for example, *Hagia Sophia* (12-c), an iconic structure in Istanbul which reflects the religious changes that have played out in the region over the centuries with its Byzantine structure and lavish mosaics of Christianity as well as minarets and inscriptions of Islam. Hagia Sophia's interpersonal charge is exploited to establish the Roman or Christian empire bond network and to enable his putative Western audiences to co-identify and align themselves with the same identity and, ultimately, with actions to *free Constantinople* from the Muslim Turks.

(12)

a. *To the heroes in Baghdad - the home of the caliphate - and its surroundings,*

[Baghdad / invoked + APPRECIATION]

affiliation: communion: iconisation $\searrow$ Baghdad is Islamic

b. *And the initiative of Prince Abdullah bin Abdul Aziz...is nothing but...a form of repeated betrayal in the history of the region's rulers regarding our issues in general and that of al-Aqsa in particular.*

[al-Aqsa / invoked + APPRECIATION]

affiliation: communion: iconisation $\searrow$ al-Aqsa is Islamic; Palestine is Ours bond

c. *UNTIL THE **HAGIA SOPHIA** IS FREE OF THE MINARETS, THE MEN OF EUROPE ARE MEN IN NAME ONLY.*

[Hagia Sophia / invoked + APPRECIATION]

affiliation: communion: iconisation $\searrow$ Hagia Sophia is Western and Christian.

The analysis, as such, has given evidence of how the choice of interpersonally charged ideations (i.e. icons) enables the forging of alignment and promoting of a common worldview. Icons enable the ingroup members to focus on the emotional importance of these icons and their associated assumptions and dispositions. Icons, as such, turn into binding glue for the terrorists' envisaged world, as contributor towards establishing bond networks such as a White supremacist network or an Islamic statehood or spirituality network that repel the anti-world.

To alienate, the three terrorists also tend to deploy de-bonding (i.e. anti) icons that construct adversarial identities and symbolize unshared values. For example, OBL promotes (in Example 13-a) a world paradigm in which the negatively appreciated *banner of the cross* embodies the crusaders as a religious enemy who came to fight against the 'Us' group. The ideational meaning of *the banner of the cross* is suppressed in favour of superseding this ideation by its interpersonal association, that is, symbolizing Christianity and thus – in Wignell, Tan and O'Halloran's (2017, p. 3) terms – a "constellation" of an opposing pole of values and worldview. This interpersonal focus rhetorically serves to demote the 'adversarial' master identity, disaligning with the religiously different 'enemy' and simultaneously inviting the incitees into the Muslim side. This deployment of anti-icons symbolizing opposing cultural/religious moral orders establishes a basis for inviting the ingroup members to align themselves with the ingroup values as driven by loyalty to these values. This concept of loyalty as a moral foundation is revisited in detail in Section 6.3.

(13) (Focus on icons in bold)

a. *Today, you are the soldiers of Allah, the arrows of Islam, and the first line of defence of this Ummah. And the Romans have gathered, under **the banner of the cross**, to fight the Ummah of beloved Mohammad, may Allah's peace and blessings be upon him.*

[the banner / invoked - APPRECIATION]

affiliation: alienation: iconisation $\searrow$ the Romans are a religious enemy

Al-Baghdadi and Tarrant have also deployed anti-icons to alienate outgroups. To encourage the jihadists to continue to kill ISIS's 'enemy' even during the occasion of Eid, al-Baghdadi (Example 13-b) deploys *Ja'd Ibn Dirham* – the name of an Arab person who was killed for being considered an apostate. This icon, taken from al-Baghdadi2, which urges perseverance in jihad, references a historic example of apostates and infidels permitted to be dis-aligned with

and killed for being considered outside the circle of Islam. In addition, Tarrant also, in 13-c, uses a proverb or an idiomatic expression (in bold) to provoke negative attitude towards the danger of immigrants and to disalign Whites from immigrants, considering this disalignment an act of wisdom.

b. *I remind you, O soldiers of the Khilafa and its supporters, to revive the example set forth with the killing of Ja'd Ibn Dirham by slaughtering every secularist, atheist, and murtad who wages war against Allah and His Messenger...*

[the killing of Ja'd Ibn Dirham / invoked - APPRECIATION]

affiliation: alienation: iconisation $\searrow$ secularists, atheists and apostates are enemy of Islam

c. ***An ounce of prevention is worth a pound of cure.*** *Preventing these enemies from reaching adulthood and their full potential of effect is of importance. Why make your children fight when you could fight in their stead?*

[An ounce... / invoked - JUDGEMENT]

affiliation: alienation: iconisation $\searrow$ killing the immigrants' children and preventing them from growing in Europe is a preventive measure

6.2.1.4 Indexical labelling tactic

Indexical labelling was employed by the terrorists to forge alignment by constructing a social value or an identity via the use of a word, name, description or structure that provokes attitude or points to, labels, stands for or focusses attention on an existing group of people and their shared attributes. This tactic is conceptualised based on the principle of indexicality, which involves establishing semiotic links between linguistic structure and social meanings by relying on ideological structures "[since] associations between language and identity are rooted in cultural beliefs and values – that is, ideologies – about the sorts of speakers who (can or should) produce particular sorts of language" (see also Bucholtz & Hall, 2005, p. 594; Omoniyi, 2006; Knight, 2010c; Jeffries, 2014). Consider Example 14.

(14) (focus on structure in bold)

a. *And the Romans have gathered under the banner of the cross to fight the Ummah of the beloved Mohammad, may Allah's peace and blessings be upon him.*

[the ummah / invoked + APPRECIATION]

affiliation: communion: indexical labelling $\searrow$ Islam bond

b. *O seekers of shahada [i.e. martyrdom], [...] O you who strive towards the Gardens and the pleasure of Allah, go forth with Allah's blessing, for indeed, this war is your war.*

[mujahidin / invoked + APPRECIATION]

affiliation: communion: indexical labelling $\supset$ martyrdom is a good end; jihad is a means to please Allah

c. ***Green nationalism** is the only true nationalism.*

[green nationalism / invoked + APPRECIATION]

affiliation: communion: indexical labelling $\supset$ environmentalism/eco-fascism is good

In the examples above, OBL (Example 14-a), used the term *Ummah* which provokes the unity of Muslim communities worldwide and taps into their symbolic provenance, in opposition to the *Romans*. Identity inference is also made possible through names and the post-modifying collocative Islamic structure (i.e. *beloved Mohammad*) which is of the indexicality of religious affiliation and cultural routine of revering the prophet Mohammad, and which can align OBL and Muslims to shared bonds. Al-Baghdadi also has deployed terms such as *shahadah* (i.e. martyrdom) (Example 14-b) which is a key part of the symbolic capital of the Islamic register used to create identity and forge alignment.

Tarrant, too, has used terms that construct identities and aim to forge alignment, as in Example 14-c, where the label *green nationalism* alludes to the notion of the impact of overpopulation and mass immigration on the environment. This notion has a long racial and ethnonational lineage and is usually deployed to provoke attitude and rationalize alignment against non-White populations. Given the xenophobic fear-based argument of Tarrant which coopts environmental concerns to licence hostility, references to green nationalism that allude to racist “greenwashing hate” (Savouliau, 2019), “eco-nationalism” and “eco-fascism” (see e.g. Wilson, 2019) discourses are interpreted as – in Caple’s (2010) and Chang’s (2004, p. 1) terms – “membership devices” that are linked to xenophobic nationalism which calls for White solidarity and proposes genocidal solutions to maintain the landscape and ‘Our’ local environment as key elements of national identity. Allusion to Islamic discourses or race-nationalist discourses as such supports previous research (e.g. Chang, 2004, p. 1) in that, when terms alluding to certain discourses are used in a text, their functions become those of aligning the text producer and its receivers as “belonging to a community with shared linguistic and cultural values” and reinforcing solidarity.

To alienate outgroups, the three terrorists also used overt naming or description to refer to a condemned master identity or a category related to adversaries. For instance, in Example 15-a, OBL labelled the US-led coalition in Iraq as *Crusader*. This mention in the warning clause affords negative attitude by alluding to the historical Crusade wars and their negative associations in the Muslim world. This establishes adversarial identities in the text and draws on the symbolic provenance of these identities. Al-Baghdadi used terms from the Islamic symbolic capital (Example 15-b) to afford negative JUDGEMENT of outgroups – for more detailed list of these labels see Section 5.3.2.1 of Chapter Five. To forge exclusion of the Kurds of Iraq who are supported by the Americans and Iran-backed militias, al-Baghdadi labels them as *atheist* and Iranian militias as *the Rafida* (i.e. the rejectionists, a term used derogatorily to label the Shiite on the basis that they do not recognise the first three caliphs of Islam as legitimate successors of the prophet Mohammad). Tarrant also used labels such as *pedophile* (Example 18-c) (repeatedly, in this example, for emphasis) to mark off and forge disalignment with the immorality alleged to be existing in Western society.

(15) (Focus on labels in bold)

a. *Beware of supporting the **Crusader** US forces and their allies...*

[the US forces / - APPRECIATION]

affiliation: alienation: indexical labelling $\supset$ bad US coalition

b. *Who among us has not heard of the 100 million dollars of support for the **atheist** Kurds, as they had announced, as well as their unpraiseworthy support for **the rafida** of Iraq?*

[Kurds / - JUDGEMENT]

affiliation: communion: indexical labelling $\supset$ America and pro-Americans are bad

c. ***Pedophile** politicians, **pedophile** priests and **pedophile** pop stars, demonstrating to all the true depravity of our age.*

affiliation: alienation: indexical labelling $\rightarrow$ priests, politicians and pop stars
demonstrate the immoral status quo of the Western society

Indexical labelling, as such, serves not only to mark off ideologically distinct areas of experience but also to reorient social meanings to intersubjectively negotiated bonds. The operative value of labelling identified in the dataset provides support to previous research (e.g. Bucholtz & Hall, 2005; Knight, 2010c, p. 183) showing that labelling allows for identity

relations to emerge and for negotiating “differential values”, which can ultimately create a fandom enabled by alluding to shared lexis of condemnation.

6.2.1.5 Adequation tactic

Adequation was employed by the terrorists to forge alignment based on the concept of similarity/difference relations (see e.g. Bucholtz & Hall, 2005; Hodge, 2007), where values and identities are constructed by being dependent; that is, they acquire social meaning in relation to other ideations and/or identity positions available in discourse. Put differently, alignment is forged through constructing an equation between two positively charged ideations (e.g. Islam) or experiences. Consider Example 16 where the Pakistanis are equated with the Afghanis in [+ JUDGEMENT] (i.e. *rush[ing] to defend Islam*), as signalled by *just as*. By this tactic OBL, in inciting the Pakistanis for jihad against the US-led war on Afghanistan, suppresses differences between the two social groups and foregrounds sameness in positive attitude towards Islam and jihad. Via this tactic, the expectation to see the Pakistani people involved in jihad has been established, and the Pakistanis are invited to axiologize around jihad through coupling them with the [+ APPRECIATION] realised by *the front line of defence*.

(16) *It is no wonder that the Muslim Ummah in **Pakistan** has rushed to defend Islam, as it is considered the front line of defence for Islam in this region - **just as Afghanistan** was the front line of defence for itself and for Pakistan against the Russian invasion more than 20 years ago.*

[Pakistan / + JUDGEMENT]

[it (Pakistan) / + APPRECIATION]

[Afghanistan / + APPRECIATION]

[the Russian / - JUDGEMENT]

affiliation: communion: adequation $\triangleright$ the Pakistanis defend Islam as the Afghanis do

To alienate outgroup, adequation was also used to stress similarity between two negatively viewed ideations while implying distinction from the ingroup. This is akin to Hodges’ (2007) adequation tactic used in portraying Saddam Hussein and Osama bin Laden. The analysis shows that each terrorist used adequation to alienate outgroups. OBL, as in Example 17-a taken from OBL6, equates *Prince Abdullah bin Abdul Aziz* (of Saudi Arabia) with *Abu Raghal* – a historic figure from the pre-Islamic period who assisted the Ethiopian Emperor to reach Mecca with the purpose of destroying the Kaaba in modern day Saudi Arabia. Abu Raghal is

usually referred to as an *archetype* of treachery. This equation in negative JUDGEMENT enables sharing of an intersubjective relation of differential values of loyalty to the ingroup. Equating the incited-against with characters that present a code or embodiment of the theme of treachery enables OBL to construct Prince Abdullah as an outsider in a step towards inciting Muslims for, for example, *go[ing] to the streets on demonstrations and civil disobedience* until the fall of Arab rulers in Saudi Arabia. This adequation also establishes a basis for an axiological proximation of situations (cf. Cap, 2017), as in 17-b, whereby OBL equates the urged violence (i.e. killing Prince Abdullah) with the violent fate of previous *traitors* such as *King Abdallah Bin al-Sharif Hussein* (of Jordan) and *Anwar al-Sadat* (of Egypt). This presents hostility and violence as reasonable and *well deserved* and taken for granted as signalled by the 'obviousness' structure (*so clear that it needs no further explanation*) which puts bonding at risk.

(17) (Focus on ideations in bold)

a. *The treacherous character of 'Abu Raghhal' has been repeatedly introduced to the Ummah since a century ago, to weaken our front, disgrace our banner, to end jihad, to bring about infidelity and to cement its pillars. And the initiative of **Prince Abdullah bin Abdul Aziz** (the Zionist-American in the clothes of the Saudi government) is nothing but a trick of Abu Raghhal...*

[Abu Raghhal / - JUDGEMENT]

[the initiative of Prince Abdullah bin Abdul Aziz / invoked - JUDGEMENT]

[Prince Abdullah bin Abdul Aziz / - JUDGEMENT]

affiliation: alienation: adequation $\searrow$ Prince Abdullah bin Abdul Aziz is as much traitor as Abu Raghhal

b. *Our Muslim Ummah: **The fate** of the tyrants and traitors is so clear that it needs no further explanation... **King Abdallah Bin al-Sharif Hussein**, for example, was killed by a Palestinian hero; and **Anwar al-Sadat** [...] was shot by one of the jihadi heroes of Egypt. [...] **the traitors cast the same fate well deserved** by traitors.*

Al-Baghdadi also used Ja'd Ibn Dirham (Example 13-b earlier) which enables al-Baghdadi to equate the incited-against with Ja'd Ibn Dirham. In addition, Tarrant (Example 17-c) also equated the threat imposed by immigrants and their children with the threat of a *nest of vipers* found in someone's yard and the need for them to be burnt before achieving what Tarrant perceives as unarmed, reversed colonialization from within.

c. *When you discover a nest of vipers in your yard, do you spare the adolescents? Do you allow them to grow freely, openly, to one day bite you child as they play in their own*

*yard? No. You burn the nest and kill the vipers, no matter their age. **The enemies of our children are being born in our lands** right now, even as you read this. [...] LEAVE NO VIPERS NEST UNBURNT*

[(immigrants) / - APPRECIATION]

affiliation: alienation: adequation $\searrow$ immigrants are as dangerous as a nest of vipers

6.2.1.6 Kinship affirmation tactic

Like adequation tactic, kinship affirmation is based on the principle of relationality. Kinship affirmation, however, was employed by the terrorists to forge alignment via the use of inclusive and/or exclusive pronouns and terms of kinship as involvement resources. This use affords attitude and constructs identities (see also Knight, 2010c; Martin & White, 2005). That is, a shared identity acquires exclusive or inclusive social meaning in relation to other social actors and identities available in discourse, achieving – in Martin and White (2005, p. 211) terms – “communing sympathies of kinship [and] friendship”. For example, in OBL texts, communion is achieved via imposing shared value through the manipulative mechanism of the use of first-person singular pronouns (e.g. *my + brothers*), first person plural consensual or inclusive ‘we’ pronouns (i.e. *we, our, and us*), and second person pronouns (e.g. *your + brother*). Similar use of kinship affirmation devices is also identified in the al-Baghdadi (e.g. *our + brothers*) and Tarrant texts (e.g. *your + brothers, my + friends/family/people/culture/RACE*).

To exemplify, consider Example 18-a, where OBL enacts the bond of brotherhood in relation to the superordinate value of Islam and an Islamic defensive-practice (i.e. jihad). The shared identity is constructed by conflating the inciter (OBL and his organization) with the incitees’ sociocultural group, given the relational identity of those included in ‘*our*’. This identity construction also serves to gratify the incitee’s image by addressing them favourably in their compliance with the shared Quranic meanings (i.e. ‘verily, believers are brothers’) used at face value to invoke shared intimacies and communal moralities.

(18) (focus on bold)

a. O **our** Mujahidin **brothers** in Iraq: Let America’s propagated lies not scare you...

[Mujahidin in Iraq / invoked + APPRECIATION]

affiliation: communion: kinship affirmation $\searrow$ Mujahidin are brothers; jihad is glue

Through kinship affirmation, each terrorist tends to invest in his worldview of who is considered kin and who is non-kin, constructing a world based on a kin/non-kin opposition. Via this kinship opposition (see e.g. Chandler, 2017), each terrorist sets the stage to introduce himself as part of or merged into a “collectivized” (van Leeuwen, 1996, p. 50) social group or a transnational community (e.g. the borderless Muslim ummah, Whites in Europe and America). This involvement ultimately serves for audience manipulation and persuasion (see e.g. Cap, 2017) by investing in the construction of solidarity and intimacy through showing how interpersonal worlds are shared (see e.g. Eggins & Slade, 1997). Consider Instances 18-b, 18-c and 18-d where collectivity becomes rhetorically powerful, particularly when constructing ingroup members as being passivated (i.e. victimised), as in: OBL7 addressing the Pakistanis on the occasion of the killing of some Pakistanis protesting against the US war on Afghanistan; al-Baghdadi¹ expressing his solidarity with ISIS adherents who ended up in captivity; and Tarrant encouraging Western men and women to support the Whites affected by mass immigration across Europe and America.

b. *I have been informed of the news of **the killing of some of our Muslim brothers in Karachi...***

[(Muslims in Karachi) / invoked + APPRECIATION]

affiliation: communion: kinship affirmation $\searrow$ Muslims killed are brothers

c. *To **our brothers**, those holding onto embers, whom Allah has **tested with captivity**: By Allah [...] we have not forgotten you nor shall we ever forget you.*

[(captive mujahidin) / invoked + APPRECIATION]

affiliation: communion: kinship affirmation $\searrow$ captive mujahidin are of brothers

d. *...why should you have peace when **your other brothers in Europe face certain war?***

[(Europeans) / invoked + APPRECIATION]

affiliation: communion: kinship affirmation $\searrow$ Europeans are one/brothers

Kinship affirmation, as such, through penetrating the micro world of the incitees, facilitates alignment in opposition to non-kin social groups. In Example 13-e, the use of the pronoun *our* as “assimilation” device (van Leeuwen, 1996, p. 48), in *we incite our Muslim brother in Pakistan...*, forges alignment and facilitates incitement by building on the kinship metaphor, the symmetrical interpersonal relationship built, and the feeling of unity enacted. Similarly, Tarrant urges European men and women to *back their brothers* passivated in different

European countries, forging alignment by using kinship terms (e.g. *your brothers*) as in 18-d above.

e. We *incite* our Muslim brothers in Pakistan to defend, with all that they possess and are capable of, against the American Crusader forces invading Pakistan and Afghanistan.

These findings, as such, support Malešević's (2019, p. 190) argument that terrorists tend to use language that "invoke[s] friendship and kinship metaphors to mobilize wider support". Kinship affirmation devices show that terrorist incitement texts are built with careful attention to the micro-world of family, friendship and peers, where drawing on shared intimacies, familiarities and emotional bonds enables terrorists to build their affiliative networks and to penetrate the micro-world of the incitees.

6.2.1.7 Authorisation lead tactic

The authorisation lead tactic was employed by the terrorists to forge alignment with an ingroup and disalignment with outgroups, occurring only in the opening of their texts. This tactic operates by quoting a text of an authoritative figure and having it re-/de-contextualized or *entered into the opening* of the inciting text to construct and radiate to the text divisive 'Our versus Their' identities and provoke opposing attitudes. Authorisation leads are based on the principle of iconisation. In the dataset, introductory quotes were strategically selected to allow for opposing identities, evoked categories and stances to run as consistent themes throughout the discourse. As such, this tactic is, in Haddington's (2005, p. 119) terms, categorising and "doing positioning" simultaneously. It establishes a background for alignment and subsequent urged actions. Consider Example 19 where the reported Muslim's value of martyrdom as a self-defence is entered into the opening of OBL2, framed by a formulation that simultaneously: aligns OBL's authorial voice with quoted value positions; and, by implication, enacts inter-group bonds in relation to aggressors as 'true' and warrantable. This is achieved by the dominant, positive APPRECIATION-based couplings realising the same negotiated bond, martyrdom is good/a defence value. Through this introductory quote, OBL also manages the Muslim incitees' perception of the act of defending values (e.g. *property, life, and family*) and transcendentalizes these values by contextualizing them as

instances of a superordinate, divine value (i.e. martyrdom). This abstraction of values enables OBL to align adherents, who treasure the Quran and Hadith, with martyrdom value.

(19) (focus concerns those in bold)

Blessing and peace be upon our prophet Mohammad, who says:

“He who dies while defending his property is a martyr; he who dies in defence of his own life is a martyr; and he who dies in defence of his faith is a martyr, he who dies in defence of his family is a martyr.”

[He who dies while defending his property, life, faith and family / invoked + APPRECIATION]

affiliation: communion: authorisation $\supset$ martyrdom is good/a defence bond

Al-Baghdadi and Tarrant also deployed authorisation leads to categorise and forge (dis)alignment. For example, al-Baghdadi, in 20-a, sets the stage from the beginning of his text (al-Baghdadi2) to do positioning and present a faith-based fight between two categories of people, *those who believe* versus *those who disbelieve*, or alternatively between *the allies of Ar-Rahman [i.e. Allah]* and *the allies of the Shaytan* (i.e. the Satan), inviting alignment with ‘Our’ fight against ‘Them’. This is facilitated by the JUDGEMENT-based couplings in the quote. Tarrant also used lines from Rudyard Kipling’s poetry that serve to: divide the world into civilized White people versus non-White people worthy of colonization to civilize them, and does so also through using a quote by Pope Urban II to set the stage for a *Holy War* between two faith-based categories: the Western Christian *people worthy of glory*, and *the Saracens* (i.e. Muslims). See Example 20-b where the authoritative voice of the Pope has the potential to align the incitee Christians with the anti-Islamist views of Pope Urban II on the premise of hate and love (dotted underlined) and the negative view on outgroups.

(20)

a. Allah also says, ***“Those who believe fight in the cause of Allah, and those who disbelieve fight in the cause of the taghut. So, fight against the allies of the Shaytan [i.e. the Satan]. Indeed, the plot of the Shaytan has ever been weak”.***

[those who believe / + JUDGEMENT]

[those who disbelieve / - JUDGEMENT]

affiliation: communion: authorisation $\supset$ ‘our’ fight is good, ‘their’ fight is bad, fight is permitted

b. ***To Christians: “The people worthy of glory [...]. The race of the elect suffers outrageous persecutions, and the impious race of the Saracens respects neither the***

*virgins of the Lord nor the colleges of priests. [...] Let the fire of our repentance raise up the Holy War and the love of our brethren lead us into combat. Let our lives be stronger than death **to fight against the enemies of the Christian people.**"*

[Christians / + APPRECIATION]

[Saracens / - JUDGEMENT]

affiliation: communion: authorisation $\supset$ 'our' fight is good, 'their' fight is bad, fight is permitted

As such, couplings and attitude evoking categorical terms deployed via the authorisation lead tactic serve: to align the inciter-incitee personae categorically; and to prepare the incitees for the subsequent relationships and obligations. Lead-quotes such as these (i) establish a basis for urged acts of violence to run throughout a text as a rational, governing 'proairetic' code (cf. Barthes, 1974) – that is, actions proposed as a solution – and (ii) activate the 'maxim of relation' (Grice, 1975) to manipulate the incitees' perception of how the world ought to be and their uptake of terrorist messages, by grounding negotiated bonds on a "working consensus" point (Goffman, 1956, p. 4) – a text by a revered or divine authority. A lead quote can align the inciter and incitees, with cultural/religious values in quotes, as participants belonging to one community with shared obligations.

6.2.2 Summary of the communion and alienation tactics

Sections 6.2.1 has given an account of the various affiliative strategies and tactics observed in the dataset. We can interpret these as recurrent bonding motifs, that is, as forming a set of practices whereby community members are invited not only to co-identify but also to exclude others. The analysis so far has shown how identities can be thought of as patterns of bonds and values when approached in terms of the social relations they enact and the meanings they negotiate in discourse. This display of patterns of bonds is aligned with (i) Martin et al.'s (2013) argument that social bonds can be seen to cluster as belongings of different orders and (ii) Zappavigna's (2014, p. 223) argument that "identities are patterns of meaning inflected by membership in networks of fellowship" which position language users to enact particular configurations of bonds.

This view of networks of bonds helps to interpret each terrorist's worldview as opposing axiological constellations (i.e. 'We' versus 'They'- centred constellations). Aligned with Doran's (2019) suggestion that axiological constellations can be seen and interpreted as

networks of bonds, the incited communities are viewed as being encouraged to distinguish between who is insider/supporter and who is outsider/threat through these networks of bonds. Accordingly, the axiology of the incitees at risk or under threat can turn out to be their foundation in driving towards violence – which is a role of axiology argued for by Burgess (2012) – turning the inter-group conflict into an axiological and valuation issue. The next section presents the clusters of bonds realised in the incitement texts.

6.2.3 Bond clusters in the inciting texts

The analysis has shown a commonality in the dataset. Each terrorist was engaged in a continuous, dynamic production of binary (i.e. 'Our good' versus 'Their bad') bonds, which enabled identification of an account of bonds that facilitated understanding of localized (i.e. text level) bond clusters realised – in Zappavigna's (2014) terms – as patterns of collocative values. Hereafter, a pattern of collocative values refers to a localized bond cluster in which a general ideation (e.g. Muslims, immigrants) collocates with a general positive or negative value, in each text and across the texts of each terrorist. This account assisted in:

- Realising the overall prosodic structure resulting from this unfolding of collocative values;
- Providing insights into the unfolding categories of ideational targets and related attitudes in discourse (see e.g. Doran 2019).

In the following subsections, a global lens is provided on the clusters of bonds in and across each terrorist's texts, and how these clusters reveal each terrorist's worldview in discourse. In addition, I provide:

- The constellation associated with 'Our' positively charged ideations – including social actors, terms (e.g. egalitarianism) and ideas (e.g. to become a minority, freedom) which convey implicit evaluative language known as affording attitude (see e.g. Doran, 2019) – with which the incitees are positioned to align.
- The constellation opposed to 'Us', and the negatively charged experiences with which the incitees are positioned to disalign.

6.2.3.1 Bond clusters in the OBL incitement texts

The overall bond clusters activated and shared in the OBL texts were predominantly realised as We-centred versus They-centred constellations. In the former constellation, positive values to align with collocated with Muslims, their Tawhid (i.e. monotheist) creed, and jihad. In the latter, negative values to disalign with collocated with America, pro-US regimes, non-Muslims, and alternative approaches to jihad (e.g. democracy). Table 6.2 summarises these constellations.

Table 6.2: Constellations across the OBL texts

Linguistic resources	Aligning with (positively charged)
Positive ATTITUDE-based couplings	Muslims
	Tawhid
	Jihad
Negative ATTITUDE-based couplings	disaligning with (negatively charged)
	America and pro-US regimes (e.g. Israel, Saudi regime)
	non-Muslims
	alternative approaches to jihad (e.g. democracy, parliamentary elections)

Focusing on the bond clusters activated, OBL tended to table throughout his texts four main bonds, meaning that his beliefs, worldview and collocative values were relatively stable in his texts. Tabling *tawhid* bonds activated the ‘good Muslims/monotheists’ bond cluster in all OBL’s texts. These bonds were predominantly realised by APPRECIATION-based couplings. These couplings (i) enacted solidarity and inclusiveness via forging Islam as a shared master identity and a basis for a ‘religious superiority’, as in 21-a, and (ii) constructed Muslims as being victimised and humiliated. This latter construction gave rise to the second primary bond

cluster, a 'victimised Muslims' bond cluster. In OBL's texts this cluster was predominantly realised by JUDGEMENT-based couplings, as in 21-b.

(21)

a. ...to the best Ummah ever raised to humanity...to our Muslim Ummah

[Ummah (i.e. Muslim community or nation worldwide) / invoked + APPRECIATION]

b. Since about 80 years ago [...] our sons are being killed, its [our ummah's] blood is being shed, its sanctities are being attacked...

[our sons / + JUDGEMENT]

[it's blood / + JUDGEMENT]

[sanctities (of our Ummah) / + JUDGEMENT]

The 'good Muslims' and 'victimised Muslims' bond clusters were activated in opposition to the 'non-believer victimiser' bond cluster in all OBL's texts. This was predominantly realised via negative JUDGEMENT-based couplings (including JUDGEMENT invoked via APPRECIATION) which constructed outgroups as a threat. This opposition built a text structure that is – in Maton's (2014, p. 20) terms – "condensed with axiological meanings and charged positively and negatively". As such, the 'good monotheists' and 'victimised Muslims' bonds represent – in Wignell, Tan and O'Halloran's (2017) terms – the 'anti-side' of *tawhid*, from the al-Qaeda's perspective. This perspective includes rejecting difference and positioning the anti-world's people and things together, including Muslims who are not in favour of OBL's view of the inter-group conflict. Consider Example 21-c, taken from OBL4 inciting the Muslim Ummah, where the Americans are constructed as anti-Muslim crusaders. This construction of the anti-world, based on who 'They' are and what 'They' are doing to 'Us', presents the bonds as a form of "identity work" and tables bonds within a "diagnostic framing" (Benford & Snow, 2000; Smith, 2018; Etaywe, 2022b, p. 5). That is, these bonds focus on construing meanings of victimisation and injustices and who is to blame, in a step towards managing the awareness of the victimised and stimulating their attitude and action towards a shared enterprise against the victimiser.

c. They [Bush and his supporters] came out to fight Islam under the falsifying name of 'fighting terrorism'.

[They / - JUDGEMENT]

Enacting *jihad* bonds, the ‘good jihad’ cluster was activated as a fourth primary cluster in all OBL’s texts. This cluster was predominantly realised via positive ATTITUDE-based couplings (as in 21-d). This cluster beautifies the invitation to pursue jihad as the right path to follow, the means to triumph over the non-believer victimisers, an act of heroism, a duty, and so forth.

d. *Jihad is a needed duty...*

[jihad / + JUDGEMENT]

As such, jihad bonds were tabled within a “prognostic framing” (Benford & Snow, 2000; Smith, 2018; Etaywe, 2022b, p. 5). That is, they serve to articulate a solution for the victimised and to enact and promote a pledge of self-defence that is aligned with the *Tawhid* value, as expressed in OBL2:

- *...permitting what Allah has banned such as joining the legislative councils, or **banning** what Allah has permitted such as **Jihad** for His cause, would be associating them as other gods with Allah.*

6.2.3.2 Bond clusters in al-Baghdadi incitement texts

The overall bond clusters activated in al-Baghdadi’s texts were realised in positive values collocating the Sunnis Muslims, Islam, ISIS, jihad, mujahidin and martyrdom to align with them. These clusters were activated in opposition to the They-centred constellation where negative values collocated with ‘outsiders’. These outsiders include non-Muslims, Muslim Shiite and Sunni Muslims non-adherent to ISIS ideology, America and pro-US states and regimes (e.g. Saudi monarchy, King of Jordan, UAE rulers, Turkey, the Kurds) to disalign with. Table 6.3 summarises these constellations.

Table 6.3: Constellations across al-Baghdadi's texts

Linguistic resources	Aligning with (positively charged)
Positive ATTITUDE-based couplings	Ahl as-Sunnah (i.e. the Sunni Muslims); Islam
	ISIS
	Jihad; mujahidin; martyrhood
Negative ATTITUDE-based couplings	disaligning with (negatively charged)
	America; Europe; pro-US regimes and states (e.g. UAE, Saudi Arabia); Turkey; the Russians
	non-Muslims; polytheists; apostates; <i>the Rafida/the Magian</i> (i.e. Iran and the pro-Iranian militias); the <i>Nusayri</i> (i.e. al-Asad regime of Syria and his supporting factions)

Like OBL, al-Baghdadi tabled four primary bonds throughout his texts. Enacting *tawhid* bonds, the 'good Islam' bond cluster was activated via forging the Sunni identity, as in 22-a where the 'Islam is glory-bringer' bond is tabled. The 'victimised Sunnis' bond cluster was also activated. This cluster was predominantly realised via JUDGEMENT and APPRECIATION-based couplings, as in 22-b where al-Baghdadi constructs the Sunnis in Iraq as undergoing humiliation and disgrace brought about by *the Rafida*.

(22)

a. It was only **through Islam** [...] that Allah gave glory to you.
[Islam / invoked + APPRECIATION]

b. O **Ahl as-Sunna in Iraq**, is it that every single time you show no sense? **You** tasted humiliation and disgrace to the extent that you grazed on it...
[you (Ahl as-Sunna in Iraq) / invoked - JUDGEMENT]

While the previous two bond clusters enabled al-Baghdadi to enact solidarity and inclusiveness, tabling these bonds established a basis for activating the 'non-believer victimiser/expansionist' cluster associated with the threatening outgroups. This third cluster was predominantly realised via negative JUDGEMENT-based couplings, and it served to reject and exclude outgroups victimising the Sunnis or expanding at the expense of their regions in

Syria, Iraq and elsewhere. Consider example 22-c where *the Rafida* (i.e. the pro-Iran militias) are constructed not only as rejectionists of the ‘true’ Islam version of Sunnism as claimed by ISIS but also as expansionist and victimiser of the Sunnis in Iraq.

c. ***¹They [the Rafida] raid your lands under the pretext of waging war against the Islamic State, ²then they do not depart until they have either killed your men ³and taken your women and children prisoner ⁴or until they have driven them out.***

1 [they (the Rafida) / -JUDGEMENT]

2 [they / -JUDGEMENT]

3 [they / -JUDGEMENT]

4 [they / -JUDGEMENT]

Like OBL, the construction of ‘Us’ versus ‘Them’ within the framework of victimisation was exploited by al-Baghdadi in mobilizing the victims and adherents to ISIS ideology into jihad – a fourth bond cluster which was predominantly realised via positive JUDGEMENT and positive APPRECIATION-based couplings. Enacting jihad bonds served to promote the alleged ISIS’ pledge towards Islam (as in Example 22-d), and to construct jihad within a prognostic framing as being (Example 22-e): a vengeful act; a pathway to victory and defending honour and religion; an act of pleasing Allah; and a sign of love of believers and hate of non-believers. This love/hate relationship is based on the *al-wala wal-bara* (i.e. loyalty and disavowal) Salafist Wahhabi principle which ideologically signifies ‘Us’ versus ‘Them’ groups based on loving and hating for the sake of Allah.

d. *So there must be a **vanguard** that makes sacrifices and becomes the arch through which the umma passes in order to enter the realms of honour and dignity.*

[ISIS / + APPRECIATION]

e. *O people of Ninawa...¹**Beware** of becoming weak in waging jihad against your enemy and repelling them [the Rafidi], ²for indeed, this will undo the bonds of Islam and extinguish the light of truth.*

1 [(being weak to wage jihad) / - APPRECIATION] invoking - JUDGEMENT

2 [this (not waging jihad) / - JUDGEMENT]

The similarity in bond clusters between OBL and al-Baghdadi’s texts can be ascribed to similarity in religious ideology. In addition, the bond clusters have given rise to a kind of “code strategy” (cf. Prideaux, 2009, p. 291), that is, an exploitation of fundamental negative-versus-positive bonds that can indicate a confrontational discourse that not only achieves communion and alienation within the victimisation paradigm but also proposes solutions (i.e.

jihad) for the constructed threat or victimiser. These findings provide support to previous research (e.g. Ascone, 2020) showing that the victimisation relationship is a characteristic of jihadist discourse deployed to enhance the persuasiveness of the texts to sympathizers.

6.2.3.3 Bond clusters in Tarrant's inciting messages

The bond clusters activated in Tarrant's texts were realised as a 'We'-centred constellation in opposition to a 'They'-centred constellation. In the former, positive values collocated with being White (race, fertility level, culture, religion, environment, cities, hierarchy, etc.) and violence to align with. In the latter, negative values collocated with the following, to disalign with: immigrants (e.g. Muslim immigrants, the Turks); state, politicians and corporate entities, leftists, NGOs and economic elites facilitating immigration; and anti-White terms and ideas (e.g. multiculturalism, democracy). Table 6.4 summarises these constellations.

Table 6.4: Constellations across Tarrant's texts

Linguistic resources	Aligning with (positively charged)
Positive ATTITUDE-based couplings	Whiteness; Europeanness
	Fertility; (better) birthrate; popularism; violence and radicalized solutions
Negative ATTITUDE-based couplings	disaligning with (negatively charged)
	Immigrants; Marxist; communists; Muslims; state; corporates; leftists; NGOs; economic elites
	Immigration; replacement; multiculturalism; democracy; Europeanization; capitalist markets; globalist culture; urbanization; industrialization; drug dealing; nihilism; consumerism; individualism

Tarrant's inciting texts activated a set of bond clusters. These, which all imply opposing clusters, were the following: 'White West is best yet threatened' by replacement; 'good hierarchy and inequality'; and 'radicalization/fight is right'. Like OBL and al-Baghdadi's

prognostic framing of violent acts, Tarrant's 'fight is right' bonds were tabled to propose and negotiate radical actions against those involved in the alleged 'conspiracy' of immigrants' influx targeting Whites. These actions were prescribed so that Whites avoid becoming a minority and thus losing power; which gave rise to three more bond clusters: 'becoming minority is bad'; 'immigrants are anti-White'; and 'state and corporate entities are anti-White'. These six clusters were predominantly realised by APPRECIATION and JUDGEMENT-based couplings.

Enacting the 'White West is best yet threatened' bonds, Tarrant enacted solidarity and inclusiveness and constructed who 'We' are via forging Whiteness and Europeaness as shared master identity. The West is best bonds have established a basis for the 'West' and 'the Rest' as a binary opposition in terms of power relations and civilization via alluding to the historical discourse about the West and Rest (see Turner & Kühn, 2019; van der Dussen, 2016) – see Chandler (2017) for a summary on the use of binary oppositions as a way of understanding the world. Consider Example 23-a where preserving ethnonationalist traditions and unity are considered a strength, unlike diversity and multiculturalism. While considering the West as the best, Tarrant blames Western men and women for a situation where while immigrants have strong cultures, the West is experiencing *decay* and *degenerate* culture due to, for example, abandoning traditions, failure to reproduce, killing the notion of God, accepting nihilism, consumerism, individualism, depravity-popstars, bad priests and politicians, drug use, mounting suicide rates and divorce rates, and urbanization – see Example 23-b. As such, modernity, globalization, prioritizing individualism and challenging ingroup traditions tend to provide justification for violence, since they impede the formation and maintenance of identity and power (see e.g. Atran, 2015; Habermas, 2004; Malešević, 2010).

(23)

a. ¹*Unity, purpose, trust, traditions, nationalism and racial nationalism is what provides strength.* ²*Everything else is just a catchphrase.*

1 [unity, purpose, trust... / + APPRECIATION]

2 [Everything else / - APPRECIATION]

b. ¹*The truth that **the West** killed the notion of god, ²*and proceeded to replace it with nothing. [...]* ³*Resulting in a **society** with no core beliefs, no purpose and no vision for the future.**

- 1 [the West / - JUDGEMENT]
- 2 [the West / - JUDGEMENT]
- 3 [a (Western) society / - JUDGEMENT]

Enacting 'good hierarchy and inequality' bonds, Tarrant maintained his argument against democracy and egalitarianism as disadvantageous ideas and concepts in relation to White superiority. While democracy is considered a mob rule controlled by enemies of Whites, Tarrant, as in Example 23-c, emphasizes that diversity entails inequality and thus hierarchy is a must while egalitarianism is wrong.

c. ¹**Diversity** by its very definition belies equality.
[diversity / - APPRECIATION]

Enacting 'becoming minority is bad' bonds, Tarrant warned Whites of becoming an ethnic, linguistic and cultural (and so forth) minority. Tarrant considers becoming a minority a lead to oppression, foreignness, less cultural and political representation, isolation, exclusion, and loss of power and control, and thus *unwise* to accept or not to fight against (as in 23-d).

d. ¹*The same [ethnic and racial minority] people will find themselves gradually less and less represented both politically and culturally, ²becoming essentially foreigners in their own lands.*

- 1 [people in ethnic and racial minority / - APPRECIATION]
- 2 [people in ethnic and racial minority / - APPRECIATION]

Enacting 'immigrants are anti-White' bonds, Tarrant promoted the negative construction of non-White immigrants as a threat. While considering the *melting pot* society a *myth*, Tarrant maintained a description of mass immigration as an assault on Whites' race, prosperity and sovereignty by unarmed invaders (as in 23-e), the impacts of which take the forms of environmental warfare, racial replacement and white genocide (see Example 23-f).

e. **THE UNARMED INVADER IS MORE DANGEROUS THA[N] THE ARMED.**
[(immigrants) / - JUDGEMENT]

f. ¹*This is racial replacement. ²This is WHITE GENOCIDE.*

- 1 [this (mass immigration and immigrants' birthrates) / - APPRECIATION]
- 2 [this / - APPRECIATION]

Enacting 'state and corporate entities are anti-White' bonds, Tarrant maintained a negative view of another source of threat, that is, outgroups from within European societies. These outgroups include leftist politicians tolerating immigration and Europeanisation (i.e.

citizenship grants) (Example 23-g), and economic elites and trade-capital owners benefiting from cheap migrant labour and accused of greed, in '*increasing profit margins*', and hindering an '*ethnocentric European future*' (Example 23-h). Those outgroups are constructed as contra White interests, power and tradition.

g. When non-Europeans are considered Europe, then there is no Europe at all.
[considering the non-European European by citizenship grants) / -APPRECIATION]

h. Nothing drives the invasion more and nothing needs to be defeated more than the **greed** that demands cheap labour.
[greed (of capital owners) / - JUDGEMENT]

Enacting 'radicalization/fight is right' bonds, Tarrant urged violent actions to allegedly defend the White, win the cultural competition against the constructed threats, and create a new, strong society. Tarrant tabled the 'fight is right' bonds to promote violence, civil war, killing those facilitating the mass immigration, and risk-taking, as a must to be rid of the global power structure (see e.g. 23-i); whereas he considers inaction, gradual change or non-revolutionary change as a defeat. To beautify the possibility that White men and women might be killed in this violence, Tarrant presents himself and like-minded White people as a '*vanguard force*' in service of the European nations (Example 23-j). This rewarding death theme and presenting self as a vanguard were also common in OBL's and al-Baghdadi's texts.

i. Therefore we must destabilize and discomfort society wherever possible.
[to stabilize and discomfort / + APPRECIATION (invoking + JUDGEMENT)]

k. **The people** speaking now, acting now, **fighting now**, are the vanguard of the vanguard of the force of the people.
[the people...fighting now / + APPRECIATION (invoking + JUDGEMENT)]

6.3 Moral foundations for endorsing bonds and licensing violence

This section argues for the moral motivations behind the bonds tabled and the moral coerciveness of the incitement texts. That is, it explores the moral reasonings (i.e. the meta-values) regulating evaluative couplings and the rationale behind the incited violence. It also considers how the activation of particular moral foundations draws on the ingroup's "basic moral perspective (BMP)", that is, the ingroup members' assumptions and predisposition (Parvaresh, 2019, p. 79). The BMP can provide a clue as to how certain experiences are responded to and how social roles, expectations, rights and duties are activated.

The analysis has revealed that the evaluative couplings in the dataset are not an “unregulated outburst of aggression” (Kádár, 2017, p. 31). They follow an identifiable pattern (i.e. a morally-founded disposition), whereby each terrorist presents themselves and their incitees as deontic participants motivated by certain moral meta-values. Six meta-values were identified as regulators of the inter-group relationships (see Table 6.5).

Table 6.5: Summary of the meta-values used in the inciting texts

Taxonomy	Moral foundations/ meta-values	Frequency			Total
		OBL	Al-Baghdadi	Tarrant	
Relational links	ingroup/(dis)loyalty	55	55	67	177
	authority/(dis)respect	23	20	14	57
	purity/degradation	1	6	15	22
Interpersonal treatment	harm/care	8	34	40	82
	liberty/oppression	25	32	2	59
	fairness/reciprocity	3	1	14	18

Table 6.5 shows that the meta-values belong to two main groups (detailed in subsequent subsections):

- 'Relational (i.e. binding) links' meta-values: which include ingroup/(dis)loyalty, authority/(dis)respect, and purity/degradation.
- 'Interpersonal treatment' meta-values: which include liberty/oppression, harm/care, and fairness/cheating.

The ingroup/(dis)loyalty meta-value was the dominant foundation across the three terrorists dataset, presenting this meta-value as the key pedestal for polarisation, showing care and respect for traditions, creating coalitions and inciting for violence, and thus as a locus for the remaining foundations that are contingent on defining who 'We' are (not). Before reporting and discussing the meta-values in detail, I make note here that, while the analysis has revealed that a meta-value or a combination of meta values has tended to underpin a series

of couplings at a time, I will be exemplifying each meta-value at a time. In the following, attention is drawn to the couplings underpinned by each meta-value at a time.

6.3.1 Ingroup/(dis)loyalty

Ingroup/(dis)loyalty underpins bonds related to obligations of group membership, virtues and practices of self-sacrifice, loyalty to the ingroup, and vigilance against betrayal and shifting coalitions. The evaluative couplings here attest to the presence of expectations about the need to maintain a strong coalition against outgroups. To clarify how values associated with (dis)loyalty may influence the creation of evaluative couplings, consider Example 24 and the JUDGEMENT-based couplings there, with a focus on structure in bold. In Example 24-a, taken from OBL6 which incites against the Saudi regime, OBL negatively evaluates Prince Abdullah for an act of betrayal, loyalty to the Americans at the expense of Muslim lands, and using these lands to target Iraq and other Muslim countries militarily. In 24-b, taken from al-Baghdadi¹ inciting the Sunnis against their rulers, al-Baghdadi describes the rulers as practicing the lowest forms of treachery. In 24-c – where Tarrant incites European men and women not to pay taxes to the state that gives the Whites' money to people who *despise* Whites – Tarrant describes the European nations as being ruled by non-loyal men and women.

(24)

a. Before that, **he** [Prince Abdullah of Saudi Arabia] **betrayed** the two holy mosques when **he allowed the Americans to enter the country of the two holy mosques** under the false allegations of the need for their assistance...

b. O Ahl as-Sunna, your **rulers** in the region have practiced the lowest and most despicable form of **treachery** history has known, for **they sold your issue and surrendered your affair and your land to your enemy.**

c. **Until** our nations are run by **men and women loyal** to our cause[,], taxation should be considered theft, and **refusal to pay taxes a sign of racial loyalty.**

As such, evaluative couplings seem to be deployed – in Ståhl, Zaal and Skitka's (2016) terms – in response to signs of disloyalty and to serve the purpose of preserving a strong union. In other words, what appears to have triggered the considerations of morality in these situations is each terrorist's expectation that people of the ingroup should be vigilant of and move against disloyalty. The negative evaluative couplings concerning Others can best be described as "*reactions to an allegedly immoral/inappropriate action*" (Kádár, 2017, p. 33), the

realisation of which is grounded in the participants' BMP. Dis/loyalty, thus, can underpin the interpretive and evaluative process (Haugh, 2015), and has a bearing on how each terrorist reacts and expects the ingroup members to react to social actions. In addition, the activation of the (dis)loyalty foundation invites activation of a set of expectations such as devotion to the cause of the ingroup. However, accusing Others of the unfulfillment of these expectations leads to aggressive, negative evaluation. Drawing on this moral foundation serves to brand OBL and al-Baghdadi as loyal warriors dedicated to an Islamic coalition against the outgroups; and so is Tarrant to his Christian and ethnic group. As such, the activation of this foundation supports van Langenhove's (2017) argument that moral foundation considerations enable explanation of how structures influence agents and are created through agency.

6.3.2 Authority/(dis)respect

Authority/(dis)respect underlies bonds related to social order and obligations of hierarchical social relationships and interactions (see Haidt, 2012). Evaluative couplings here attest to the presence of expectations about virtues such as obedience, leadership, followership, respect for traditions, respect of legitimate authority and subversion against an authority considered illegitimate. Put differently, social values associated with authority/(dis)respect influence how evaluative couplings are formed. Consider Example 25 and the JUDGEMENT-based couplings there. In Example 25-a, taken from OBL7 inciting the Pakistani people to support the Afghans in their jihad against the Americans, OBL perceives *Mullah Mohammad Omar* positively as a leader aligned with Allah's voice while OBL and the mujahidin are constructed as respectful subordinates and followers of that leader.

(25)

a. *I convey glad tidings to you brothers, announcing that **we are steadfast in the path of jihad ... under the leadership of our Mujahid emir [i.e. leader], who is proud of his religion, the Commander of the faithful, Mullah Mohammad Omar.***

In Example 25-b, taken from OBL6 inciting disobeying and toppling Muslim countries' rulers and rejecting Prince Abdullah bin Abdulaziz's initiative for Peace with Israel, Prince Abdullah is viewed negatively as someone who disrespects traditions by supporting non-Muslims and following in the footsteps of another illegitimate leader (i.e. his father). In 25-c, taken from al-Baghdadi2 inciting the Sunnis in Syria against the commanders of *Sahwa* (awakening)

factions, al-Baghdadi negatively views those commanders and officers for being dishonest, deceivers of their followers, supporting *the Nusayri taghut* (i.e. the Syrian regime) and fighting with him against ISIS and the Sunnis. In 25-d, in inciting a swift taking over of European cities and decision-making institutions, Tarrant negatively views the politicians controlling these cities as being anti-White and thus that they ought to be changed.

b. By announcing the initiative, **he** [Prince Abdullah of Saudi Arabia] is **following** the footsteps of **his father** who **aborted** 1936 CE/1354 H Intifada with a **false promise** to the Palestinians from him and the English government, thus **tricking** the Palestinians, **stopping their Intifada**, and **continuing the occupation** until ... **Palestine was handed over to the Jews**.

c. Therefore, O soldiers of the Sahwa factions in Syria, ...what situation **your commanders and the officers of your faction** are leading you to? **They deceived you and seduced you** with supporting ahl al-Sunna in Syria after **claiming** to have split away from and opposed the **Nusayri taghut**. But today, **they reconcile with him and stand with him side by side in fighting the Khilafa State...**

d. ...it's the cities where the **anti-white politicians** and the NGOs make their homes.

As such, evaluative couplings were deployed in response to signs of 'illegitimate' leadership and to serve to preserve the integrity of (the 'ought to be') established hierarchies. What appears to have triggered the considerations of morality in these instances is the terrorists' expectation that authorities and leaders should work for their own particular social groups; otherwise, authority subversion should be accepted. These considerations operate – in Haidt's (2012, p. 168) terms – by “look[ing] in two directions – up towards superiors [e.g. Allah, Islamic traditions, pro-White traditions] and down towards subordinates”. That is, couplings appear to be in response to the perception of leaders' conduct as being a violation of the ingroup traditions and interests, which occasion the negative evaluations of alienated leaders and reinforce the call for subordinates to align with the inciters' proposals. The evaluative couplings were, thus, reactions to allegedly immoral actions, which are contra participants' BMP. The underpinning authority/(dis)respect serves to support not only OBL's and al-Baghdadi's discourse as being an echo of the concerns of Muslim countries in relation to subversion against illegitimate rulers (see e.g. Miller, 2015), but also Tarrant's discourse as echoing the White supremacists' concerns.

6.3.3 Purity/degradation

Purity/degradation underlies evaluative couplings related to concerns about striving to live in sanctity and distant from physical and spiritual contagion. The evaluative couplings here attest to the presence of expectations about virtues of chastity, control of desires and avoidance of the degradation of entities. Such social values influence the creation of the evaluative couplings as per considerations of conceptualising self (or an ingroup), body or something as an entity that should attain purity, or a temple that should not be desecrated (see e.g. Graham et al. 2011; Lai, Haidt & Nosek, 2014; Parvaresh, 2019).

Consider the JUDGEMENT-based and APPRECIATION-based couplings in Example 26. In Example 26-a, taken from OBL6 inciting against Prince Abdullah of Saudi Arabia who permitted the Americans' entrance into the land of the two holy mosques, OBL draws on Muslims' BMP about protecting this land from polytheists' desecration, grounded in understanding a Quranic verse – from the *At-Tawbah* (i.e. The Repentance) chapter: "O believers! Indeed, the polytheists are 'spiritually' impure, so they should not approach the Sacred Mosque after this year". The same meaning is drawn on in al-Baghdadi1 where al-Baghdadi deploys the prophetic saying: *Remember the final will of your prophet SAW that "there cannot exist two religions in the peninsula of the Arabs"*. In addition, al-Baghdadi activated the 'purity' value to incite the Sunnis to be patient and steadfast in jihad, through presenting the suffering of some defeats, trials and tribulations as being *like a doctor* and Godly acts to purify the Muslims' souls from arrogance and transgression – as in 26-b. Couplings in 26-c also attest to Tarrant's expectations about the chastity of European women and how *non-White scum* (i.e. immigrants) are polluting it. The same moral theme underpins Tarrant's evaluations elsewhere to serve to encourage actions against suicide rates, drug addiction, pedophile persons, suicidal pop icons, and ignorance of environmental health. Purity/degradation considerations, as such, serve the right to enjoy and protect sanctities, and assign blame to those committing acts of desecration and soul/body/environment pollution.

(26)

a. *Before that, he [Prince Abdullah of Saudi Arabia] betrayed the two holy mosques when he allowed the Americans to enter the country of the two holy mosques...*

- b. *...if Allah were to always give victory to the believers over their enemies everywhere and always grant them consolidation and domination over their enemies, their souls would have transgressed and become arrogant.*
- c. *But what few know is that Rotherham is just one of an ongoing trend of rape and molestation perpetrated by these **non-white scum**.*

What seems to have triggered the considerations of morality in these situations is the terrorists' expectation that the ingroup entities must be protected. The negative evaluative couplings thus come in reaction to allegedly immoral actions by social actors alienated in discourse. The findings provide support to previous studies (e.g. Haidt, Graham & Joseph, 2009; Smith et. al, 2014; Parvaresh & Tayebi, 2018; Parvaresh, 2019) that have found notions of purity linked to Western, rightist, Eastern and Muslim societies' practices of derogation, stigmatization and discrimination. So far, evaluative couplings have been found to be underpinned by social values related to relational and binding foundations. The remaining meta-values focus on providing, regaining and protecting the ingroup's rights.

6.3.4 Liberty/oppression

The liberty/oppression meta-value underlies bonds concerned with reactions and resentment that an inciter feels towards those dominating the 'Us' group or restricting 'Our' right to **freedom**. Evaluative couplings are thus deployed in response to hatred and actions of dominators or to signs of restricting 'Our' freedom, and to serve to encourage actions to preserve freedom and to come together in solidarity to topple or overcome the oppressors. Consider the JUDGEMENT-based couplings in Example 27. In Example 27-a, OBL deploys negative evaluations to serve to motivate ingroup members to come into solidarity, rise and accept death to be rid of the oppressors and regain dignity and freedom. Al-Baghdadi, as in Example 27-b, creates awareness about those plotting against the Sunnis' freedom, in inciting for 'justified' hostility and aggression. Tarrant, as in Example 27-c, manages awareness about the negative role of immigrants and the Marxists, viewing them as being *invaders* from whom European cities should be freed.

(27)

- a. *O Ummah, Rise up and stand against [...] **tyranny, oppression, aggression, humiliation and contempt**, for...our property is not more valuable than our **dignity**, and death is not more difficult for us than to **live in humiliation and contempt**...*

b. ...here is **the disbelieving world** today having mobilized, called out, formed coalitions and parties, and gathered all its strength, partners, allies, and awliya **to wage war against Islam and its people and to plot against the believers and their religion...**

c. It's the cities where the struggle lies, it's the cities where the **invaders** have massed, it's the cities where **the Marxists** have poisoned the institutions...

Evaluative couplings, as such, attest to the presence of expectations about the right to enjoy and protect freedom. The realisation of outgroups' actions as being immoral appears to be grounded in the ingroup's BMP of the right to protect Self from restrictions on 'Our' freedom and 'Our' upper hand. Considerations of the liberty/oppression foundation can thus serve to promote violence as rational in reaction to the hatred and negative actions of dominators.

6.3.5 Fairness/cheating

Fairness/cheating underpins bonds concerned with **equality**, and with in-kind reciprocal treatment including virtues of altruism, compassion and being considerate of the ill-treatment directed at members of the ingroup. Evaluative couplings here attest that what appears to have triggered the considerations of morality is the presence of expectations about the need to maintain fair treatment and prevent exploitation. By reference to these considerations, a terrorist's evaluations come in reaction to a situation of alleged immoral actions of cheating in saying and doing, and alleged inequality. Consider Example 28. In Example 28-a, in relation to the US war on Iraq, OBL couples the US soldiers and government with acts of lying concerning fighting terrorism, hence the evaluative couplings respond to signs of cheating and unfairness. The US soldiers are coupled with the unfair cause of fighting, making gains via illegitimate access (e.g. selling arms), and supporting evil (e.g. *the criminal gang at the White House, usury takers, and capitalists*) to access 'Our' resources (i.e. stealing 'Our' oil). Considerations of the immorality of these US actions also promote OBL as the adversary of unfair capitalism and illegitimate control over Muslims' resources – a negative view of globalization driven by greed is also identified in Tarrant's texts to urge preservation of the resources and thrift of the White. In 28-b, al-Baghdadi also promotes ISIS as a Sunni group committed to jihad in rejection of the injustices against the Sunni people. Unlike OBL and al-Baghdadi who incite violence against inequality and unfairness, Tarrant, as in 28-c, defends inequality and views equality and fairness in treatment as being inappropriate in a diverse society, laying the ground for unfair treatment towards people from different

ethnicities and cultures. Tarrant's evaluative couplings, as such, appear to have been triggered by expectations about the need to maintain the superiority of the White over: *race[s] of low intellect, low agency, muddled, muddled masses.*

(28)

- a. *Those [US] soldiers are completely convinced of the injustice and lying of their government. They also lack a fair cause to defend. They only fight for capitalists, usury takers, and the merchants of arms and oil, including the criminal gang at the White House.*
- b. *The Islamic State is not confined to Hajin [a small city in Syria], for the sons of the Sunnah are warriors who do not sleep in the face of injustice.*
- c. *The more diverse a group becomes, the less equal it becomes. Diversity is anathema to equality.*

The couplings, nevertheless, serve to demand and promote radical acts (i) against equality and in-kind treatment, as in Tarrant's texts or (ii) against unfairness, as in OBL's call to Muslims to *work hard against this [US led] unjust campaign*. For the jihadist terrorists, considerations of fairness/cheating constitute – in Rae and Fiske (2011, p. 57) terms – a motive and a moral premise for the incitees to act and demand “balanced, in-kind reciprocity, equal treatment, equal say, and equal opportunity”.

6.3.6 Harm/care

The harm/care foundation underpins bonds about the pain of the ingroup members and the feeling of disliking that pain, and **vulnerability**. Evaluative couplings tend to be triggered by experiencing signs of suffering, and attest to the presence of expectations about the need to care for and defend the ingroup. To clarify how values associated with harm/care may influence how evaluative couplings are formed, consider the JUDGEMENT-based couplings in Example 29. In Example 29-a, in inciting suicide attacks such as those of the 9/11 attack on America and justifying them, OBL frames al-Qaeda acts within the ‘care’ for ‘*vulnerable sons, brothers and sisters*’ frame and in response to decades of humiliation and debasement exercised by the Americans and their Israeli allies against Muslims. Similarly, al-Baghdadi, as in 29-b, draws on this moral foundation to reflect care for those jihadists in captivity and to communicate sympathy, compassion and commitment to liberate them. Tarrant's couplings, as in 29-c, appear to be influenced by his feelings of care for future alleged vulnerability and destruction of White societies caused by immigrants (especially those coming from *China*,

Turkey and India), if not acting against them now and before their *reaching their own zeniths of power*.

(29)

a. When **these** [9/11 attackers] defended their vulnerable sons, brothers and sisters in Palestine and in many Islamic countries, the world at large screamed out.

b. To **our brothers** [...] tested with captivity: By Allah [...] **we have not forgotten you nor shall we ever forget you**... We ask that Allah make your liberation at our hands...

c. Also, relying on this time period [2028-2038, until most of the European boomers begin to pass] for our victory holds a second major disadvantage, that being vulnerability to foreign invasion...

The three terrorists, as such, tend to endorse the harm/care foundation to present themselves as ‘good’ action-takers and dis-likers of harm targeting the ingroup. The evaluative couplings deployed serve to morally justify violence in reaction to alleged vulnerability, and to urge for protecting the vulnerable ‘We’ group. The evaluative couplings can contribute to constructing a positive image of the terrorists, and the harm/care considerations may influence how an inciter takes up and responds in language to what they view as harmful to the ingroup.

6.3.7 Summary of the moral foundations

To conclude this section on moral foundations, each terrorist tends to endorse a range of similar binding and inter-group treatment meta-values that influenced and provided a logic to the construction of evaluative couplings. These couplings ultimately serve to position the inciter and incitee to morally tolerate and celebrate the incited violence against outgroups; an effect that accords with Reicher, Haslam and Rath’s (2008) argument that negative representation of outgroups makes eradicating them justified. Unlike Smith et al. (2014, p. 1560) who found that binding meta-values (e.g. loyalty, and respect for authority) do not “necessarily lead to ingroup favoritism (sic) and outgroup derogation”, these foundations were found to be doing so in the terrorist incitement texts. This finding, nevertheless, supports Smith et al.’s contention that the role of binding meta-values may vary across discourses, contexts and users, be they Western or not. Terrorists coming from “individualistic cultures” yet condemning them, (i.e. Tarrant), and “sociocentric cultures” (i.e. OBL and al-Baghdadi) (Haidt, 2012, p. 30) tended to use the same binding meta-values. In addition, endorsing the inter-group treatment meta-values, each terrorist sought not only to morally

condemn outgroups but also to enhance the terrorists' moral regard and audacious image, and the moral value of urged actions.

The similarities between the terrorists in drawing on similar meta-values could be ascribed to their extremism, the norms of the terrorist incitement genre, and that these foundations are – according to Spencer-Oatey and Kádár (2016) – universally applicable yet socio-culturally and contextually sensitive. Rhetorically speaking, the use of similar foundations is likely driven by the terrorists' need to enhance their credibility and the take-up of the communicated messages by the addressees, particularly adherents to each extremist's worldview. The best credibility effects are expected when an author produces their messages “in line with the psychological, social, political, cultural, religious [and more] predispositions [i.e. BMP] of the addressee” (Lehman, Sułkowski & Cap, 2019, p. 2). This evaluative construction enables the terrorists – in van Langenhove (2017) terms – to appropriate collective values and make them individual projects of the incitees, just as the terrorists appropriate their individual values and ideology and promote them as collective in a (dis)affiliative scene.

By leveraging a host of evaluative couplings underpinned by a set of meta-values, each terrorist tended to manufacture a social and moral anxiety and triggered emotions related to, for example, self-defence, self-preservation and rights to freedom. By reference to these stirred up emotions, the proposed violent goals/actions can be viewed as being in the service of “emotional goals” (Poggi, 2005, p. 315). ‘These meta-values enabled the construction of the Outgroups with incongruent moral values while presenting the inciter and the ingroup with congruent moral values. This (in)congruence is based on each terrorist's “truth criteria”, which are ideologically based (van Dijk 1998b, p. 30), and promoted by evaluative couplings that tap into individual/collective existing experiences, knowledge, beliefs and predisposition – thus reflecting a virtues-versus-vices ordering of the world. These moral foundations can serve to package the evaluative couplings within a “motivational framing” and in a consistent identity talk (Benford & Snow, 2000; Smith, 2018; Etaywe, 2022b, p. 5); that is, drawing on these foundations provides a call or moral rationale for engaging in corrective or ameliorative collective duty (e.g. jihad). As such, by drawing strategically on certain meta-values, the terrorists employed the evaluative couplings as resources rooted in morality to produce a morally coercive discourse to mobilize a degree of popular, culturally resonant and commonsensical support to violence. This accords with Haidt's (2001) argument that

behaviours and attitudes rooted in morality become intertwined with intuition, commonsensicality and emotions and are thus taken as correct and responding viscerally to counter-attitudinal challenges. Once the ways of perception of inter-group relations and defending rights are felt to be commonsensical, “they may become powerful tools for legitimating attitudes, behavior (sic), and policies” (Verschuere, 2012, p. 2) of the terrorist organisations and their adherents in resisting the outgroups’ ‘evil’.

In next section, I move from what could be viewed as the ‘bag of bonds’ view of discourse to focus on the rhetorical functions of the deployment of these bonds or evaluative couplings. This deployment is considered a function of the discursive purpose to which these couplings are strategically put in these inciting texts. These public texts drive the use of the ‘Our’ versus ‘Their’ moral evaluation categories to achieve two functions: coercing the ingroup members into an action, and legitimizing that action.

6.4 Rhetorical functions of couplings: (De)legitimizing and coercing

The previous section has shown that each terrorist tends to draw on certain themes of morality to produce a morally informed and morally coercive discourse. This section discusses one more form of coercion observed in every terrorist text in the dataset: coercing the addressees into a violent course of action via suggesting the action (Section 6.3.1). The focus of the remaining section is on the set of rhetorical, persuasive strategies whereby each terrorist tends to lend legitimacy to ‘punitive’ violent activities (Section 6.3.2).

6.4.1 The ‘coercing’ function

Each terrorist tends to coerce his incitees into violence through suggesting it as collective actions and goals to pursue. This is aligned with Cap’s (2017) argument that coercion can be achieved by suggesting actions via commanding (i.e. issuing ‘directive’ speech acts), suggesting and/or recommending certain actions to prevent or neutralize a constructed threat. The analysis has shown that each terrorist has not only constructed outgroups as a threat but also explicitly called for radical actions/goals towards which the addressees are encouraged to follow suit. For example, OBL coerces by calling for jihad and proposing it as a *must* to defend Self and to establish the ruling of Allah, and by reference to joining jihad as a *required* action to which each able man and women ‘*ought to chip in*’ (see the structures in

bold, Examples 30-a and b). OBL also promotes lists of options of jihad against humiliation and to restore dignity (Example 30-c) and uses the performative verb ‘*incite*’ (Example 30-d) to incite Muslims of Pakistan to defend against the US forces.

(30)

- a. *Thus, Muslims in general, and in Iraq in particular, **must roll up their sleeves of jihad, work hard** against this unjust campaign...*
- b. *Today, everyone is **required to join jihad** and be hardworking.*
- c. *Therefore, the means are **accessible and available** to everyone from this Ummah, and they are as follows:*
 - ***Rejecting*** the submissive initiative...
 - ***incitement to overthrow*** the heads of infidelity and hypocrisy...
 - ***Attacking*** American interests...
 - ***Boycott*** of American and Jewish products.
 - ***Killing*** the Americans with bullets, knives, stones, etc.
- d. *We **incite** our Muslim brothers in Pakistan to **defend**, with all that they possess and are capable of...*

Like OBL, al-Baghdadi tends to coerce his addressees into collective actions explicitly. For example, al-Baghdadi coerces by warning (Example 31-a) the Sunni people of Ninawa, Iraq, of the negative consequences of not waging jihad against the non-Sunni militias. He also coerces by commanding (Example 31-b) the men of the Arabian Peninsula to attack the Saudi ‘pro-Roman regime’ to avoid the negative consequences of accepting these regimes. Al-Baghdadi also coerces by referring to the ‘obviousness’ of the ‘reality’ (Example 31-c) that preserving the Sunni Muslims from extermination and establishing the state of Islam are contingent on confronting the enemy.

(31)

- a. *Therefore, O people of Ninawa [...] **Beware of becoming weak in waging jihad against your enemy and repelling them...***
- b. *Therefore, O men of the Arabian Peninsula, O grandsons of the Sahabah, **attack** them, following one attack with another...*
- c. *And **it goes without saying** that [...] **without...confronting the enemy’s massive war machine** – even if it leads to them [the Mujahidin] being wiped out – **this umma will not live and Islam will have no state.***

Tarrant also tends to explicitly suggest radical actions against the constructed threats to curb or win against them, be they immigrants, politicians controlling the institutions, economic elites, etc. Tarrant coerces by specifying the action (*must bleed his last...*) he urges the incitees to carry out against (Example 32-a) the President of Turkey, Erdogan, who is constructed as a religious and ethnic enemy. To emphasize the incited-for-actions, Tarrant tends to mention or summarise his suggested actions as ‘in all upper caps’ at the end of his messages, as in Example 32-b where Tarrant coerces by communicating commands to *kill* Merkel of Germany, Erdogan, and Sadiq Khan, the London Mayor, accusing them of being anti-White.

(32)

a. *Erdogan, the leader of one of the oldest enemies of our people [...] **This warlord must bleed his last**, whilst he visits his ethnic soldiers currently occupying Europe.*

b. **KILL ANGELA MERKEL, KILL ERDOGAN, KILL SADIQ KHAN**

In sum, besides grounding their worldviews in moral foundations to produce texts that can manufacture social anxiety and stimulate emotions and actions, the three terrorists tend to suggest violent actions as collective and value-serving goals. These suggestions serve to steer the incitees into specified actions to fight against, prevent or neutralize the constructed threat. That said, to manipulate the perception of the link between the incited-for actions and individual/collective concerns, and to maximize the value of the suggested actions/goals (see e.g. Poggi, 2005, p. 12), each terrorist tends to lend legitimacy to violence via a range of persuasive strategies. The next section reports and discusses the strategies utilized in the terrorist incitement texts to legitimate ingroup violence.

6.4.2 The ‘(de)legitimizing’ function

The analysis shows that the evaluative couplings mobilised in the incitement texts serve to achieve the (de)legitimizing function of these texts. Given that (de)legitimation, manipulation and persuasion become combined insofar as a social group “tries to impose or promote its ideology” and actions (van Dijk, 1998a, p. 258), the modes of persuasion whereby evaluative couplings (i.e. critique) were geared towards (de)legitimizing in the dataset have become identifiable. This section exhibits the rhetorical strategies used to gear critique towards legitimizing violence, unveiling the persuasive force of the incitement texts.

The analysis shows that the three inciters have repeatedly drawn on a combination of each of the following three options at a time (see Figure 6.5):

- Modes of persuasion (ethos, logs, and pathos);
- Themes of what is being (de)legitimated – (de)legitimation of actions, values, goals, membership, social position, and access to resources;
- General forms of critique dynamics – authorisation (i.e. doing X is good because some authority says so), moral evaluation, rationalization (i.e. by reference to the necessary, good or bad goals, effects and uses of some practices and social actions), and mythopoesis (i.e. through telling a story or a narrative with un/happy ending or symbolic action that represents a mythical model of action whose results de/legitimate it).



Figure 6.5: (De)Legitimation modes, themes and dynamics in the inciting texts

6.4.2.1 The (de)legitimizing function in OBL's incitement texts

The deployment of evaluative couplings in the dataset has provided support to previous research (e.g. van Leeuwen, 2007) on the role of interpersonal language as the most important vehicle for any attempts to establish and cultivate the addressees' belief in the legitimacy of actions of an individual or organization and its existence. For example, towards legitimating Self/ingroup, OBL tends to focus on legitimating 'Our' actions (i.e. *We* have the right to engage in what *We* do/ought to do) – see Table 6.6 – while delegitimizing the outgroups' actions, values, goals, membership and social position to serve in the cultivation of the legitimacy of their opposites (i.e. the ingroup's themes). While deploying various dynamics of critique, OBL has most frequently relied on ethos and logos to package his evaluative couplings (as signalled in bold in Table 6.6).

Table 6.6: Summary of (de)legitimation strategies – themes and modes – and their occurrences in OBL's inciting texts

Legitimation of 'Us'			
Themes	Occurrences	Modes	Occurrences
actions	46	ethos	25
values	3	logos	24
membership	4	pathos	5
social position	1	-	-
Delegitimation of 'Them'			
Themes	Occurrences	Modes	Occurrences
actions	8	ethos	17
values	9	logos	15
goals	3	pathos	0
membership	5	-	-
social position	7	-	-

To demonstrate how legitimization of action is established, consider Example 33. OBL (Example 33-a) appeals to the feelings (i.e. pathos) of pride, jealousy towards Islam, and the insecurity of Muslims, to legitimate the *mujahidin's* action (i.e. jihad), chiefly by moral evaluation, that is, by glorifying jihad and mujahidin and their role towards defending Islam. This is briefly annotated as 'pathos: legitimization of action: moral evaluation'. In Example 33-b, OBL legitimates actions against the US-led troops in Iraq by rationalization (i.e. by reference to the aim of the social action); that is, he recommends dragging the enemy into a long close combat, fighting in built up areas, and taking advantage of camouflaged positions in order to lure and overcome the 'enemy'. OBL does so by drawing on his experience in fighting the Americans in Afghanistan, which constructs his ethos as a credible, experienced character. In Example 33-c, OBL legitimates jihad through mythopoesis, that is, by reference to the 'happy' details and outcomes of the impact of mujahidin's jihad against the US interests in Iraq, and by presenting (via logos mode) these consequences of jihad as 'rational', exemplary punishment and 'expected' effort (signalled by *not surprisingly*).

(33)

a. To my brothers, **the mujahidin** in Iraq, to the heroes in Baghdad and its surroundings, to Ansar al-Islam, the descendants of Salahuddin, to the free people..., and to those who migrated for the cause of Allah so that **they** would fight in support of their religion... Today, you are the soldiers of Allah, the arrows of Islam, and the first line of defence of this Ummah.

pathos: legitimization of action: moral evaluation

b. **We also recommend the importance of luring the enemy forces into a long and exhausting close combat, taking advantage of the camouflaged defensive positions in the plains, farms, mountains and cities. The most fearful to the enemy is fighting in built up areas, a war in which the enemy expects heavy losses of lives.**

ethos: legitimization of action: rationalization

c. ...**it** [America] sought help from the canaille of people and begged the mercenary soldiers from the East and West. **Not surprisingly, you** did these deeds to America, and you showed it this exemplary punishment; You are the sons of those great knights...

logos: legitimization of action: mythopoesis

To enhance the value of the legitimated actions, OBL has delegitimated the outgroups, including Muslim rulers allying with them. OBL has negatively critiqued 'Their':

- Actions (i.e. 'They' have no right to engage in what they do or say, or to criminalize 'Our' actions);
- Values (i.e. 'Their' social values and norms are not 'Ours');
- Goals (i.e. 'They' come aiming to take advantage of our physical territories and to discredit 'Us', etc.);
- Membership (i.e. 'They' do not belong to 'Our' ingroup);
- Social positions ('They' are not 'real' or legitimate rulers). In so-doing, OBL has drawn on the four forms of critique dynamics, and primarily on two persuasive modes (ethos, and logos).

To exemplify the ethos-based delegitimation, where OBL appeals to audience values and the credibility of OBL, consider Example 34. OBL (Example 34-a) delegitimizes the actions of rulers and countries supporting the US-led war, via moral evaluation, that is, based on viewing pro-Americans as being hypocrites, evildoers, falsehood followers and pro-victimisers. In Example 34-b, OBL delegitimizes the *Crusaders'* goals by rationalization – that is, by reference to their preparations for war as being **aimed at** establishing the Greater Israel, occupying a Muslim country, looting Muslims' wealth, and so forth. In Example 34-c, OBL also delegitimizes the social position of the rulers of Muslim countries by moral evaluation, that is, by reference to these leaders as disgraceful to the ummah.

(34)

a. *The least that can be said to describe **these hypocrites** is: **they** are evildoers! They have followed the falsehood! They have supported the butcher ... They have supported the oppressor...*

ethos: delegitimation of action: moral evaluation

b. *We are following up with great care and concern the **Crusaders'** preparations for war to occupy the former capital of Islam, to loot Muslims' wealth, and appoint a puppet government which follows its masters in Washington and Tel Aviv- just like all other treasonous and traitor-agent Arab governments – in preparation for the establishment of the Greater Israel.*

ethos: delegitimation of goals: rationalization

c. *...how disgraced we have been since we came under the rule of the disgraceful leaders!*

ethos: delegitimation of social position: moral evaluation

In his logos-based delegitimation, OBL has deployed couplings that operate by persuading through logical argumentation. In Example 35-a, 'Their' action is delegitimated by couplings in the form of authorisation and moral evaluation, that is by reference to non-jihad/democratic solutions as serious misguidance (moral evaluation), against Allah's law (authorization), and showing inconsistency in Muslim different beliefs (moral evaluation). In Example 35-b, a goal of alienated governments is delegitimated by rationalization, that is, by reference to example governments – preceded by an 'obviousness' marker (*it is no secret*) – as being aimed at annihilating jihad and weakening the Muslim ummah for the advantage of the Americans.

(35)

a. It was, **therefore**, imperative to alert briefly to the seriousness of this misguided and misleading approach, which is against Allah's law...

logos: delegitimation of action: authorization & moral evaluation

b. It is no secret that any **government** formed by the United States is a traitor and collaborator government like...the governments of Karzai and Mahmud Abbas, which were created to annihilate Jihad.

logos: delegitimation of goals: rationalization

6.4.2.2 The (de)legitimizing function in al-Baghdadi's incitement texts

Like OBL, al-Baghdadi tends to legitimate the Self/ingroup with a focus on legitimating 'Our' actions – as displayed in Table 6.7. Alongside this, al-Baghdadi tends to delegitimize all other themes of the outgroups, which by contrast serves to reinforce the legitimacy of 'Our' action. While deploying the various forms of critique, al-Baghdadi has most frequently relied on ethos, followed in order of frequency by logos and pathos strategies (see Table 6.7).

Table 6.7: Summary of (de)legitimation strategies – themes and modes – and their occurrences in al-Baghdadi’s inciting texts

Legitimation of 'Us'			
Themes	Occurrences	Modes	Occurrences
actions	40	ethos	43
values	18	logos	24
membership	16	pathos	10
social position	1	-	-
goals	2	-	-
Delegitimation of 'Them'			
Themes	Occurrences	Modes	Occurrences
actions	9	ethos	14
values	3	logos	7
goals	6	pathos	8
membership	4	-	-
social position	7	-	-

To establish the legitimacy of ‘Our’ actions, al-Baghdadi also draws on the three modes of persuasion. In an ethos-based legitimation act (Example 36-a), al-Baghdadi legitimates by reference to jihad as a must or a top up of faith, and as a tool to confront the people of falsehood and other faiths, presenting himself as the knower, a ‘true’ faithful and a slave of Allah. In Example 36-b, a logos-based legitimation act, al-Baghdadi legitimates by reference to an authority who gives permission to fight when wronged. In Example 36-c, a pathos-based legitimation act, al-Baghdadi legitimates by rationalization, that is, by urging to wage jihad so that mujahidin defend the existence of Islam and the security of Muslims, as emphasised by a warning (realised in *beware*) that Muslims can be hurt from a mujahid’s direction.

(36)

a. *O slaves of Allah, indeed, **faith will not be complete** in the soul of the Jama’ah of the Muslims **until** the Jama’ah [i.e. collectivity] is exposed to – and makes preparations for – jihad against mankind over the matter of this faith and confronting the people of falsehood...*

ethos: legitimation of action: moral evaluation

b. Allah says, “**Permission has been given** to those who are being fought, because they were wronged.

logos: legitimization of action: authorization

c. O mujahideen for Allah’s cause! Know that today you are **the armor and strong fort of Islam**. **Beware** and, again, **beware**—may Allah have mercy upon you—**that Islam and Muslims be hurt from your direction**, for the sunan [i.e. norms] of Allah are not partial to anyone.

pathos: legitimization of action: rationalization

To enhance the legitimization of ‘Our’ action, al-Baghdadi also tends to delegitimize the Outgroups’ attributes and phenomena – consider Example 37. In an ethos-based delegitimation of action (Example 37-a), al-Baghdadi delegitimizes by moral evaluation, that is, by reference to the leaders of the Syrian Sahwa (i.e. awakening) factions as traitors – and the factions as disgracing – in supporting the Russians and al-Assad regime’s violence against Sunni majority cities. In a logos-based delegitimation act (Example 37-b), al-Baghdadi delegitimizes by moral evaluation and rationalization, that is, by reference to the Saudi regime’s negative values (disbelief and tyranny) and to their determination to Westernize and secularize the Sunnis. In a pathos-based delegitimation of goals (Example 37-c), al-Baghdadi delegitimizes by rationalization, that is, by reference to coalition forces’ mobilization as aiming to wage war against Islam and Muslims. For more examples of all themes of (de)legitimation by al-Baghdadi, see Appendix D.

(37)

a. ...**these traitors** from **the factions of humiliation and disgrace** continue to play the same role through the mobilization of their media, and the people still continue to believe them.

ethos: delegitimation of action: moral evaluation

b. ...**the tyranny and disbelief of the state of Al-Salul**—may Allah disfigure them—is no longer hidden from anyone [...]. **They** [the Saudi regime] are **determined to westernize you and secularize you through a calculated campaign, in an endeavour to turn you into disbelievers and to destroy the manhaj** [i.e. path] of ahl al-sunna wal-Jama’a in your land.

logos: delegitimation of goals & social position: moral evaluation & rationalization

c. ...here is **the disbelieving world** today having mobilized [...coalitions and parties] to **wage war** against Islam and its people and **to plot against** the believers and their religion

with all means available [...] all this [is] in a rapid endeavor to extinguish the light of Allah...

pathos: delegitimation of goals: rationalization

6.4.2.3 The (de)legitimizing function in Tarrant's incitement texts

Like OBL and al-Baghdadi, Tarrant tends to legitimate the Self/ingroup with a focus on legitimating 'Our' actions (see Table 6.8). Likewise, Tarrant tends to delegitimize outgroups (e.g. the democrats, immigrants, the non-White) to maximize the value and the legitimacy of the incited-for actions. Besides OBL and al-Baghdadi's five themes of (de)legitimation, Tarrant (de)legitimizes via a critique related to a sixth theme, access to social resources (e.g. lands, jobs, housing) (see Example 38).

38. These same [immigrants'] children will one day become teens [...], taking our peoples lands, work, houses and even attacking and killing our children.

This delegitimation of access to resources emphasises Tarrant's concerns about outgroups' consistency/equality with Whites in their rights to these resources and urging the giving of priority in welfare to the White. Additionally, like OBL and al-Baghdadi, Tarrant used the three modes of persuasion with more emphasis on ethos and logos (see Table 6.8).

Table 6.8: Summary of (de)legitimation strategies – themes and modes – and their occurrences in Tarrant’s inciting texts

Legitimation of 'Us'			
Themes	Occurrences	Modes	Occurrences
actions	48	ethos	52
values	8	logos	14
membership	1	pathos	5
social position	4	-	-
Goals	4	-	-
access to social resources	6	-	-
Delegitimation of 'Them'			
Themes	Occurrences	Modes	Occurrences
actions	18	ethos	54
values	29	logos	11
goals	2	pathos	5
membership	11	-	-
social position	7	-	-
access to social resources	3	-	-

To legitimate radical actions, Tarrant deployed the three modes of persuasion to gear critique of not only the outgroups but also the ingroup. In Example 39-a, a pathos-based act, Tarrant legitimates violence against the immigrants by hyperbolic reference to the need to crush immigrants as being a matter of survival and prosperity and a must, endowing the urged act with cognitive validity and turning the urged action into an emotional goal. In an ethos-based critique of the ingroup and in urging for violence against the Turks and Muslims (Example 39-b), Tarrant legitimates violence via emphasised (through capitalization) moral evaluation – that is, by reference to European men not freeing Hagia Sophia as not being ‘real’ men (i.e. lacking courage). In logos-based acts (Example 39-c), Tarrant incites for the killing of children of immigrants to deter immigrants from staying and to protect the future of Whites’ children. This is facilitated by rationalization, that is, by a rhetorical question about the effects of

leaving a nest of vipers (compared with immigrants' children) in one's backyard and about the practice of controlling vipers.

(39)

a. We must crush immigration and deport those invaders already living on our soil. It is not just a matter of our prosperity, but the very survival of our people.

pathos: legitimization of action: rationalization

b. UNTIL THE HAGIA SOPHIA IS FREE OF THE MINARETS, **THE MEN OF EUROPE ARE MEN IN NAME ONLY.**

ethos: legitimization of action: moral evaluation

c. When you discover a nest of vipers in your yard, do you spare the adolescents? Do you allow them to grow freely, openly, to one day bite you child as they play in their own yard? No. You burn the nest and kill the vipers, no matter their age.

logos: legitimization of action: rationalization

To enhance the incitees' belief in the legitimacy of urged actions, Tarrant also tends to delegitimize outgroups with emphasis on 'Their' negative actions, values and membership. For example, in a pathos-based act of delegitimizing alleged acts and influences of the immigrants (Example 40-a), Tarrant delegitimizes by moral evaluation, that is, by reference to immigrants or mass immigration as a disenfranchiser and demolisher of White existential and kin values – nations, ethnic bonds, communities, cultures and people – as stressed by anaphora ('*destroy our*'). In delegitimizing values such as diversity (Example 40-b), Tarrant deploys a logos-based act of delegitimation where he compares non-diverse nations' strength to that of diverse nations. Tarrant legitimates via moral evaluation – by reference to diversity as weakness, which is unlike the case in non-diverse nations such as China. Delegitimizing the membership of the non-White and the practice of granting them citizenship, Tarrant (Example 40-c), deploys logos via comparison to rationalize by reference to interchanging identities as an *insane* idea. For more examples on (de)legitimation by Tarrant, see Appendix E.

(40)

a. **Mass immigration** will disenfranchise us, subvert our nations, destroy our communities, destroy our ethnic binds, destroy our cultures, destroy our peoples.

pathos: delegitimation of action: moral evaluation

b. ...How are they so strong, China set to be the world's most dominant nation in this century, whilst lacking diversity? Why is that their **non diverse nations** do so much better than our own, and on so many different metrics? [...] **Diversity** is not a strength. **Unity, purpose, trust, traditions, nationalism and racial nationalism** is what provides strength. Everything else is just a catchphrase.

logos: delegitimation of value: moral evaluation

c. The idea that all it takes for a Han Chinese man to become German is to be born on German soil is as insane as a German born on Mars becoming a Martian.

logos: delegitimation of membership: rationalization

In sum, the three terrorists tend to mobilize evaluative couplings via several critique dynamics to (de)legitimize out/ingroups in relation to a set of themes. Despite variation in emphasis on these themes across the authors, they tend to focus on gearing couplings via ethos and logos persuasive strategies. The ethos-based (de)legitimation act serve to enhance the character and reliability of the inciters. Each terrorist has mobilized couplings that induce the addressed audiences to believe that the negative evaluations of outgroups' beliefs, values, actions, goals and so forth are coming from a reliable and credible source. This credibility is enhanced by the inciters presenting themselves as having the goal of serving the ingroup and defending shared values, or as relying on a reliable source (e.g. Allah, or 'loyal' White European men and women) that the incitees trust. As such, ethos-based acts of (de)legitimation appear to persuade by appealing to the inciter's ethos as a member of the community. As such, through ethos-driven delegitimation acts, each inciter seeks to legitimate 'Our' action and to invite the incitees to attribute the feature of ethical, benevolent and competent character to him. The findings discussed in this section support previous research (e.g. Poggi, 2005) showing that benevolence and competence are two main features through which a persuader may seek to lead their audiences to attribute credibility to the persuader's assertions.

In their logos-based acts of (de)legitimation, the inciters have deployed couplings to serve persuasion through logical argumentation. This included deploying couplings not only when providing concrete details, representative examples, statistics, cause and effects, results, obviousness markers and so forth, but also through showing inconsistency or incongruence in the different beliefs of the incited-against social actors (e.g. democrat politicians, Arab rulers). As such, by logos, each inciter has sought to show consistency – or alternatively, "coherence" (Poggi, 2005, p. 313) – in their beliefs and congruence with the incitees' beliefs.

6.5 Summary of Chapter Six

This chapter has contributed to understanding how terrorists incite violence. It has capitalised on the power of the SFL evaluative coupling approach to affiliation. This chapter has discussed: the analysis of affiliation strategies as discursive incitement tactics; how an extremist's appraisal signature serves to construct social groups as opposing networks of values or clusters of bonds in discourse; the moral reasoning of evaluative couplings and thus the bonds tabled; and how these couplings are mobilized to achieve two rhetorical functions, coercion and (de)legitimation, by considering bonding as a (de)legitimation act. These elements can serve to give warning signs of there being an instance of malicious/dangerous speech that is intended to encourage inflicting harm. The incitement texts also appeared to be of an ideological, moral and axiological character. Axiologically speaking, the texts – in Martin & White's (2005, p. 211) terms – unfold rhetorically as “an invitation to community” and action; and ideologically, they tend to unfold as rationality (i.e. in “a quest for ‘truth’”).

The ideological and axiological construction of the incitement texts contributes to a “discursive formation” (Foucault, 2002, p. 38) and emotive rhetoric that lends legitimacy to punitive violent activity. This construction enables the terrorists to turn the ingroup values that are challenged by the outgroups into something to be supported, while turning the outgroups' actions, values and goals into something to be resisted – presenting power and resistance relations as primary concepts for incitement to violence. This resistance and support, encouraged by the inciters as allegedly for the good of the incitees, is thus associated with the terrorists' “discourse of truth” through which they promote defending their societies as a must and duty (cf. Foucault, 2003, p. 35). This implies that, in terrorist inciting discourse, beliefs and evaluative couplings are “socially, historically and culturally relative” and the ‘truth’ criteria are ideologically based, since they favour the ingroup (van Dijk, 1998b, p. 30) and legitimate the negative viewing of opposition as commonsensical, natural or ‘real’ to the ingroup members.

The findings offer insights into understanding how the terrorist incitement texts operate. That is, these texts tend to table bonds via the affiliation strategies of communion and alienation. This approach enables us to view incitement as “a network of bonds and obligations” (Firth, 1964, p. 113). To neutralize, prevent or fight against outgroups (i.e. the constructed threat),

the texts tend to activate a range of meta-values that are morally coercive. These meta-values appear to underpin the interpretive and evaluative process (see Haugh, 2015) and have a bearing on how an ingroup ought to react. The morally founded evaluative couplings appear as regulated reactions to allegedly immoral actions, which contributes to viewing hostility as being justified and actions as legitimate.

To augment the coercive nature of their inciting texts, the terrorists tend to urge for certain violent actions as collective goals in a shared enterprise. In this enterprise, the inciter and incitees are constructed as cultural members who “share beliefs about what are good and bad actions, as well as who are responsible for scenes, [thus] they can indict Others [and generate conflict] through description of situations” (Tracy, 2008, p. 176). To enhance the value of these urged actions as well as the incitees’ belief that urged actions are in a means-end relationship, the texts tend to gear the evaluative couplings and suggested actions by the three traditional modes of persuasion. By turning violence into a communal goal, a terrorist organization’s (e.g. al-Qaeda’s) goals (e.g. to drive America out of the Muslim world and establish the Caliphate) become aligned with the incites’ goals (of e.g. seeking justice, equality, family or country protection) via the incitees’ involvement in toppling ‘bad’ rulers and avenging American atrocities in Iraq and the Muslim world. This value appropriation, or alternatively “goal-hooking” (Poggi, 2005, p. 330), can serve in “bridging” (cf. Benford & Snow, 2000, p. 624) the inciters’ and incitees’ worlds through: firstly, the positioning of the terrorist (e.g. OBL) within the incitee’s individual and national concerns as an affiliative hero in relatable experiences; secondly, reinforcing a central social goal for both the terrorist organization and the incited audiences; and thirdly, reversing the negative image of, or the disdain a society may feel for, a terrorist (Khosrokhavar, 2014) into a common enterprise against a shared enemy.

Finally, the identified tactics used in communion and alienation augment existing linguistic accounts of identity in discourse by suggesting the role of axiological forms of communion and alienation that occur in discourse. These resources add to the literature (e.g. Benwell & Stokoe, 2006; Omoniyi & White, 2006) on how identities are (re)produced and performed. They also demonstrate the role of evaluation in inciting violence and putting bonds at risk.

CHAPTER SEVEN:

FINDINGS 3 – SOCIAL DISAFFILIATION IN TERRORISTS’ COMMUNICATED THREATS

7.1 Introduction

This chapter explores disaffiliation in the communicated threats of terrorists. These threats are a key concern of forensic linguistics because – unlike one-to-one threats – they constitute a form of violence and a language crime that is committed in a complex context of public intimidation, and are communicated publicly and designed strategically to force desired sociopolitical changes. This chapter adopts a similar approach to the previous chapter in terms of exploring the co-patterning of evaluation and ideation as a way of understanding the key social bonds at stake. Through exploring the patterning and functions of ideation-attitude couplings in the communicated threats (hereafter, ‘threats’) the chapter aims to:

1. Showcase how disalignments between primary social actors (namely, a threatener and their victims) are forged.
2. Demonstrate how these couplings can serve as linguistic evidence of the social action of disaffiliation in the threat texts – regardless of the threat type.
3. Explore the discursive functions for which the bonds are employed in the threat texts, in terms of the linguistic tactics that are employed to gear the underpinning couplings.

In response to the third research question of this thesis, analysis of evaluative couplings in the dataset is detailed in the analytical procedure presented in Section 4.4.4 of Chapter Four. The aim of the analysis is to identify the patterns of bond types that characterize the “appraisal signature” (Martin & White, 2005, p. 208) of the evaluative language of a terrorist’s threat, and to explain: how these patterns serve the process of disaffiliation in threat texts of different types; which tactics are used to gear these couplings; and for which discursive functions. The focus is on ATTITUDE type- based typification of bonds (e.g. IN/CAPACITY-based bonds) to help to reveal a terrorist’s attitudinal disalignments and stances forged in discourse and to inform our understanding about a “threat justification” (Gales, 2010, p. 196) as realised in the evaluative language. This focus on evaluative couplings as the main units of analysis in the terrorist threat texts is thus to serve in uncovering two aspects: first, the point of the

threat text, or alternatively – in Chilwa's (2017) terms – what a threatener is getting at; second, the positive and negative construction of threatener and victims, which is facilitated by focusing on the polarity of evaluation that is guiding the analysis of the threatener-victim value disalignment in OBL's, Shekau's and Tarrant's threat texts.

7.1.1 Chapter structure

This chapter discusses the findings, regarding how disaffiliation is enacted in the service of threats, in three main sections. Section 7.2 offers a macro lens on the evaluative discourse structure and the primary social actors constructed in discourse as well as their power relations. That is, this section shows how terrorist threats present an evaluative construct of the world and who the main players within this construct are, in terms of who 'We' versus 'They' are – a construct that serves to influence social networks and interpersonal relationships, regardless of the threat type. Section 7.3 identifies and details the types of threats in the dataset and their purposes, in order to sensitise our understanding of their underlying rationale. Finally, Section 7.4 discusses the discursive functions of the threat texts. It describes the evaluative tactics used to table (i.e. make available) particular social bonds as moral bases for forging social disalignments. This section also summarises the patterns of bonds, in terms of their attitudinal bases, as foundations for disalignment in and across the texts of each terrorist. It investigates how these bonds contribute to the discursive construction of disaligned social groups and to morally justifying the threats.

Throughout this chapter, JUDGEMENT is underlined, APPRECIATION is double underlined, and AFFECT is dotted underlined. 'Bold' is used to mark the evaluated ideations unless mentioned otherwise.

7.2 Threat texts: evaluative discourse structure and the primary social actors

This section describes the evaluative structure that terrorists build in their threats (for a similar description, see Chilwa, 2017). The analysis shows that the terrorists tend to structure their threat texts as narratives that have: an introduction; a main body that serves to construct the threateners and their action positively and to provide justifications for threatened acts; and a conclusion. As such, the threateners in the dataset follow particular stages in structuring that serves to achieve the social purposes and communicative functions

of the threats (as a social semiotic practice) or/and to justify “exigence” (cf. Miller, 1984, p. 158). By describing the structure of the threat texts, we become more sensitised: about how a threat is carried out in a terrorism context and about terrorist threatening texts as a category of “illicit genres” (Bojsen-Møller et al., 2020, p. 34). This category – contrary to Bojsen-Møller et al.’s (2020) argument about threats being communicated secretly, anonymously or indirectly – is communicated publicly and mostly directly to address a range of audiences, and is defined by: who threateners exclude and disalign with, how, and why (in terms of the attitudinal and moral justifications for violence) (Subsection 7.2.3 and Section 7.4); the constant negotiation of power relations (Subsection 7.2.3); the purpose of violence (7.3.1); and the discursive functions of terrorist threats (e.g. ethical manipulation, deontic retribution, or producing a boulomaic effect) (Section 7.4). This description of the discourse semantics definitive nature of terrorist threat texts adds to SFL-grounded genre analysis (e.g. Martin & Rose, 2008).

In this section, attention is paid to the introductory and closing structure of the threat texts and to the primary participants constructed throughout these texts, to give a global picture of the primary social actors and the relationships between them. The positive/negative construction of the social actors and their actions as well as the justifications for threatened actions are discussed in detail in Section 7.3 and Section 7.4 which focus on the main body of the threat texts and the purposefulness and functions of the threats.

7.2.1 The evaluative opening structure

The threat texts showed a commonality in their opening phases. The opening parts include a praise, a greeting, a ‘from-to’ (i.e. addresser-addressee) conventional structure, and/or a mention of a main reason behind communicating the text. Regarding praise, the OBL threat texts (OBL1 and OBL3) are consistent in beginning with praising God, Allah, as the one who commanded his creatures to be just and permitted them to fight oppression and oppressors. These are construed using positive PROPRIETY (see Example 1, in bold). This structure sets the stage for justifying OBL’s threatened acts and framing them within the ‘struggle against injustice and oppression’ framework. This structure also communicates a series of evaluations. Specifically, it serves to give OBL’s text a divine colouring of the negative evaluation of oppression and positive evaluation of the act of seeking justice and retaliation.

This divine command-like opening aids OBL in establishing an authoritative lead. This lead supports upcoming argumentation regarding the positive ethical perception of someone seeking retaliation when oppressed (as underlined in Example 1). Through this opening structure that connects with Godly values and appeals to universal values of, for example, fighting injustices, OBL appears to introduce his threat texts through – in van Dijk’s (2006, p. 379) terms – an “ideological globalization” lens of the value of countering the ‘bad’ as a central, deontic value. The concept of deontic retaliation is visited in detail in Section 7.4. Unlike OBL, while Shekau’s texts incorporates praising God, Shekau tends only to thank Allah for achievements that Shekau’s fighter made in encountering God’s adversaries (as in Shekau3, Shekau7, and Shekau8), but not to introduce a central Godly value (see Example 2).

(1) Praise is due to Allah who created the creation for his worship, commanded them to be just [to be just/+ PROPRIETY], and permitted the oppressed to retaliate against the oppressor in kind [to retaliate.../+ PROPRIETY]. (OBL1)

(2) We give thanks to Allah the exalted for bringing us to this day. We are happy and we are bringing glad tidings to our brothers who are spread all over the world that God has given us victory after He has safely taken us to the city of Maiduguri... (Shekau7)

Regarding offering greetings, greeting is a consistent structural element in the opening of the OBL texts (see Example 3). This greeting appears – in Duranti’s (1997, p. 72) terms – as a “ceremonial greeting” that is part of a public communicative event, which serves to construct OBL’s moral bearing as someone who is cool-tempered and acknowledges the addressees, even his threatened audience (namely, the Americans). However, OBL greets them with a different expression to the one used among Muslims (that is, ‘peace, mercy and blessings of Allah be upon you’), meaning that this greeting serves to initially construct the threatener and the victims as social actors who belong to different social groups of different master, religious identities. In addition, this greeting structure facilitates the presentation of OBL to his ingroup audiences as someone with epistemic knowledge of Islamic literature regarding how a religious figure should greet non-Muslims. According to the Saudi Salafist scholar bin Baz, address to atheists shall be begun with following the guidance (i.e. Allah’s message), and they shall not be greeted initially with peace (Bin Baz, n.d.). Unlike OBL, Shekau tended to use greetings only to greet his ingroup audience, as found in Shekau6, Shekau7 and Shekau8 (see Example 4).

(3) *Peace be upon he who follows the guidance.*

(4) *I greet you, my brothers and sisters in Islam.* (Shekau7)

Regarding the ‘from-to’ structure, this serves to colour the threat texts with certainty and confidence deriving from self-identification of a threatener and identification of the threatened audiences. This letter-writing conventional structure appears consistently in the OBL threat texts, see Example 5 which specifies OBL as the source of the text, and *people of America* as the intended addressee, elucidating doubts about the threat text’s source and authenticity. A similar structure appears in Shekau’s texts where he introduces himself as the leader of his sect (Example 6) and clearly specifies his addressed victims (Example 7). While the Tarrant texts show no use of greeting and religious opening as is the case for OBL and Shekau, Tarrant explicitly names the threatened audience in his two texts, as in: *To Antifa/Marxists/Communists* (Tarrant1), and *To Turks* (Tarrant2). Through this addresser-addressee identification structure, the three terrorists appear to invest in a presupposed powerful image of self as a source of fear (e.g. that of 9/11 traumas in OBL’s texts) and to clearly announce the involved social actors (visited in Subsection 7.2.3) in an attempt to manipulate and win – in Chilwa’s (2017, p. 327) terms – “an emotional war in advance” (more about the discursive function of manipulation is discussed in detail in Section 7.4).

(5) **From** *Osama bin Muhammad bin Laden* **to** *the American people concerning your aggression on Iraq.* (OBL3)

(6) *I am Abubakar Shekau, leader of the group known as Jamaatu Ahlil Sunna Li Dawati wal Jihad.* (Shekau 6)

(7) *This is a message* **to** *Goodluck* **and to** *the CAN [Christian Association of Nigeria] president.* (Shekau 8)

A fourth commonality found in the OBL and Shekau texts’ opening parts is the mention of the purpose or the reason behind a text. For example, the purpose of the OBL1 is stated in a form of threat inviting (or alternatively, manipulating) the addressees to take the ideal path to avoid death and destruction such as that of the 9/11 attacks (see Example 8). The reason behind this threat is signalled by the verb ‘*concerns*’ in bold. Shekau also tends to mention that his threatening messages come as a response to the Nigerian officials’ decision to fight Boko Haram’s members and with an aim to invite all Nigerians to convert to Islam or to expect death. For instance, Shekau in Example 9 (taken from Shekau8 where he threatens CAN’s

president and the Nigerian president) mentions that his message is in response to previous statements issued by the Nigerian President and the president of the Christian Association of Nigeria (CAN) against Boko Haram and describing Boko Haram as ‘*cancer*’ in Nigeria. This construction of the reason is realised by the clause ‘*why...is because of*’ (in bold).

(8) *People of America, this talk of mine, for you, **concerns** the ideal way to prevent another Manhattan, and the war: its causes and results.*

(9) ***Why I have come out to explain myself is because of** the explanation Jonathan and the CAN president gave on us...that we are like cancer in this country called Nigeria.*

This subsection has emphasized that the opening structure of the threat texts tends to include specific elements such as reasons of a threat, and the social actors involved as signalled by the from-to structure. The introductory elements are not devoid of propositional content. Such content was found in, for example, instances of greeting the non-Muslim, threatened audience by formulaic structure of religious greeting. Aligned with Duranti’s (1997) argument – that greetings may convey information about conflicting parties and their identities – these greeting expressions presuppose the existence of conflicting social groups of different religions. The propositional content of these greetings thus can aid threat assessors in gathering information about a threatener’s identity and sociocultural background, and how threatened audiences are acknowledged through greeting for what they embody or represent (i.e. the non-Muslim oppressor). In addition, the opening structure of the threat texts has been found to serve in sanctioning social behaviours, as realised in the acts of praising God as the commander for fighting injustices. In sum, the opening structure serves the establishment of a religious as well as a political dichotomy of threateners and victims, a dichotomy of primary social actors that is elaborated on in Subsection 7.2.3.

7.2.2 The evaluative closing structure

Despite the commonalities in the opening parts across the threat texts, there is no consistent form of closing in these texts; but the closing structure is nevertheless evaluatively-loaded. For example, OBL1 concludes with the signal ‘*In conclusion*’ (see Example 10-a, in bold) to flag a summary of the OBL threatening message. This conclusion serves to emphasise that the American people are held responsible for their (in)security based on whether they decided to

continue their war in Iraq. This summary is followed by a formulaic Islamic expression to sign-off, whereby OBL emphasises OBL's reliance on the power of Allah, hence building OBL's power ([+ CAPACITY]) and the Americans' powerlessness (see Example 10-b), and repeats the same opening greeting for the non-Muslim audience as a formal sign-off (in bold). This repetition of religious greeting stresses the importance of social identity and membership categorisation in threat texts, where greeting: (i) is part of an ongoing activity of manipulating the Americans' position from conflict in Iraq in order for them to guarantee their security; and (ii) in Duranti's (1997) terms, entails an ideological/religious type of social encounter or conflict. That is, according to Duranti (1997, p. 65), "if we accept that greeting behaviour might have phylogenetically originated from avoidance behaviour, we still must demonstrate that such an origin is relevant to the specific [terrorist] context in which [this] greeting is used". Unlike in OBL1, the OBL3 provides a conclusion in the form of a threat (see Example 11, in bold), followed by the same sign-off as the OBL1's but without a final greeting which, if it were there, would counteract OBL's commitment to the threatened jihad against the American injustices. That is, the deletion of greeting serves to emphasize the threatened aggressive behaviour of OBL.

(10)

a. ***In conclusion, I say to you nothing but the truth, that your security is not in the hands of Kerry, Bush, or al-Qaeda. Your security is in your own hands. And every state that does not play with our security has automatically guaranteed its own security.***

b. *Allah is our protector [(we)/ + CAPACITY], and you have no protector [you/ - CAPACITY]. **Peace be upon he who follows the guidance.***

(11) ***In conclusion, I say to the American people: Allah willing, we are continuing fight you. We will continue the martyrdom operations inside and outside the United States until you terminate your injustice, stop your stupidity, and curb your insolent fellows.... Allah is our protector, and you have no protector. And Allah (alone) is sufficient for us, and He is the Best Disposer of affairs.***

Shekau tends to close his texts via one of three options. The first is by emphasising his power and by a formal sign-off that mentions his name, which serve to send "a chill on the spine of some [Nigerian audiences]" (Chiluwa, 2017, p. 327). Consider Example 12 (taken from Shekau 1) where Shekau announces his name (in bold), describes himself as an '*invincible enemy*' ([+ CAPACITY] underlined), and recommits himself to the struggle until death. The same sign-off of announcement of self as the source of the threat text is also found in Shekau4.

(12) ***This is the message I have for you all. My name is Abubakar Shekau, the one that is an invincible enemy that you are fighting [Shekau/ + CAPACITY]. That is our stand...it is better I die and go to rest in paradise.*** (Shekau1)

The second form of closing in Shekau's texts is by an ethical reframing of his threatened acts. For instance, Shekau3 (see Example 13, in bold) concludes by framing Boko Haram's interests as being '*not in killing*' but in converting the Nigerian people of Maiduguri to Islam – that is, '*da'wa*' by jihad (literally, invitation through jihad). In addition, Shekau6 also concludes with framing the Nigerian authorities' violence against Boko Haram as being a '*war is against Islam*', and Shekau's fight as being in the cause of Allah. This framing presents Shekau and Islam as victims of the brutality of the wilful acts of the Nigerian government or their agents.

(13) ***Our interest is not in killing you [people of Maiduguri], but to see that you accept true worship of God. This is our brief message; we invaded Maiduguri and God has helped us to come out safely.***

The third form of closing in Shekau's text is by emphasis on challenging the threatened audiences and threatening them. For example, in Shekau5 (Example 14), the message ends with challenging the security troops '*Kato da Gora*' (in bold) and threatening them with acts of killing at the hands of Shekau's incited men (underlined). An explicit closing with a threat is also found in Shekau9 in which Shekau threatens anyone who cooperates with the Nigerian authorities to arrest any of his followers (Example 15).

(14) ***This is the message I bring to you today; this is what Allah has planned for you. Kato da Gora, come, I beg you! I beg you, come! My brothers, there is no rest. Go out, kill, cut their throats! This is the religion!***

(15) *Anyone who is instrumental to the arrest of our members is assured that their own [death] is coming.*

The closing structure of Tarrant's texts is comparable to Shekau's third form. Tarrant tends to close his texts with acts of threat that are emphasised in all upper caps. For example, in Tarrant1, he directs a challenge at adherents of the Antifa, Marxists and Communists whom he describes as *ANTIWHITE SCUM*, warning them about walking in the street and that they will be shot dead (Example 16). In Tarrant2, he also closes his text by threatening the Turks through urging them to flee Europe to Turkey before they are dead (Example17). In sum, the

closing structure of the threat texts in the dataset serves to emphasise or reframe the inter-group conflicts and relationships between the primary social actors in discourse.

(16) *SEE YOU ON THE STREETS YOU ANTI-WHITE SCUM.*

(17) *FLEE TO YOUR OWN LANDS, WHILE YOU STILL HAVE THE CHANCE.*

7.2.3 Primary social actors and power relations

A critical examination of the relationships between a threatener and their threatened audiences as social actors has revealed a wide range of participants in the threat texts who belong to various sociopolitical and ideological/religious backgrounds. The results emphasise the importance of this level of analysis, particularly for identifying who is included in the 'We' coalition of a threatener and the 'They' group of victims (see also Gales, 2011). That is, the results enable a threat analyst to identify those "parties who are specified (to whatever degree) as the targets of violence", and thus to identify categories of social actors and their inter-relationships as main topics that help to set boundaries on potential violent events and those involved in them (see also Hurt & Grant, 2019, p. 165). For example, in the OBL threat texts, two primary groups of participants dominate his texts. The first includes OBL, al-Qaeda (of which OBL is a leader) and the 'victimised' Muslim Ummah of which OBL is a part. The second group includes the threatened American people, of which George W. Bush and his 'corrupt' and 'victimiser' administration are part, and the Israelis who are the US ally in the Middle East region and are perceived as being responsible for murdering many in the region (more accusations and acts of manipulation of audiences' perception are further discussed in Section 7.4). Table 7.1 exemplifies the references to each primary group as taken from OBL1 – the threatener group and the victims (or alternatively, the threatened) group as well as their additional referents.

The construction of the primary social actors and their additional references shows that the threatened group belongs to a different cultural and national identity (Americans, and their Israeli allies) and to different religious affiliations, Christians and Jews. This construction facilitates the positioning of the victims as in disalignment with the identities of the threatener and those whom he assumes to represent and defend. Throughout his texts OBL refers to himself as part of a mujahidin group (al-Qaeda) whose mission is to 'restore freedom' to the Muslim ummah, to retaliate for the atrocities against Muslims in the Middle East (e.g.

in Lebanon), and to terminate the ‘injustices’ of the Americans and their allies targeting the “passivated” (van Leeuwen, 1996, p. 44) ummah (see Example 18). By referring to self and his wider affiliations, OBL aligns himself with a retaliating organisation (al-Qaeda) and creed of a religious value (fighting against injustices, as previously discussed in relation to Example 1) that would be valued in the eyes of the supporters of this value which is as such underpinned by the meta-value of ‘care’ for the ingroup’s vulnerability through opposition of victimisers’ ‘oppression’. As such, the OBL threat texts appear to be communicated as driven by the meta-value of ‘care’ and responsibility towards the ingroup that has been passivated.

(18) *We want to restore freedom to our Ummah.* (OBL1)

Table 7.1: References to primary social actors in OBL’s threat texts

Primary social actors	Additional referents
Threatener: Osama bin Laden	I
al-Qaeda	we
	al-Qaeda fighters
	Mujahidin
	who
	us
	those (Perpetrators of 9/11 attacks)
Our ummah	our people in Palestine and Lebanon
	our women and children
	our people
Threatened: American people	you
	they
	America
	the thousands who left you on the 9/11; we
	Bush
George W. Bush	he
	The White House
	Bush (the senior)
Bush administration	the White House leadership
	Bush administration; his administration
	their (private companies)
	American-Israeli coalition; the American 3 rd fleet
Israelis	your allies in Palestine; they

To achieve his alignment with a caring organisation (i.e. al-Qaeda) and borderless ummah, OBL uses strategies of inclusion/exclusion (see van Leeuwen, 1996, pp. 38-42; 2008) and specific/generic classifications (van Leeuwen, 1996, pp. 46-48). These strategies of social actor representation enable the threatener to set up a dichotomous situation between his group of actors and those who are responsible for injustices and thus deserve punishment, as realised in the 'I, we' versus 'you' dichotomy in Examples 19-20. Representations such as these include and exclude primary social actors to suit OBL's interests and purpose in relation to the putative audiences for whom these representations are intended.

19. ...**we** **will fight** **you** *as long as **we** have weapons in hands.* (OBL3)

20. *I also say to the US soldiers in Iraq: **you** should know that your continued presence in Iraq is a compound injustice and a great folly.* (OB3)

Regarding specific/generic classifications, OBL tends to not only specify those who belong to each social group – as signalled in bold: '*It is true that this shows that **al-Qaeda** has gained; but, in return, it shows that **the Bush administration** has also gained* [from the repercussions of the 9/11 attacks]' – but also use genericization. He does this, firstly, in reference to assumed entities or classes of people who are not aligned with al-Qaeda's values of, for example, freedom, as in: '*It is known that **those who hate freedom** do not possess defiant souls like those of the 19 [person who executed the 9/11 attacks]*'. Secondly, OBL uses genericization to refer to a class of army Generals (in bold) who lack tenacity since they are only making profits for their companies out of the US injustices and wars (underlined) (see Example 23). As such, it is in the interest of OBL to attempt to justify threatened acts against the Americans by reference to specific social actors and by systematic inclusion and exclusion, constructing an 'Us' versus 'You' dichotomy. Even when genericization is utilized, it appears to serve in suppressing the mention of individuals to allow for shifting focus onto their moral values or negatively positioned class, such as freedom-haters or '*Generals*', in opposition to a few powerful Mujahidin as realised in '*two Mujahidin*' (in bold, Example 21).

(21) [*It is enough to send **two Mujahidin** to the far east to raise a piece of cloth on which is written 'al-Qaeda' in order to make **Generals** run there quickly to incur America human, economic, and political losses, without achieving for America*

anything of note other than some profits to their private companies) [Generals/ - JUDGEMENT].

The OBL representation of social actors also serves to construct al-Qaeda as a powerful and capable group (as in: ‘...**we** had no difficulty dealing with Bush and his administration’). This representation gives OBL control over the situation in which the victim group is constructed as being insecure or less powerful. This representation also serves in the positioning of OBL on the side of Muslims who are included and targeted for recruitment purposes for supporting the ‘defensive’ cause led by al-Qaeda against the threatened group (see Example 22).

(22) *We do incite our brothers to fight you [US soldiers in Iraq], stab you, and inflict a massacre in you.* (OBL3)

In Shekau’s texts, a wider range of groups of participants prevails than those in the OBL texts. This variety is in terms of the categories of the victims and who is considered part of the ‘We’ group. The ‘We’ group includes Shekau, *Jamatu Ahlis Sunna Lidda’awati wal-jihad* (literally, group of the people of Sunnah for preaching and jihad, or alternatively Boko Haram) of which the threatener is a leader, Muslims who are following Shekau’s path (of them he is a member), and Allah, as is predominant in Shekau 3, 5, 6, and 7. The victim group includes unbelievers/infidels (including Christians, Jews, Shiite, other Muslims who are non-adherents of Boko Haram’s creed or helpful to the Nigerian government in the fight against Boko Haram, the Christian Association of Nigeria and its president), the government of Nigeria and governmental officials (e.g. the Nigerian presidents Buhari and Jonathan Goodluck, and Sultan of Kano), civilian people of Nigeria (e.g. people of Maiduguri which is the capital and the largest city of Borno State in north-eastern Nigeria, people of Chibok which is a local government area of Borno State, people of Kano, people of Sokoto which is a major city located in northwest of Nigeria), and Nigerian security personnel (e.g. the youth vigilantes, General Rogers, policewomen, soldiers, defence minister, the Chief of Army Staff, and TJF troops). Table 7.2 exemplifies the two primary groups of social actors as taken from Shekau3.

Table 7.2: Examples of primary social actors in Shekau 3

Primary social actors	Additional referents
Threatener: Abubakar Shekau	I
Boko Haram	we
Allah	Allah; God
Threatened: Nigerian government and security personnel	infidel soldiers; the soldiers; they
	the defence minister; you
	General Buratai, the Chief of Army Staff; you; he
Nigerian civilian people	the Civilian-JTF (joint task force); you; vigilant (troops); the infidel soldiers
	the people of Maiduguri; you

While the 'We' group and the threatened social actors belong to the same national identity (Nigeria), the constructed 'Us' versus 'You' dichotomy is underpinned by a conflict motivated by sociopolitical and religious ideologies. That is, Shekau tends to drive the cause of having an '*Islamiyya*' pathway to nationhood and '*to do proper Sharia*' and wage '*a war against western education, democracy and constitution*' and against '*those who stand against God's commandment*'. In addition, within this construction of the world, Shekau presents *Allah* as a main participant in his group, which ultimately serves in presenting the ingroup as being a powerful group that has God's support as the element of '*prowess*' which gives Shekau control over the situation (see Example 23). This construction facilitates the positioning of the victims as in disalignment with the identity and ideology of the threatener and those whom he assumes to represent. In addition, the representation of Shekau as '*this small Shekau*' is relevant to portraying himself as having a more powerful endorsement (*Allah*). That is, Shekau presents himself as a powerful leader, but this self-representation of someone less powerful than God contributes to gaining affiliation and power in the ingroup, and reinforces the idea that *Allah* is the main participant of their group.

(23) *I am talking to you Buhari... It is not this small Shekau that is disturbing you. No. It is Allah that is doing everything for us, continue and see.* (Shekau4)

Shekau, throughout his texts, refers to himself as leader of a Muslim sect (see Example 24, in bold) and a follower of God's path, as in: *'This path we are taking is God's path'*. Similar to OBL, along this path, Shekau constructs himself as a retaliation member of the passivated Muslims and Islam in Nigeria (retaliation is revisited in Section 7.4). Shekau, similar to OBL, aligns himself with a defensive, religious organisation and with the creed of a religious value (that is, fighting against injustices), which would be positively appreciated in the eyes of the supporters of defending Muslims as driven by the meta-value of 'care' for 'Our' vulnerability and against the oppression of 'Our' victimisers. Shekau, as stressed in Shekau3, as such aligns himself with the experiences of Muslims worldwide (in e.g. Chechnya, Somalia) and their steadfastness against oppressors (see Example 25, in bold).

(24) ...as **leader of this sect** I tell you [CAN president] to repent, and to you Christians, repent! (Shekau8)

(25) You [General Buratai, the Chief of Army Staff] need to know that there is no way you could end this war by killing us... **Our brethren in Chechnya and Somalia have been in this kind of war for over many years and it is still ongoing. The same applies to Afghanistan, Iraq, Yemen and Syria as well as Libya.** (Shekau3)

To communicate his claims that align himself with shared values of Muslim community and with the power and message of God, Shekau, like OBL, uses strategies of inclusion/exclusion and specific/generic classifications. The inclusion/exclusion strategies serve to set up a dichotomous situation between the powerful threatener's group (*I, we, us*) and the threatened participants (*you*), as in: *'...you [President Buhari] cannot defeat us'; 'We killed many of you and you took their corpses to conceal the truth'* – excerpted from Shekau2. In addition, by including Allah, Shekau seeks to give a religious value to his cause which the ingroup putative audience are invited to support and align with, as in Example 26 where Shekau mobilizes his brothers in religion (in bold) to fight against *Kato da Gora* (literally, big men with big sticks, a name given by Shekau to mock the capacity of the Civilian Joint Task Force of Nigeria) as a manifestation of practicing religion (thus positively appreciated). A similar finding is also realised in Shekau 1, 2, 6, and 7. This incorporation of mobilisation messages into threat texts attests a characteristic of terrorist threat texts (see also Ascone, 2020). As such, these inclusion/exclusion strategies serve to manipulate the ingroup audience's perception of supporting Shekau's cause as an obligation of religious brotherhood.

(26) ***My brothers**, there is no rest. Go out, kill, cut their throats! This is the religion [Go out...throats/ + APPRECIATION].*

Shekau, akin to OBL, also tends to specify and genericize those who belong to each conflicting party. Regarding the use of specification, this serves in delineating the situation in terms of who exactly is included in each coalition. For instance, Example 27 specifies Shekau (*I*, in bold) as a 'good' doer acting in the name of Allah, not in the name of a creed of out-grouped specific entities (in bold) such as *Lamido* (a spiritual leader of the Tijanniyah Sufi Islamic order in Nigeria), and *Obasanjo* (a Nigerian president and military ruler), *Atiku* (a former vice president of Nigeria), *Babangida* (a Nigerian army General and politician). That is, while Shekau couples himself as specific with 'positive JUDGEMENT', these specifically condemned leaders are constructed as opposing to Islam by going for alternative beliefs such as *democracy* or non-Boko Haram versions of Islam (e.g. the '*Tijanniyah*' sect). A similar specification of victims is also found in, for example, '*our war is with **the Government...** with **the Christian Association of Nigeria...***' (in bold).

(27) *I speak in the name of religion, Allah, Islam, the religion of the Holy Koran, and not that of democracy... It is not the religion of **Sanusi Lamido**, it is not the religion of **Jonathan** [a Nigerian president], it is not the religion of **Obasanjo**, it is not the religion of **Atiku**, it is not the religion of **Babangida**.* (Shekau5)

Genericization in Shekau's texts serves to outline the conflict in reference to classes of people who might not be aligned with Boko Haram's values. These classes include '*those who helped*' the Nigerian government to fight Boko Haram (Example 28). This generic reference allows for suppressing the mention of specific individuals to allow for including '*whoever*' or '*anyone*' who would be within this negatively positioned class, as in: '*whoever that stands on any creed other than that our Prophet Muhammad brought to us...should know that he is our avowed enemy*'. This use of specific/generic strategies of representation of social actors serves to construct Boko Haram as a powerful social actor who has control over a situation in which those in the victims category, regardless of their specific naming, will not be safe.

(28) *...our war is...with **those who helped them to fight** us even if they are Muslims.* (Shekau 9)

Tarrant constructs victim groups comparably to the OBL and Shekau construction of 'We' versus 'They' groups of primary social actors. However, Tarrant tends to use genericization to represent the excluded victims. That is, on one hand, the 'We' group included Tarrant as the

threatener and a generic class of Western men and women who believe in White Christians' supremacy and control over Western resources, as realised in *'those that believe in hierarchy'*. On the other hand, the victims include generic classification of 'outgroups', namely *egalitarians, Antifa, Marxists, Communists, and Turks*. This 'Us' versus 'They' dichotomy is established on the threatener's worldview that rejects the values of equality and egalitarianism and other competing ideologies (e.g. Marxism), religions and ethnicities (e.g. Muslim Turks). For a summary of mentions of the groups of primary participants in each of the Tarrant's texts, see Tables 7.3 and 7.4.

Table 7.3: References to primary social actors in text Tarrant 1

Primary social actors	Additional referents
Threatener: Tarrant	I
	those that believe in hierarchy
Threatened: Antifa/Marxists/Communists	egalitarians
	you

Table 7.4: References to primary social actors in text Tarrant 2

Primary social actors	Additional referents
Threatener: Tarrant	we
Threatened: Turks	you

Tarrant's tendency to use genericization, in reference to the larger social group (to which he belongs) and to the class of people who are not aligned with Tarrant's values and identities, serves to set up a division and conflict. This conflict is presented as being between classes and groups of identities rather than between individuals – see Examples 29 and 30 which, respectively, build a egalitarians-versus-white supremacists dichotomy and Muslims-versus-Christians dichotomy. In addition to genericization, Tarrant also uses inclusion/exclusion strategies to serve this dichotomous situation, as realised in the *I* versus *you* dichotomy in Tarrant's texts, as in: *'I want **you** in my sights'* (which are part of his rifle) – excerpted from

Tarrant1. This use of inclusion/exclusion strategies serves in the presenting of Tarrant as being a powerful social actor who is in control of the situation.

(29) *Egalitarians and those that believe in hierarchy will never come to terms.* (Tarrant 1)

(30) *The Hagia Sophia will be free of minarets and Constantinople will be rightfully Christian owned once more.* (Tarrant 2)

To conclude this subsection, despite the commonalities and distinctions in the strategies of representation of the threateners and victims in the threat texts, the various strategies are used to set up a conflictive situation of opposing participants of disaligned values and identities. The representation of various experiences thus appears to be rooted in ideology-based representation of the world and inter-group relationship. These representation strategies are also consistently used to reinforce the power of the threateners, in terms of participant role configurations. That is, the strategies tend to serve the construction of threateners in the position of power over victims, thereby benefitting from the “linguistic exchange” in the threat texts that amounts to: (i) “signs of [a threatener's] authority”; and (ii) “an economic exchange which is [first] established within a particular symbolic relation of power between a [text] producer, endowed with a certain linguistic capital, and a consumer... and which is [second] capable of procuring a certain material or symbolic profit” (Bourdieu, 1991, p. 66). To enhance our understanding of the role of representations of selves in the act of threatening and their ingroup-oriented profit in terms of procuring material or symbolic profits for a threatener, the next section (Section 7.3) discusses the types of threats identified in the threat texts and the purpose of threatened violence as constructed in discourse. The aim is also to argue for what type(s) of a threat may exist in a terrorist threat text. In addition, the constructed purposefulness of threats, I argue, can provide clues of pro-ingroup moral justifications for threatened violence.

7.3 Threat texts: threat types and purposes

The repeated types of threat in the dataset accord with the law enforcement-based threat categories – direct, veiled, and conditional – as characteristic types of terrorist rhetoric. These categories are summarised in Table 7.5 by number of instances (and shown in Appendices F, G and H, column 2, of analysis of threat texts by OBL, Tarrant and Shekau, respectively). Direct threats are predominant in the terrorist texts, meaning that the terrorists tend to

communicate their threats with language that clearly identifies a threatened action (or mode of action), a targeted victim, and time and/or place of the action – or at least two or more of these elements (namely, the target and the mode of action). The increased use of direct threat also serves in amplifying the fear factor from the terrorists. For instance, in Example 31 OBL provides three pieces of information as elements of the direct threat. He specifies the target ('*the American people*', in bold), the mode of action ('*martyrdom operations*', underlined) and the place of action ('*inside and outside the United States*', dashed underlined). In Example 32, Shekau mentions two essential pieces of information that realise a direct threat: the targets of violence ('*Sultan of Kano*', and President '*Jonathan*') and the action ('*kill*', and '*wipe out*'). Similar to Shekau, Tarrant in Example 33 specifies two pieces of information: his target (in bold) and the mode of action (underlined) which is realised by mention of parts of his weapon ('*sights*') – see also Muschalik (2018) for similar mention of weapons or parts of weapon in threats – and a physical action of killing ('*...want your neck under my boot*').

(31) *I say to **the American people**: Allah willing, we are continuing fight you. We will continue the martyrdom operations inside and outside the United States.* (OBL3)

(32) *We are going to kill them; we are going to wipe them out... That is what we are going to do with **you, Sultan of Kano**. That is what we are going to do with **you, Jonathan**.* (Shekau6)

(33) *I want **you** [members of Antifa/Marxists/Communists] in my sights. I want your neck under my boot.* (Tarrant2)

Table 7.5: Summary of threat types in the threat texts

Threatener	Text	Threat type		
		direct	veiled	conditional
OBL	OBL 1	3	1	1
	OBL 3	5	1	-
Shekau	Shekau 1	6	-	-
	Shekau 2	4	-	-
	Shekau 3	7	-	-
	Shekau 4	-	4	2
	Shekau 5	3	1	2
	Shekau 6	15	1	1
	Shekau 7	17	1	1
	Shekau 8	2	-	3
	Shekau 9	1	-	1
Tarrant	Tarrant 1	1	-	-
	Tarrant 2	2	-	1

In addition to direct threats, OBL and Shekau also communicate veiled threats in their texts in combination with the other types of threat. The veiled threats appear in utterances where the language does not clearly state the violent action, its time, target and/or place, and where there is no condition that a victim needs to fulfill. These veiled threat utterances are understood in relation to the direct threats in context, emphasizing the importance of understanding threat at the text level. For example, in OBL1, OBL threatens the American people in the context of the US presence in Iraq and the hostilities of the US '*allies in Palestine*', stating that: '*Remember that for every action there is a reaction*'. This veiled threat is best understood when considering the entire text where OBL mentions the reason behind the 9/11 attacks, that is as a reaction to the US and the Israeli's hostile actions in Lebanon and Palestine.

(34) *Allah knows that it had never come to our mind to strike the towers. But after enough was enough and we witnessed the injustice and tyranny of the American-Israeli coalition against our people in Palestine and Lebanon, the idea came to my mind.*

While the language elements of a direct threat may be viewed as being elements of a "known threat", a veiled threat can still help analysts to identify an "assessed threat" to exist,

particularly when the modes of violent actions that a terrorist utilizes are previously known to the analysts (see UN Security Risk Management Manual [UNSRMM], 2017, p. 29).

This background knowledge about a terrorist's modes of violence helps to identify veiled threats which, for example, characterized Shekau⁴. For instance, the utterance (underlined) in Example 35 can be assessed as a threat against President Buhari – which aims to influence Buhari's support for democracy and the Nigerian constitution and to lead him to support instead the application of the Sharia law. This threat is assessable in light of knowing the different modes of Shekau's threat that are made available in his other texts.

Shekau's texts provide evidence of various modes of threatened actions, in the light of which an analyst can assess veiled threat utterances. These modes include shooting, killing, cutting throats, burning, taking the soldiers' weapons, fighting by guns, kidnapping, imprisonment, destroying (e.g. armoured tanks of security forces, and oil refineries) and enslaving. While some threatened acts are, in Olsson's (2008, p. 145) terms, primary forms (e.g. killing) and secondary forms (e.g. kidnapping, enslaving), Shekau's texts emphasize the value of building a profile of each terrorist (organization) in relation to their language of threatening and forms of threatened actions in order to better assess veiled threats. In addition, identification of veiled threats, as in Examples 35-36, provides clues as to how a terrorist seeks to manipulate the victim's emotions and peace of mind even when mention of a threatened action is missing. Veiled threats, as such, can be thought of as part of a terrorist's psychological warfare tactic which adjoins verbal aggression and propaganda about the terrorist's power, to modify or influence victims' behaviour through coercion and targeting their peace of mind (see also Spitaletta, 2016) through targeting their emotions and ultimately their sociopolitical choices by fear (e.g. McCauley & Mosalenko, 2016). This effect is realised in, for instance, Example 35 (underlined) where Shekau attempts to influence President Buhari's choices that target Boko Haram. A similar influence is pursued against the people of Kano (Example 36, underlined) who are accused of not following the religious traditions of 'Usman Danfodio' and thus should worry about their safety or should follow Boko Haram's religious tradition (more about the evaluative tactics used in manipulating the victims' behaviour is discussed in Section 7.4).

(35) *You [Buhari]...Continue and see, one day you will not even be able to go to the toilet and defecate.*

(36) *The people of Kano you are in trouble.*

The terrorists also use conditional threats alongside other types of threat in their texts. Unlike direct threats, in the conditional threats a threatened action is presented as being contingent on the victim's performance of some action or on the victim's behavioural compliance (i.e. 'if you..., then you/we will...' – as realised in the structures in bold in Examples 37-39). Consider Example 37 – taken from OBL1, a threat against the American people in light of the US war on Iraq – where OBL seeks to manipulate the Americans' support of the war, that is, to compel them to exercise pressure on George W. Bush to stop the war as a condition to avoid another attack such as that of 9/11. The same manipulative effect is also realised in Example 38 where Shekau threatens the Sultan of Kano and invites him to follow the Islamic ruling and Shekau's path as a condition to be safe. Similarly, Tarrant in Example 39 attempts to affect the Turk immigrants' decision on living in Europe and tries to deter them so that they leave Europe or they will be killed. This effect-based purpose of threat and more purposes are discussed in the next subsection to provide a fuller account of the purposes of the threats in the dataset. The aim is also to demonstrate how the construction of purpose, firstly, helps to reveal the negotiation of power in discourse and, secondly, provides clues to motivations of violence and what constitute "the heart of disagreement and conflict" (van Leeuwen, 2008, p. 125/136) in terms of the terrorists' agenda items and goals.

(37) ***If you were to avoid** these reasons [behind 9/11 attacks], **you would take the correct path** that would lead America to the security it enjoyed before 9/11.* (OBL1)

(38) ***If you submit to Allah, you will be welcome** so that we can practice our religion together. Submit!* (Shekau5)

(39) ***But if you attempt to live in European lands, anywhere west of the Bosphorus. We will kill you.*** (Tarrant2)

7.3.1 Purposefulness as constructed in the threat texts

The analysis of the local co-text of the identified utterances of threat types (discussed in previous subsection) reveals that the terrorist threats were constructed as purposeful. They tend to serve three main purposes of the terrorists and their organization, in terms of what needs to be (un)done. These purposes accord with van Leeuwen's (2008) purposes of social and discursive actions:

- Goal-oriented threats;
- Means-oriented threats;
- Effect-oriented threats.

The goal-oriented threats are constructed as actions for certain aims or goals. The kinds of goals vary and include, firstly, to satisfy some desires and wants. The essential meaning of this type of purpose construction can be glossed as 'I do 'X' because I want 'Y'', as in Example 40 where OBL's desire is realised in the positive INCLINATION process '**want to**' (in bold), and the desired goal is realised in a positive PROPRIETY laden-expression 'restore freedom' (underlined). Put differently, OBL wages jihad and martyrdom operations because he wants to restore freedom to the Muslim countries.

(40) We **want to** [we/+ INCLINATION (desire)] restore freedom [we/+ PROPRIETY] *to our Ummah; just as you squander our security, so shall we squander yours.* (OBL1)

The second type of goal-oriented purpose is to do/achieve something. This purpose construction can be glossed as 'I do 'X' to achieve 'Y'' such as to establish a caliphate. For instance, Shekau's purpose of the fight against the youth vigilant troops and General Rogers – the commander of operation Lafyia Dole, i.e. operation peace by force which is targeting Boko Haram – is made explicit in Example 41 by a purpose clause with '**to**' (in bold), and the desired goal is realised in a positive CAPACITY-loaded expression 'establish our caliphate' (underlined) which is positively valued as a goal worthy to die for (as realised in 'a bonus', double underlined).

(41) Our course is **to establish our caliphate** [(we) / + CAPACITY] *and die doing that. We may not be alive to see the caliphate but even if it comes to be after we die, it is still a bonus on our side* [(to die for the caliphate) / + VALUATION]. (Shekau1)

The third type of goal-oriented purpose is to curb or prevent something as a precaution (i.e. 'I do 'X' so that...not'). Consider Example 42-a where Shekau's intention to kill the State Security Service (SSS) members as a precaution (i.e. so that Shekau's followers are not chased or hurt by the SSS) is lexicalized as a '**mission**' and '**goal**' (in bold), and is also made explicit by the '**to**' clause (underlined). While this purpose is not explicitly constructed in Example 42-a, the purpose is more explicit in Example 42-b where Shekau communicates his lack of intention to kill ('*we do not have any intention*'); however, this intention is contingent on that no one

'touches' his followers (in bold) – that is, to prevent chasing of Boko Haram's members. This constructed, conditional intention serves to manipulate (i.e. deter) Nigerians' support of the Nigerian government against Shekau. It also serves to protect Shekau's followers by operating – in Spitaletta's (2016) terms – as part of a psychological warfare tactic that aims to impede unaffiliated target audiences into passive compliance, i.e. into not supporting the government's measures against Boko Haram's members. Tarrant, as in Example 43, also negates his want (*don't want*) to come into an agreement with those different in ideology (e.g. Antifa, and Marxism) to place stress on his desire and inclination to kill them as a measure to prevent the whites' loss of power.

(42) a. *I will be happy **to kill those against us** every time I encounter them. This is now the main goal of my mission, the **mission** of Shekau...* (Shekau7)

b. ***We do not have any intention** of touching any people of this town **if** they do not touch us... Anyone who is instrumental to the arrest of our members is assured that their own [turn of killing] is coming.*

(43) *I **don't want** [I/ - INCLINATION (desire)] share power...I **want** [I/+ INCLINATION (desire)] you in my sights.*

The fourth type of goal-oriented purpose is to construct a threatener's preparedness and readiness for something. For instance, in a power-demonstration scene, Shekau in Example 44 constructs his power and readiness and a threat against the Civilian Joint Task Force (CJTF) of the Borno people, as realised in the positive CAPACITY-loaded expressions '*prepared for*' and '*waiting for*' CJTF (underlined).

(44) *We are prepared for [we / + CAPACITY] it and we are waiting for you [we / + CAPACITY]. JTF, ...I am going to kill you, I am going to slit your throats.*

The goal-oriented purposes are found in the analysis to be constructed in the threateners (i.e. in social actors) and their aims. Put in van Leeuwen's (2008, p. 128) terms, the purposes are constructed "'in people,' as conscious or unconscious motives, aims, intentions, goals, etc.". A threatener is presented – in van Leeuwen's (2008, pp. 127-128) terms – as being "discursively empowered" as an "intentional" social actor. That is, a threatener is constructed as an agent who has the capacity to set a goal, decide (as in '*decided to fight*'), commit (as in '*committed to fighting*'), intend (as in '*intend to fight*') and proceed in harmful actions that influence the world and of which the threatened audience ought to be afraid. Table 7.6

presents a summary of the example clues to the goals, intentions and decisions of the three terrorists as intentional agents as found in their texts (indicative structures are in bold). The construction of these purposes is predominantly explicit. However, regardless of their explicitness or implicitness (which is beyond the scope of this thesis), the essential meaning of the goal-oriented threats is glossed as: I will do 'X' action *in order to* have/be/do 'Y'. That is, the agent of the threatened action and its purpose are the same, the threatener and their organizations.

In the means-oriented threats, the purpose of threatened actions is constructed as a mechanism for or a useful pathway or means to a particular end. That is, the purpose is constructed in the threatened actions themselves not in the threateners, the former which serves as a facilitator or having a potential or function to help do some job. The essential meaning of means-oriented threats is glossed as: 'I achieve having/being/doing 'Y' *by means of* 'X', or alternatively "X' is used to achieve 'Y". For instance, OBL in Example 45 constructs the threatened acts of '*guerrilla warfare and attrition warfare*' as a tool or a '*policy*' (in bold) by means of which OBL seeks to '*drain America to the point of bankruptcy*' – which is a manifestation of OBL's capacity – and ultimately to force America to withdraw from Iraq. Shekau also, as in Example 46, constructs the threatened acts of killing and fight against '*infidels*' as a means of proving faith and a method for entering paradise (in bold).

(45) So, we are continuing this ***policy to drain America to the point of bankruptcy***, Allah willing, and that is not difficult for Allah. (OBL1)

(46) ...We will kill and imprison...Allah made us to fight you [infidels] ***so as to taste our faith***...Those who died working for Allah, they will not lose their deeds, and they will see it in ***heaven***. (Shekau6)

Table 7.6: Summary of goals in the dataset

Text	Goals
OBL 1	to restore freedom (for the Muslim ummah) (to react and avenge the Israelis' actions against Muslims in Palestine) <i>They terrorize the women and children, and kill and captive the men... for every action there is a reaction</i> to repeat what happened [i.e. attacks similar to those of the 9/11 if the Americans do not stop their injustice]
OBL 3	...to respond in the appropriate time and place to all countries that are participating in this [US-led] unjust war, especially Britain, Spain, Australia, Poland, Japan, and Italy. The participating states of the Islamic world, particularly the Gulf states, and chiefly Kuwait, the land base for the Crusader forces, are not excluded. to fight...stab...and inflict a massacre in the Americans <i>...we will have the legal retribution from your own blood</i> [in return of the killing of Muslims particularly in Palestine] <i>will fight</i> [the Americans in Iraq]
Tarrant 1	<i>I don't want share power ...I want you in my sights...want your neck under my boot.</i>
Tarrant 2	<i>...destroy every mosque and minaret in the city [Constantinople].</i>
Shekau 1	to establish our caliphate
Shekau 2	<i>detonate bombs...for God's sake</i>
Shekau 3	to do proper Sharia
Shekau 5	want to implement the religion of the Koran want to fight...want to be wounded...want our blood to flow. ...wish for death so we can rest in the cemeteries of paradise trying to be saved by Allah to kill them...going to wipe them [i.e. Sultan of Kano, Jonathan, and those who blaspheme] out
Shekau 6	until...get majority over infidels of the world until we soak the ground of Nigeria with infidels' blood and that of the so-called Muslims contradicting Islam. <i>...will open prison and imprison [the infidels]</i> <i>...will kill Jonathan</i>
Shekau 7	decided to fight [JTF] committed to fighting [JTF] intend to fight the Kato da Gora happy to kill those against us...This is...the mission of Shekau going to slit your [SSS] throats killing is my mission now going to take those women [of infidels, going to Western education] and sell them fight the whole world, especially all those who do not practice Islam going to kill you all [those who do not convert to Islam] <i>to burn the constitution</i> to blow you [infidels] up with my bombs...to slit your throat
Shekau 8	Our objective is not to kill or humiliate or steal [in mobilization of Muslims against Christians]

Concerning the effect-oriented threats, the purpose of threatened actions is constructed so as to emphasize the outcome, result or effect of the actions. The essential meaning of effect-oriented threats is glossed as: 'doing 'X' builds or *leads to* 'Y'', or alternatively 'I do 'X' *so that* the victims or someone else – but not the threatener – do 'Y''. That is, a threatened action causes the action of some other social actors. To illustrate this, see Example 47 in which OBL constructs the desired outcome of his threatened jihadist operations against America as being of deterrence, that is so that the Americans '*terminate...injustice, stop...stupidity, and curb [the US] insolent fellows*', as realised in the 'until-clause' (in bold). Tarrant also (see Example 48) constructs the effect of his threatened acts against Turks as being to lead them to flee European lands and live in Turkey, which is an advantageous effect for the wellbeing of whites and disadvantageous to Turkish immigrants. This effect corroborates Shuy's (1993, p. 98) suggestion that language is used to "threaten the wellbeing of another [group of people]" coming, in this case, from a different ethnicity and religious background. Shekau also constructs the outcome of his threat against, for example, General Buratai (the Chief of Army Staff) and the people of Maiduguri (Example 49) as that of compellent effect, that is, so they convert to Islam and become true Muslims (as positively judged deeds – underlined) and abandon commitment to the values of democracy and constitution, which amounts to negatively appreciated forms of infidelity (double underlined). This effect of having non-Muslims convert to and accept Islam appears repeatedly in Shekau's texts (e.g., Shekau2, Shekau3, Shekau6, Shekau7).

(47) *We will continue the martyrdom operations inside and outside the United States **until you terminate your injustice, stop your stupidity, and curb your insolent fellows.*** (OBL3)

(48) **FLY TO YOUR OWN LANDS**, WHILE YOU STILL HAVE THE CHANCE. (Tarrant2)

(49) *The only way out for you [General Buratai] is to accept Islam in the proper way and repent your sins... We have no dialogue or truce between you and us... What we have between us is fire for fire; rifle for rifle. If you repent and become true Muslims, then we will lay down our rifles... To the people of Maiduguri... As long as you are under constitution, you are infidel...* (Shekau3)

In sum, the analysis of the purposefulness constructed in the threat texts reveals that the threats are constructed as being either goal-, means-, or effect oriented which assist the threateners in procuring particular material or symbolic profits. These purposes corroborate

Fraser's (1998) contention that threateners use language for various reasons and purposes, including: to show the seriousness of their purpose (e.g. establishing a state or Caliphate, restoring justice); to challenge authorities; and to make a desired result happen (through using threatened actions as means to an end, or through manipulating the targets' choices via deterrence or compelling). The constructed purposes also provide signs of the negotiated power relations and supply clues of: firstly, the objectives that are at the heart of disagreement and conflict between the groups of primary social actors; secondly, the violent/power means to the terrorists' ends; and thirdly, the semantic options that the terrorists use in order to affect the choices of the victims or their wider audiences. These findings on power relations provide support to those in previous research (e.g. Shuy, 1993; Fraser, 1998; Gales, 2010), that the practice of threatening tilts the scale of power in favour of the threatener and to the detriment of the threatened audiences. Building on the idea of affecting the addressees' choices and the moral values behind the practice of this influence, Section 7.4 next discusses the macro-functions of the threats (see e.g. Muschalik, 2018) as realised by evaluative language at the text level.

The aim of the next section is to showcase: how coupling of social actors with attitudinal values manifests in the threat texts; how the texts attempt to discursively position the victims in disalignment with the threatener; and what functions this positioning has in terms of coercing the addressed audiences into specific choices that are benefiting the speaker and serving them to procure some material or symbolic profit. In so doing, the next section builds on Shuy's (1993, pp. 99-105) notion of a threatener's profile – that is, a threatener's engagement in tactics and topic areas that reveal the threatener's pursuit of power and influence – which may take the form of: "complaints" about injustices which serve in offering to settle conflicts; and "accusations" to arouse fear and justify violence. While Shuy focused on speech acts to identify these tactics, the next section reports on and discusses the findings of a discourse analysis of the evaluative structure of the threat texts, specifically the personal opinions and evaluations deployed in negotiating the disalignment between the threateners and the addressed audiences as well as the tactics used to forge disalignment via evaluative choices. This evaluative structure analysis is, nevertheless, aligned with Shuy's (1993, p. 105) contention that a threatener's text-structure could be built on (ir)rational argumentation and maintenance of certain positions and possibly "replaces logical or factual argumentation with

emotional, personalized (*ad hominem*) issues and shouting". The focus in the next section is placed on victims – those social actors who are specified in the threat texts as the targets of the threatened acts – to enable identification of the victims and features or values coupled with the victims, as the main topic of discourse and the target of value-disalignment and social disaffiliation (for a similar focus on victims, see Hurt & Grant, 2019).

7.4 Discursive functions of the threat texts: strategies employed and bonds contested

The overall strategy of positive self-presentation and negative victim presentation is typical in the dataset. This presentation provides an account of beliefs and worldviews that are advantageous to the threateners' interests, and disadvantageous to, discrediting, delegitimizing and blaming the victims. The evaluative couplings and bond types (as shown in Appendices F, G and H, column 3) are tactically deployed in alignment with three discursive macro-functions (as shown in Appendices H, I and J, column 4): ethical manipulation, deontic retribution, and boulomaic effect (discussed in the next subsections). These findings are aligned with Hermann's (2003) argument that a threatener engages in two main activities. The first includes attempts to regulate the behaviour of other persons and social groups. These attempts are found in the dataset to be revolving around three regulatory discursive functions: manipulation, retribution, and boulomaic effect (explained in the subsequent subsections). The second activity is concerned with a threateners' endeavour to persuade and ideologically position persons and social groups by, for example, speech acts such as accusations. These endeavours are found in the dataset to be the tactics that are used to gear up the evaluative couplings, namely the tactics of discrediting (by accusation, criticism, and insulting), blaming, denying and (de)legitimizing, while engaging in forceful actions (e.g. threatened attacks) and justifying them. The evaluative couplings that realise the contested, disaligning bonds (e.g. bonds of victims' impropriety) appear in particular patterns. These bonds and frequency-based patterns are summarised in Table 7.7 to give a synoptic view on the attitudinal bases of the bonds tabled as a foundation for disaffiliation and a moral justification of violence against victims. (Note: Most frequent attitudinal bases of bonds are in bold).

Table 7.7: Summary of the bonds tabled as bases for disalignment

JUDGEMENT-based bonds	Frequency		APPRECIATION-based bonds	Frequency	AFFECT-based bonds	Frequency
Social esteem-related bonds	Capacity	204	Valuation	102	Security	26
	Tenacity	23	Reaction	7	Happiness	15
	Normality	11	Composition	2	Satisfaction	6
Social sanction-related bonds	Propriety	267	-	-	Inclination	13
	Veracity	55	-	-	-	-

Table 7.7 presents an increased rate of use of JUDGEMENT-based bonds. These findings provide support to those in research on discourses of violence (e.g. Gales, 2011; Hurt & Grant, 2019), that texts with ethically charged topics such as killing and murder tend to use more judgements than any other attitude type. In Martin and White's (2005, p. 52) terms, these results also provide clues about a threatener's "attitudes to people and the way [threateners] behave" and view other people's acts. This increased rate of JUDGEMENT colours the discursive functions – discussed in the next subsections – with ethicality. The APPRECIATION-based bonds are the second-most used, meaning that not only actions related to social sanction and social esteem values are critical to the formation and legitimation of threatened actions but also the APPRECIATION-based bonds – that is, appreciation of entities, processes and aspects of personal identities. These APPRECIATION based bonds reveal an ideological reworking of feelings towards victims as propositions about their value and, hence, whether worthy of human or inhuman treatment based on "what they are worth or not" (Martin & White, 2005, p. 45). While presenting (in)security as a main affective theme in their texts, the threateners use AFFECT-based bonds the least, meaning that the threateners tend to show more antipathy towards the victims, to distance the threateners from emotional connections with victims, and to strengthen their overall appearance of ideological determination and emotional detachment – for similar findings of least-used AFFECT in violence discourse, see also Gales (2010). Although PROPRIETY, CAPACITY and VALUATION-based bonds are predominant in the dataset – see Figure 7.1 for a visual representation – and are used to serve the various functions of the threat texts, the remaining types of attitude-based bonds with least

frequency of use (e.g. VERACITY, TENACITY and INCLINATION-based bonds) are also used for the same discursive functions.

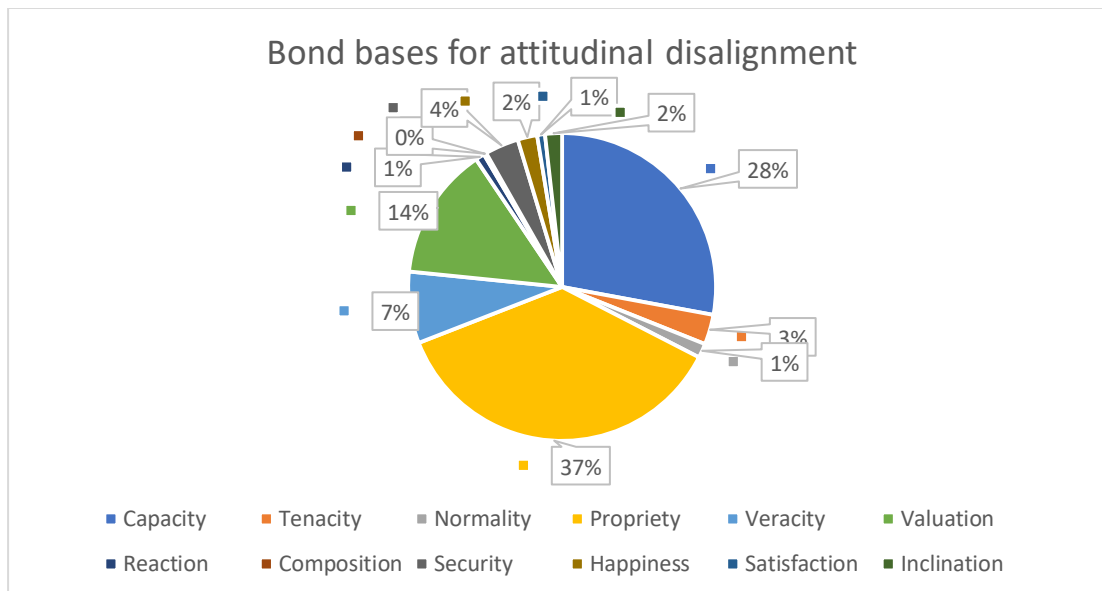


Figure 7.1: Frequency of attitude-based bonds used in the threat texts

The following subsections report and discuss the discursive functions of the threat texts and the tactics used to gear the key bonds to achieve these functions. Table 7.8 summarises the threat texts in which instances of the discursive functions are identified within different textual chunks whose manual counts are also provided.

Table 7.8: Summary of the discursive functions in the threat texts

Threat text	Discursive functions		
	Ethical manipulation	Deontic retribution	Boulomaic threat
OBL 1	17	7*	-
OBL 3	-	10	-
Tarrant 1	-	-	1
Tarrant 2	2	1	1
Shekau 1	2	2	3
Shekau 2	2	1	1
Shekau 3	5	1	-
Shekau 4	5	-	-
Shekau 5	8	-	1
Shekau 6	18	-	1
Shekau 7	13	1	1
Shekau 8	3	5	-
Shekau 9	2	-	-

**Reported retribution events which serve in manipulation*

7.4.1 Ethical manipulation and the disaffiliation tactics utilized to serve in manipulation

Ethical manipulation refers to the function of a terrorist threat text that operates by: (i) deterring the victims from taking a position or performing an action that is unfavourable to a threatener's ingroup; or (ii) compelling them to (not) act in a way that is (dis)advantageous to the ingroup, whereby the threatener's group ideological or physical territories are preserved and benefits are maintained. For example, OBL1 manifests as a manipulative text where OBL, while constructing al-Qaeda as a powerful social actor who can execute another Manhattan attack similar to those of the 9/11 attacks, mentions explicitly that the function of his text is of deterrence and avoidance of cost of their war on Iraq (see Example 54, in bold).

*(50) People of America, this talk of mine, for you, concerns the ideal way **to prevent another Manhattan...***

This function is aligned with Muschalik's (2018) and Martínez's (2013) coercive, manipulative function of threats – a function that manifests, in Sachs' (2012) terms, in two forms: deterring and/or compelling. This ethical manipulation function is related to an ongoing or a future action taken or possibly (not) taken by the threatened audiences, where the evaluative

language serves to instantiate the bonds that serve the ethical justification of avoidance of cost of non-compliance with the threat message. That is, to achieve this manipulation, a threatener is found to be gearing key bonds via a series of tactics – discrediting, blaming and denying (specifically, responsibility-shifting, framing, denying of intention, and reversal), and (de)legitimizing – which are explained and exemplified in the subsequent subsections.

7.4.1.1 Discrediting

Discrediting is the tactic used to forge threatener-victim disalignment by spoiling the image of or casting discredit on the threatened audience (e.g. the American citizens) or part of them (e.g. the Bush administration) through criticizing, accusing or insulting descriptions relating to criteria such as dishonesty and incapability. This tactic is based on Poggi, D'Errico and Vincze's (2011) and D'Errico and Poggi's (2012) concept of discrediting in political discourse, a practice that involves casting doubts on an opponent's characteristics via negative evaluations about them. Emphasis in my analysis is placed on the persons discredited and the features (e.g. capacity) attacked and as realised by evaluative couplings. The aim here is to shed light on the discursive dimensions relating to polarized structures of positive self-representation versus negative victim-representation (see e.g. van Dijk, 2006), in terms of enhancing the moral superiority of the threatener and discrediting (or vilifying) dissidents and victims as being, for example, opportunistic, non-trustworthy and hence immoral. Discrediting is predominant in OBL's and Shekau's texts.

7.4.1.1.1 Discrediting by OBL

Discrediting is used in OBL's threat texts to enable him to influence the American people's trust in their political leadership (i.e. Bush administration), as a step towards inviting the Americans to act in protest of the war against Iraq and, ultimately, to avoid another wave of '9/11 attacks'. To serve this manipulative function, OBL constructs Bush and his administration negatively in OBL1. That is, Bush and his administration are constructed: as being responsible for the 9/11 attacks; as corrupted benefitters from waging wars at the expense of the Americans' economy and security; and as incapable of protecting the Americans from al-Qaeda. Thus, OBL attacks Bush's features of PROPRIETY, CAPACITY, TENACITY and VERACITY.

For instance, while al-Qaeda ('we') is coupled with positive CAPACITY as a deterrence feature, OBL discredits Bush and his administration by attacking their ethicality – as in examples 51-52. That is, through coupling them with negative PROPRIETY, specifically by adequation (see Hodge, 2007) of the Bush administration's features compared to those of Arab regimes (e.g. 'arrogance', and 'misappropriation of wealth') (Example 51) and their 'tyranny' (Example 52). In addition, to construct Bush's interests in the Iraqi war as being different from those of the Americans' public interests, OBL (as in Example 52) attacks Bush's VERACITY by accusing him of waging the war under the untrue 'pretext' of counterterrorism – just for his private interest. For instance, OBL in Example 53 accuses Bush of deliberate ignoring of the warnings by 'American thinkers and wise men' about going for the 'unjustified war', driven by Bush's IMPROPRIETY, i.e. greed in Iraq's oil, and lack of TENACITY, i.e. placing his companies' interests first regardless of the 'reality' that: *'the death toll [among the US troops] rose [and] the American economy has been drained'*.

(51) *The most important [results of the 9/11 war] are: that **we** had no difficulty [we/+ CAPACITY] dealing with **Bush and his administration** given the similarities between them and the regimes in our countries [...] Both types [of administration] are replete with those characterized by prejudiced lordliness, arrogance, and misappropriation of wealth [Bush...administration/- PROPRIETY].*

(52) *So, **he** transferred tyranny and suppression of freedoms to his country [he/- PROPRIETY], and they named it the Patriot Act and used it as a pretext [[he/- VERACITY] to fight terrorism.*

(53) *But the luring **darkness of the black gold** blurred his eyesight and insight [Bush being lured by black gold (oil)/- VALUATION (invoking – PROPRIETY)], and **he** put his private interests first and prioritized over the public interests of America [he/- TENACITY].*

Amid this unethicity of the US political leadership, al-Qaeda is constructed as not only capable of dealing with the US leadership and troops but also as of superior morality (see Example 54). That is, al-Qaeda is experienced in fighting oppression and 'oppressor-superpowers' such as Russia in Afghanistan. This construction of self-moral power serves in contrasting OBL with the US Army Generals' INCAPACITY ('losses') and in their lack of TENACITY and in their power being used unethically for their personal profits, albeit conceding 'America human, economic, and political losses' and Bush's 'resort to emergency funds to continue the fight in Afghanistan and Iraq' (see Example 55).

(54) *In addition, **we** gained experience in guerrilla warfare and attrition warfare [we/+ CAPACITY], while **we** struggled with the oppressor-superpowers [we/+ CAPACITY].*

(55) *It is enough to send two Mujahidin...to make **Generals** run there quickly to incur America human, economic, and political losses [(the US Generals)/- CAPACITY], without achieving for America anything of note other than some profits to **their private companies** [(the US General)/- TENACITY].*

Discrediting, as such, tends to be used to cast doubt about key features of the threatened audience, specifically the Bush administration, to influence the Americans' perception of and relationship with their leadership and ultimately their stance and action towards stopping the war in Iraq. Put differently, the bonds that OBL tables as a basis for disalignment with the Americans serves to construct the American leadership as non-trustworthy and incapable of providing security to the Americans who are '*the real loser*' but not the '*Bush administration-linked corporations like Halliburton*'. This construction of 'reality' serves to invite the threatened audiences – as social actors responsible for their own security – to rethink their relationship with their leadership, its corrupt companies (e.g. Generals) and their stance towards sending their children to the '*unjustified war*' under the '*pretext to fight terrorism*', as a condition to maintain their security (as in Example 56). In Poggi, D'Errico and Vincze's (2011) and D'Errico and Poggi's (2012) terms, discrediting has enabled OBL to target Bush's benevolence, that is, to raise doubts about his being full of civil values or taking care of all Americans' interests and to present him instead as a politician of malevolent wrongs. This serves the OBL threat texts' function of manipulation.

(56) *In conclusion, I say to **you** [people of America] nothing but the truth, that your security is not in the hands of Kerry, Bush, or al-Qaeda. Your security is in your own hands [(the American people)/- CAPACITY]. And every state that does not play with our security has automatically guaranteed its own security.*

7.4.1.1.2 Discrediting by Shekau

Shekau uses discrediting tactics within the Nigerian context where his aim is to establish his caliphate as an alternative of what he perceives as weak, dishonest and illegitimate governance. Shekau tends to construct his CAPACITY while casting doubt on the CAPACITY of the victims, to serve in manipulating the victims' perception of his power image and the incapability of his opponents, through two practices. The first is through announcing his commitment to future violent actions and claiming responsibility for past actions as in: '*Well, you should know that **we** are the authors of the work [we/ + CAPACITY] carried out in Maiduguri*'. The second is through manipulating the victims' perception of the Nigerian

officials and troops as being weak, and thus that ‘the only’ choice for the Nigerians to enjoy security and avoid the cost of violence is through converting to Islam. For example, in a clear threat to the Nigerian security forces and Christian Nigerians in Shekau 8, Shekau challenges the capacity of President Jonathan and casts doubts about Jonathan’s capability to extract the so-called Boko Haram ‘*cancer*’ from Nigeria, by describing Jonathan’s endeavours as beyond his power, as realised by coupling him with negative CAPACITY (see Example 57). By evaluations such as these, Shekau implies that the opponent is incompetent to lead the country to the stabilization that the victims seek for. Instead, Jonathan is invited to consider another option, ‘*to repent*’, *accept Islam* and stop following Shekau’s fighters. Similar doubts are cast on the CAPACITY of the Civilian Joint Task Force (CJTF) and the vigilant youths who work to extirpate Boko Haram fighters (see also Agbiboa, 2020), and on the CAPACITY of General Buratai, the Chief of Nigerian Army Staff (see Example 58), which serves in building a negative image of Buratai’s power and the Nigerian forces’ control over the security situation. Shekau, however, offers General Buratai a way to end ‘*this war*’, that is by accepting Islam and practicing ‘*the proper worship of God*’ and doing ‘*proper Sharia*’.

(57) ...*this is beyond your power. It is not our doing but that of God. It is beyond you [you (Jonathan)] / - CAPACITY*. (Shekau 8)

(58) **You** need to know that *there is no way you could end this war by killing us as you usually claimed* [you (General Buratai) / - CAPACITY] ... *The only way out for you* [you / - CAPACITY] *is to accept Islam in the proper way and repent your sins...*

Shekau also tends to couple his victims with negative VERACITY to cast doubt on the opponents’ truthfulness in saying and doing things relating to bringing stability to Nigeria. This construction serves ultimately to present, for example, President Buhari (see Example 59) with an image of a helpless, lying person who spends Nigerians’ money under the pretext of combatting Boko Haram and freeing hostages and kidnapped children. In so doing, Shekau seeks to manipulate the audiences’ perception of Buhari’s benevolence, and compels Buhari to stop lying and instead follow Shekau’s religious path as a solution towards stabilization. In contrast to his victims, Shekau couples himself with positive VERACITY, particularly in relation to executing his promised harm (e.g. to destroy the ‘*oil refinery*’), which ultimately magnifies fear in his victims in an attempt to compel them to not support the government troops against Boko Haram and to follow Shekau’s path towards establishing the caliphate (see Example 60). In addition to coupling his opponents with INCAPACITY and INVERACITY, negative VALUATION and

negative PROPRIETY are also used to manipulate the perception of victims as inhuman or doers of improper actions, who hence are encouraged to become worthy by converting to Islam and to stop from doing what is 'wrong' in order to be saved. For instance, Shekau casts an inhuman, valueless image on victims (as in Example 61) to manipulate their stance and to compel them to become Muslims, since remaining as infidels endows them with valueless or dehumanized status (e.g. 'sheep') and hence makes them worthy to be killed. Shekau also tends to couple his victims with negative PROPRIETY within the framework of a two-camps-worldview: '*those that are with us, and the rest*'. This binary oppositional construction of the world serves in manipulation of the conflict as being between followers of 'bad' Christianity, which Shekau perceives as '*paganism*' (as in Shekau8), and followers of 'good' Islam. Within this framework, the victims are compelled to choose to which camp they belong in order to be saved. For instance, Shekau, as in Example 62, constructs the president of Christian Association of Nigeria as well as Christian Nigerians as cheaters, killers and humiliators of Muslim Nigerians – thus lacking PROPRIETY. As such, Shekau's camp is constructed as a defender and the camp of PROPRIETY.

(59) **Buhari**, all your actions are fake [Buhari/ - VERACITY]. **You** are lying to the people [Buhari/ - VERACITY], collecting their money and saying you will free their children and you know **you** are lying [Buhari/ - VERACITY] ... I am talking to you **Buhari**...continue and see... But if you repent, then you are a brother. Repent and follow the Quran. (Shekau4)

(60) Wait and see. I had promised to put an end to your [oil] refinery. Oh well, you will soon see, the refinery will be destroyed in the coming days... **We** do everything we say we will do [we/ + VERACITY] ... **We** always do what we say [we/ - VERACITY]. (Shekau8)

(61) **Any infidel** is a sheep to be sold [any infidel/ - VALUATION], **Jonathan**, if I catch you, I will sell you...for peanut [Jonathan/ - VALUATION]. **Infidels** do not have value... [infidels/ - VALUATION] (Shekau6)

(62) ...you **Christians** cheated [Christians/ - PROPRIETY] and killed us to the extent of eating our flesh like cannibals [Christians/ - PROPRIETY]! **You** did all you wanted to us... **you** slaughtered us [Christians/ - PROPRIETY] and took our wives [Christians/ - PROPRIETY] and humiliated us [Christians/ - PROPRIETY]! ... This is why as leader of this sect I tell you to repent... and **we** do not harm anybody, but anybody that looks for our trouble... [we/ + PROPRIETY]! (Shekau8)

In brief, Shekau strategically utilizes discrediting to attribute lack of power, lack of veracity, impropriety and negative valuation to the opponents as an act of remarking a negative evaluation of religious opponents, security personnel and Nigerian officials. In Poggi, D'Errico and Vincze's (2011) terms, these opponents are presented as people with pretended

superiority and actual inferiority (to Shekau's power, veracity, propriety and value), in a violated expectation to the way the Nigerian people are presented.

7.4.1.2 Blaming and denying: Responsibility and blame shifting

Blaming and denying is used to forge threatener-victim disalignment by designing arguments that manipulate the audience perception so that the threatener should not be regarded as being responsible and blameworthy and, instead, the victims should be blamed. This tactic operates by manipulating the audiences' perception: (i) of harm or loss, by proposing that there is no reason to blame the threatener because the harm is little or an appropriate response; and (ii) perception of agency, by proposing that harm is done unintentionally or instigated by someone else. This tactic is based on: Hansson's (2015) conceptualization of blame-avoidance; and van Dijk's (2006) concept of blaming as a form of manipulation through which a language user seeks to discursively influence the positions and mental models of text-recipients by, for example, "the re-attribution of responsibility of actions in their own interests" (van Dijk, 2006, p. 368). This tactic is used by OBL and Shekau.

OBL, as in OBL1, shifts the blame for the 9/11 attacks to the history of the Americans' support for the Israelis' invasion and bombardment of Lebanon, and their killing and displacement of the Lebanese in the 1980s, a description that couples the Americans with IMPROPRIETY (see Example 63). These improper American actions in the Middle East are constructed as a source of sorrow and desire to retaliate (dotted lined). Via this construction, the perception of the reattributed responsibility of the Americans for the 9/11 attacks and the threat of repeating them serves to generate fear in the American people so that they are compelled (at least cognitively) to rethink this attribution of responsibility in order to avoid future threats. To refute any antithesis of this reattribution of responsibility, OBL describes Bush's declared reasons for the war as an unethical act and lack of VERACITY (Example 64), that is, as a form of: '*distortion, misinformation...*'. In addition, to manipulate the Americans' perception of agency and losses caused or that might be caused in future by al-Qaeda, OBL (as in Example 65) proposes that there is no reason to blame him because the (would-be) inflicted losses are, firstly, appropriately similar punishment to that inflicted upon 'Our' ingroup – as the phrase '*in kind*' implicates (Grice, 1975), i.e. 'We' target towers in America for towers 'You' the Americans targeted in Lebanon. Secondly, the losses are presented as creating relatively less

harm as implicated by the partitive article 'some', as in: '*...so that [the Americans] taste **some** of what we tasted*', which serves in manipulating the perception of the threatener's actions as being loaded with PROPRIETY, unlike those of the Americans which should be '*refrained*' from and thus coupled with IMPROPRIETY.

(63) *The events that directly affected my soul go back to 1982 and the ensuing events when **America** permitted the Israelis to invade Lebanon [America/- PROPRIETY] supported by the American 3rd Fleet [the American 3rd fleet/- PROPRIETY], the bombardment began [American-Israeli coalition/- PROPRIETY], many were killed and injured [American-Israeli coalition/- PROPRIETY], and many others were terrorized and displaced [American-Israeli coalition/- PROPRIETY].*

(64) *But I am amazed at you. Though we are approaching the fourth year after the events of 9/11, **Bush** is still practicing distortion, misinformation and hiding (from you) the real cause [Bush/- VERACITY]. And thus, the reasons are still there to repeat what happened.*

(65) *While I was looking at those demolished towers in Lebanon, it triggered in my mind that **we** should punish the oppressor **in kind** [we/+ PROPRIETY], and should destroy towers in America [(we)/+ PROPRIETY] so that **they** taste some of what we tasted and **they** refrain from killing our women and children [they/- PROPRIETY].*

Shekau also uses responsibility shifting to manipulate the audience's perception so that the threatener should not be blamed since harm is urged by someone else, particularly God, and hence coupled with positive PROPRIETY. For instance, in Example 66, Shekau shifts the responsibility for arresting and detaining his victims to God (wave underlined) who instructed him to do so, which serves in coupling Shekau's actions with positive PROPRIETY. Similarly, in Example 67, the acts of hitting the neck of infidels and those who support democracy, the Nigerian consultation and the Western type of education are ascribed to Allah's command. In this act of responsibility shifting, Shekau applies "topoi" (see Reisigl & Wodak, 2001, p. 79), or alternatively the topos of divine law, to justify and legitimise his positions by providing a commonplace of obedience to God and God's divine rules. In Bandura's (2016) terms, Shekau evades personal accountability for harmful actions by shifting the responsibility to a divine source of commands. Via this shift of responsibility, Shekau attempts to manipulate the audience's perception of his actions as being a kind of doing of God's bidding (wave underlined – Example 67) for which he should not be blamed; instead, the victims should be blamed for violating religious, codified norms and for '*practicing paganism*', hence for their improper actions. Shekau's violence is thus constructed as a deterrent to the Nigerians so that they stop going to the Western form of education and do not accept democracy and

constitution as alternatives to the Sharia law, otherwise they should be blamed for violating the topos of divine law. The evaluative couplings, as such, thus serve to construct “sacred justifications” (Bandura, 2016, p. 316) and blame shifting in Shekau’s texts.

(66) God has instructed us to catch whoever that is not following our path and detain such persons in our prisons [us/ + PROPRIETY] ... Whatever we see in the holy book is what we do [we/ + PROPRIETY]. We do not look elsewhere. (Shekau2)

(67) If we meet infidels, if we meet those that become infidels, according to Allah, there is no any talk except hitting of the neck...This is from Allah on the need for us to break down infidels, practitioners of democracy, and constitutionalism, voodoo and those that are doing western education, in which they are practicing paganism. (Shekau6)

7.4.1.3 Blaming and denying: Framing

Framing is used to forge threatener-victim disalignment by structuring an experience in a form that establishes “definitions of a situation” (Goffman, 1974, p. 10). These definitions, firstly, facilitate the audience’s making sense of discursively constructed, social experiences, and secondly, create threatener-victim dis/re-alignments as well as their dis/re-alignments with what/who is evaluated. This tactic is based on, firstly, Hansson’s (2015) concept of blame avoidance in which framing is used as a tactic, and secondly, Gordon’s (2015) argument that framing plays a key role in aligning speakers to one another and to utterances. This tactic is used in OBL’s and Tarrant’s texts.

OBL, for example, in an attempt to manipulate Americans’ perception of his violent intentions and to shift blame for threatened martyrdom operations and another Manhattan on the part of the Americans, uses two frames. He uses them in such a way that the American people are positioned either for each of these frames or against these frames if they choose to be blameworthy. As such, the threatened audiences (i.e. the Americans) are morally compelled to do what is ‘right’ to avoid being positioned against the frames and ultimately to avoid the cost of the threatened harm. The first frame that OBL uses is “the Bad Apple” frame (see, e.g., Lakoff, 2008, pp. 163–167). For instance, OBL, in Example 68, deploys a proverb – ‘*An ounce of prevention is better than a pound of cure*’ – which evokes a basic moral: take the preventive measures as early as possible and you will be saved from the costly harm. Interpreting the proverb in the light of a potential repetition of the 9/11 attacks, the good (yet, polluted) contains the American people, the polluting or sickening apple is the Bush administration

(immoral), and the ‘sane’ American people can do what is right and curb ‘*the White House-liar*’ (Bush/ - VERACITY) as an act of PROPRIETY to stay safe, or they can allow Bush to go bad and spoil the ‘*security, wealth and children*’ of America – a spoil for which al-Qaeda should thus not be blamed. In Seals’ (2012) terms, this framing serves to position the American people – coupled with positive CAPACITY – in a way that influences their impressions and understandings of the events and the conditions required to avoid threatened violence, and thus that is relative to their (in)security experiences. In other words, the Bad Apple frame is used to, firstly, manipulate the Americans’ impression of OBL as being not blameworthy and to find a target in their society to blame, and secondly, to manipulate their understanding of ‘*the correct path*’ in order to protect themselves and preserve their security – if the Bad Apple goes, America keeps ‘*the security it enjoyed before 9/11*’.

(68) *As has been said: ‘An ounce of prevention is better than a pound of cure.’ And know that **returning to the right** is better than persisting in wrong [returning to the right/+ PROPRIETY]; and that the sane person does not squander his security, wealth and children [(those who do not squander...) /+ CAPACITY] for the sake of the White House-liar [(Bush) /- VERACITY].*

OBL also uses the “Rescue narrative” frame (Lakoff, 2008, p. 24) to attribute blame to the American people and to manipulate their position. In Hansson’s (2015) terms, according to this frame, OBL constructs a social reality in which an inherently evil social actor (Villain – the Bush administration) harms the American people (Victim), then a wise or inherently good social actor (Hero) works to defeat and punish the Villain in order to rescue the Victim and enable them to be rewarded with security and wellbeing. Consider Example 69 where OBL couples the Americans who may take the right ‘*actions to find and avoid disasters*’ causes’ with positive CAPACITY (‘*wise people*’). Invoking this wisdom feature, the ‘good’ American addressees are positioned as potential Hero who should punish those responsible for causing ‘*the killing of over 1000 of [the American] sons for money*’ in Iraq and Palestine; otherwise, the Americans are held blameworthy and responsible for ‘*let[ting] the noble escape*’. That is, the entire nation is framed (Example 70) as being with the CAPACITY to punish the Villain, be they from ‘*the weak*’ or ‘*the noble*’, or to let them ‘*escape*’ and go unpunished for acts of IMPROPRIETY (e.g. terrorizing, killing and imprisoning). In the case that the nation decides not to do what is ‘right’, OBL then attempts to manipulate the Americans’ perception of his agency that he is not doing the wrong thing or he should not be regarded blameworthy or the Villain

but instead should be viewed as being an actor against improper actions of a common Villain. The American people in each state (see Example 71) are thus positioned to struggle and defeat this Villain in order to enjoy security, or they will endanger their security.

(69) *The wise people, instead, when disasters strike, make it one of their most important actions to find and avoid disasters' causes [(those who find and avoid disasters' causes)/+ CAPACITY].*

(70) *Be aware that it is **the nation** that punishes the weak when he causes the killing of one of its sons for the sake of money [nation/+ CAPACITY] and that lets the noble escape [nation/+ CAPACITY] when he causes the killing of over 1000 of its sons for money too. And the same applies to your allies in Palestine. **They** terrorize the women and children, and kill and take captive the men [they (the US allies in Palestine)/- PROPRIETY].*

(71) *I say to you nothing but the truth [I (OBL)/+ VERACITY], that your security is not in the hands of Kerry, Bush, or al-Qaeda. Your security is in your own hands [(the American people)/+ CAPACITY].*

Tarrant also uses framing in his threat against Turks (in Tarrant2). Tarrant (Examples 72-73) shifts the responsibility onto Turks for their security or any violence that may target them. That is, Tarrant attempts to manipulate Turks' perception of who should be blamed for harm to come if they choose to stay and live in Europe, compelling them to rethink their stay in Europe (or '*anywhere west of the Bosphorus*') and to decide, instead, to live in Turkey '*On the east side of the Bosphorus*' which is coupled with positive SECURITY. In this act of manipulation, Tarrant uses the Bad Apple frame to present Turks as being dehumanized, as realised in coupling them with the negative VALUATION lexical item '*roaches*' that conveys them being dirt and sickness for the European lands, providing the moral justification for driving Turks out of those lands. Put differently, this frame lays the ground for the threatener to morally disengage (Bandura, 2016) from victims through obliterating any sense of shared humanity, which allows Tarrant to commit violence while living in peace with himself.

(72) ***You** can live in peace in your own lands [You / + SECURITY], and may no harm come to you. *On the east side of the Bosphorus.**

(73) *But if you attempt to live in European lands, anywhere west of the Bosphorus. **We** will kill you and drive you roaches from our lands [we / + JUDGEMENT].*

7.4.1.4 Blaming and denying: Denying and reversal

Denying and reversal mechanism is used as a social defence strategy of threatener-victim disalignment. This strategy involves: (i) defending against the accusations and formation of negative impressions about self or ingroup (denying); and (ii) accusing victims of the same acts that the threatener is performing or accused of, or alternatively changing the victims into aggressors and aggressors being portrayed as victims (reversal). This tactic is based on van Dijk's (1989, 1998b, 1992, p. 92) reversal tactic (by blaming the victim) and his typology of denying which includes, inter alia, intention-denial ("I did not mean that", "You got me wrong") and goal-denial ("I did not do/say that in order to..."). For instance, OBL (Example 74) denies any previous intention to target the Twin Towers (*'it had never come to our mind...'*, in bold), but that it was the IMPROPRIETY (*'injustice and tyranny'*) of America and its Israeli allies that changed the situation (as *'but'* implicates, wave underlined) and instigated *'our'* DISSATISFACTION and the idea of *'reaction'* (dotted underlined). This propositional relation (i.e. implication) is an ideologically relevant property of evaluative meaning by means of which information related to blameworthiness is – in van Dijk's (1998a, p. 207) terms – explicitly asserted to emphasize negative properties of outgroups and positive properties about the ingroup. By means of reversal, OBL as such can "turn the tables" (Wodak, 1991, p. 77) by accusing *'the American-Israeli coalition'* of being the agents who targeted the towers in Palestine and Lebanon and thus whom should be blamed for the later consequences in America.

(74) Allah knows that ***it had never come to our mind to strike the towers***. *But after enough was enough* [(American-Israeli coalition)/- SATISFACTION] *and we witnessed the injustice and tyranny of the American-Israeli coalition against our people in Palestine and Lebanon* [(American-Israeli coalition)/- PROPRIETY], *the idea came to my mind*.

Reversal is also used in terms of accusing America of a series of acts of IMPROPRIETY such as intentional killing and injustice (see Example 80) to lay a moral ground for OBL's intentional killing, in a scene of – in Bandura's (2016) terms – moral engagement when the victims are from the ingroup and moral disengagement when the victims are from among the accused. In Example 75, OBL describes America as a social actor which views *'resistance'* as being loaded with negative VALUATION (i.e. *'terrorism and backward'*), invoking negative PROPRIETY, and which views the acts of IMPROPRIETY (i.e. *'intimidation'* against Muslim countries) as being

loaded with positive VALUATION (i.e. '*freedom and democracy*') invoking positive PROPRIETY. Unlike America, OBL considers resistance to be a right and thus welcome even if it is described as terrorism, and rejects US democracy because it is associated with intimidation. By this mechanism of denying and reversal, OBL continuously argues for the legitimacy of his agency and positions the addressees to shift blame. OBL attempts to manipulate the perception of his actions and agency as being ethically grounded, serving to free himself of blame by drawing on the moral basis of violence. That is, OBL's acts are constructed (in the same threat text) as acts of '*self-defence*' and '*a must*' and in-kind punishment against American aggressors, and thus acts of PROPRIETY even if they are viewed in the American eyes as '*vilified terrorism*'.

(75) *On that day, I was assured that injustice [(America)/- PROPRIETY] and intentional killing [(America)/- PROPRIETY] of innocent women and children [(Lebanese and Palestinian women and children)/+ NORMALITY] is an approved American law [(American law of violence)/- VALUATION (invoking – PROPRIETY)], and that **intimidation** is freedom and democracy [(America's intimidation)/- VALUATION (invoking – PROPRIETY)], while **resistance** is terrorism and backward [(al-Qaeda's resistance)/- VALUATION (invoking + PROPRIETY)].*

7.4.1.5 Legitimizing

Legitimizing is deployed in ethical manipulation only by Shekau, to forge disalignment via deploying moral evaluations that are part of a religious group's symbolic power. These evaluations appear in Shekau's texts as a response or preemptive action to potential blaming for an unfavourable behaviour that targets victims. This tactic is based on van Leeuwen's (2007) pool of (de)legitimation strategies, particularly moral evaluation technique, and is aligned with Ilie's (2005) argument that manipulation can occur through responses or as preemptive communication. Within the Nigerian context, Shekau tends to communicate threats of eradicating anything Western (e.g. democracy, and education system) and those non-abiding by Allah's path, in an attempt to, for example, prevent the Nigerians from embracing democracy instead of the Sharia law, or to prevent girls from going to schools or otherwise to abduct and sell them as an '*avowed enemy*' (Example 76). In his threats, Shekau couples those who follow his ideology with positive PROPRIETY, for standing on the 'right' creed, while coupling those not following Shekau's ideology (from among Muslim Nigerians) and those acting in favour of democracy, the Nigerian constitution or Western education with

negative PROPRIETY for acts of infidelity (Example 77), and hence as sinners who deserve to be killed.

(76) **Whoever that stands on any creed other than that our Prophet Muhammad brought to us, ...should know that he is our avowed enemy** [whoever.../ - PROPRIETY] **and if he confronts us, we will fight him** [we/ + PROPRIETY]. (Shekau1)

(77) **The Izala are infidels** [the Izala/ - PROPRIETY]; **the believers who belong to a tariqa are infidels** [the believers who belong to a tariqa / - PROPRIETY]. **The Tijani are infidels** [the Tijani/ - PROPRIETY]! **Whoever follows the Qadiriyya is an infidel** [Whoever follows the Qadiriyya/ - PROPRIETY]! **Shiites are infidels** [Shiites/ - PROPRIETY]! **Whoever follows democracy is an infidel** [whoever follows democracy/ - PROPRIETY]! (Shekau5)

Through these moral evaluations, Shekau also attempts to manipulate his victims' perception of his violence as being a moral '*Jihad war against Christians and Christianity*' (Shekau 6). In this war, the Nigerians are positioned to be either with or against Shekau. They are coerced to make a choice of whether or not they would follow what Shekau alleges to be the teachings of '*Usman Dan Fodiyo*' (the Fulani Sunni scholar, who founded the Sunni Muslim Sokoto Caliphate in West Africa during the jihad of the Fulani war in 1804). Shekau's moral evaluations as such value those whose "perception and appreciation [...] express the state of relations of symbolic power" (Bourdieu, 1989, p. 20) and serve in constructing a social reality of a world divided into 'Us' versus 'Them'. Shekau's act of legitimation of his actions by moralization (i.e. by reference to a moral system which Shekau claims to be part of his religious system) serves to manipulate the audiences' stances and actions while – in Bourdieu's (1990, p. 134) terms – imposing vision and division and positioning who is doing right or wrong along a spectrum of this moral system.

7.4.2 Deontic retribution and the disaffiliation tactics utilized

Deontic retribution refers to the function of a threat text that operates by constructing a threatened act as being a permitted response to or retaliation for a past event – without aiming at the victims' compliance as is the case in the manipulative function. This past event is deemed to have caused disruption of an ingroup moral order, or have posed a danger against the ingroup's physical and ideological territories. This function is inspired by Searle's (2009, p. 9) concept of "deontic powers" which refers to "rights, duties, obligations, requirements, permissions, authorizations, entitlements, and so on" that inform and morally

motivate a social actor's behaviour in order to protect or maintain their ingroup's interests. To achieve this function in the terrorist context, a threatener chiefly deploys couplings that serve to present the self as being a deontic or value-serving agent who is obliged to retaliate. To achieve this discursive function, the threateners tend to gear key bonds via similar tactics to those used in the manipulative function, namely: legitimating, discrediting, blaming and denying (specifically, framing) – which are explained and exemplified in the subsequent subsections.

7.4.2.1 Legitimizing

Legitimizing is deployed by OBL and Tarrant to construct the function of retribution. Legitimizing is utilized to forge disalignment via deploying couplings that emphasise victims being wrongdoers and threateners as acting in retribution as a moral and legal responsibility. That is, violence is constructed as being in response to immoral or illegal values such as injustice and oppression, where the threateners as well as their victims are positioned on opposing poles, along a moral spectrum of wrongdoers versus retaliators, in binary opposition. This tactic is based on van Leeuwen's (2007, 2008) techniques of legitimation, namely, authorisation, moralisation and rationalisation. OBL establishes retribution in his texts as – in Barthes' (1974) terms – a 'proairetic' code, i.e. a legitimate action that comes in response to previous events and that is read in discourse as being in relationship with a governing 'semic' code; that is, as a set of proliferating moral values that relate to specific semantic field binaries in his texts (e.g. in/justice, in/security, oppression and freedom) as in: '*...we are free men who don't sleep under **injustice***' [we/ + PROPRIETY]. For instance, retaliation against an oppressor in Example 78 (in bold) is constructed as loaded with positive PROPRIETY ('permitted'). This positive view of retaliation is facilitated by founding it on a reference to authority ('Allah' – the source of authorisation). This reference to authority provides a shortcut to scriptural warrant (see e.g. Brookes & McEnery, 2020) which serves to manipulate divine commandments to influence perception of retaliation acts as being morally accepted. Restoring 'Our' freedom and security, which the oppressor squandered, is also constructed, as in Example 79, as an act of PROPRIETY that becomes an in-kind response – as signalled by '*just as*', wave-underlined – to the Americans' acts that are loaded with negative PROPRIETY. OBL's violence is thus constructed by reference to its goal (i.e. by rationalisation); that is, '*to restore freedom*'.

(78) *Praise is due to Allah who...permitted the oppressed to retaliate against the oppressor in kind* [[the oppressed to retaliate/ + PROPRIETY]]. (OBL1)

(79) *We want to restore freedom to our Ummah* [we/ + PROPRIETY]; *just as you squander our security* [you/ - PROPRIETY], *so shall we squander yours*.

OBL uses legitimization in OBL1 as part of his attempt to enhance the credibility of his manipulative threatening stance, via what I term here anecdotal retribution. That is, although the function of OBL1 is manipulative, OBL reports the 9/11 attacks as examples of past retribution events to provide anecdotal evidence of his serious intentions, so that the American people take his threats seriously and change their position on the US war on Iraq (or they can expect another wave of retaliatory actions). This manipulative function of anecdotal retribution is stressed in the introduction of OBL1, as in: '*...this talk...concerns the ideal way to prevent another Manhattan, and the war: its causes and results*'. However, unlike in OBL1, retribution is constructed in OBL3 as the main discursive function of the text, that is, as an upcoming moral response.

In the construction of retribution in OBL3, evaluative couplings are used to legitimate retaliation by reference to a moral value system of justice and legal actions. Consider Example 80 where OBL presents himself as referring to a legal moral order (signalled by '*legal retribution*'), coupling retribution with positive PROPRIETY – as legal winning for the blood of 'our' deaths for whom the US Israeli allies in Palestine are responsible, and hence coupled with negative PROPRIETY. Similarly, OBL (Example 81) positively constructs the mujahidin fight against the Americans in Iraq as being '*just reward*' for the US '*injustice*' – thus, an act coupled with a positive PROPRIETY that comes in as reward for a previous US action of negative PROPRIETY. This construction of the immorality of the Americans and their allies is stressed as a main theme throughout OBL's text. Evaluations such as these, and descriptions of '*the majority*' of the Americans as being '*just a folk or rabble dissociated with good morals*', serve in constructing OBL's threat as being morally based, while OBL is strategically morally disaffiliating and – in Bandura's (2016) terms – disengaging from his victims for the purpose of licensing his violence and presenting it as being in reaction to victims' immorality, as in: '*We will continue the martyrdom operations...until you terminate your injustice...*'.

(80) *You should know that we count our deaths...particularly those killed in Palestine at the hands of **your allies, the Jews** [your allies, the Jews/ - PROPRIETY]. And **we** will have the **legal** retribution from your own blood [we/ + PROPRIETY] ...*

(81) *What you are facing in Iraq at the hands of the heroes of Islam [(mujahidin)/ + CAPACITY] is **your just reward** [(mujahidin's acts)/ + PROPRIETY]; it has once been said: 'To death injustice chases its people, and the end thereof is grave.' [you (US soldiers' presence in Iraq)/ - PROPRIETY]*

Tarrant also uses the legitimating tactic, in Tarrant 2, by drawing on the moral value of freedom and the legal right to restore what he views as being 'right'. In his threat to Turks, Tarrant (as in Example 82) constructs his threat as being ultimately with the aim to 'free' the Hagia Sophia mosque in Istanbul. Hagia Sophia is an iconic structure, in Istanbul, with its minarets and inscriptions of Islam as well as Byzantine structure and lavish mosaics of Christianity, which reflects the religious changes that have played out in the region over the centuries. Tarrant invokes this historical significance and constructs his threat as part of retaliatory attempts to turn Hagia Sophia again into a Christian Church and to 'rightfully' own it. OBL's and Tarrant's deployment of what they perceive to be legal and moral thus serves as a topos, that is, as a shortcut warrant that is applied to legitimize the threateners' positions against their victims.

(82) *The Hagia Sophia will be free of minarets and Constantinople will be rightfully Christian owned once more [we / - (+) JUDGEMENT].*

7.4.2.2 Discrediting

Discrediting is used to forge threatener-victim disalignment and to lay moral bases for retribution by casting discredit on the victims or part of them. Discrediting is predominant in OBL3. For example, OBL tends to discredit the US leadership by attacking their acts' PROPRIETY, TENACITY, VERACITY and CAPACITY. Consider Example 83 where the Americans are coupled with negative CAPACITY, portrayed as being followers of the Jews' plans in the Middle East in the service of the Israelis at the expense of Muslim nations, which serves in justifying the targeting of Americans in retribution. In the same example, the Americans are also coupled with negative TENACITY, portraying the US democracy that is marketed in the Middle East as a 'trick' that aims to change regimes and serve the Jews' interests. A similar use of TENACITY-based bonds of disalignment exists in Example 84 where Bush is described as being indifferent to the Americans' blood and economy and fulfilling only the Zionist lobby's interests who

supported him to win the presidency. This lobby is coupled with negative PROPRIETY since they worked to destroy the power of Iraq, a neighbouring and thus threatening country to Israel, in return for their support for Bush. This ‘deliberate’ targeting of Iraq’s power thus justifies retribution. Discrediting, as in Example 85, also facilitates coupling Bush with a lack of VERACITY (*‘lying’*) and PROPRIETY via accusing him of being a leader of a *‘gang’* of *‘greed’* and of *‘war, theft, and robbery’* of the resources of Muslim countries.

(83) *...the Jews, who are dragging you behind them [(Americans) / - CAPACITY] under the trick of democracy [(Americans’ democracy) / - TENACITY] in order to support the Israelis and their plans, with hostility [(the Jews) / - HAPPINESS] to our religion and at the expense of our blood and land...*

(84) *...he [Bush] is fulfilling the demand of the Zionist lobby [he (Bush)/ - TENACITY] which helped him reach the White House, that is, to destroy the military power of Iraq which neighbors the Jews in occupied Palestine [the Jews / - PROPRIETY]. In so doing, he shows indifference to the repercussions on your blood and economy [he (Bush)/ - TENACITY].*

(85) *This gang and their leader find lying [US administration / - VERACITY], war, theft, and robbery palatable... [US administration / - PROPRIETY].*

This use of discrediting of the American audiences or part of them serves to justify retaliation as being – in Thrasher and Handfield (2018, p. 371) terms – “honor violence”. That is, threatened acts seek to serve Muslim societies that lack mechanisms of governance and to enforce two types of norms in inter-group relationship (see, e.g., Sommers, 2009): the norm of preserving honour as a rational means of response to wrongdoing; and the norm of the moral responsibility of the threatened audience.

7.4.2.3 Blaming and denying: Framing

Framing – namely via the use of the Bad Apple frame and the Rescue narrative frame – is used to forge disalignment with victims to construct a retaliatory, in-kind response. This tactic is predominant in Shekau’s threat texts. For example, Shekau (in Shekau1) constructs his declaration of war against *‘any Nigerian’* in Cameroon, Chad and Benin Republic (see Example 86) as a response – as realised in *‘just like...’* and *‘So, we too have declared...’* (wave underlined) – to a step taken by the Nigerian armed forces, that is, forming a joint force with Cameroonian forces to chase Boko Haram fighters and eliminate the ‘Bad Apple’ – or alternatively the “disease” (e.g. Thurston, 2016) – in Nigeria. A similar framing, in response, is used by Shekau in presenting the victims of the Nigerians in the African countries

(mentioned in Example 86), and the Nigerian troops in Sambisa forest and Nigeria (Example 87), as being the Bad Apple that needs be removed and that Shekau does '*not want to see*'. Within this framework, Shekau constructs his threatened war as being in reaction to the government's act of IMPROPRIETY: '*just like you [Minister of Defence and his troops] are searching for us in the bushes [you/ - PROPRIETY], we shall bring the war to the cities... [we/ + PROPRIETY]*'. This construction as such serves not only Shekau's denying of the goal behind his violent acts but also his blaming of the victims for his violence.

(86) *Just like one of the leaders of unbelievers...was recently boasting that **they have formed a joint force with Cameroonian forces to fight us** [they/ - PROPRIETY], [and] that **they would not only chase us from Sambisa forest but also in all parts of Nigeria** [they/ - PROPRIETY]. *So, we too have declared that we do not want to see any Nigerian in Cameroon, in Chad, in Nigeria and even Benin Republic...**

(87) *Just as you said you [vigilante troops and CJTF] do not want us on the face of Nigeria, so shall we too declare **you persona non grata** in Sambisa...*

This reactive form of threat is constructed as a fact in, for example, Shekau8. Consider Example 88 where Shekau's UNHAPPINESS (realised in '*enough is enough*') with the acts of Nigerian government and the Christian Association of Nigeria (CAN) is constructed as a response to a 'fact': that members of Boko Haram are '*being killed*' and described by President Jonathan and the CAN president as '*cancer [the Bad Apple] in this country called Nigeria*'. Shekau as such constructs his threat as a retaliation to these acts of IMPROPRIETY and to this framing of his organisation, a retaliation to defend self: '*We decided to defend ourselves*'. This is a reactive, not preemptive, defence that comes in response to factive information about acts of IMPROPRIETY (of killing, wickedness and betrayals) that security troops and Christians meted out against Muslims and Boko Haram members (see Example 89). This construction of factive information of the victims' IMPROPRIETY is facilitated by Shekau's repeated use of the 'factive' presupposition (Yule, 1996) phrase '*everyone knows*' (wave underlined), by means of which Shekau lays the moral ground to '*take our revenge on their lives*' as justified and based on 'facts' for which the victims should be blamed.

(88) *Our members are being killed [President Jonathan and CAN's president/ - PROPRIETY]!... we say enough is enough [we/ - HAPPINESS]!*

(89) *We hardly touch anybody except **security personnel and Christians and those who have betrayed us** [security.../ - PROPRIETY]. Everyone knows what **Christians did** to*

Muslims, not once or twice [Christians/ - PROPRIETY] ... Everyone knows what happened to our leader. Everyone knows what wickedness was meted out to our members and fellow Muslims in Nigeria...

This blaming and denying tactic appears to be part of Shekau's "blame game" (Fairclough & Fairclough, 2012, p. 172) by means of which he attempts to strategically shift blame by justifying his actions as being an in-kind-response. Thus, the government officials and 'infidel' troops should be blamed because they 'tend to' target Muslims and Boko Haram members first. This construction of opposing social groups helps Shekau to avoid being depicted as Villain in the Nigerian officials' news stories and accounts of blameworthy events about interchangeable harm and loss. In opposition to the officials' thesis and narrative about the villain Shekau, Shekau presents his antithesis, portraying himself as Rescuer of Muslims in Nigeria. Put differently, the negatively loaded evaluative couplings of the victims within the Rescue narrative frame serves to enable Shekau to escape being assigned the role of the Villain in his discursively constructed act of retribution.

7.4.3 Boulomaic function

The boulomaic function refers to the use of language in a threat text to serve (i) in expression of a fantasy level of desire (AFFECT) to cause harm, or (ii) as a symbolic identity-damage to threatened audiences merely because they belong to a different social category. This function implies no coercion into (un)doing something. This function is based on what has been termed master "identity attacks" (Culpeper, Iganski & Sweiry, 2017, pp. 22-23) and violent fantasy wants and the pledge to harm concept (Hurt & Grant, 2019), where the use of expressions of desire characterize – in Kushneruk's (2017) terms – the boulomaic features of a text. These features can be realised lexicogrammatically via verbs such as want, wish and hope, and via descriptions of wishes, desires and fantasies of powerful agents.

The boulomaic function is constructed in Tarrant's and Shekau's texts. Regarding the former, Tarrant, in Example 90, tables an AFFECT-based bond – 'the Antifa, Marxists and Communists are bad: undesired part of national identity'. Although the threatener cannot wipe out all 'Antifa/Marxists/Communists' whom he is addressing (thus, this is a fantasy), this incapability does not eliminate the fact that Tarrant's language expresses a strong desire (INCLINATION) and pledge to harm the affiliates of these 'outgroups', as realised in the repeated use of verb

'want' in the context of a direct threat against these outgroups, where Tarrant mentions a part of his weapon (*sights*) and a violent action invoked in '*I want you neck under my boot*'.

(90) *I do not want to convert you* [I / - INCLINATION (desire)], *I do not want to come to an understanding* [I / - INCLINATION (desire)]. *Egalitarians and those that believe in hierarchy will never come to terms* [I / - COMPOSITION]. *I don't want you by my side* [I / - INCLINATION (desire)] or *I don't want share power* [I / - INCLINATION (desire)]. *I want you in my sights* [I / + INCLINATION (desire)]. *I want your neck under my boot* [I / + INCLINATION (desire)]. (Tarrant1)

The boulomaic function appears not only as an independent, primary function (as in Tarrant1, see Example 90 above) but also as an ancillary to the manipulation or retribution functions in Tarrant2 and in Shekau's texts (namely, Shekau 1, 2, 5, 6 and 7). In both the independent and ancillary functions, the main purpose of the boulomaic function is to cause harm in terms of generating a negative effect (fear) in the threatened audiences and to disturb their piece of mind, while attacking their master identities (for more on frightening threats, see e.g. Storey, 1995). Consider Example 91 (taken from Tarrant2) where Tarrant's threat against Turks comes to supplement the fear effect of his manipulation of the Turks' perception of themselves as being responsible for their own safety. The extract below comes immediately after '*You can live in peace in your own lands...But if you attempt to live in European lands...We will kill you and drive you roaches from our lands*'. As such, while in Example 90 there is no reference to the victims' actions or pursuit to force any behavioural compliance, the ancillary boulomaic effect in Example 91 supplements manipulation with increased desire to come to Istanbul and destroy '*every mosque and minaret*'. This increase appears to be more a warning of what will happen (i.e. a personal prediction of a violent movement, signalled by the use of 'we').

(91) *We are coming for Constantinople and we will destroy every mosque and minaret in the city.* (Tarrant2)

The ancillary boulomaic effect is also manifested in Shekau's threat texts to colour the manipulation or retribution function with increased fear that is generated to target and – in Chiluba's (2017) terms – chill the spine of Shekau's victims. In Example 92, the boulomaic function is realised in the underlined Shekau's declaration of his strong desire (INCLINATION) to chase all Nigerians across Nigeria and out of its neighbouring countries: '*...we do not want to see any Nigerian...*'. While it is beyond Shekau's capacity to eliminate or prevent all Nigerians'

existence in African countries, this boulomaic effect manifests as part of Shekau's psychological warfare, which is merged with his constructed retribution against the Nigerian military's action of forming a joint force with the Cameroonian forces to fight Boko Haram members and chase them '*in all parts of Nigeria*'. In addition, Shekau, in Example 93 taken from a threat that targets the manipulation of the perception of Sultan of Kano's INCAPACITY and Shekau's CAPACITY, stresses his desire to fight and be wounded – as realised in the INCLINATION verb '*want*' as well as in his '*wish*' for blood and death. This frightening, wishful pursuit for death is also constructed as being morally justified in a fight that is between two camps of the world, '*Us*' versus '*the rest*' (the 'infidels'), and as part of the act of manipulation of audiences' perception of the conflict (see Example 94). This frightening, divisive construct is enhanced by the boulomaic effect that is realised in the construction of desired harm to be inflicted on the State Security Service (SSS), as in: '*I will be happy to kill...*' and '*will not be content until...*' (Example 94, dotted underlined).

(92) *So, we too have declared that we do not want [we / - INCLINATION (desire)], to see any Nigerian in Cameroon, in Chad, in Nigeria and even Benin Republic.* (Shekau1)

(93) *Sultan of Kano... We want to fight [we / - INCLINATION (desire)]; we want to be wounded [we / - INCLINATION (desire)]. We want our blood to flow [we / - INCLINATION (desire)]. We wish for death... [we / - INCLINATION (desire)].* (Shekau5)

(94) *Whether you are SSS or even SSSS if you want, know that for me there are two categories of people in the world: those that are with us, and the rest. I will be happy to [I / - INCLINATION (desire)] kill those against us every time I encounter them... I will not be content until I have cut your throats [I / - INCLINATION (desire)].* (Shekau7)

7.5 Summary of Chapter Seven

This chapter has contributed to forensic investigation aimed at obtaining a fuller understanding of the disaffiliative function of terrorists threats. The focus was on how a terrorist's appraisal signature, or alternatively their evaluative disposition (Etaywe & Zappavigna, 2021, forthcoming), manifests and functions in the threat texts. The chapter has capitalised on the power of the SFL evaluative coupling approach to (dis)affiliation in terrorist discourse, to argue for the disaffiliative function of the threat texts. The analysis is also based on complementary forms of linguistic analysis aimed at unpacking interpersonal meaning and discursive function, which includes social role allocation, legitimisation and purposefulness in

discourse (van Leeuwen, 2008), and the rhetorical concepts of discrediting (D'Errico & Poggi, 2012), blaming, denying and manipulation (van Dijk, 2006; Hansson, 2015).

The chapter has provided support to findings in previous research (e.g. Chilwa, 2017) that terrorists tend to structure their threat texts as narratives with an evaluative structure that can be realised in an introduction, main body and conclusion of a threat text. This structure facilitates the establishment of particular values (e.g. fighting injustices) and in (re)framing, promoting and justifying conflict and inter-group relationships on ideological bases. The chapter has emphasised the role of critical examination of the categories of a threatener's ingroup and their victims in specifying the ideological and sociopolitical boundaries demarcating conflict and relationships, providing support to recent research findings in this regard (see e.g. Hurt & Grant, 2019).

The threat texts tend to include a mix of threat types that accord with the three threat-categories proposed by Gales (2010, 2015) – direct, veiled and conditional threats. The direct type of threat was predominant in the dataset, meaning that the terrorists tend to communicate their threats with language that explicitly identifies key elements. These elements include a threatened action or a mode of it, targeted victims, and time and/or place of the action – or at least the first two elements. The repeated use of this type of threat provides further support to the argument that the strategic use of terrorism and terrorist public communication is a form of violence that is designed to force desired sociopolitical change “by instilling fear in the public” (e.g., Bandura, 2016, p. 310). The analysis of the co-text of the threat types also emphasised the purposefulness of the terrorist threat texts. The three purposes identified accord with van Leeuwen's (2008) purposes of social and discursive actions and provide clues for identifying how the terrorists tend to seek to procure material or symbolic profits for their ingroups. The purposes also provide clues to the motivations of violence and what constitutes the heart of disagreement and conflict.

The chapter has shown how an extremist's evaluative signature manifests as idiolectal reconfigurations of attitudinal meaning-making inflected primarily by an ideological view of the victims' behaviours and processes. The patterns of bonds that were tabled as bases for disaffiliation with the victims show that the bonds are predominantly judgmental and APPRECIATION -based. The PROPRIETY, CAPACITY and VALUATION- based bonds are predominant in

the dataset. That said, the most and least frequently used attitudinal bases were also used to serve the same discursive functions. The terrorists' choices of disaligning bonds not only provide clues of moral justifications of disalignment and violence but also serve to achieve three discursive functions: ethical manipulation, deontic retribution, and the boulomaic function. While OBL's threat texts tend to be characterized by one predominant function (either manipulation or retribution) and Tarrant uses the boulomaic function predominantly in his texts, Shekau's texts tend to include a mix of these discursive functions, which could be ascribed to Shekau's tendency to communicate a threat to multiple targets of a wide range of backgrounds (e.g. civilian, paramilitary, military, political leaders, religious figures). This requires Shekau to communicate a threat text with a combination of discursive functions. In sum, the approach to terrorist threat texts and the analysis showcased in this chapter can aid in threat assessment by sensitising threat assessors to the kinds of language used in threat texts and their functions, as summarised in the toolkit outlined in Table 7.9 which (akin to Prideaux's, 2011 toolkit) provides a kind of catalogue of the components used in the analysis in this chapter.

Table 7.9: A toolkit for examining disaffiliation in terrorist texts

Relevant components and functions	Primary reference tools and methods
Revealing the evaluative structure of the threat texts	Coupling approach and Affiliation framework (e.g. Knight, 2010)
Revealing the victims categories	Social actor representation strategies (van Leeuwen, 1996, 2008), and coupling approach (Knight, 2010)
Revealing the types of threats enacted	Threat types (Gales, 2010)
Revealing the purpose of threatened acts	The discursive construction of purpose of social actions (van Leeuwen, 2008)
Revealing pattern evidence of moral and attitudinal bases for a threatener-victim disalignment	Appraisal framework (Martin & White, 2005)
Revealing evidence of disaffiliation tactics used for particular discursive functions	Macro functions of threats (Muschalik, 2018), Appraisal framework (Martin & White, 2005), coupling approach and Affiliation (Knight, 2010), conceptualisation of discrediting (Poggi, D'Errico & Vincze, 2011; D'Errico & Poggi, 2012), conceptualisation of blame avoidance, denying and reversal (e.g. van Dijk, 2006; Hansson, 2015), legitimization strategies (van Leeuwen, 2007, 2008)

CHAPTER EIGHT: CONCLUSION

This final chapter revisits and consolidates the findings of Chapters 5-7 in light of the research questions for this thesis presented in Chapter 1, Section 1.3. It also interprets the primary findings of the thesis and conceptualizes their implications and relevance to the linguistic analysis of terrorist language for forensic purposes. The chapter also reflects upon the thesis limitations and makes proposals for future research.

8.1 Research questions and a summary of findings

This thesis has contributed to linguistic research on how terrorists incite violence and communicate threats, through its timely topic and novel approach to terrorist public statements. It has contributed to the aim of security, intelligence and legal investigators to understand the language of transnational terrorism, namely jihadism and far-right extremism. In reviewing the analysis and discussion undertaken throughout this thesis, points of intersection across the findings of Chapters 5-7 are worth noting holistically. Before providing a summary relating to each research question (visited in Subsections 8.1.1 through 8.1.3), the function of this section is to offer a holistic view of the findings.

The SFL-based analytical discourse analysis has enabled a deeper understanding of the ways in which attitudinal meanings are manifested and function in the terrorist texts. The findings offer evidence of how the function of (dis)affiliation is cultivated in the dataset to generate conflicts and influence inter-group relationships. This insight is important for security and legal practitioners seeking to understand how value-based social and action networks are created in the violent extremism context. The nurturing of the (dis)affiliative function gives rise to a discourse of (dis)affiliation par excellence. In this discourse, the terrorists tend to strategically drive particular patterns in structure and meaning, and key social values and bonds are leveraged to legitimize violence and the existence of the violent extremist movements. The patterned couplings of affiliation in the incitement texts and of disaffiliation in the threat texts reveal that the evaluative language style is influenced not only by the authors' extremist personality, motives, attitudes and emotions but also by the (putative) audiences, whether they are ingroup incitees or outgroup victims (see also Bell, 1984, pp. 168/183), and by the functional and ideological needs of the text producer (e.g. Birch &

O'Toole, 1988). The examination of the functional style in terms of metafunctional linguistic patterning has offered useful insights into terrorist texts, an analysis that can supplement linguistic and psychological profiling of an author in real-world forensic analysis cases and in the field of criminology, through decoding attitude in discourse and identifying patterns of collocative values.

The findings stress the usefulness of focusing on the evaluative language in terrorist public statements. By means of the evaluative language, the terrorists seek: firstly, to create a “reality of deontology” which “confers rights [and] responsibilities” (Searle, 2009, p. 89); secondly, to activate particular moral orders (e.g. van Langenhove, 2017); thirdly, to cause offence and to incite for an offence against people with distinct identities and values (e.g. Culpeper, 2011); and fourthly, to present the language users as agents in social structures who have the deontic power to create, promote, challenge and/or negate some moral orders. The findings provide evidence of how “the morality of terrorism” (Seto, 2002, p. 1227) is constructed through language, and support van Langenhove’s (2017) argument that morality in discourse links agency to structure. Violence is presented as being out of a set of duty, religious convictions and ideological practices that emphasise the “vitality of values” (Atran, 2019, p. 1) and beliefs in – using Habermas’ (2004, p. 16) terms – the formation and maintenance of an individual’s and a group’s identity and power.

The systematic analysis of attitude-ideation couplings in the dataset has been found to be revelatory of the terrorists’ ongoing attempts to ideologically position ingroup putative readers to favour the terrorists’ agendas. The terrorists attempt to strategically position putative readers in relation to a frame of reference of loci of moral valuations and membership categorisations. These loci include ingroup-centred ideations (e.g. ingroup members, ideas, abstractions) which are part of the ingroup’s social structure and master identities (e.g. religion, ethnicity). This ideological positioning, relating to master identities, attests to the terrorists’ response to alleged challenges against traditional social structures and hard boundaries of membership; the latter which the terrorists also utilize as a means to exclude outgroups and mobilize support: “The harder the boundary between groups – the more exclusive are membership rules – the more extreme is the “us” versus “them” dichotomy” (Pape, 2005, p. 87).

Within this dichotomy, the terrorists strategically decide “what to textualize”, and they keep the ideational meaning within a limit that guides the audience on how to understand a text (Coulthard, 1994, p. 4). The terrorists construct themselves in relation to their ingroup members as role models, “tied to group affiliations” and thus to desired roles that are bound up with these memberships (e.g. Arena & Arrigo, 2006, p. 74; Stryker, 2000), in a context where identity is used as a tool and its protection is constructed as an achievement. For example, the far-rightist Tarrant constructs himself as part of a ‘*lead*’ movement that European people ‘*will follow*’ in pursuit of a desired radical change. Shekau also presents himself as the ‘*leader*’ of a Muslim ‘*sect*’ who is ‘*instructed*’ by God and follows a ‘*model [of] Prophet*’, and that thus Muslims in Nigeria should follow him or they have ‘*allowed [themselves] to be cheated*’ and victimised.

Focus on the semantics of attitude has shown that the terrorists’ stances tend to appear predominantly judgmental and appreciative, and thus ideological and institutionalised. That said, the use of affective language has also provided evidence of hate and love as a motivation of violence in the terrorism context. For example, to justify his hostility and violence, Tarrant reports the anti-Islamist views of Pope Urban II on the premise of hate and love and the pope’s negative view on Muslims. Considering his xenophobic, conspiratorial and pro-‘replacement’ theory beliefs, Tarrant also encourages his incitees to ‘*show the warmth and genuine love we have for our people*’ while he associates negative views about immigrants, describing them as ‘*cultural competitors*’ who ‘*hate us*’. Similar to Tarrant’s sanctioning of hate, al-Baghdadi also associates his hatred to ‘disbelievers’ with reports of hate and love responses that are recommended by a religious man (Bin Abd al-Wahab, who represents an authority for Wahabis), and thus considered acts of PROPRIETY: “*having love without any enmity or hatred, there would be no furqan [i.e. distinguisher] between truth and falsehood, nor between a believer and a disbeliever*”. This authority bidding for God thus appears as a source of the doxa – i.e. “the natural, social order” – and a guide to emotional and interpersonal relationships and social norms (e.g. Brookes & McEnery, 2020, p. 368). As such, the focus on the semantics of attitude has been found useful for providing evidence of not only the ideological motives of violence but also the emotional/hatred motive that is sanctioned by the terrorists. This focus may thus support recent scholarly endeavours (see e.g. U.S. National Institute of Justice, 2022) to study the changing threat landscape of terrorism where hate and

terrorism may appear combined and the motivations appear, simultaneously, ideologically and emotionally based.

In van Dijk's (1998a, p. 207) terms, the consistent construction of positive 'we' and negative 'they' in the terrorist texts serves in constructing a "'code for' ideological positions". The ATTITUDE-based analysis of the dichotomous construction of social groups as opposing networks of values and identities reveals texts as having prosodies of positive/negative values. The prosodies of patterning in the polarity of evaluative couplings distributed through discourse reveal that the texts constantly promote a divisive worldview. Given that "the source and target of evaluation are [...] criterial" and categorical, negative prosody tends to collocate with the outgroups and their ideational targets while positive prosody couples with the ingroup and their ideations, as strategically "coordinated choices from system networks" (Martin, 2010, p. 39). In Hood's (2006) terms, this binary, prosodic structure of the texts and the values radiated accumulate to build a world of opposing poles in evaluatively cohesive texts. This prosodic structure of the texts has a persuasive power and can promote certain feelings, decisions and actions. These binaries – in Bourdieu's (1990, p. 134) terms – serve not only in presenting a terrorist's socio-logic and "categories of perception" and classification, but also in "construct[ing] social reality as much as they express it" and in arguing for what is claimed to be the crucial stakes of the inter-group struggle, which manifest as a struggle over meanings and values. These meanings and values, as realised in patterns of evaluative couplings, can inform threat investigators about why some texts are polarising.

8.1.1 Features of the language of extremism

The analysis and discussion presented in Chapter 5, which followed the framework outlined in Section 4.4.2, Chapter 4, aimed to address the first research question of this thesis:

How do the following patterns of lexicogrammatical features discursively mark an author's violent extremist style and identity? These patterns are:

- Structures realising discursive themes and conceptual burstiness.
- Repeated, attitudinally loaded lexical items.

This analysis has enabled synoptic insights into the patterns of meaning and structure in the dataset, and provided evidence of text type, violent agenda, the kind of author, and stylistic features of violent extremist authorship. The findings relating to this research question has

enabled the description of the discursive features of the language of extremism in terrorist public statements, by focusing on how the foregrounding (through repetitions) of lexical resources and their functions can reveal a terrorist's ideology and identity and can characterise the lexicogrammar used in construing the experience of violence in a terrorism context. First of all, by adopting an analysis that is assisted by a corpus tool (i.e. AntConc) and fully computerized (i.e. LIWC-based), this research has showcased how certain semiotic clues are extracted from the linguistic “traces” [i.e. lexical resources] that make up [the terrorist] texts” (Longhi, 2021, p. 1), and how frequencies and relative repetitions of discursive themes and concepts are translatable into information that is useful to criminal investigators.

The need of legal and law enforcement agencies for tools to obtain evidence of the motivations and categorisation of terrorism is pressing, especially amid the changing threat landscape of terrorism. The findings relating to the first research question contribute to meeting this need. The findings have revealed a set of discursive thematic categories (detailed in Section 5.2, Chapter 5) that provide semiotic clues (i.e. grounds via lexical selection) to the terrorists' motives and concerns. By comparing the terrorists' texts with a reference corpus, the findings have shown that particular themes can provide evidence of engagement in terrorists actions, motives and concerns. For example, the statistics suggest that Tarrant's text, while motivated in part by religious intolerance and hostility, foregrounds the themes of achievement, money and leisure (i.e. economic status, privilege and welfare of the ingroup) as indicators of primary concerns of this far-right terrorist. The findings of comparing and contrasting, between the four terrorists, the themes of affiliation (e.g. *Muslims, Christians, West, immigrants*), reward, achievement (e.g. *victory, control, better*), power (e.g. *invader, wealth*) and risk (e.g. *fear, die*) reveal ideological variation. That is, focus on themes such as these has been found useful not only in indicating the text type but also in profiling the ideological background of each terrorist. For example, Tarrant's text shows more prominent use of the social, work, leisure, money, swearing, and achievement categories, which indicates his characteristic social and personal concerns. Tarrant's use of the achievement, power and reward themes also reveal his most statistically salient drivers. The theme of affiliation (Muslim versus non-Muslim) in the Boko Haram-Shekau appears as the most significant clue to the drivers of his jihadism and is the highest factor compared to the other authors. In addition, the power and affiliation themes represented the most significant drivers

for all the authors, which presents these two themes as being associated with increased levels of aggression and indicate the ideological and cultural reasoning of violence. The frequent use of lemmas of affiliation also serves in reflecting an author's commitment to salient identities that could account for the threatened or incited-for violence and for why individuals ought to join a violent course of action: "the higher the salience of an identity [...], the higher the probability of behavioural choices in accord with the expectations attached to that identity" (Stryker & Burke, 2000, p. 286). The statistically significant construction of the themes of affiliation and religion also emphasises the idea of the use of identity as a tool – in Stryker and Burke's (2000, p. 292) terms – to manipulate symbols and to create a collective value through which identities can increase the level of commitment to ingroups. These findings thus give insights into differences between terrorists coming from different ideologies and sociocultural backgrounds, and enhance the capacity of computational analysis to trigger early warning to prevent extremist behaviour.

The findings largely exhibit higher levels in the use of the categories examined than those levels in the reference corpus, indicating that discourse of international terrorism appears to show a greater extremity level than the discourse of national terrorism. That said, future research still needs to verify this claim by using larger corpora. In addition, the findings regarding the affect and social processes feature have revealed that the international terrorism texts show increased rate of negative emotions (e.g. *punish*, *hate*) relative to the reference corpus. The higher rate of negative emotions, together with anger, presents negativity as a typical feature of the terrorist texts and the authors as being more emotionally attached to topics and audiences. The consideration of the affect element has been found to be useful in indicating the authors' engagement in emotional labour, or alternatively the "emotional marketplace": to justify and steer feelings towards violent actions; to appeal to audiences' emotions in a polarising and mobilising context; and to invoke the feelings of victimhood, otherness and blameworthiness (see also Wright-Neville & Smith, 2009, p. 85; Baider & Constantinou, 2014; Breeze, 2020).

Regarding the feature of conceptual burstiness (detailed in Section 5.3, Chapter 5), the heightened, relative frequency of lemmas with close semantic proximity display the burstiness of four groups of concepts: 'people', 'religion', 'power', 'violence and military', and 'sayers' categories. These concepts have been found to be useful in obtaining a fuller

description of the repeated textual elements of extremism and in eliciting intelligence from these elements about: how they serve the discursive purposes of the texts; and how these elements provide clues to the authors' ideology, master identity or group affiliation, violent intentions, and agendas.

The heightened use of the speech verb 'say' has revealed an attribution pattern that indicate a rhetorical feature of the argumentative jihadist discourse. The 'say' word functions – in Szczyrbak's (2016) terms – as: a signpost of the terrorists' commenting on participants' stances; and textual moments that signal who is saying what in the context of conflict and for what pragmatic functions – just as was found in the courtroom context (e.g. Szczyrbak, 2016). The examination of the concordance lines of the 'say' word has helped to elicit clues of verbal aggression where a terrorist momentarily tends to construct themselves as powerful and oppositional personae who are in control over the situation and "capable of maintaining or subverting the social order" (Bourdieu, 1991, p. 170). This is a distinct finding from research that considers the word 'say' to be a neutral speech verb in the conflict context (e.g. Thetela, 2001).

Regarding the examination of stance encoded in the repeated, attitudinally loaded lemmas (detailed in Section 5.4, Chapter 5), focus on "how form-function pairings work in human language" (Jeffries, 2014, p. 410; Gales, 2010) has been found useful in providing evidence of the terrorists' personal and relational identities. The affordances of the corpus analysis tool, AntConc (e.g. inspection of concordance lines and frequency information), utilized to identify these lemmas, has allowed for illumination of dimensions of attitudinal meaning by drawing on the use of the Appraisal framework. The findings offer a way of understanding the personal and relational identities performed in the dataset, and demonstrate how attitudinal resources operate as discursive markers of these identities. This approach has allowed for identification of dimensions of terrorist personae, such as (in)tolerance, aggression, and opposition to or support of particular phenomena, through decoding the attitudinal meanings. In Etaywe and Zappavigna's (2021) terms, this approach has revealed a tendency for attributing values to an ingroup versus outgroups, as realised in co-instantiation of ATTITUDE type with the primary participants' attitudinal targets, taken and discussed as: firstly, features of the terrorists' relational identity (i.e., being distant from/or superior to 'Others' vs. close to ingroup's members); and secondly, features of the terrorists' personal identity (i.e. being aggressive

and antagonistic towards 'Others' vs. caring and protagonistic towards ingroup's members). These findings provide support to Bednarek's (2010) and Etaywe and Zappavigna's (2021) contention that analysis of repeated, attitudinally loaded lemmas can offer a diagnostic for characterizing the personal and relational identities performed in discourse. The findings also offer support to Smith's (2004, p. 431) suggestion on potential grounds for suspicion of terrorist violence: when trying to predict whether an author or a group is likely to engage in terrorist acts, it is important to examine how the authors describe their group attitudinal targets, and how they describe the opponents' attitudinal targets.

8.1.2 Social affiliation in terrorist incitement texts

The analysis and discussion presented in Chapter 6 aimed to address the second research question of this thesis:

Which affiliation strategies and tactics are employed as discursive incitement tactics?

- How does the appraisal signature of a terrorist function within inciting language – i.e. what patterns of bonds are tabled as bases for *affiliation*?
- How can analysing affiliation strategies inform our understanding of how terrorists incite violent acts?

This analysis has enabled a focus on understanding how the terrorists incite violence, from an SFL social semiotic perspective, adding to literature on the semantics of violence. This approach was necessary, given the functional context of meaning-making in the context of terrorism, the discursive positioning and legitimation of particular groups in the practice of incitement, and the role of ideologies and relations of power in addressees' beliefs and social relations. The analysis showcased in Chapter 6 required the elaboration of an analytical framework and procedures for examining incitement texts. This framework was outlined in Section 4.4.3., Chapter 4. Equipped with this framework, Chapter 7 presented the analysis of the sample incitement texts communicated by the jihadists OBL and al-Baghdadi, and by the far-rightist Tarrant.

The findings have shown that a terrorist tends to invite their putative incitees to take sides and affiliate with the positively constructed ingroup against the negatively evaluated victims. At the most general level, opposing bond clusters appear in each terrorist's discourse, where an ingroup-centred bonds cluster is constructed in opposition to an outgroup-centred bonds

cluster. These clusters are on account of key bonds resulting from a terrorist's constant, dynamic production of binary bonds. This account, of groupings of key bonds made on the basis of repeated couplings, facilitates understanding of localized bond clusters – in Zappavigna's (2014) terms – as patterns of collocative values (e.g. bad Muslim immigrants versus good White Christians, in Tarrant's manifesto). Identification of these clusters has provided insights into the unfolding categories of ideational targets and related attitudes in discourse, and thus the field of a text: what or whom a text is taking a stance about, who is good, victim, passivated and incited for violence, and who is bad, victimiser, activated and incited-against. In addition, in Zappavigna's (2014, p. 223) terms, what has been identified is an extremist's evaluative signature in terms of "patterns of meaning inflected by membership in networks of fellowship" which position the extremist to enact particular configurations of polarizing bonds for ideological purposes. The findings provide support to previous research findings (e.g. Malešević, 2010) that modernity and related values, and ideas such as democracy, globalization, immigration and citizenship (e.g. Europeanization), tend to challenge and impede the formation and maintenance of traditional identities, providing a justification of violent actions as one form of "response to these challenges" (Lutz & Lutz, 2008, p. 100; Malešević, 2010).

The findings have shown that the terrorists leverage social values and bonds in the process of incitement to violence in the inciting texts. The use of the Affiliation framework as grounded in the SFL framework has illuminated how values and alignments are construed in terrorist incitement of violence and how language attempts to forge particular kinds of community membership and to foster social bonds as shared values to protect. Values that collocate with outgroups are construed as a source of friction that require rejection of particular values and categories of outgroups, thus presenting categorization as the only way of experiencing 'reality', as if "we have no way of experiencing reality without categorization" (Chandler, 2017, p. 73). The focus of the analysis has been on the key role that evaluative couplings, as the main unit of analysis, plays in the discursive incitement strategies. An analytic need encountered in this investigation was to extend the analysis beyond the existing SFL Affiliation model's analytical unit and to adopt a complementary interpretive lens in order to best suit the dataset. That is, it was necessary to capture the meta-values underpinning the evaluative couplings, and the rhetorical functions of these couplings in terms of coercion and

legitimization of violence. This perspective, firstly, has served in focusing on evaluative couplings to identify and describe the terrorists' evaluative disposition which manifests as a path of choices from the network of systems of the language. Secondly, the complementary perspective has allowed for a close study of how incitement involves attending to shared "goals and beliefs" (Poggi, 2005, p. 297) which are expressed by the terrorists as they attempt to legitimize and moralize violence as a collective enterprise and to influence, motivate and bond with putative incitees. This complementary lens is aligned with sociological research (e.g. Malešević, 2019; Bandura, 2016) and recent linguistic research (e.g. Etaywe & Zappavigna, 2021; Etaywe, 2022b), in arguing that terrorists require a degree of ideological justification and the exploitation of social bonds and moral reasoning, to legitimate their violent actions and mobilize support to achieve their violent agendas.

Grouping the evaluative couplings as patterns of bonds tabled for negotiating inter-group relationships has revealed two primary affiliation strategies aimed at persuading the incitees to align with the inciter: 'communing' and 'alienation' – which are ingrouping and outgrouping strategies, respectively. In each strategy, the following tactics are used: attitudinal expansion, attitudinal projection, iconisation, indexical labelling, and authorisation. The kinship affirmation is, however, used only in communion. The affiliation strategies appear to function: firstly, to establish a connection between the violent actions being promoted and putative incitees' pre-existing beliefs and values; and secondly, to manage the putative incitees' perceptions of both ingroup and outgroups by promoting alignment/disalignment with these values. These (dis)alignments contribute to presenting incitement: firstly, as an axiological practice in which terrorist texts unfold rhetorically as an invitation to community and joint action; and secondly, as an ideological practice, where the texts unfold as moralized rationality. The findings on the role of evaluation in building a divisive world for inciting purposes accord with previous research (e.g. Reicher, Haslam & Rath, 2008) showing that collective hostility-fed actions include enacting: (i) identification with the good 'We'; and (ii) exclusion of the bad 'They', whose presence and acts constitute an ideological and physical threat to 'Us' that ought to be confronted collectively as active participators in creating and maintaining shared, ideological/cultural values.

The findings also provide evidence that there exists a set of six moral meta-values serving as, what has been termed by Graham et al. (2011), deliberate reasoning processes – that are

used to justify violence. These meta-values emerge in two taxonomies: relational links (i.e. binding) meta-values (which include ingroup/loyalty, authority/respect, and purity/degradation); and interpersonal, or inter-groups treatment meta-values (which include liberty/oppression, care/harm, and fairness/cheating). These meta-values also function to contribute to the moral coerciveness of the incitement texts. The activation of these moral foundations draw on each inciter's ingroup-members' assumptions and predisposition, providing a clue as to: how evaluative couplings are morally regulated; how certain issues, situations and experiences are responded to; and how social roles, expectations, rights and duties are activated. As such, the adopted approach has provided evidence relating to the moral justifications, or alternatively the "moral considerations", for why incitees should employ radical acts (Jaconelli, 2017, p. 246). In van Dijk's (1998a, pp. 256/258) terms, the findings emphasise that not only does extremist discourse presuppose norms and values but that these values also regulate and organize the actions of group members. The approach taken in this thesis has also revealed how terrorists construe what they view as "reasonable hostility" (Tracy, 2008, p. 169).

In addition to the moral coerciveness of the incitement texts, the findings have provided evidence of how the terrorist texts drive the use of evaluation to achieve two rhetorical functions. The first is coercing the putative incitees into violence through suggesting it as collective actions against a shared threat and towards achieving shared goals. This coercion is achieved by suggesting actions via commanding (i.e. issuing directive speech acts), the use of performative verb '*incite*', warning (of the negative consequences of not pursuing particular actions), suggesting and/or recommending certain actions – e.g. via the use of adjectives such as 'required' – and the use of obviousness markers relating to suggested violent actions. The second function is legitimizing the suggested violent actions. These functions accord with Cap's (2017) argument for coercing and legitimating as two primary functions of public threatening communication that serve in constructing a threat and generating fear, to justify violence and mobilize public support against that threat.

Besides grounding the evaluative couplings and the suggested violent actions in moral foundations, the findings have shown that the terrorists tend to legitimize violent solutions as collective values-serving goals. To manipulate the incitees' perception of the link between these violent actions and the individual/collective interests or goals, and to maximize the

believability of the importance and urgency of these actions, the terrorists enact key bonds to lend legitimacy to 'Our' violence whilst delegitimizing outgroups (mainly, their actions, values and membership). The evaluative couplings realising these bonds provide a basis for perception and (de)legitimation and serve as an entry point to and evidence of the acts of (de)legitimation. Legitimizing 'Us' implies delegitimizing outgroups via evaluative acts that appear, firstly, to "follow the categories of the ideological schema" of the ingroup, and second, to challenge the identity of the outgroups (e.g. van Dijk, 1998a, pp. 258-259). These findings provide support to Shuy's (2021) argument that language, particularly here, evaluative language, reveals a terrorist's ideological schemas.

The findings also provide support to previous research (e.g., van Leeuwen, 2007) on the role of interpersonal language in establishing and cultivating addressees' belief in the legitimacy of social actions. This discursive act of (de)legitimation is revealed in a pattern of a combination of simultaneous choices from: firstly, the rhetorical modes (i.e. logos, ethos, and pathos, reflecting the rhetorical structure level-style); secondly, themes of (de)legitimation (i.e. what is de/legitimated); and thirdly, critique dynamics (that is, the semantic-functional strategies of critique by means of which the terrorists provide references to moral or ideological reasons for (de)legitimation). The findings show that the terrorists tend to deploy bonds to legitimize 'Our' violence and to delegitimize outgroups, chiefly via moralization, rationalization and authorization, and by drawing on the authors' ethos, and logical reasoning. These choices in the act of (de)legitimation suggest that, while inter-group conflicts appear to take the form of struggles over categories such as activities, resources and values, conflicts are inherently over group legitimacy. The similarities between the terrorists in their rhetorical choices can be ascribed to their violent, ideological agendas, their need to justify their violence as a means for social and political change, and their extreme, dichotomous ideological schemas.

In brief, the affiliation strategies have been found to function to construct opposing social groups in discourse, with the condemned groups positioned as a threat, hostility legitimated as morally reasonable, and violence as warranted and serving collective ideological and physical goals. An ingroup's failure to act is constructed to serve in stimulating fear of consequences, as the authors lay the "socio-psychological premise" (Cap, 2017, p. 1) to

mobilize a degree of popular support to encounter an existing or imminent, ideological and physical attack against an individual's personal and/or group's way of life.

8.1.3 Social disaffiliation in terrorist threat texts

The analysis and discussion presented in Chapter 7 aimed to address the third research question of this thesis:

How does the appraisal signature of a terrorist manifest and function in terrorist threat texts?

- What kinds of patterns of bonds are tabled as bases for *disaffiliation* with the victims?
- What does the analysis reveal about the discursive functions of threat texts and the 'moral' justifications and purposes of threats?

The analysis showcased in Chapter 7 required the elaboration of an analytical framework and procedures for examining these texts. This framework was outlined in Section 4.4.4, Chapter 4. Equipped with this framework, Chapter 7 presented the analysis of the sample threat texts communicated by the jihadists OBL and Abubaker Shekau, and the far-rightist Tarrant. Through a focus on the co-patterning of evaluation and ideation as a way of understanding the key social bonds at stake, Chapter 7 showcased how threatener-victim disalignments are forged, and how these patterns are geared to serve particular discursive functions.

The findings add to literature on the semantics of violence. They show that the terrorists tend to build their threat texts as narratives of an evaluative structure that serves in constructing the point of a threat text (i.e. their functions). Within this evaluative structure, the positive and negative construction of a threatener and their victims, respectively, also serves as a basis for disalignment and threat justification. The critical examination of the relationships between a threatener and their threatened audiences has been found useful for identifying the specified and genericized targets of violence and presenting them within a 'We' versus 'They' dichotomy. This representation facilitates the positioning of the victims as in disalignment with the identities of the threateners and those whom the threateners claim to represent and defend. The approach adopted has provided clues to the types of threats characteristic of the context of terrorism. While the repeated types of threat accord with the three threat categories proposed by Gales (2010, 2015) – direct, veiled, and conditional threats – the threats are found to be mostly direct, emphasizing the role of terrorist context

in the frequency of use of this types. The direct threats serve in augmenting the public intimidation impact of the terrorist discourse. The findings from the analysis of the co-text of the threatening utterances show that the threatened acts are constructed as purposeful. They serve three main social and discursive purposes which reveal clues to the heart of interpersonal and inter-group disagreement and conflict: goal-oriented, means-oriented, and effect-oriented purposes. These three types of constructed purposes of violence corroborate Fraser's (1998) contention that threateners use language for various reasons and purposes. These purposes also provide support to findings of previous research (e.g. Shuy, 1993; Fraser, 1998; Gales, 2010) in that the practice of threatening tilts the scale of power to the threatener's benefit and to the victim's detriment.

The findings from the analysis of co-patterning of attitude and ideation, tabled as basis for a threatener-victim disaffiliation, in each threat text reveal that the texts constantly attempt to position the victims in disalignment with the threatener. This positioning in discourse serves in coercing the victims into specific courses of actions that might benefit the threateners, and serve to rebalance the inter-group relationships, redress injustice, and procure some material or symbolic profit for the threateners' social groups. These findings corroborate Culpeper's (2011, pp. 225-233) contention that threats are typically of a coercive nature; that is, the evaluative language used in threat texts "seeks a realignment of values", for example within the framework of restoring justice and redressing a wrong (as in OBL's texts), and seeks a disalignment of values such as those of equality (as in Tarrant's texts) and religious beliefs (as in Shekau's texts). This act of disalignment between the threateners and the victims is achieved so that the threateners benefit or have "their current benefits reinforced or protected" (Culpeper, 2011, p. 252). This departs from a perceived moral backing that underpins violence and empowers the threateners' moral bearing.

The findings, regarding the argumentative tactics and topics used to forge disalignments, add to the literature on Shuy's (1993) notion of a threatener's profile. These tactics – namely, discrediting, blaming and denying via responsibility and blame-shifting, blaming and denying via framing, denying and reversal, and (de)legitimizing – function to gear the evaluative couplings in a morally-backed binary opposition and construction of the primary participants. The evaluative structure of this binary reveals that the patterns of bonds, tabled as basis for disaffiliation with the victims and for morally and attitudinally justifying violence, are

predominantly IM/PROPRIETY-, IN/CAPACITY-, and VALUATION- based. The JUDGEMENT-based bonds (i.e. 'our' PROPRIETY and CAPACITY versus 'their' IMPROPRIETY and INCAPACITY) provide semantic evidence of disalignment by relating the threateners' beliefs to some system of social norms and morality that judges the "social acceptability of the behaviour of human actors" (White, 2011, p. 16). Meanwhile, the APPRECIATION-based bonds (chiefly, the devaluation of victims) provide evidence of acts of disalignments by reference to the value of people, entities and phenomena and whether they are worth violence. Shekau's description of his victims from Nigerian security forces as '*rats*', and of victims abducted and worth selling as '*sheep*', are examples of VALUATION -based acts. Thus, appreciation appears as in a direct link to PROPRIETY, where Shekau, for example, claims that this act of devaluation is religion- and history-based. As such, the most frequent ATTITUDE type-based bonds provide evidence of two predominant features of the threat texts overall: providing a warrant of violence based on the perceived value of the victims; and engaging in a constant discussion of whether the primary participants uphold the necessary ethical power and social esteem (i.e. CAPACITY) and whether the participants comply with social sanction in place. In the former, CAPACITY is "critical to the formation of [strong] social networks" and reflects their feasibility, while social sanctions in the latter present an area that encompasses ideas of "civic duty and religious observances" as well as of desirability to have, for example, a better (e.g. more just) world (Martin & White, 2005, p. 52; Geurts et al., 2016).

Regarding the use of binary attitudinal values for disaffiliative functions, the findings show the repeated construction of three discursive functions: ethical manipulation; deontic retribution; and the boulomaic function. To achieve ethical manipulation, the texts operate by deterring the victims from taking a position or performing an action that is unfavourable to a threatener's ingroup, or by compelling them to (not) act in a way that is (dis)advantageous to the ingroup. This function accords with Muschalik's (2018) and Martínez's (2013) argument that coercive manipulation is a primary function of threats. In deontic retribution, the texts construct threatened acts as a morally justified response to or retaliation for a past event. This function accords with Muschalik's (2018) argument that retribution is a primary function of threat texts but in response to a constructed need for "retributive justice" or "sanitized revenge" (Oldenquist, 1988, p. 468). It is retribution by means of aggressive acts against those who have made 'us' suffer (e.g. Elster, 1990; Fischer,

Haslam & Smith, 2010). Regarding the boulomaic function, the texts show the use of language that serves in expression of a fantasy level of desire (AFFECT) to cause harm, and/or as a symbolic identity-damage to threatened audiences merely because they belong to a different social category. This function implies no compliance. These three discursive, disaffiliative functions of the threat texts provide support to social, discursive psychological research findings on violence and coercive actions (e.g. Tedeschi & Felson, 1994), that threat actions are coercive practices wherein threateners communicate the intention of imposing harm on another person or forcing compliance. In these coercive actions, a threatener expects that their behaviour will either lead to compliance (as in ethical manipulation) or merely harm the threatened audience. The value that the threateners attach to compliance or harm posed against their victims arises from their belief about the causal relationship between the maintenance or protection of their ideological and physical values and that compliance or harm. For example, OBL tends to value the causing of harm to his victims because he believed harm would result in justice, redress the US oppression, or preserve 'honour', where violence is perceived as a rational means of response to wrongdoing and as part of his moral responsibility.

The findings provide support to previous research findings on coercive actions (e.g. Tedeschi & Felson, 1994; Culpeper, 2011), that a threat can force behavioural compliance (as in the ethical manipulation and deontic retribution functions in the dataset) and aim to cause – in Tedeschi and Felson's (1994, p. 171) terms – “damage to the social identity of target persons and a lowering of their power or status” (as in the boulomaic function). A terrorist uses appraisal in a threat text to lower the victims' relative symbolic power (Bourdieu, 1991) and, ultimately, to lift the threateners' symbolic benefits; which benefits – in Culpeper's (2011, p. 227) terms – may lead to material benefits or avoiding material loss in the future.

8.2 Implications

This thesis offers tools for understanding the discursive features of the language of violent extremism and the discursive nature of how terrorists incite violence and threaten their victims. This thesis also proposes semiotic clues, that is, grounds for reasonable suspicion, regarding the violent intentions, agendas, ideological schemas and identities of terrorists, and for establishing suspects' engagement in terrorist activity and terrorism justification. The set

of semiotic clues are applicable for risk contexts, to suspect and characterize terrorist activities and for profiling of text producers. While a feature such as a heightened use of personal pronouns is characteristic of interpersonal texts in general (O’Keeffe, Clancy & Adolphs, 2011), examining a set of features has been found useful in providing discriminatory clues that can characterise terrorist texts. These features include the divisive use of pronouns, the dominant employment of negative emotions and anger words, and the salience in frequency of use of themes such as religion, money, death and achievement. That said, future studies can explore more variables and exhaustive lists of features that characterise terrorist texts. The use of such linguistic resources can provide indications to how some texts foment anxiety, provoke antagonism, and justify drivers and concerns. The statistical results of the categories discussed in this thesis may serve as reference controls for future analyses of terrorist texts, assisting in establishing evidence of engagement in terrorism. In addition, the approach to conceptual burstiness here also adds to the investigatory tools for characterizing terrorist texts, and for retrieving intelligence about the purpose of the use of certain sets of lemmas in terrorist texts, how this repeated use is driven by the discursive functions of these texts – chiefly, causing public intimidation – and the clues related to a terrorist’s ideology, violent intentions, agendas and affiliation. As such, this thesis contributes to research into the possibility of distinguishing terrorist from non-terrorist violent language users, in the same way that previous research (see e.g. Almela et al., 2019; Smith & Shuy, 2002) has used semantic, lexical and psycholinguistic features to distinguish offenders from non-offenders and abusers from non-abusers.

The approach to personal and relational identities here also adds to the tools for empirical exploration of identity as performatively produced or constituted by repeated attitudinal expressions. This thesis also suggests a functionalist stylistics approach be introduced to the protocols of threat assessment where focussing on patterns of judgement and appreciation can indicate that an extremist may potentially be behind a keyboard. By exploring the discursive patterns of authorial identity in a terrorist’s texts, as shown in this thesis, a threat analyst is provided with a diagnostic for characterizing personal and relational identities. This approach has shown that, just as the markedness of “[h]igh frequency lexicon could discriminate the works of authors from each other” (Olsson, 2008, p. 37), repeated attitudinal form-based functional patterns also play a pivotal role as an ideological tool and identity-

marker. The approach demonstrated here emphasizes the value of investigating language on both syntagmatic and paradigmatic axes, with a focus on a functional linguistic account of relevant features. This thesis adds to the limited research attempting to apply, simultaneously, a *system and structure* approach (i.e., paradigmatic and syntagmatic feature-based approach) and *value parameter-based* approach to attitude in terrorist communication.

The findings have emphasized the usefulness of computational analysis for enabling the extraction of clues “from the linguistic “traces” that make up texts” (Longhi, 2021, p. 1). In addition, the findings support Canning’s (2014) contention that examining metafunctional linguistic patterning can offer a robust analytical basis for forensic analyses, in terms of enabling us to describe the interaction between the ideational meaning and interpersonal meaning. The discourse analytical strategy adopted here accords with other studies that have noted the value of discourse analysis to forensic investigation (e.g. Coulthard, Johnson & Wright, 2017).

The discourse analytic approach to the practice of incitement in terrorist texts, as shown in this thesis, provides a useful complementary method to investigative approaches to understanding the ‘destructive messages’ (Tsesis, 2002) of terrorists and the inherent appeal of terrorist organizations to potential followers, an understanding that is crucial for maintaining global peace and stability. This analytic strategy adds to current linguistic tools and methods used in forensic contexts to better understand inciting texts, and to the scarce tools available for examining the moral motivations behind racially and religiously aggravated hate crimes (see also Culpeper, Iganski & Sweiry 2017, for similar argument about this scarcity). The approach in this thesis also enables the provision of evidence on what is usually referred to as indirect or ‘opaque’ incitement (e.g. Jaconelli, 2017, p. 246). While some explanation of the pragmatics of inciting language can be “‘inherently’ fuzzy” outside systemic linguistics (Butler, 1988, p. 87), the adoption of a systemic functional perspective has shown its ability to provide – in Butler’s (1988, p. 97) terms – “a set of principled explanations for the actual use of language in context” and a well-suited basis for pragmatic interpretation of the social, discursive acts of incitement, given that meaning-making choice is a fundamental organising principle and that paradigmatic choice patterns are explicit.

The adopted analytical strategy has the potential to aid in threat assessment by sensitising assessors to the kind of linguistic tactics used in incitement. Specifically, by illuminating the nuances of evaluative semantics, this social semiotic approach also provides an explanation of how a terrorist, towards whom a society may feel disdain, successfully persuades his putative incitees to join a violent course of action to advance a joint cause and action networks – that is, by attending to the incitees’ goals and beliefs, to achieve communal alignment and encourage violence against social groups that are constructed as threats to people of particular identity.

The analytical strategy adopted in the investigation of the threat texts here adds a set of principled explanations for the actual use of language in its threat context. It offers analysts a way of exploring semantic, evaluative patterns, of understanding the key social bonds employed as a basis for a threatener-victim disaffiliation, and of identifying the moral and attitudinal justifications of threatened violence that target particular categories of threatened victims and the discursive functions of a threat text. The evaluative patterns can serve as linguistic evidence of the social action of disaffiliation in threat texts, regardless of the types of threat communicated. This thesis also offers a complementary approach to terrorist threatener-profiling. In addition, the analytical framework provides a tool for the analysis of the purposes of the threatened acts (i.e. whether a threat is goal-, means-, or effect-oriented), which adds to existing investigatory tools that explore the purposes of threats.

8.3 Limitations and future directions

This thesis has a number of limitations, which may serve in steering future directions of research. Firstly, it should be noted that the qualitative analysis undertaken in this paper has chiefly focused on certain patterns in the dataset and thus only a fraction of the discursive features. The research questions necessitated close analysis and thus constrained the size of the data sample. That said, while this qualitative approach to the samples analysed may limit the generalisability of the research findings, this approach is consistent with the social semiotic tradition of investigating language in context, which sheds light on the grammar of a particular register, and the method of development of the approach is consistent with its theoretical foundations. The analytical procedures undertaken, and the features and patterns explored, can add to the tools and features that security and intelligence investigators can

use to better detect and understand terrorist communication. Future research might also use the analytical strategy to expand the examination of the (dis)affiliative function of terrorist discourse, undertaken in this study, to consider threats and inciting acts performed by terrorists from different ideological backgrounds, in order to better understand the practices of incitement and threatening along moral positioning by terrorists from different radical groups. Although I do not claim that the description of the (dis)affiliation tactics identified is exhaustive, nevertheless, I hope that the approach used will provide a useful complementary method to the investigative approaches of intelligence and security organisations, given that understanding the public intimidation of terrorism and the inherent appeal of terrorist organizations to potential followers is crucial for maintaining global peace and stability.

This thesis demonstrated a linguist's social responsibility to deal with applied issues, by attending to the patterns of the language use and the (dis)affiliative functions of evaluative language. Research on how appraisal and affiliation are employed in various language crimes, within and outside terrorism contexts, should continue to be carried out in linguistics. Through a broader understanding of how authors of different sociocultural backgrounds use evaluative language to negotiate relationships, we can continue to illuminate the ways in which the language functions at the interpersonal level. By attending to these functions, researchers can continue to contribute to the discursive pragmatics of appraisal (White, 2011; Zienkowski, 2011) in extremist discourse. Appraisal has "a clear pre-occupation with pragmatic concerns: the functions of actual language use, the role of context and form with respect to the realisation of these functions; and an emphasis on evaluation as an ongoing and intersubjective process" (Zienkowski, 2011, p. 5).

The study of violent discourse as performed within the Appraisal and Affiliation frameworks enables exploration of language use such that: (i) "linguistic phenomena can best be explained by reference to [...] the functional demands placed upon language by its users"; (ii) "systematic analysis of evaluation and stance as they operate in whole texts and in groupings of texts" is feasible; and (iii) these evaluations and stances provide a means by which writers "engage with socially-determined value positions and thereby align and disalign themselves with the social subjects who hold these positions" (White, 2011, p. 14). With this approach, researchers can continue to extend the power of SFL tools into new areas of research for forensic purposes to examine the supporting role of evaluative meanings.

This thesis has advanced the social semiotic project of investigating the language of incitement and threatening. Nevertheless, future researchers may want to modify, refine and renovate the analytical framework as they apply it to data within and beyond terrorist contexts. If we want to understand the co-constructed identities and ideological struggle manifest in the meanings and social values that are contested in discourse, we need systematic ways of accounting for the role of evaluative language in contested, interpersonal meanings, values and relationships – an issue this thesis has contributed to. This thesis has also added to the tools available for unlocking the links between membership categorization, morality, hate, violence, identity, framing, and the “triune act” of stancetaking (i.e. evaluation, dis/alignment, and ideological positioning) (Du Bois, 2007, p. 162) in the context of terrorism. These links emphasise previous arguments in research on the role of context and shared moral values in the choice of evaluative resources (e.g. Kádár, Parvaresh & Ning, 2019), and the role of these resources in offering evaluative values for negotiation and building social networks (e.g. Millar & Hunston, 2015). However, more research is required to explore these links and how they operate in other discourses of violence and language crimes, to yield more useful insights.

Aligned with Halliday and Hasan’s (1985, p. 10) view of text as a product and process, the use of appraisal and affiliation frameworks can help analysts to understand the persuasive power of the terrorist texts, which turns the texts into a site of “centrifugal ideologisation” (Malešević, 2010, p. 9) and a constant process of negotiating social and action affiliations. Insights obtained from the analysis of the language of incitement can be useful for researchers seeking to better understand the linguistic strategies used to encourage acts of terrorism, and the relationship between evaluation, language aggression and radicalisation, in relation to terrorism. The analysis of the incitements texts in this thesis has found that evaluative language can serve in: the diagnostic framing of the world (i.e. identification of who is responsible for the events and who is the source of problems); the motivational framing of violence (i.e. providing rationale and justifications for engaging in violent, social roles); and the prognostic framing of violent actions (that is, articulation of the proposed solution). This framing function of evaluative language can provide useful insights into the enactment of radicalisation towards terrorism (see also Etaywe, 2022b).

In terms of the quantitative (i.e. corpus) analysis in this thesis, while the findings have emphasized the usefulness of computational analysis for identifying insightful patterns and the development of “potential markers of [terrorist] authorial style” (Koppel, Schler & Argamon, 2009, p. 9), future analyses might use tools such as the Automated Linguistic Identification and Assessment System (ALIAS) (see e.g. Chaski & Croghan, 2010) to offer more semantic insights into transnational terrorism and patterned evidence of transnational terrorism. Quantitative, particularly computational, analysts can also operationalize the rich (qualitative) semiotic descriptions used in the analysis here towards richer computational/automated methods. Using stringent protocols is key to enhancing our understanding of terrorist texts, to bolster the global commitment to counterterrorism, to help threat assessors suspect and examine terrorist language, and to help to apply appropriate instruments to extract linguistic patterns that may arise from terrorist communication.

Finally, I hope that my approach to terrorist public statements provides a useful complementary method to the investigative approaches of intelligence and security organisations. More than ever, the need to understand the inherent appeal of terrorist organizations to potential followers, and terrorists’ motivations and justifications, is crucial for maintaining global peace and stability. The use of the Appraisal and the Affiliation frameworks in this thesis has been found to be crucial in implementing finely systematic analysis of prosodic realisations of interpersonal meaning, and in gaining deep understanding of the rhetorical devices a terrorist uses to threaten, incite violence and justify violence. The resources used by these terrorists appear to be influenced by and aim to influence social relations; thus, attending to these interpersonal meaning-making resources is essential, firstly, for successful linguistic contributions to evidence, and secondly, for improving interdisciplinary collaboration in informing the investigatory and intervention protocols that respond to terrorism.

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